ONGO WEIGHT LOSS · BOOK TWO

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Earned, Not Built.

The Zero-to-Hero Off-Page SEO Handbook for Ongo

For every Ongo teammate who has never done SEO, and for every fresher who was told "bas yeh 3 sites pe link bana do" and nothing more.

PREPARED BY

Ashish Osten

Team Lead, Ongo Weight Loss

Edition: October 2026 · Book Two of the Ongo onboarding series

ONGO WEIGHT LOSS · ONBOARDING SERIES

Earned, Not Built

The Zero-to-Hero Off-Page SEO Handbook for Ongo

Book Two of the Ongo onboarding series

Prepared by	Ashish Osten, Team Lead, Ongo Weight Loss
Edition	October 2026 (first edition)
Written for	Ongo SEO team members, from first day to team lead
Read first	Book One: The Foundation
Inside	48 chapters in 4 levels · 480 practice MCQs · 46 illustrations · checklists, templates, formulas · 261-term glossary · dated sources for every claim

Important

This book is a training guide. It is not medical, legal or regulatory advice. Any health content, claim or outreach that mentions Ongo's treatments goes through Ongo's medical review process before it is published.

Search engine policies, tools and laws change often. Every claim carries a dated source and an evidence label so you can recheck it. When this book and a newer official source disagree, the official source wins.

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ABOUT THIS BOOK

What's inside

> **Before you start:** read **Book One: The Foundation** first. Book One explains what Ongo is, who our patients are, what compounded semaglutide and tirzepatide are, and what we are and are not allowed to say. Book Two assumes you know that. Off-page work for a health brand goes wrong fast when you don't.

How every chapter is built

Every chapter follows the same pattern, so a newbie always knows where to look.

Part of chapter	What it gives you
Trivia hook	One surprising fact that shows why the topic matters
Plain explanation	The concept in very easy English
Desi analogy (Hinglish)	Rotates between restaurant, IT/SEO office, cricket, wedding, mohalla and more
Ongo example	How the idea applies to ongoweightloss.com specifically
Illustration / chart / table	Simple drawings that make the idea land at a glance
Evidence labels	Source type, success-chance range, risk level
Steps	Exactly what to do, in order
Do's and Don'ts	Quick rules
Pros and Cons	Honest trade-offs
Where freshers go wrong	Common mistake, why it happens, how to avoid it, how to fix it
Thumb rules + Notes to remember	One-line rules to keep
10 MCQs	Answer key at the footer, flipped upside-down in the PDF
Sources	Every claim linked to where it comes from

Front matter

- **A letter to the reader** – why off-page has no syllabus, and why this book is one
- **How to read this book** – levels, labels, boxes, and how to use the MCQs for onboarding
- **The evidence label legend** – how to read source, success and risk labels

LEVEL 1 – FOUNDATION

Goal: understand how search and links work before touching a single backlink.

#	Chapter	What you'll learn
1	**What Is SEO, Really?**	Search engines, the three pillars, YMYL, and why a health site like Ongo is judged more strictly
2	**How Google Works**	Crawling, indexing, ranking and serving, plus AI Overviews and AI Mode in plain words
3	**What Is Off-Page SEO, and Why Freshers Skip It**	Everything that happens outside ongoweightloss.com, and why it decides who wins
4	**The PageRank Story**	How links became "votes," and why a vote from a respected site counts more
5	**How Google's Link Rules Changed: 1998 to October 2026**	PageRank, Penguin, nofollow hints, SpamBrain, site reputation abuse, and the 2026 spam updates
6	**Google's Spam Policies in Plain English**	Link spam, inauthentic mentions, site reputation abuse, expired domain abuse, scaled content abuse, and how they now apply to AI answers too
7	**Anatomy of a Backlink**	Anchor text, source page, target page, placement, context, and rel attributes (follow, nofollow, sponsored, ugc)
8	**What a Backlink Gives You Beyond Rankings**	Referral traffic, faster discovery, brand trust, entity signals, AI citations, partnerships
9	**Metrics 101: DA, PA, DR, UR and Friends**	Every third-party metric explained, why Google doesn't use them, and how to read them together
10	**Your Free Toolkit**	Google Search Console, Bing Webmaster Tools, GA4, and the free versions of Ahrefs, Semrush, Moz and Majestic, with their limits
11	**Reading a Website Without Any Tool**	The eyeball test: judging a site in 2 minutes with only a browser

LEVEL 2 – PRACTITIONER

Goal: create links that actually deliver something, the right way, every time.

Part A – Know what you're building

#	Chapter	What you'll learn
12	**Off-Page Rules for a Health Brand Like Ongo**	Why YMYL changes everything: which sites are safe neighbours, which claims we can never place on another site, and medical review before anything goes live
13	**The Complete Catalog of Backlink Types**	Every link type that exists, with evidence labels, success chances and risk for each

#	Chapter	What you'll learn
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15	**The Two-Axis Grading System**	Relevance Tier 1–3 × Quality Tier Platinum, Gold, Silver, Bronze, Iron, with the scoring checklist
16	**Is This Website Good for a Backlink?**	Vetting with free tools, premium tools and no tools; red flags of link farms, PBNs and link sellers

Part B – Know your market

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20	**Digital PR and Journalist Requests**	Getting quoted and linked by news and health publications
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22	**Broken Link Building and Resource Pages**	Fixing other people's dead links with our content
23	**Unlinked Mentions and Link Reclamation**	Turning existing mentions into links, and recovering lost links
24	**Images and Visual Assets That Get Linked**	Infographics, charts, original photos, and claiming credit for our images
25	**Communities: Reddit, Quora, Forums and Niche Groups**	Real presence in weight-loss communities; why value beats links here
26	**Partnerships, Sponsorships, Testimonials and Associations**	Business relationships that create links, and when to use rel="sponsored"
27	**Podcasts, Interviews, Webinars and Speaking**	Getting Ongo's doctors featured as experts

Part D – Execution and quality control

#	Chapter	What you'll learn
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#	Chapter	What you'll learn
29	**Writing Bios, Descriptions and Submissions That Get Approved**	Easy formulas for every field, and Ongo-safe wording
30	**Cold Email Outreach That Gets Replies**	Finding contacts, personalization, templates, follow-ups, deliverability, and exactly where the line is
31	**The Pre-Creation Checklist**	Everything to check before you create or request a link
32	**After Submission: Live, Under Review, Rejected, Removed**	What to do in each situation, with a decision flowchart

LEVEL 3 – STRATEGIST

Goal: plan, measure, report, and win in local search and AI search.

#	Chapter	What you'll learn
33	**Local SEO Off-Page (USA)**	Google Business Profile, NAP citations, data aggregators, reviews and local links for a telehealth brand
34	**Entity SEO: Making Google Recognize Ongo**	Knowledge Panels, Wikidata, sameAs, and consistent brand information everywhere
35	**Off-Page for AI Search**	How AI Overviews, AI Mode, ChatGPT, Perplexity and Gemini choose what to cite, and what earns mentions
36	**Tracking Ongo's AI Visibility**	Search Console's generative AI report, GA4 referral tracking, manual prompt checks
37	**Social Media and YouTube**	What social signals do and don't do for SEO, and how they still help
38	**Auditing Your Backlinks**	A monthly routine: lost links, changed links, risky links, and when (rarely) to disavow
39	**Measuring Impact**	Connecting a link to rankings, traffic and booked appointments using GSC and GA4
40	**The Google Sheets System**	Sheet setup, owner name column, status dropdowns, scoring formulas, conditional formatting, team rules
41	**Your Best Link: Choosing It and Presenting It to Your Manager**	A 60-second pitch format built on the grading system
42	**Off-Page Priorities: A 90-Day Plan**	What to do first, second and third for Ongo

LEVEL 4 – EXPERT AND RISK

Goal: recognize danger before it costs you, and never make an irreversible mistake.

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44	**Manual Actions and Recovery**	What a Google penalty looks like in Search Console and how recovery works
45	**Negative SEO: Defending Ongo**	When someone attacks your link profile, and what Google says about it
46	**Reading Google Updates**	How to tell whether an algorithm update is about your links or something else
47	**Myths That Waste Years**	Popular beliefs that are wrong or outdated, with evidence
48	**The ZETA Model: Zero-Error Tolerance Approach**	The most damaging fresher mistakes, the warning signs of dangerous situations, and the "stop and ask your team lead" rules

Back matter

- **Glossary** – every term in the book, A to Z, in one line each
- **Master checklists** – pre-creation, post-creation, monthly audit, website vetting
- **Templates** – outreach emails, follow-ups, bios, manager report
- **Google Sheets formula cheat sheet**
- **MCQ answer keys** (flipped in PDF)
- **Sources index** – every source used, by chapter

What's in this edition

Level	Chapters	Pages (approx.)
Level 1 – Foundation	11	~100
Level 2 – Practitioner	21	~150
Level 3 – Strategist	10	~70
Level 4 – Expert and Risk	6	~40
Back matter: checklists, templates, formulas, 261-term glossary, all answer keys, sources index	–	~27
Total (with front matter)	**48**	**~395**

One .md file per chapter, with images in an `images/` folder.

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Front Matter

A Letter to the Reader

Welcome to Ongo.

If you are reading this, you are probably new to SEO, or new to off-page SEO, or new to doing it for a health brand. Maybe all three. Good. This book was written for exactly you.

Here is a secret most companies won't tell you: **nobody teaches off-page SEO properly.**

On your first day, someone will sit you at a desk, open a spreadsheet, show you three websites, and say *"bas yeh 3 sites pe link bana do."* You'll do it. You'll do it again tomorrow. Two years later, you'll still be doing the same three things. You'll have built hundreds of links, and you won't be able to explain which one actually helped.

On-page SEO has a syllabus. Technical SEO has a syllabus. Off-page SEO doesn't. It has no boundaries, no fixed list of tasks, and no textbook. It is a way of thinking: **who would trust us, why would they mention us, and how do we earn that mention honestly?**

This book is that missing syllabus.

It will teach you:

- How Google and AI search actually decide who to trust
- Which links help, which do nothing, and which can hurt
- How to judge any website in two minutes, with or without tools
- How to earn links instead of begging for them
- How to track everything in Google Sheets so your work is visible
- How to choose your best link and present it to your manager with confidence
- How to never make a mistake that costs Ongo its rankings

And it does this for **Ongo specifically**: a US telehealth weight-loss brand in one of the most strictly judged categories on the internet. What works for a pizza blog can get a health brand into trouble. You'll learn the difference.

One promise: every important claim in this book comes with a source and a label telling you how strong the evidence is. No "trust me, bro." No 2012 tricks. Only what works in **October 2026**.

Let's begin.

How to Read This Book

The four levels

Level	Who it's for	What you can do after
Level 1 – Foundation	Day 1 freshers	Explain how Google and links work

Level	Who it's for	What you can do after
Level 2 – Practitioner	Anyone creating links	Earn, vet and track quality links safely
Level 3 – Strategist	After 2–3 months of practice	Plan, audit, measure and report
Level 4 – Expert and Risk	Everyone, eventually	Spot danger and avoid irreversible mistakes

Rule: don't skip Level 1. Freshers who skip foundations build links fast and break things faster.

The boxes you'll see

> 💡 **Trivia** – a surprising fact to show why the topic matters.
>
> 🍛 **Desi analogy** – the idea explained in Hinglish with an everyday example.
>
> 🟧 **Ongo example** – how the idea applies to ongoweightloss.com.
>
> ⚠️ **Where freshers go wrong** – the common mistake, why it happens, how to avoid it, how to fix it.
>
> 👍 **Thumb rule** – one line to remember forever.
>
> 📝 **Note to remember** – something easy to forget that matters.

Using the MCQs for onboarding

Every chapter ends with **10 multiple-choice questions**. The answer key sits in the chapter footer, printed **upside-down** in the PDF, so the reader can't glance at it by accident.

For team leads: a fresher should score **8 out of 10 or better** on every Level 1 chapter before creating a single live link.

The Evidence Label Legend

Every important claim or tactic carries a label. Learn these once; you'll see them everywhere.

Source labels: where the claim comes from

Label	Meaning	Example
🟢 **Google official**	Written in Google's own documentation, policies or official blog	Google Search Central docs, spam policies
🟡 **Google spokesperson**	Said publicly by a Google employee, but not in official documentation	Statements by John Mueller, Gary Illyes, Danny Sullivan
🟠 **Industry data**	Not confirmed by Google, but backed by studies, tool data, patents or reliable reporting	StatCounter, Ahrefs studies, Search Engine Land reports
🔵 **Expert judgment**	No published data exists; this is reasoned professional judgment	"This works well for health brands in our experience"

Success chance: how likely it is to work

Shown as a range, for example **Success: 40–60%**.

- It means: *if you do this well, how often does it produce the result?*
- It is **always an estimate.** Google publishes no success rates for any tactic.
- The label next to it tells you whether the estimate is based on industry data 🟠 or expert judgment 🔵.

Risk level: what can go wrong

Risk	Meaning
Low	Worst case, you waste some time
Medium	Worst case, the link is ignored, removed, or wastes real budget
High	Worst case, Ongo gets a penalty, loses rankings, or damages its reputation

> 📝 **Note to remember:** a High-risk tactic stays High-risk even if it "worked for someone." Survivors tell stories. Penalized sites go quiet.

How the Answer Keys Work

In this Markdown version, answer keys look normal. In the PDF, they appear upside-down. The flip is done with this code, which you'll see at the bottom of each chapter:

```
<div markdown="1" class="flip-answer" style="transform: rotate(180deg); display: inline-block;">
  Answers: 1-B · 2-C · 3-A ...
</div>
```

You don't need to understand the code. Just don't delete it when editing.

01

LEVEL 1

Foundation

Understand how search and links work before touching a single backlink.

1 · What Is SEO, Really?

2 · How Google Works

3 · What Is Off-Page SEO, and Why Freshers Skip It

4 · The PageRank Story

5 · How Google's Link Rules Changed, 1998 to October 2026

6 · Google's Spam Policies in Plain English

7 · Anatomy of a Backlink

8 · What a Backlink Gives You Beyond Rankings

9 · Metrics 101: DA, PA, DR, UR and Friends

10 · Your Free Toolkit

11 · Reading a Website Without Any Tool

LEVEL 1 · CHAPTER 1

Chapter 1: What Is SEO, Really?

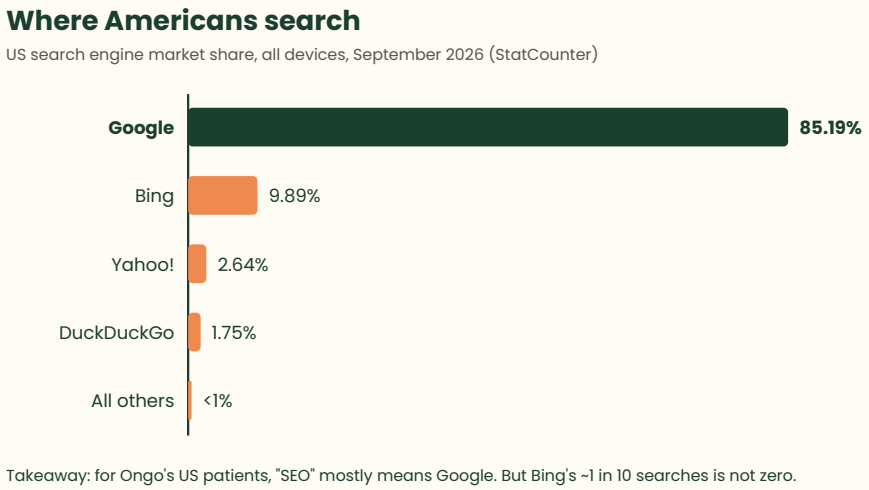
Before you build a single link, you need to know what you're building it for.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> Google handles **more than 5 trillion searches a year**. That's roughly 14 billion every single day. Google shared this figure in early 2025, the first time it had updated the number since 2016, when it was "at least 2 trillion." [5]
>
> Somewhere in those 14 billion daily searches, people are typing *"semaglutide online," "tirzepatide cost,"* and *"weight loss doctor near me."* SEO decides whether they find Ongo or someone else.

1.1 What is a search engine?

A **search engine** is a website that finds answers on the internet for you. You type a question; it shows you a list of pages that might answer it.

The biggest search engines in the US today:



Source: StatCounter, September 2026 [6] · ● Industry data

In September 2026, Google handled about **85 out of every 100 searches** in the United States. Bing handled about 10. Everyone else shared the rest. [6]

So for Ongo, which serves US patients, "SEO" mostly means **"getting found on Google."** That's why this book talks about Google most of the time.

📝 **Note to remember:** Bing's share is small but not zero. Most of what works on Google also works on Bing, so you don't need a separate strategy.

1.2 What is SEO?

SEO stands for **Search Engine Optimization**.

Google's own definition, in simple words: SEO is about **helping search engines understand your content**, and **helping people find your site** and decide whether to visit it. [1] 🟢 Google official

Break that into two halves:

Half	What it means	Ongo example
Help Google understand	Make it clear what each page is about	Google knows our compounded semaglutide page is about a doctor-prescribed weight-loss treatment
Help people decide	Make our result look trustworthy and useful in search	A patient sees our result and thinks, "This looks legit, let me check"

> 🍛 **Desi analogy: the new restaurant**
>
> Socho tumne ek naya restaurant khola hai. Khana zabardast hai. Lekin gali ke andar hai, board chhota hai, aur kisi ko pata hi nahi.
>
> **SEO ka kaam hai:** board saaf karna taaki log samjhein yahan kya milta hai, rasta aasaan karna taaki log pahunch sakein, aur shehar mein naam banana taaki log khud bolein, *"bhai, wahan jaake khao."*
>
> Accha khana zaroori hai. Lekin sirf accha khana kaafi nahi hai, agar koi aata hi nahi.

What SEO is NOT

Google is very direct about this: there are **no secrets that will automatically rank your site first**. [1] 🟢 Google official

So whenever someone says:

- *"Guaranteed #1 ranking in 30 days"*
- *"Secret Google trick"*
- *"500 backlinks for $50"*

...you now know, from Google's own words, that it's not real.

👍 **Thumb rule:** If an SEO offer sounds like a lottery ticket, it's a scam.

1.3 Organic results vs paid ads

When you search on Google, you see two kinds of results:

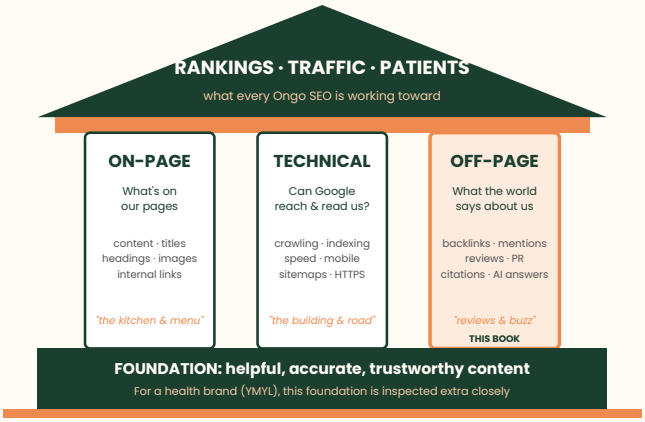
	Paid (ads)	Organic (SEO)
How you get there	You pay Google per click	You earn it with quality and trust
Label	Marked "Sponsored"	No label
When you stop paying	Traffic stops immediately	Traffic keeps coming
Speed	Instant	Slow: weeks to months
Cost over time	Keeps costing	Mostly time and effort
Trust from users	Many people skip ads	Many people trust organic more 🔵

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: rent vs apna ghar**
>
> **Ads = kiraye ka ghar.** Jab tak kiraya doge, rehne milega. Kiraya band, ghar khatam.
>
> **SEO = apna ghar banana.** Time lagta hai, mehnat lagti hai, EMI jaisa lagta hai shuru mein. Lekin ek baar ban gaya, toh tumhara hai.
>
> Smart businesses dono karte hain. But apna ghar kabhi nahi chhodte.
>
> 🟧 **Ongo example**
>
> Google Ads restricts ads for online prescribing of prescription drugs, and in the US, telemedicine providers need a recognized certification (such as LegitScript) before they can advertise those services. [8] 🟢 Google official
>
> That makes organic search especially valuable for a brand like Ongo. It's the channel we fully earn, and it doesn't depend on ad approvals. 🔵 Expert judgment

1.4 The three pillars of SEO

Most SEO professionals divide SEO into three pillars. This split is an industry convention, not a Google term, but Google's documentation covers all three areas. 🟠 Industry framing

The SEO House: Three Pillars, One Foundation



Break any one pillar and the roof tilts. No pillar can stand on a cracked foundation.

Pillar	Simple question it answers	Examples	Where it happens
On-page SEO	Is each page useful and clear?	Content, titles, headings, images, internal links	On our website
Technical SEO	Can Google reach and read our site?	Crawling, indexing, speed, mobile, sitemaps	On our website's code and server
Off-page SEO	Does the rest of the world trust us?	Backlinks, brand mentions, reviews, PR, citations	**Outside** our website

> 🍛 **Desi analogy: restaurant ke teen pillar**
>
> - **On-page = kitchen aur menu.** Khana kaisa hai, menu saaf hai ya nahi.
> - **Technical = building aur sadak.** Darwaza khulta hai? Rasta theek hai? Light hai?
> - **Off-page = reviews aur word of mouth.** Food critic ne kya likha? Log dosto ko kya bolte hain?
>
> Zabardast kitchen, lekin darwaza band hai? Koi nahi aayega. Shaandaar building, lekin khana bekaar? Log ek baar aayenge, dobara nahi. Khana accha, building acchi, lekin kisi ko pata nahi? Restaurant khaali.

Why all three must work together

Situation	What happens
Great off-page, weak on-page	Links bring visitors to a page that disappoints them. Rankings don't hold.
Great on-page, broken technical	Google can't read the page. The best content in the world stays invisible.
Great on-page + technical, no off-page	Google can read it, but has little evidence anyone trusts it. In competitive topics, you stay on page 3.
All three strong	This is how sites reach page 1 and stay there.

Table: 🔵 Expert judgment, consistent with Google's guidance that content quality, technical access and links all play a role. [1][4]

> 📝 **Note to remember:** This book is about the third pillar. But never forget: off-page amplifies what's already there. It can't fix a bad page.

1.5 How important are links, really?

Links are how Google discovers most new pages. Google says it **primarily finds pages through links** from pages it has already crawled, and that in many cases these are links from other websites. [1] 🟢 Google official

Links also help rank pages. Google lists **"link analysis systems and PageRank"** among its ranking systems, and says PageRank is still part of its core ranking systems, though it has changed a lot since Google launched. [4] 🟢 Google official

But Google also warns against obsessing over it: PageRank is **one of many ranking signals**, and there is much more to Search than just links. [1] 🟢 Google official

> 🍛 **Desi analogy: cricket selection**
>
> Selectors kisi player ko sirf ek cheez dekh ke nahi chunte. Runs dekhte hain, fitness dekhte hain, form dekhte hain, aur senior players kya bolte hain, woh bhi sunte hain.
>
> **Backlinks = senior players ki recommendation.** Bahut kaam ki cheez hai. Lekin agar player ka khud ka form kharab hai, toh recommendation se zyada din team mein nahi tikega.
>
> 👍 **Thumb rule:** Links are a strong signal, not the only signal. Treat them like recommendations, not magic.

1.6 YMYL: why Ongo is judged more strictly

This is the single most important idea in Chapter 1 for anyone working on Ongo.

Google gives **even more weight** to signals of trust for topics that could significantly affect a person's **health, financial stability, or safety**. Google calls these topics **"Your Money or Your Life,"** or **YMYL**. [2] 🟢 Google official

For YMYL topics, Google says the content must be **highly accurate** and consistent with **established expert consensus**. [2] 🟢 Google official



The more a page can hurt someone, the more proof of trust Google wants: from the page, and from the sites that mention it.

Ongo helps people access prescription weight-loss medication. A wrong answer on our pages can hurt someone's health. **Ongo is YMYL, at the strictest end of the scale.**

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: rishta ki enquiry**
>
> Jab koi sabzi wale se dhaniya leta hai, koi background check nahi karta.
>
> Lekin jab shaadi ka rishta aata hai? Poora khandaan enquiry karta hai. *"Ladka kya karta hai? Kahan kaam karta hai? Log kya bolte hain uske baare mein? Kaun jaanta hai unki family ko?"*
>
> **Google health websites ke saath rishta wali enquiry karta hai.** Sirf tum kya bolte ho, woh nahi. Duniya tumhare baare mein kya bolti hai, woh bhi.

What this means for off-page work

For a normal website	For Ongo (YMYL)
A link from any decent blog is fine	The linking site's own trust matters much more
Casual guest posts are low risk	Every word we place on another site must be medically accurate
Exaggerated claims are bad marketing	Exaggerated health claims can be dangerous and can create legal problems
A spammy neighbour is embarrassing	A spammy neighbour damages trust in a category where trust is everything

> 🟧 **Ongo example**
>
> Imagine a fresher places a guest post on a fitness blog that says *"Lose 30 pounds in a month with compounded semaglutide, guaranteed!"* with a link to Ongo.
>
> The link might count. But the claim is inaccurate, promises an outcome, and blurs the difference between compounded and FDA-approved medication, which Book One explained. That one link can create more risk than a hundred good links create value. **This is why every piece of off-page content about Ongo's treatments goes through medical review first.** You'll learn the exact process in Chapter 12.

1.7 E-E-A-T: the four letters everyone misunderstands

You'll hear SEO people say "E-E-A-T" all the time. It stands for:

Letter	Meaning	Ongo example
E	**Experience**: first-hand experience with the topic	A patient-care team that talks to patients every week
E	**Expertise**: real knowledge or qualifications	Board-certified doctors reviewing content
A	**Authoritativeness**: recognized as a go-to source	Health publications quoting our doctors
T	**Trustworthiness**: accurate, honest, safe	Clear pricing, clear risks, clear policies

Two facts from Google that most freshers get wrong:

1. **Trust is the most important** of the four. The others feed into trust. [2] ● Google official
2. **E-E-A-T itself is not a specific ranking factor.** Google uses a *mix of other signals* that help identify content with good E-E-A-T. [1][2] ● Google official

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> Google employs human **quality raters** who check whether search results are good. But raters **cannot change any page's ranking**, and their ratings aren't fed directly into the algorithm. Google itself compares them to **feedback cards a restaurant collects from diners**: useful to know if the kitchen is working, but they don't cook the food. [2] ● Google official
>
> Yes, Google uses the restaurant analogy too.

Where off-page fits into E-E-A-T

Google's own self-check questions for content include whether someone researching the site would come away thinking it's **well-trusted or widely recognized as an authority** on its topic. [2] ● Google official

How does anyone research a site's reputation? By looking at what **other people** say about it: reviews, news mentions, links from respected sites, discussions in communities. **That's off-page SEO.**

> 👍 **Thumb rule:** On-page says "trust me." Off-page is the world saying "you can trust them."

1.8 SEO in the AI era

In 2026, many people don't just see a list of blue links. They see **AI Overviews** at the top of Google, or chat with **AI Mode**. Some use ChatGPT, Perplexity or Gemini instead of Google.

Freshers often ask: *"Is SEO dead? Do we need something new like GEO or AEO?"*

Google's answer, from its official guide: **SEO best practices still apply** to its AI features, because those features are **rooted in Google's core ranking and quality systems**. From Google's point of view, optimizing for AI search is still SEO. [3] 🟢 Google official

Google also lists things you **don't** need to do for its AI features: [3] 🟢 Google official

Myth	What Google says
"Create an llms.txt file"	Google Search doesn't use it. It neither helps nor hurts in Google.
"Chunk content into tiny pieces for AI"	Not required
"Rewrite everything in a special AI style"	Not needed
"Get lots of mentions anywhere"	Seeking **inauthentic mentions** isn't as helpful as it seems; Google's spam systems apply to AI features too
"Special schema for AI"	Not required

📝 **Note to remember:** That fourth row matters for this whole book. **Fake mentions, planted reviews and spammy "AI visibility" tricks are not a shortcut.** Real mentions from real, trusted places are what count, in classic search and in AI answers alike.

🍛 **Desi analogy: naya waiter, wahi kitchen**

Restaurant ne naya waiter rakha hai jo menu padh ke customer ko summary sunata hai. (Yeh AI Overview hai.)

Lekin waiter wahi dishes recommend karega jo kitchen mein achhi bani hain aur jinke baare mein log acchi baatein karte hain. **Kitchen aur reputation wahi hai. Bas parosne ka tareeka badla hai.**

1.9 How long does SEO take?

Google says some changes take effect in **a few hours**, others take **several months**. It suggests waiting **a few weeks** before judging whether a change worked. [1] 🟢 Google official

For off-page work specifically, expect slower results:

Activity	When you might notice effect	Evidence
A page change Google re-crawls	Days to weeks	🟢 Google official [1]
A single new backlink	Weeks to months, often not individually visible	🔵 Expert judgment
A steady off-page program	3–6 months for clear trends	🔵 Expert judgment
Brand reputation in a YMYL niche	6–12+ months	🔵 Expert judgment

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: Test match, T20 nahi**
>
> Off-page SEO **Test cricket** hai. Pehle din koi result nahi aata. Session by session, din by din, pressure banta hai. Jo khilaadi T20 wali jaldi mein Test khelta hai, woh jaldi out hota hai.
>
> ⚠️ **Where freshers go wrong: expecting instant results**
>
> - **The mistake:** Building a link on Monday, checking rankings on Wednesday, deciding "links don't work."
> - **Why it happens:** Every other task in the office shows results the same day.
> - **How to avoid it:** Record every link with its date in the team sheet (Chapter 40). Review impact monthly, not daily.
> - **How to fix it:** If you already judged too fast, go back to your links from 2–3 months ago and check them against Search Console data.

1.10 Things Google says not to worry about

Google's SEO Starter Guide includes a list of popular ideas it says people **shouldn't focus on**. Knowing these saves you years of wasted effort. [1] ● Google official

Popular belief	Google's position
Meta keywords tag matters	Google Search doesn't use it
Repeating keywords many times helps	Keyword stuffing is against spam policies
Keywords in the domain name help a lot	Hardly any effect on ranking
There's a perfect word count	Content length alone doesn't matter
Duplicate content causes a penalty	It's inefficient, not penalized (copying *others* is a different story)
E-E-A-T is a ranking factor	No, it's not
PageRank (links) is everything	One signal among many

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> Google's SEO Starter Guide has been around since the PDF era. In 2024, Google gave it a "makeover," cutting it down for beginners and adding the section on ideas people shouldn't focus on. [7]

1.11 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Learn all three pillars, even if you only work on off-page	Think off-page can rescue a bad page

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Treat Ongo as YMYL in every task	Write or approve health claims yourself
Check what Google officially says before believing a tactic	Believe "guaranteed #1" offers
Give SEO work weeks to months to show results	Judge a link after two days
Focus on real trust and real mentions	Chase fake mentions for "AI visibility"
Use Google's own documentation as your first source	Treat SEO tool scores as Google's opinion

1.12 Pros and cons of SEO as a channel

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
Traffic keeps coming without paying per click	Slow to build
Users often trust organic results	No guarantees, ever
Builds long-term brand trust	Google updates can shift rankings
Works across Google, Bing and AI answers	Requires patience and consistent effort
Not dependent on ad platform approvals	Results are hard to attribute to a single task

1.13 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 1 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Skipping straight to building links	Link building looks like "real work"	Finishing Level 1 first	Re-reading Chapters 1–3 before the next link
Treating Ongo like any other niche	Previous job was in a low-risk niche	Remembering the YMYL meter	Running past content through medical review
Believing SEO tool scores are Google's	Tools look official	Remembering DA/DR are third-party (Chapter 9)	Checking Google's docs for any claim
Thinking AI search needs "new tricks"	Lots of noise online about GEO	Reading Google's AI optimization guide	Dropping any tactic Google says it ignores

1.14 Thumb rules

👍 Off-page amplifies what's there. It can't create quality that doesn't exist.

👍 For Ongo, every claim on another website must be one our doctors would sign.

👍 If Google officially says "we don't use it," stop spending time on it.

👍 SEO is a Test match. Plan for months, not days.

1.15 Notes to remember

📝 SEO = helping Google understand us + helping people choose us.

📝 Three pillars: on-page, technical, off-page. This book is pillar three.

📝 YMYL means health topics get the strictest trust checks.

📝 E-E-A-T is not a ranking factor itself, and trust is its most important part.

📝 Google's AI features run on the same core systems as regular search.

Chapter 1 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Search engine	A website that finds pages answering your question
SEO	Search Engine Optimization: helping search engines understand you and people find you
Organic results	Unpaid search results, earned through SEO
Paid results / ads	Results a business pays for, marked "Sponsored"
On-page SEO	Improving what's on your own pages
Technical SEO	Making sure search engines can reach and read your site
Off-page SEO	Building trust and visibility outside your website
Backlink	A link from another website to yours
PageRank	Google's original link-based ranking system, still part of its core systems
YMYL	"Your Money or Your Life": topics that can affect health, money or safety
E-E-A-T	Experience, Expertise, Authoritativeness, Trustworthiness
Quality raters	People who give Google feedback on search quality; they don't change rankings

Term	Simple meaning
AI Overviews / AI Mode	Google's AI-generated answers in Search
GEO / AEO	Industry terms for optimizing for AI answers; Google says this is still SEO

Chapter 1 Quiz

1. According to Google, what is SEO about?

- A) Buying ads on Google
- B) Getting as many backlinks as possible
- C) Helping search engines understand your content and helping people find your site
- D) Using secret tricks to rank first

2. About what share of US searches did Google handle in September 2026?

- A) About 65%
- B) About 99%
- C) About 85%
- D) About 50%

3. Which pillar of SEO is this book about?

- A) Paid ads
- B) Technical
- C) Off-page
- D) On-page

4. What does YMYL stand for?

- A) Your Market, Your Leads
- B) Your Mentions, Your Links
- C) Your Money or Your Life
- D) Your Medicine, Your Lifestyle

5. Why is Ongo judged more strictly than a recipe blog?

- A) Because Ongo is a new website
- B) Because health topics can significantly affect people's well-being
- C) Because Ongo has more pages
- D) Because Ongo uses a .com domain

6. Is E-E-A-T a specific ranking factor, according to Google?

- A) No; Google uses a mix of other signals that identify good E-E-A-T
- B) Yes, but only for health sites
- C) Yes, the most important one

- D) No, and Google ignores trust completely

7. Which part of E-E-A-T does Google call the most important?

- A) Expertise
- B) Trust
- C) Experience
- D) Authoritativeness

8. What does Google say about optimizing for its AI features like AI Overviews?

- A) SEO no longer matters; you need GEO instead
- B) Only structured data matters
- C) SEO best practices still apply, because the AI features are rooted in core ranking systems
- D) You must create an llms.txt file

9. How long does Google suggest waiting before judging whether an SEO change worked?

- A) One day
- B) A few minutes
- C) A few weeks
- D) Exactly one year

10. A fresher writes "Lose 30 pounds in a month, guaranteed!" in a guest post linking to Ongo. What's the main problem?

- A) The post is too short
- B) The anchor text is wrong
- C) Guest posts are always banned
- D) It's an inaccurate, outcome-promising health claim on a YMYL topic that skipped medical review

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Answer key, Chapter 1: 1-C · 2-C · 3-C · 4-C · 5-B · 6-A · 7-B · 8-C · 9-C · 10-D

LEVEL 1 · CHAPTER 2

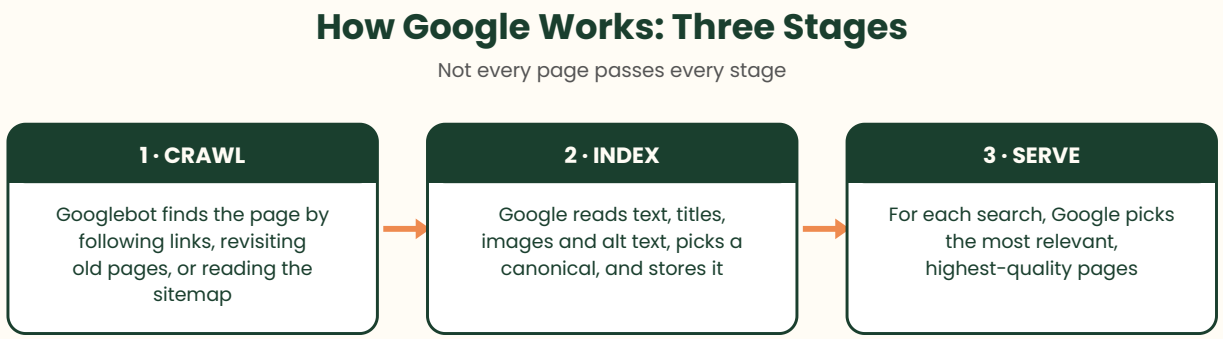
Chapter 2: How Google Works

You can't earn Google's trust if you don't know how Google meets your website in the first place.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> There is **no central register of web pages** anywhere in the world. Google has to keep discovering pages on its own, mostly by following links from pages it already knows. [1] ● Google official
>
> In other words: if nobody links to a page, Google may simply never find it. Links aren't just a ranking thing. They are the roads Google travels on.

2.1 The three stages

Google Search works in three stages. Not every page gets through all three. [1] ● Google official



Links help twice: they help Google FIND our pages (crawl) and JUDGE them (serve).

Stage	What happens	Simple question
1. Crawling	Google's robot (Googlebot) finds and downloads pages	"Does Google know this page exists?"
2. Indexing	Google reads and understands the page, then stores it	"Does Google understand what this page is about?"
3. Serving	When someone searches, Google picks the best pages to show	"Is this page the best answer for this search?"

> 🍛 **Desi analogy: shaadi ka caterer dhoondhna**
>
> 1. **Crawling = naam pata chalna.** Mausi ne bataya, padosi ne bataya, Instagram pe dekha. Pehle naam pata chalna chahiye.
> 2. **Indexing = diary mein likhna.** "Sharma Caterers: veg, Punjabi, 500 log tak, Model Town." Ab family ko pata hai woh kya karte hain.
> 3. **Serving = sahi time pe chunna.** Jab shaadi aati hai aur zaroorat hai "Punjabi veg, 300 log," toh diary mein se sabse bharosemand naam nikalte hain.
>
> **Off-page SEO teeno stage mein kaam aata hai.** Log tumhara naam lete hain (crawling), sahi context mein lete hain (indexing), aur bharose ke saath recommend karte hain (serving).

2.2 Stage 1: Crawling

Crawling means Google's software visits pages and downloads them.

How Google finds pages

Google discovers URLs in three main ways: [1] ● Google official

Way	What it means	Ongo example
Links from known pages	Googlebot follows a link from a page it already knows	A health news site links to Ongo's semaglutide page; Googlebot follows it
Pages it crawled before	Google re-visits pages it already has	Googlebot comes back to check if our pricing page changed
Sitemaps	A file listing the URLs we want Google to know about	Our sitemap lists every service and blog page

> 📝 **Note to remember:** Google says the **vast majority of new pages** it finds every day are found **through links**. [2] ● Google official. Every good backlink is also a discovery path.

What is Googlebot?

Googlebot is the program that crawls the web. People also call it a **crawler**, **bot** or **spider**. It decides which sites to crawl, how often, and how many pages to fetch. It slows down if a server shows errors, so it doesn't overload the site. [1] ● Google official

Googlebot also **renders** pages using a recent version of Chrome, which means it runs JavaScript like a browser does. [1] ● Google official

Why some pages aren't crawled

Reason	Example
Blocked by **robots.txt**	The site told Google not to visit that folder
Needs a **login**	Patient dashboard pages
Server problems	The site was down or very slow
No links and no sitemap	Google doesn't know the page exists

[1] ● Google official

> 🟧 **Ongo example**
>
> Ongo's patient portal (logins, prescriptions, account pages) should **not** be crawled. That's correct and healthy. What we want crawled are the public pages: services, medical team, blog, policies. Off-page work should always point to these public pages.

2.3 Stage 2: Indexing

Indexing means Google tries to understand the page and store it in its giant database, the **Google index**. [1] ● Google official

During indexing, Google looks at: [1] ● Google official

- The **text** on the page
- Important tags like the **title** and image **alt text**
- **Images** and **videos**

Duplicates and canonicals

If several pages look the same, Google groups them and picks one as the **canonical**: the main version it may show in results. [1] ● Google official

> 🍛 **Desi analogy: ek hi aadmi, teen visiting card**
>
> Ek aadmi ke teen visiting card hain: ek mein "Rajesh," ek mein "R. Kumar," ek mein "Rajesh Kumar Ji." Google samajhdaar hai; woh ek card chun ke diary mein likh leta hai. Baaki ko "same person" maan leta hai.

Indexing is not guaranteed

Google says plainly that **indexing is not guaranteed**. Common reasons pages aren't indexed include low-quality content, robots rules that block indexing, and site designs that make indexing hard. [1] ● Google official

⚠️ **Where freshers go wrong: building links to pages that aren't indexed**

- **The mistake:** Building backlinks to an Ongo page that Google hasn't indexed, or that's blocked by a "noindex" rule.
- **Why it happens:** Freshers assume every page on a website is in Google.
- **How to avoid it:** Before pointing links at a page, search `site:ongoweightloss.com/page-url` on Google, or check the page in Search Console's URL Inspection tool.
- **How to fix it:** If you already linked to a non-indexed page, tell your team lead. Either the page needs fixing, or future links should point to a page that is indexed.

2.4 Stage 3: Serving (ranking)

When someone searches, Google returns the pages it judges to be **most relevant** and **highest quality**. [1] ● Google official

Relevance depends on **hundreds of factors**, including the searcher's **location**, **language** and **device**. The same search can show different results in different places. [1] ● Google official

A page can be indexed but **still not show** in results, because it's not relevant to the search, its quality is low, or robots rules block it from being served. [1] ● Google official

Where links fit in serving

Remember from Chapter 1: Google's ranking systems include **link analysis systems and PageRank**, which use how pages link to each other to understand what pages are about and which might be most helpful. [3] ● Google official

So links help in two stages:

Stage	How links help
Crawling	Links help Google **find** our pages
Serving	Links help Google judge **what our pages are about** and **how trusted** they are

---

2.5 Things Google says it will never do

Google states two things very clearly: [1] ● Google official

1. It **does not accept payment** to crawl a site more often or to rank it higher.
2. It **does not guarantee** that any page will be crawled, indexed or shown, even if the site follows all of Google's guidelines.

👍 **Thumb rule:** Anyone who says "I know someone at Google who can boost your ranking" is lying. Google ranks pages with software, not favours.

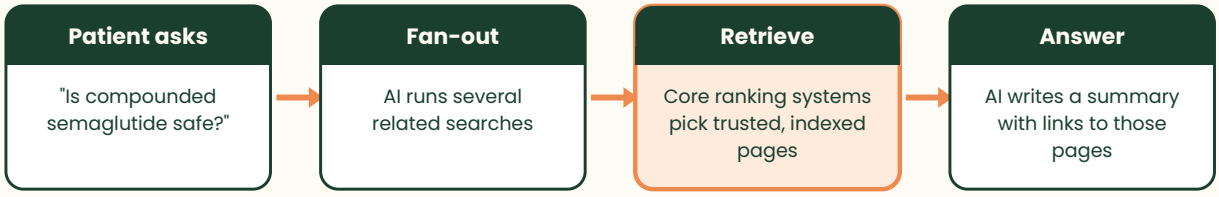
2.6 AI Overviews and AI Mode: where they fit

AI Overviews are AI-written summaries that appear at the top of some Google results. **AI Mode** is a chat-style search experience inside Google.

Google says these features are built on its **core ranking and quality systems**. They use a technique called **retrieval-augmented generation (RAG)**, where Google's ranking systems first find relevant pages from the index, then the AI writes an answer based on those pages and shows links to them. [4] ● Google official

Google also uses **query fan-out**: the AI quietly runs several related searches to gather more information. For example, a question about fixing a weed-filled lawn might fan out into searches about herbicides and natural weed removal. [4] ● Google official

AI Overviews Use the Same Index



No index, no trust, no citation. Off-page trust feeds the pages AI chooses.

To appear in Google's AI features, a page must be **indexed** and **eligible to show in Search with a snippet**. [4] ● Google official

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: dulhe ka bio-data**
>
> AI Overview ek aunty jaisa hai jo poore mohalle se poochh ke ek short summary banati hai: "Ladka engineer hai, family acchi hai, log tareef karte hain."
>
> Lekin aunty sirf unhi logon se poochhti hai jinko woh pehle se jaanti hai (index) aur jin pe bharosa karti hai (ranking). **Agar tumhara naam mohalle mein kisi ko pata hi nahi, toh summary mein tum aaoge hi nahi.**
>
> 🟧 **Ongo example**
>
> A patient asks Google: *"Is compounded semaglutide safe?"* Google's AI fans out into related searches, collects trusted pages from its index, and writes a summary with links.
>
> For Ongo to be one of those links, our page must be indexed, genuinely helpful, and trusted. Off-page work (respected health sites mentioning and linking to us) feeds that trust.

2.7 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Point links only at public, indexed Ongo pages	Build links to login, cart or test pages
Check a page is indexed before building links to it	Assume every page is in Google
Remember that links help Google find us	Think links only matter for ranking
Expect results to vary by location and device	Judge rankings from one search on your own laptop
Treat AI Overviews as part of normal SEO	Chase "AI tricks" Google says it ignores

2.8 Pros and cons of relying on links for discovery

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
Links from trusted sites help Google find new pages fast	Low-quality sites may be crawled rarely, so their links get found slowly
A link brings both discovery and trust	A link to a broken page wastes the discovery
Works even for brand-new pages	Discovery is never guaranteed

- *Expert judgment, based on how Google describes crawling. [1]*

2.9 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 2 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Linking to non-indexed pages	Assuming everything is in Google	Running a `site:` search first	Redirecting future links to an indexed page
Checking rankings only from India	Personal laptop habit	Remembering results vary by location	Using Search Console data, which shows real US users
Building links to URLs with tracking codes	Copying links from ads or emails	Using the clean page URL	Asking the site owner to update the link
Believing paid "Google partners" can boost rankings	Sales pitches	Remembering Google doesn't accept payment for ranking	Reporting the pitch to your team lead

2.10 Thumb rules

👍 No links, no discovery. No discovery, no ranking.

👍 Indexed first, links second.

👍 Google ranks with software, not favours.

2.11 Notes to remember

📝 Three stages: crawl, index, serve.

📝 Most new pages are found through links.

📝 Indexing is never guaranteed.

📝 AI Overviews pick from pages that are already indexed and trusted.

Chapter 2 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Crawling	Google's robot visiting and downloading pages
Googlebot	Google's crawler program
Rendering	Running a page's code (like JavaScript) to see it as a user would
robots.txt	A file that tells crawlers which parts of a site not to visit
Sitemap	A file listing a site's important URLs
Indexing	Google understanding and storing a page
Google index	Google's giant database of known pages
Canonical	The main version Google picks among duplicate pages
Serving	Choosing which pages to show for a search
RAG	Retrieval-augmented generation: AI answers built from pages Google retrieves
Query fan-out	The AI running several related searches to build one answer
site: search	Typing `site:example.com` in Google to see pages it has indexed

Chapter 2 Quiz

1. What are Google's three stages, in order?

- A) Indexing, serving, crawling
- B) Crawling, indexing, serving
- C) Linking, ranking, converting
- D) Ranking, crawling, indexing

2. How does Google discover most new pages?

- A) A central government register
- B) Paid submissions
- C) Website owners emailing Google
- D) Following links from pages it already knows

3. What is Googlebot?

- A) Google's ad system
- B) Google's crawler program
- C) Google's customer support team
- D) A Chrome extension

4. Which Ongo page should NOT be crawled?

- A) The medical team page
- B) A blog article
- C) The compounded semaglutide service page
- D) The patient login dashboard

5. What is a canonical page?

- A) A page blocked by robots.txt
- B) A page written by a doctor
- C) A page with the most backlinks
- D) The main version Google picks among duplicates

6. Is indexing guaranteed if a site follows Google's guidelines?

- A) Yes, always
- B) No, indexing is never guaranteed
- C) Only for paid sites
- D) Yes, for health sites

7. Does Google accept payment to rank a site higher?

- A) No, ranking is done programmatically
- B) Yes, through Google Ads
- C) Yes, for verified businesses

- D) Only for big brands

8. What does "query fan-out" mean in AI Overviews?

- A) Sharing a search on social media
- B) The AI running several related searches to build one answer
- C) Showing ads to more people
- D) Deleting old pages

9. Before building a link to an Ongo page, what should you check first?

- A) Whether the page is indexed by Google
- B) How many images it has
- C) The page's word count
- D) The page's font

10. In which two stages do links help Ongo?

- A) Rendering and deleting
- B) Crawling and serving
- C) Only paid ads
- D) Only indexing

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Answer key, Chapter 2: 1-B · 2-D · 3-B · 4-D · 5-D · 6-B · 7-A · 8-B · 9-A · 10-B

LEVEL 1 · CHAPTER 3

Chapter 3: What Is Off-Page SEO, and Why Freshers Skip It

Everything that happens outside ongoweightloss.com, and why it often decides who wins.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> Google's own SEO Starter Guide says one of the **most effective and lasting** ways to promote a website is plain old **word of mouth**: people who know your site telling their friends about it. [1] 🟢 Google official
>
> The world's most advanced search engine, recommending the world's oldest marketing method. That is off-page SEO in one sentence.

3.1 What is off-page SEO?

Off-page SEO is everything you do **outside your own website** to make search engines and people trust it, find it and talk about it.

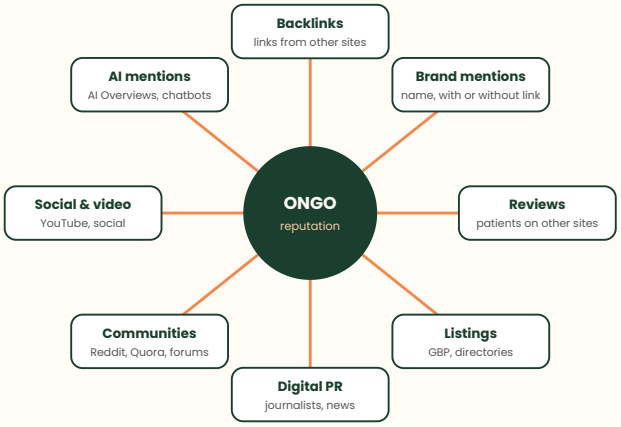
On-page SEO asks	Off-page SEO asks
"Is our page good?"	"Does the world think we're good?"
"What do **we** say about Ongo?"	"What do **others** say about Ongo?"
We control it fully	We can influence it, never fully control it

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: shaadi ka rishta**
>
> Ladke ka bio-data = **on-page.** Khud likha hai: "Engineer, smart, family-oriented, non-smoker."
>
> Rishta wale kya karte hain? Bio-data padhte hain, phir **mohalle mein poochhte hain.** Padosi kya bolte hain? Office wale kya bolte hain? Purane dost kya bolte hain?
>
> **Woh mohalle wali enquiry = off-page SEO.** Bio-data kitna bhi accha ho, agar mohalla kuch aur bole, rishta atak jaata hai.

3.2 Off-page is not just backlinks

Most freshers think off-page = backlinks. Backlinks are the biggest part, but not the only part.

The Off-Page Universe



Backlinks are the biggest planet, not the whole universe.

Off-page signal	What it is	Ongo example	Chapter
Backlinks	Another website linking to us	A health publication links to our semaglutide guide	7, 13
Brand mentions	Our name mentioned, with or without a link	A news article quotes "Ongo Weight Loss"	23
Reviews	What patients say about us on other sites	Patient reviews on Google or Trustpilot	33
Business listings / citations	Our name, address, phone on directories	Our Google Business Profile, healthcare directories	33
Digital PR	Getting covered by journalists	A reporter quotes one of our doctors	20
Community presence	Being genuinely helpful in forums and groups	Answering GLP-1 questions on Reddit or Quora	25
Social and video	Our presence on social platforms and YouTube	Doctor explainer videos on YouTube	37
Entity signals	Google recognizing Ongo as a known "thing"	A consistent brand profile across the web	34
AI mentions	Being cited in AI answers	Appearing as a source in an AI Overview	35

📝 **Note to remember:** Google's starter guide lists **social media**, **community engagement**, **advertising** and **word of mouth** as ways to promote a site. [1] 🟢 Google official. All of these live outside our website.

3.3 Why off-page matters so much for Ongo

Reason 1: Google looks at what others say

Recall from Chapter 1: one of Google's own self-check questions is whether someone **researching your site** would find it **well-trusted or widely recognized as an authority** on its topic. [2] 🟢 Google official

You cannot answer that question with on-page work. It's answered by **other people**.

Reason 2: Links are still part of how Google ranks

Google's ranking systems include **link analysis systems and PageRank**. [3] 🟢 Google official

Reason 3: Health is YMYL

For health topics, Google gives even more weight to trust signals. [2] 🟢 Google official. Ongo competes against well-funded telehealth brands. When two sites have similar on-page quality, reputation is often the tiebreaker. 🔵 Expert judgment

Reason 4: Off-page brings real people, not just rankings

A link on a trusted health site sends **real visitors** who are already interested. A doctor quoted in a news article builds trust **before** a patient even visits Ongo. (Chapter 8 covers all the benefits.)

> 🟧 **Ongo example**
>
> A patient in Texas reads a health article that quotes one of Ongo's doctors on GLP-1 side effects, with a link to our guide. Three things happen at once:
>
> 1. The patient **clicks** and visits (referral traffic).
> 2. Google **finds and trusts** our guide a bit more (link).
> 3. The patient **remembers** the name Ongo (brand).
>
> One placement, three benefits. That's what good off-page looks like.

3.4 Why freshers skip off-page

Reason	What's really going on
No syllabus	On-page has checklists (title, H1, meta). Off-page has no fixed list, so it feels vague.
Slow results	On-page changes can show in days. Off-page takes months.
It depends on other people	You can't force someone to link to you. That feels uncomfortable.
Bad training	"Make links on these 3 sites" teaches a task, not a skill.
Fear of penalties	Freshers hear "links can get you penalized" and avoid the whole topic.
Hard to measure	One link rarely moves rankings visibly on its own.

🔵 *Expert judgment, based on common onboarding patterns in SEO teams.*

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: IT office ka naya fresher**
>
> Naye developer ko pehle din bolte hain: "Yeh 3 bugs fix karo." Woh kar deta hai. Lekin usko kabhi system design nahi sikhaya. Do saal baad bhi woh sirf bugs fix kar raha hai.
>
> Off-page mein bhi wahi hota hai. **Task sikhaya, soch nahi sikhayi.** Yeh book soch sikhati hai.

3.5 The off-page mindset: earn, don't build

The single biggest shift in this book:

Old mindset (2010s)	2026 mindset
"How many links can I build today?"	"Who would genuinely want to mention Ongo, and why?"
Quantity	Quality and relevance
Any site that accepts links	Sites our patients actually read and trust
Exact-match anchor text	Natural, varied, mostly branded anchors
Links are the goal	Trust, traffic and reputation are the goal; links are a result

Why this shift? Because Google's spam policies treat links **created mainly to manipulate rankings** as link spam. [4] 🟢 Google official. A link that only exists because you manufactured it is exactly what Google is trying to ignore or penalize.

> 👍 **Thumb rule:** If you'd be embarrassed to explain to a patient why a link exists, it shouldn't exist.

3.6 What off-page is NOT

Not off-page SEO	Why
Fixing our page titles	That's on-page
Improving site speed	That's technical
Buying followed links	That's link spam [4]
Posting the same comment with a link on 100 blogs	That's link spam [4]
Creating fake reviews	That's deception, and harms trust

3.7 Steps: how to think about any off-page task

Before doing any off-page task, ask these five questions, in order:

1. **Would a real Ongo patient ever see this?** If not, it's probably worthless.
2. **Is this site relevant to weight loss, health or telehealth?** (Chapter 15 grades this.)
3. **Would this site link to us if SEO didn't exist?** If yes, it's an earned link.
4. **Is everything we say there medically accurate and approved?** (Chapter 12.)
5. **Can I record and measure it?** (Chapter 40.)

If you get "no" on question 1 or 4, stop.

3.8 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Think of off-page as reputation, not just links	Treat it as a link-count game
Include mentions, reviews and PR in your work	Ignore anything that isn't a backlink
Ask "why would they mention us?"	Ask "where can I drop a link?"
Be patient: months, not days	Give up after one week
Follow the five questions before every task	Skip medical review for health content

3.9 Pros and cons of off-page SEO

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
Builds trust that competitors can't easily copy	Slow
Brings real visitors, not just rankings	Depends on other people's decisions
Strengthens brand recognition and AI visibility	Hard to measure one task at a time
Long-lasting when done well	Bad off-page can cause penalties

3.10 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 3 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Counting only backlinks as off-page	Narrow training	Using the off-page signal table	Adding mentions and reviews to your weekly report

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Building links on irrelevant sites	Easy approvals	Asking "would a patient see this?"	Not repeating it; log it and move on
Avoiding off-page out of fear	Penalty stories	Learning what's actually risky (Chapters 6, 43)	Starting with low-risk, high-value tasks
Measuring success by link count	Easy to count	Tracking traffic and trust too	Using the grading system (Chapter 15)

3.11 Thumb rules

👍 On-page is what we say. Off-page is what the world says.

👍 Earn, don't build.

👍 One trusted mention beats a hundred forgettable links.

3.12 Notes to remember

📝 Off-page = backlinks + mentions + reviews + PR + community + social + entity + AI mentions.

📝 Google lists word of mouth among the most effective, lasting promotion methods.

📝 Links made mainly to manipulate rankings are link spam.

Chapter 3 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Off-page SEO	Building trust and visibility outside your own website
Brand mention	Your brand name appearing on another site, with or without a link
Citation	Your business name, address and phone listed on another site
Digital PR	Getting covered and quoted by journalists and publications
Referral traffic	Visitors who arrive by clicking a link on another site
Earned link	A link someone gives because your content genuinely helps their readers
Link spam	Links created mainly to manipulate rankings

Term	Simple meaning
Entity	A "thing" Google recognizes, like a brand, person or place

Chapter 3 Quiz

1. What is off-page SEO?

- A) Improving site speed
- B) Everything done outside our website to build trust and visibility
- C) Writing blog posts on our own site
- D) Fixing page titles

2. Which of these is NOT an off-page signal?

- A) A backlink from a health site
- B) A news article mentioning Ongo
- C) Our page's H1 heading
- D) Patient reviews on Google

3. What does Google's starter guide call one of the most effective, lasting ways to promote a site?

- A) Word of mouth
- B) Meta keywords
- C) Buying links
- D) Keyword stuffing

4. Why is off-page especially important for Ongo?

- A) Because health is YMYL and trust signals carry more weight
- B) Because Ongo has few pages
- C) Because off-page is faster than on-page
- D) Because Google ignores on-page for health sites

5. What is the 2026 off-page mindset?

- A) Build as many links as possible
- B) Earn mentions from places patients trust
- C) Use exact-match anchors everywhere
- D) Only use paid links

6. Which of these is link spam according to Google?

- A) Links created mainly to manipulate rankings
- B) A journalist quoting our doctor
- C) A business listing with correct details
- D) A patient sharing our article

7. Why do freshers often skip off-page work?

- A) Google bans it
- B) It's only for big brands
- C) It has no fixed syllabus and results are slow
- D) It doesn't affect rankings

8. What's the first question to ask before any off-page task?

- A) How fast can I finish it?
- B) What's the site's font?
- C) Is it free?
- D) Would a real Ongo patient ever see this?

9. A brand mention without a link is...

- A) Against Google's rules
- B) The same as a paid link
- C) Still an off-page signal worth tracking
- D) Worthless

10. In the shaadi analogy, what represents off-page SEO?

- A) The wedding card
- B) The wedding venue
- C) The mohalla enquiry about the person
- D) The bio-data

Sources

1. Google Search Central, SEO Starter Guide (last updated December 10, 2025)
2. Google Search Central, Creating helpful, reliable, people-first content (last updated October 5, 2026)
3. Google Search Central, A guide to Google Search ranking systems (last updated December 10, 2025)
4. Google Search Central, Spam policies for Google web search (last updated August 28, 2026)

Answer key, Chapter 3: 1-B · 2-C · 3-A · 4-A · 5-B · 6-A · 7-C · 8-D · 9-C · 10-C

LEVEL 1 · CHAPTER 4

Chapter 4: The PageRank Story

How a Stanford research idea turned links into "votes," and why that still shapes your job today.

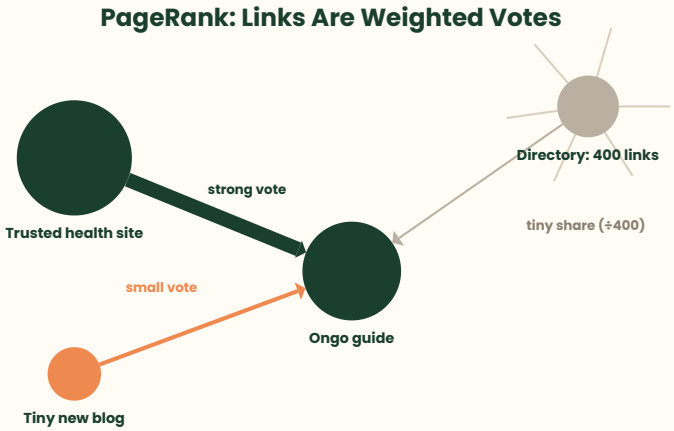
> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> Before it was called Google, the search engine Larry Page and Sergey Brin built at Stanford was called **BackRub**, because it analysed the web's **back links**. Google still links to the original research paper and the PageRank patent from its own documentation. [1] ● Google official
>
> Your job as an off-page SEO started as a university research project in the 1990s.

4.1 The big idea: links are votes

Before Google, most search engines ranked pages mainly by looking at the words on them. Spammers simply repeated keywords to rank.

Page and Brin had a different idea: **a page is important if other important pages link to it.** [2] ● Academic source

This became **PageRank**.



Bigger circle = more important page. Thicker arrow = more value passed.

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: college election**
>
> College election mein har student ka ek vote hai. Lekin socho agar **principal** ka vote 100 ke barabar ho, aur ek naye fresher ka vote 1 ke barabar.
>
> PageRank aisa hi hai. **Har link ek vote hai, lekin har vote ka weight alag hai.** Ek bade, trusted health website ka link, ek nayi random blog ke link se kai guna zyada maayne rakhta hai.
>
> Aur principal agar 500 logon ko vote de de, toh har ek ko milne wala hissa chhota ho jaata hai.

4.2 How PageRank works, in simple steps

You don't need maths. Just these five ideas: [2] ● Academic source

Idea	Simple meaning
1. Every page starts equal	At the start, all pages get the same small score
2. Links pass value	Each page shares part of its score with the pages it links to
3. Important pages pass more	A page with a high score passes more value per link
4. Value is split	A page that links out to 100 pages gives each one a smaller share than a page linking to 5
5. Repeat until stable	The calculation runs over and over until scores settle

The "random surfer"

PageRank is often explained with a **random surfer**: imagine a person clicking links on the web at random, page after page. A page's PageRank is roughly the chance that this person ends up on it. Pages that many important pages link to are visited more often. [2] ● Academic source

The original model also assumes the surfer sometimes gets bored and jumps to a random page instead of clicking a link. This "boredom" factor is called the **damping factor**. ● Academic source

> 🟧 **Ongo example**
>
> Imagine two links to Ongo's tirzepatide guide:
>
> - **Link A:** from a well-known health publication's article, on a page with 5 outbound links.
> - **Link B:** from a "free directory" page listing 400 random websites.
>
> Link A comes from a stronger page and shares its value among only 5 links. Link B comes from a weak page and splits its value 400 ways. **Even in 1998 maths, Link A wins by a mile.** In 2026, Google's spam systems may also ignore Link B entirely. (Chapter 6.)

4.3 What's changed since 1998

PageRank was the beginning, not the end.

Then	Now (2026)
PageRank was the star of ranking	PageRank is **one of many** ranking signals [3] 🟢 Google official
The original formula	Google says PageRank has **evolved a lot** and is still part of its core ranking systems [1] 🟢 Google official
Public PageRank score visible in the Google Toolbar	Toolbar PageRank was removed in 2016, after years without updates [4] 🟠 Industry reporting
Links counted almost equally if they existed	Spam systems like **SpamBrain** detect and neutralize manipulative links [5] 🟢 Google official
More links = more power	Google's Gary Illyes said in 2024 that Google needs **very few links** to rank pages, and has made links less important over the years [6] 🟡 Google spokesperson

> 📝 **Note to remember about that last row:** Illyes later said on X that he "shouldn't have said that," because it was taken out of context. [6] 🟡 The safe reading: **links still matter, but a few great links beat many average ones.** 🔵 Expert judgment

4.4 What happened to the visible PageRank score?

Years ago, a Google Toolbar showed every page's PageRank as a score from 0 to 10. SEOs obsessed over it, and people sold links based on "PR."

Google stopped updating it for years, then confirmed its removal from the toolbar in **March 2016**. [4] 🟠 Industry reporting

There is no public Google score for a website today. Every "authority" number you see (DA, DR, Authority Score) is made by a third-party tool, not by Google. (Chapter 9.)

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: purana CIBIL score**
>
> Socho bank ne kabhi public mein ek score dikhaya tha, phir band kar diya. Ab kuch private companies apna-apna "estimated score" banati hain.
>
> Woh estimates kaam ke hain, lekin **bank ka asli score sirf bank ke paas hai.** Google ka asli score bhi sirf Google ke paas hai.

4.5 Why PageRank still matters for your daily work

Even though the formula changed, its core lessons still guide good off-page work:

PageRank lesson	What it means for your daily work
Links from important pages are worth more	Aim for respected, trusted sites, not just any site
Value is split across outbound links	Pages stuffed with hundreds of links pass little value
Links help Google understand what pages are about	Context and relevance matter (Chapter 7)
It's a network, not a single link	Your link profile as a whole matters

> 👍 **Thumb rule:** Ask "how important is the page linking to us, and how many other links share that page?" before you celebrate a link.

4.6 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Value links from strong, trusted pages	Chase links from pages with hundreds of outbound links
Remember PageRank is one of many signals	Think more links always means better rankings
Look at the specific page linking to us, not just the domain	Judge a link only by the homepage's reputation
Use third-party scores as estimates	Call DA/DR "Google PageRank"

4.7 Pros and cons of the "links as votes" model

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
Rewards sites that others genuinely recommend	Invited link buying and selling for years
Hard for one site to fake trust on its own	Can favour older, established sites
Still a solid way to think about link value	Pure link counting is easy to game, so Google adds spam detection on top

4.8 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 4 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Thinking DA is Google's PageRank	Old blog posts mix them up	Remembering public PageRank ended in 2016	Correcting reports that say "PageRank" for tool scores
Celebrating a link on a page with 300 outbound links	Domain looks strong	Checking the specific page's outbound links	Grading it honestly in the sheet
Believing "more links = more rankings"	2010-era advice	Remembering links are one signal among many	Focusing on fewer, better links

4.9 Thumb rules

👍 A link is a vote. Not all votes are equal.

👍 Important page + few outbound links = valuable vote.

👍 Google's real score is private. Every public score is an estimate.

4.10 Notes to remember

📝 PageRank started at Stanford as "BackRub."

📝 Google says PageRank has evolved a lot and is still part of its core ranking systems.

📝 The public Toolbar PageRank was removed in 2016.

Chapter 4 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
PageRank	Google's link-based system for judging a page's importance
BackRub	The original name of Page and Brin's search project
Random surfer	An imaginary person clicking links at random, used to explain PageRank
Damping factor	The chance the random surfer stops following links and jumps elsewhere
Outbound link	A link from a page to another page
Toolbar PageRank	The old public 0–10 score, removed in 2016
Link equity / "link juice"	Industry slang for the value a link passes

Chapter 4 Quiz

1. What is the core idea of PageRank?

- A) A page is important if other important pages link to it
- B) Pages with more images rank higher
- C) Pages with more words rank higher
- D) Newer pages rank higher

2. What was Google's original project called?

- A) LinkRank
- B) BackRub
- C) WebCount
- D) PageVote

3. A strong page links to 5 sites; a weak page links to 400 sites. Which link is likely worth more?

- A) The link from the strong page with 5 outbound links
- B) They're equal
- C) Neither counts
- D) The link from the weak page

4. Is PageRank still part of Google's core ranking systems?

- A) Only on Bing
- B) Only for news sites
- C) Yes, though it has evolved a lot
- D) No, it was removed in 2016

5. What happened to Toolbar PageRank?

- A) It moved to Search Console
- B) Google removed it in 2016 after years without updates
- C) It became Domain Authority
- D) It's still updated daily

6. Who makes DA, DR and Authority Score?

- A) Third-party SEO tools
- B) Google
- C) Website owners
- D) The US government

7. What did Gary Illyes say in 2024 about links?

- A) Google needs very few links to rank pages
- B) Links matter only for news sites

- C) Links are the only ranking factor
- D) Links are banned

8. What is the "random surfer"?

- A) A spam bot
- B) A Google employee
- C) An imaginary person clicking links at random, used to explain PageRank
- D) A type of backlink

9. In the college election analogy, why does the principal's vote count more?

- A) Because important voters carry more weight, like important pages
- B) Because the principal votes twice
- C) Because there are fewer principals
- D) Because the principal is older

10. Before celebrating a new link, what should you check?

- A) The site's logo colour
- B) Nothing; all links are good
- C) How important the linking page is, and how many other links share it
- D) Only the linking site's homepage

Sources

1. Google Search Central, A guide to Google Search ranking systems (last updated December 10, 2025), which links to the original PageRank research paper and patent
2. Stanford CS54N, The Google PageRank Algorithm (course handout)
3. Google Search Central, SEO Starter Guide (last updated December 10, 2025)
4. Search Engine Watch, Google is killing off PageRank from its Toolbar (March 9, 2016)
5. Google Search Central, Spam updates (last updated December 10, 2025)
6. Search Engine Journal, Google needs very few links to rank pages (April 2024)

Answer key, Chapter 4: 1-A · 2-B · 3-A · 4-C · 5-B · 6-A · 7-A · 8-C · 9-A · 10-C

LEVEL 1 · CHAPTER 5

Chapter 5: How Google's Link Rules Changed, 1998 to October 2026

Every outdated tactic you'll hear about was once "best practice." This chapter shows you when, and why, each one stopped working.

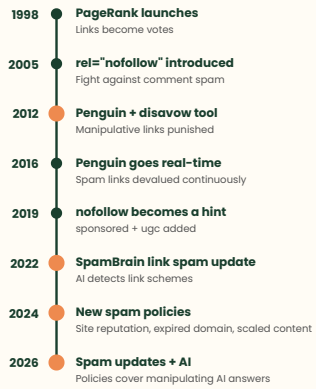
> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> When Google released its first **Penguin** update on April 24, 2012, it affected about **3.1% of English-language search queries**. [1] ● Industry data
>
> That sounds small, until you realise it hit millions of searches overnight, and many businesses that had bought links lost most of their traffic in a single day.

5.1 Why history matters

Freshers are often given advice that was true in 2010, half-true in 2015, and dangerous in 2026. If you know the timeline, you can instantly tell whether a tactic is current or outdated.

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: cricket ke rules**
>
> 1990s mein ek bowler jo kar sakta tha, aaj woh no-ball hai. Agar koi naya bowler purani coaching video dekh ke bowling kare, toh umpire baar baar no-ball dega.
>
> **Purane SEO blogs = purani coaching videos.** Date dekho, phir trust karo.

How Google's Link Rules Changed



Orange dots = turning points every off-page SEO should know.

5.2 The eras of link building

Era 1: The Wild West (1998–2004)

- **1998:** Google launches with PageRank: links are votes. [2] 🟢 Google official
- Links from almost anywhere helped. People quickly learned to manufacture them.

Popular tactics then: link farms, mass directory submissions, link exchanges ("you link me, I link you").

Era 2: The first defences (2005–2011)

- **January 18, 2005:** Google introduces **rel="nofollow"**, backed by other search engines, mainly to stop spammers from posting links in blog comments to boost rankings. [3] 🟠 Industry reporting
- Spammers moved on to article directories, web 2.0 blogs, social bookmarking and paid links.

Popular tactics then: article submission sites, web 2.0 properties, social bookmarking, blog comments with keyword names, paid sidebar links.

> 📝 **Note to remember:** These are the exact "2015 tasks" many companies still give freshers. Most of them now fall under link spam: low-quality directory or bookmark links, forum comments with optimized links, and automated link creation are all listed in Google's spam policies. [4] 🟢 Google official

Era 3: Penguin and the great clean-up (2012–2016)

- **April 24, 2012: Penguin** launches, targeting manipulative link building. It affected about 3.1% of English queries. [1] 🟠
- **October 2012:** Google launches the **disavow links tool**, letting site owners ask Google to ignore specific links. [5] 🟢 Google official
- Several Penguin refreshes followed between 2012 and 2014. Sites hit by Penguin often had to wait for the next refresh to recover. [1] 🟠
- **September 23, 2016: Penguin 4.0** becomes part of Google's core ranking systems and runs in **real time**. It mostly **devalues** spammy links (ignores them) rather than demoting whole sites. [1][6] 🟠 / 🟢
- **March 2016:** Google removes the public **Toolbar PageRank** score. [7] 🟠

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: traffic police ka naya camera**
>
> Pehle traffic police kabhi kabhi checking karti thi (Penguin refresh). Sab log signal todte the, aur checking wale din pakde jaate the.
>
> Phir har chauraahe pe camera lag gaya (Penguin 4.0, real-time). Ab har violation turant record hota hai. **Signal todne ka "safe din" khatam.**

Era 4: Hints and smarter AI (2019–2023)

- **September 10, 2019:** Google adds two new link attributes, **rel="sponsored"** (for paid links) and **rel="ugc"** (for user-generated content), and says nofollow, sponsored and ugc are now treated as **hints** for ranking. [3] 🟠
- **March 1, 2020:** nofollow also becomes a hint for crawling and indexing. [3] 🟠
- **July 2021:** Google runs a **link spam update**. [8] 🟠

- **December 2022:** Google's **link spam update** is the first to publicly use **SpamBrain**, its AI-based spam-prevention system, to detect link manipulation at scale. [9][18] 🟠

Era 5: Reputation, scale and expired domains (2024–2025)

- **March 5, 2024:** Google announces three new spam policies: **scaled content abuse**, **site reputation abuse**, and **expired domain abuse**. [11] 🟠
- **April 2024:** Google's Gary Illyes says Google needs **very few links** to rank pages. [12] 🟡
- **May 2024:** Enforcement of site reputation abuse begins (manual actions). [13] 🟠
- **November 19, 2024:** Google clarifies that site reputation abuse applies **even when the host site oversees** the third-party content. [13] 🟠

Era 6: AI search and spam enforcement (2026)

- **2026:** Google runs spam updates in **March, June, August and September**. [14][15] 🟠
- Google confirmed that the **June** and **August** 2026 spam updates did **not** target link spam or site reputation abuse; those are handled by separate systems. [14][15] 🟠
- **August 28, 2026:** Google updates its site reputation policy; from **August 30, 2026**, manual actions under that policy no longer affect results shown to users in the **European Economic Area**. Nothing changes for the US. [13] 🟠
- Google's spam policies now explicitly include attempts to **manipulate generative AI responses** in Google Search. [4] 🟢 Google official
- Google's AI optimization guide says seeking **inauthentic mentions** across the web isn't as helpful as it seems, because its AI features depend on the same spam-blocking systems. [16] 🟢 Google official

> 🟧 **Ongo example**
>
> Ongo serves **US** patients. The August 2026 EEA change does **not** protect us. If a site we placed content on gets a site reputation manual action, US results are still affected. Always assume the strictest version of every policy.

5.3 The rule that changed everything: lost link value can't be regained

Google's spam updates documentation says that when a **link spam update** removes the effect of spammy links, **any ranking benefit those links gave is lost and cannot be regained**. [10] 🟢 Google official

Content spam	Link spam
Fix the content, and Google's systems may recognise improvement over months	Once Google neutralises the links, their benefit is **gone for good**

> 👍 **Thumb rule:** A bought link is a loan with no repayment plan. One day Google takes it back, and you're left where you would have been without it, minus the money and time.

5.4 What each era teaches you today

Era	Lesson for 2026
Wild West	Easy links were never real trust
First defences	Comment, directory and bookmark links were the first to lose value
Penguin	Manipulation gets caught; sometimes all at once
Hints and SpamBrain	Google's AI looks at patterns, not just individual links
Reputation era	Renting someone else's trust (parasite SEO) is a policy violation
AI search era	Fake mentions and spam don't work for AI answers either

5.5 The "outdated tactic" quick-check table

When someone suggests a tactic, check it here first.

Tactic	Popular in	Status in October 2026	Evidence
Article directory submission	2008–2012	Mostly worthless; can look like link spam	🟢 [4] (low-value content for links)
Web 2.0 blogs made for links	2010–2014	Worthless or risky	🟢 [4]
Social bookmarking for links	2008–2013	Low-quality bookmark links are listed as link spam	🟢 [4]
Blog comments with keyword names	2005–2012	Listed as link spam when optimized	🟢 [4]
Paid followed links	Always	Link spam unless marked sponsored/nofollow	🟢 [4]
Link exchanges at scale	2000s	Excessive exchanges are link spam	🟢 [4]
PBNs (private blog networks)	2012–2018	Black-hat; high risk	🟠 [1]
Sponsored posts on big sites to rank fast	2019–2024	Site reputation abuse risk	🟢 [4]
Buying expired domains to redirect	2015–2024	Expired domain abuse if done to manipulate	🟢 [4]
Planting fake "mentions" for AI	2024–2026	Inauthentic mentions; not helpful	🟢 [16]

Tactic	Popular in	Status in October 2026	Evidence
Earning links with genuinely useful content	Always	**Works**	🟢 [17]

5.6 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Check the date of any SEO advice	Follow a 2014 tutorial in 2026
Use the quick-check table before trying a tactic	Assume "it worked for someone" means it's safe
Treat link spam as unrecoverable	Think you can "undo" bought links later
Watch Google's Search Status Dashboard for updates	Panic at every ranking change

5.7 Pros and cons of today's stricter rules

✅ Pros (for Ongo)	❌ Cons
Competitors can't easily buy their way past us	Honest link earning is slower
Quality work holds value longer	Fewer "easy" opportunities
AI answers favour genuinely trusted sources	Requires better content and real relationships

5.8 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 5 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Doing 2012-era tasks	Old training material	Checking the quick-check table	Stopping and reporting it to your team lead
Thinking nofollow links are useless	Old belief	Remembering nofollow is a hint, and still brings traffic	Valuing nofollow links for traffic and brand
Believing bought links can be "cleaned later"	Hope	Reading the "can't be regained" rule	Not buying them in the first place
Assuming the EEA change helps US sites	Misreading news	Checking where the change applies	Treating all policies as fully active for Ongo

5.9 Thumb rules

👍 Check the date before you trust the advice.

👍 If it was easy in 2010, it's probably spam in 2026.

👍 Link value Google removes never comes back.

5.10 Notes to remember

📝 Penguin 2012 → real-time in 2016.

📝 nofollow 2005; sponsored and ugc added 2019; all are hints.

📝 March 2024: scaled content, site reputation and expired domain abuse policies.

📝 2026: spam policies cover attempts to manipulate AI responses too.

Chapter 5 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Penguin	Google's 2012 system against link spam, part of core since 2016
Real-time	Evaluated continuously instead of in occasional refreshes
Devalue	Ignore a link's value without penalizing the whole site
Disavow	Asking Google to ignore certain links pointing to your site
SpamBrain	Google's AI-based spam-prevention system
Link spam update	A Google update specifically targeting manipulative links
Site reputation abuse	Using a trusted site's reputation to rank low-value third-party content
Expired domain abuse	Buying an old domain to repurpose it mainly for ranking manipulation
Scaled content abuse	Mass-producing low-value pages to manipulate rankings
EEA	European Economic Area

Chapter 5 Quiz

1. When did Google first launch Penguin?

- A) April 2012

- B) 2005
- C) 2009
- D) 2019

2. Why was rel="nofollow" first introduced in 2005?

- A) To speed up websites
- B) To sell ads
- C) To block Googlebot entirely
- D) To fight spam links in places like blog comments

3. What changed with Penguin 4.0 in 2016?

- A) It became real-time, part of core ranking, and mostly devalues spammy links
- B) It only applied to Europe
- C) It started rewarding paid links
- D) It was removed

4. In 2019, Google said nofollow, sponsored and ugc are treated as...

- A) Hints
- B) Penalties
- C) Ranking boosts
- D) Strict commands

5. Which three spam policies were announced in March 2024?

- A) Cloaking, hidden text, keyword stuffing
- B) Page speed, mobile, HTTPS
- C) Scaled content abuse, site reputation abuse, expired domain abuse
- D) Link exchange, nofollow, ugc

6. Once a link spam update neutralizes spammy links, can their ranking benefit be regained?

- A) Yes, after disavowing
- B) Yes, after a reconsideration request
- C) No, Google says it cannot be regained
- D) Only for health sites

7. Does the August 2026 site reputation change (EEA) protect Ongo's US rankings?

- A) Yes, worldwide
- B) No, it only affects results shown in the European Economic Area
- C) Only on Bing
- D) Only for compounded medications

8. Did Google say the June and August 2026 spam updates targeted link spam?

- A) Yes, both did
- B) Only June did

- C) Google never comments on updates
- D) No; Google said they did not target link spam

9. Article directory submission is best described in 2026 as...

- A) The top off-page tactic
- B) Required by Google
- C) Only useful for AI Overviews
- D) Mostly worthless and potentially link spam

10. Do Google's spam policies now cover attempts to manipulate AI responses?

- A) No
- B) Only for news sites
- C) Only in Europe
- D) Yes, they explicitly include generative AI responses in Search

---

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15. TechWyse, Google June 2026 spam update, and Coalition Technologies, September 2026 spam update
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Answer key, Chapter 5: 1-A · 2-D · 3-A · 4-A · 5-C · 6-C · 7-B · 8-D · 9-D · 10-D

LEVEL 1 · CHAPTER 6

Chapter 6: Google's Spam Policies in Plain English

The rulebook nobody reads, until it's too late. Read it now.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> Google's spam policies say sites that violate them **may rank lower or not appear in results at all**. [1] ● Google official
>
> Not "might lose a few positions." **Not appear at all.** For a telehealth brand that depends on patients finding it, that's the business disappearing from Google.

6.1 What Google calls "spam"

Google defines spam as techniques used to **deceive users** or **manipulate Search systems** into ranking content highly. Since 2026, that explicitly includes attempts to manipulate **generative AI responses** in Google Search. [1] ● Google official

Google catches spam in two ways: [1] ● Google official

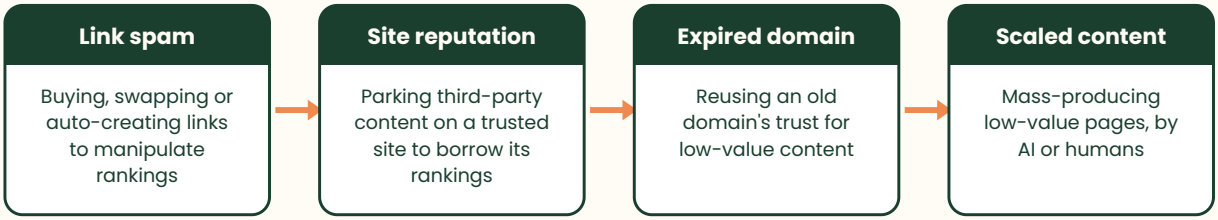
How	What it means
Automated systems	Software like SpamBrain detects patterns automatically
Human review	A Google employee reviews a site and may apply a **manual action** (a penalty you'll see in Search Console)

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: exam hall**
>
> Exam hall mein CCTV camera hai (automated systems) aur ek invigilator bhi ghoom raha hai (human review). Camera pakde ya invigilator, **result wahi hai: paper cancel.**

6.2 The policies that matter most for off-page work

Google lists many spam policies. These four matter most for anyone doing off-page work for Ongo.

Four Spam Policies Every Off-Page SEO Must Know



Plus, in the AI era: inauthentic mentions don't help, and spam rules cover AI answers.

Policy 1: Link spam

Link spam means links created **mainly to manipulate rankings**. Google's own examples: [1] ● Google official

Google's example	What it looks like in real life	Ongo risk
Buying or selling links (money, goods, services, or free products for a link and write-up)	"Pay $150 for a dofollow link on our health blog"	**High**
Excessive link exchanges or partner pages just for cross-linking	"Link to us and we'll link to you" at scale	**High**
Automated programs or services that create links	Software that posts links on 1,000 sites	**High**
Requiring links in terms of service or contracts without letting owners qualify them	"Our widget is free if you keep our link"	Medium
Text ads or text links that pass ranking credit	Paid sidebar links without sponsored/nofollow	**High**
Paid advertorials, native ads, guest posts or press releases with ranking-passing links or optimized anchors	A press release with "best compounded semaglutide" linked	**High**
Low-quality directory or bookmark links	Mass submission to free directories	Medium
Keyword-rich or hidden links in widgets spread across sites	A BMI calculator widget with a hidden keyword link	**High**
Links widely spread in site footers or templates	"Website by..." style footer links across hundreds of sites	Medium
Forum comments with optimized links in the post or signature	Forum signature: "Cheap semaglutide online"	Medium
Low-value content made mainly to manipulate links and rankings	Thin articles written only to hold a link	**High**

The exception: paid links are **not** a violation if they use **rel="nofollow"** or **rel="sponsored"**. [1] ● Google official

📝 **Note to remember:** "Free products for a review with a link" is also listed. Sending free merchandise to a blogger in exchange for a followed link counts as buying a link. [1] 🟢

Policy 2: Site reputation abuse (Google now calls it the "site reputation policy")

This happens when **third-party content** is hosted on a site **mainly to exploit that site's ranking signals**. Third-party content by itself is fine; the problem is using a trusted host to rank content that wouldn't rank on its own merits. [1] 🟢 Google official

Google's own examples include an **educational site hosting sponsored payday loan reviews** and a **medical site hosting a low-quality casino page**. [1] 🟢 Google official

Since **November 2024**, Google says the policy applies **even if the host site oversees or is involved** in the content. [2] 🟠

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: bade hospital ka letterhead**
>
> Socho ek bade hospital ne apna letterhead kisi aur ko kiraye pe de diya. Ab woh aadmi uss letterhead pe kuch bhi likh ke bechta hai. Log hospital ka naam dekh ke bharosa kar lete hain.
>
> **Google yahi pakadta hai.** Kiraye ka letterhead = site reputation abuse. Hospital ka naam bhi kharab hota hai, aur kiraye wale ka bhi.
>
> 🟧 **Ongo example**
>
> A vendor offers: *"We'll publish your 'Best GLP-1 Clinics 2026' article on a big news site's coupon/partner section. Ranks in 48 hours!"*
>
> That's the textbook pattern of site reputation abuse: low-value commercial content parked on a trusted domain to borrow its rankings. **Never accept this, even if it "works" for competitors.**

Policy 3: Expired domain abuse

Buying an **expired domain** and reusing it **mainly to manipulate rankings** with low-value content. Google's examples include **commercial medical products on a former nonprofit medical charity's site**. [1] 🟢 Google official

> 🟧 **Ongo example**
>
> Someone offers you an old domain that "used to be a diabetes charity, DR 55!" and suggests redirecting it to Ongo or filling it with GLP-1 content to link to us. That's very close to Google's own example. **Hard no.**

Policy 4: Scaled content abuse

Generating **many pages mainly to manipulate rankings**, usually with unoriginal, low-value content, **no matter how it's made**: AI, humans, or both. [1] 🟢 Google official. Examples include mass AI pages without added value, scraping, stitching content together, and **creating multiple sites to hide the scale** of the content. [1] 🟢

Why it matters off-page: Some "link building services" run hundreds of thin, AI-written blogs whose only purpose is to sell links. Links from these sites are links from scaled content abuse.

6.3 The AI-era addition: inauthentic mentions

Google's guide to generative AI search says **seeking inauthentic "mentions" across the web isn't as helpful as it might seem**, because Google's AI features depend on both its quality systems and its spam-blocking systems. [3] 🟢 Google official

Inauthentic mentions include things like:

- Fake "best telehealth clinic" listicles you paid for
- Planted forum posts pretending to be patients
- Fake reviews
- Bots or paid accounts "recommending" Ongo on Reddit

> 👍 **Thumb rule:** If a mention would disappear the moment we stopped paying or pretending, it's inauthentic.

6.4 What happens when you break the rules

Consequence	What you'll see	Recoverable?
Links ignored	Nothing visible; your work simply doesn't count	The effort is lost
Link spam update neutralizes links	Rankings drop to where they'd be without those links	Lost link benefit **cannot be regained** [4] 🟢
Manual action	A notice in Search Console's Manual actions report	Possible after cleanup and a reconsideration request (Chapter 44)
Lower rankings or removal	Pages or the whole site vanish from results	Months of work, if at all [1] 🟢

6.5 Ongo's red-flag offers checklist

If anyone offers you any of these, stop and tell your team lead:

Red flag offer	Policy it breaks
"Guaranteed dofollow links on DA 50+ health sites, $X each"	Link spam (buying links)
"Link exchange: we'll both benefit"	Link spam (excessive exchanges)
"We'll post your article on a big news site's partner section"	Site reputation abuse
"Buy this expired medical domain, redirect it to you"	Expired domain abuse
"1,000 AI articles across our 50 blogs, all linking to you"	Scaled content abuse + link spam

Red flag offer	Policy it breaks
"We'll get Ongo recommended in ChatGPT with 500 Reddit posts"	Inauthentic mentions, likely platform rule violations
"Free product for a review with a followed link"	Link spam

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: "bhai, setting ho jayegi"**
>
> Jab koi bole "bhai, setting ho jayegi, paise do, kaam ho jayega," toh samajh lo khatra hai. RTO agent bhi yahi bolta hai, aur jab pakda jaata hai toh licence tumhara cancel hota hai, uska nahi.

6.6 What's allowed

Google's policies don't ban promotion. These are fine:

Allowed	Condition
Sponsorships and paid placements	Links marked **rel="sponsored"** or **nofollow** [1][5] 🟢
Guest articles	Written for the audience, not mainly for links; ideally no optimized anchors (Chapter 21)
Press releases	Links nofollowed; news value is the point (Chapter 20)
Links in forums	Genuinely helpful, not keyword-optimized signatures
Partnerships	Real relationships; paid parts properly marked
Earning links with great content	Always fine

6.7 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Mark any paid link as sponsored or nofollow	Accept a paid followed link, ever
Report red-flag offers to your team lead	Accept "secret" deals from vendors
Assume every policy applies fully to Ongo	Assume a competitor "getting away with it" makes it safe
Keep evidence of how each link was earned (in the sheet)	Hide how a link happened
Check for inauthentic mentions in proposals	Plant fake reviews or patient stories

6.8 Pros and cons of following the rules strictly

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
No risk of penalties or losing link value	Slower growth
Links keep their value through updates	Can feel like competitors are "cheating and winning"
Builds a reputation that also helps in AI answers	Requires more creativity

📝 **Note to remember:** Competitors who cheat are not "winning." They are borrowing. Chapter 5 shows what happens when Google calls in the loan.

6.9 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 6 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Accepting a "free" link that needs a product in return	Doesn't feel like buying	Remembering free products for links are listed	Asking for sponsored/nofollow, or declining
Using keyword-rich anchors in press releases	Old habit	Using brand name or no link	Asking the distributor to change or nofollow it
Signing up for "AI visibility" Reddit services	New trend	Reading the inauthentic mentions section	Cancelling and telling your team lead
Thinking site reputation abuse only affects the host	Misunderstanding	Remembering our content and link are involved	Removing or not placing such content

6.10 Thumb rules

👍 If it's paid, it's sponsored. No exceptions.

👍 Never rent someone else's reputation.

👍 Fake mentions don't fool AI search either.

6.11 Notes to remember

📝 Spam can now mean manipulating AI responses too.

📝 Paid links are fine only with rel="sponsored" or rel="nofollow".

📝 Site reputation abuse applies even with first-party oversight.

📝 Lost link spam benefit cannot be regained.

Chapter 6 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Spam policies	Google's rules about manipulative tactics
Manual action	A penalty applied after human review, shown in Search Console
Advertorial	Paid content made to look like an article
Native ad	An ad designed to blend in with normal content
Optimized anchor text	Link text stuffed with target keywords
Third-party content	Content on a site written or provided by someone else
Inauthentic mention	A fake or paid mention made to look natural
Reconsideration request	Asking Google to review a site after fixing a manual action

Chapter 6 Quiz

1. According to Google, spam now includes attempts to manipulate...

- A) Generative AI responses in Search as well
- B) Only blue-link rankings
- C) Only Google Ads
- D) Only images

2. Which is listed by Google as link spam?

- A) Sending free products in exchange for a link and write-up
- B) Linking to a cited source
- C) A journalist linking to our study
- D) A patient sharing our guide

3. When is a paid link NOT a violation?

- A) When the site has high DA
- B) Never
- C) When it's marked rel="sponsored" or rel="nofollow"
- D) When it's expensive

4. A medical site hosting a low-quality casino page is an example of...

- A) Expired domain abuse
- B) Keyword stuffing
- C) A healthy partnership
- D) Site reputation abuse

5. Since November 2024, does first-party oversight exempt content from site reputation abuse?

- A) Only for news sites
- B) No
- C) Yes
- D) Only in the US

6. Buying an old medical charity domain to sell commercial medical products is...

- A) A Google example of expired domain abuse
- B) Required for E-E-A-T
- C) Smart branding
- D) Fine if redirected

7. What does Google say about seeking inauthentic mentions for AI search?

- A) It isn't as helpful as it might seem
- B) It only works on Bing
- C) It's required
- D) It's the best AI strategy

8. A vendor offers 1,000 AI articles across 50 blogs, all linking to Ongo. Which policies does this touch?

- A) Only site speed
- B) Scaled content abuse and link spam
- C) None
- D) Only image policies

9. What's the right action when you receive a red-flag offer?

- A) Stop and tell your team lead
- B) Forward it to the medical team
- C) Accept it quietly
- D) Try it on one page first

10. Where would a manual action notice appear?

- A) In GA4

- B) In the Manual actions report in Search Console
- C) In your email spam folder
- D) On the homepage

Sources

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4. Google Search Central, Spam updates (last updated December 10, 2025)
5. Google Search Central, Qualify your outbound links to Google (last updated December 10, 2025)

Answer key, Chapter 6: 1-A · 2-A · 3-C · 4-D · 5-B · 6-A · 7-A · 8-B · 9-A · 10-B

LEVEL 1 · CHAPTER 7

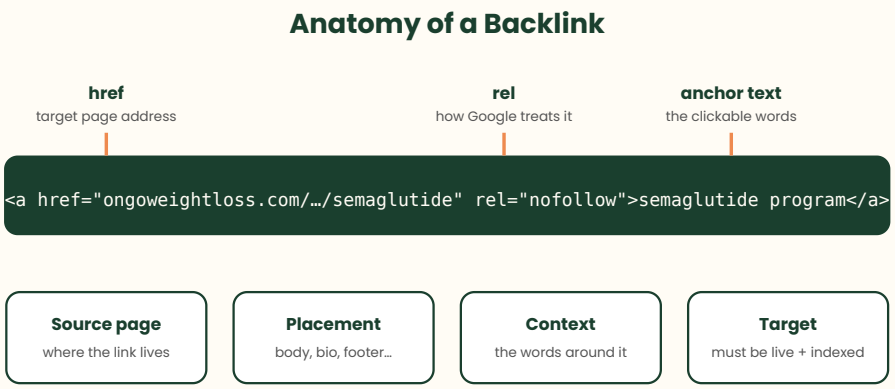
Chapter 7: Anatomy of a Backlink

Two links can look identical and be worth completely different amounts. This chapter teaches you to see the difference.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> Google can only reliably crawl a link if it's built as a standard HTML `<a>` **element with an** `href` **attribute**. Links made in other ways (like some JavaScript click events) may not be picked up at all. [1] 🟢 Google official
>
> Translation: some "backlinks" you see on a page aren't backlinks to Google.

7.1 The parts of a backlink

A backlink has more parts than most freshers realise.



Seven parts. Two links can look identical and differ on every one of them.

```
<a href="https://ongoweightloss.com/services/glp-1/compounded-semaglutide" rel="nofollow">
  compounded semaglutide program
</a>
```

Part	What it is	Example above	Why it matters
Source page	The page where the link lives	A health article on another site	Its quality and topic shape the link's value
Target page	The page the link points to	Ongo's compounded semaglutide page	Should be a public, indexed, relevant page

Part	What it is	Example above	Why it matters
href	The web address the link points to	`https://ongoweightloss.com/...`	Must be correct and working
Anchor text	The clickable words	"compounded semaglutide program"	Tells users and Google what the target is about [1] 🟢
rel attribute	A label describing the link relationship	`nofollow`	Tells Google how to treat the link [2] 🟢
Placement	Where on the page the link sits	Inside the article body	In-content links usually matter more than footer links 🔵
Context	The words around the link	A paragraph about GLP-1 treatment	Helps Google and readers understand the link [1] 🟢

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: shaadi ka invitation card**
>
> - **Source page** = kisne card bheja (bade uncle ya kisi anjaan ne?)
> - **Target page** = kis address pe bulaya (sahi venue?)
> - **Anchor text** = card pe kya likha hai ("Sangeet," "Reception")
> - **rel attribute** = card pe "sirf jaankari ke liye" likha hai ya asli nimantran hai
> - **Placement** = card haath mein diya ya notice board pe chipka diya
> - **Context** = card ke saath kya bola: "Zaroor aana, beta!" ya kuch nahi

7.2 Anchor text: what Google says

Google's own guidance on anchor text: [1] 🟢 Google official

Good anchor text	Bad anchor text
Descriptive	Generic: "click here," "read more"
Reasonably short	Empty (no visible text)
Relevant to both pages	Stuffed with keywords
Makes sense when read alone	Several links chained together

For **image links**, Google uses the image's **alt text** as the anchor text. [1] 🟢 Google official

> 📝 **Note to remember:** Good anchor text on *our* site is about clarity. Anchor text in *backlinks* has an extra danger: Google's link spam examples include links with **optimized anchor text** in guest posts, press releases and advertorials. [3] 🟢. Chapter 14 covers the safe mix for Ongo.

7.3 The rel attributes: follow, nofollow, sponsored, ugc

Attribute	Use it for	Google's treatment
(none) "**follow**" / "dofollow"	A normal editorial link	Can pass ranking credit
rel="nofollow"	When you don't want to vouch for the linked page	Generally not followed; treated as a hint [2] 🟢 [4] 🟠
rel="sponsored"	Ads, paid placements, sponsorships	Google's preferred label for paid links [2] 🟢
rel="ugc"	User-generated content: comments, forum posts	Labels links added by users [2] 🟢

Values can be combined, like `rel="ugc nofollow"`. [2] 🟢 Google official

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> "Dofollow" is not a real HTML attribute. It's SEO slang for a link **without** nofollow, sponsored or ugc. If someone sells you a "rel=dofollow" link, they don't know HTML, or hope you don't.

Are nofollow links worthless?

No. Since 2019, Google treats nofollow, sponsored and ugc as **hints**, not strict commands. [4] 🟠. More importantly, a nofollow link can still bring:

- Real visitors (referral traffic)
- Brand awareness
- Discovery: Google may still find pages through other routes [2] 🟢
- Natural-looking link diversity 🔵

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: Instagram influencer ka shoutout**
>
> Kisi bade influencer ne tumhare restaurant ka naam story mein daala, lekin "paid partnership" tag ke saath. Kya woh bekaar hai? Bilkul nahi. **Log aate hain, naam failta hai.** Bas "official recommendation" ka tag nahi milta.

7.4 Placement: where the link sits

Placement	Typical value	Why
In the main article text	Highest	Editorial, in context, seen by readers
In an author bio	Medium-low	Expected, often templated
In a resource list	Medium	Useful if the list is curated and short
Sidebar / blogroll	Low	Often site-wide, not specific

Placement	Typical value	Why
Footer	Low, sometimes risky	Google lists widely distributed footer links as link spam [3] 🟢
Comments	Very low	Usually ugc/nofollow; optimized comment links are link spam [3] 🟢

Value column: 🔵 Expert judgment, consistent with Google's link spam examples.

7.5 Context: the words around the link

Google says context matters: surrounding words help readers understand a link, and you shouldn't chain links together. [1] 🟢 Google official

Weak context	Strong context
"For more, visit Ongo."	"Doctors at Ongo, a telehealth clinic, explain the difference between compounded and FDA-approved semaglutide in their patient guide."

> 🟧 **Ongo example**
>
> Same link, two placements:
>
> 1. In a footer: *"Partners: Ongo"*. Low value, possible template pattern.
> 2. In a health article: *"According to Ongo's medical team, side effects of GLP-1 medications are most common when doses increase."* Linked to our side-effects guide.
>
> The second is editorial, relevant, in context, and useful to readers. It's worth far more, and it's also the kind of mention AI answers draw on.

7.6 Target page: where should links point?

Target	When to use	Note
Homepage	Brand mentions, business listings, partnerships	Natural for brand-name anchors
Service pages (e.g. compounded tirzepatide)	When the source discusses treatment options	Must go through medical review
Blog guides	Educational articles, resource pages	Usually the easiest to earn links to
Medical team / doctor pages	Expert quotes, interviews, podcasts	Builds E-E-A-T
Tools / calculators	Resource lists, health tools roundups	Very linkable (Chapter 19)
Policies / about pages	Directories, partnerships	Supports trust

> ⚠️ **Where freshers go wrong: every link to the homepage**
>
> - **The mistake:** Pointing every backlink at the homepage.
> - **Why it happens:** It's the easiest URL to remember.
> - **How to avoid it:** Match the target to the source's topic. An article about tirzepatide side effects should link to our tirzepatide content.
> - **How to fix it:** For links you control (profiles, your own guest posts), update the target URL. Log the change in the sheet.

7.7 The link quality checklist (quick version)

Before recording a link as "good," check:

1. ☐ Is it an `<a href>` link that Google can crawl? [1]
2. ☐ What's the rel attribute (follow, nofollow, sponsored, ugc)?
3. ☐ Is the source page relevant to health or weight loss?
4. ☐ Is the link in the main content?
5. ☐ Is the anchor text natural (brand, URL, or descriptive)?
6. ☐ Does the surrounding text make sense?
7. ☐ Does the target page work, and is it indexed?
8. ☐ Is the source page itself indexed? (`site:` search)

The full version is in Chapter 31.

How to see a link's code (no tools needed)

1. Open the page in Chrome.
2. Right-click the link → **Inspect**.
3. Look for `<a href="...">`. Check if `rel="..."` appears.
4. Note the anchor text between `<a>` and `</a>`.

7.8 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Check every link's rel attribute	Assume a visible link is a crawlable link
Value nofollow links for traffic and brand	Reject nofollow opportunities on great sites
Match target pages to the source topic	Send everything to the homepage
Prefer in-content links	Chase footer and sidebar links

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Keep anchors natural	Use keyword-stuffed anchors

7.9 Pros and cons: follow vs nofollow

	Follow	Nofollow / sponsored / ugc
✅ Pros	Can pass ranking credit	Safe for paid or user content; still brings traffic and brand
❌ Cons	If paid, it's link spam	Less direct ranking value

7.10 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 7 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Recording JavaScript "links" as backlinks	They look clickable	Inspecting the code for `<a href>`	Marking them as mentions, not links
Rejecting nofollow links on top sites	"Nofollow = useless" myth	Remembering traffic and brand value	Pursuing them for referral traffic
Keyword-stuffed anchors in guest posts	Old SEO habit	Using brand or descriptive anchors	Asking the editor to change the anchor
Linking to non-indexed or broken pages	Not checking	Running the 8-point checklist	Updating the target where possible

7.11 Thumb rules

👍 The page matters more than the domain; the paragraph matters more than the page.

👍 No `<a href>`, no backlink.

👍 Paid? Sponsored. User-added? UGC. Don't trust it? Nofollow.

7.12 Notes to remember

📝 Seven parts: source, target, href, anchor, rel, placement, context.

📝 Image links use alt text as their anchor.

📝 "Dofollow" isn't a real attribute.

Chapter 7 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Backlink	A link on another site pointing to ours
Source page	The page containing the link
Target page	The page the link points to
href	The web address inside a link
Anchor text	The visible, clickable words of a link
rel attribute	A label telling Google about the link relationship
Follow / dofollow	Slang for a normal link without nofollow/sponsored/ugc
Nofollow	A label meaning "don't associate us with this link"
Sponsored	A label for paid or advertising links
UGC	User-generated content label
Alt text	Text describing an image; used as anchor text for image links
Contextual link	A link inside the main text, surrounded by relevant words

Chapter 7 Quiz

1. What must a link be built as for Google to reliably crawl it?

- A) A JavaScript pop-up
- B) A button image
- C) An `<a>` element with an `href` attribute
- D) A PDF

2. Which is good anchor text according to Google?

- A) Descriptive text relevant to the target page
- B) "Click here"
- C) "Read more"
- D) Empty text

3. What does Google use as anchor text for an image link?

- A) The file name
- B) The image size
- C) The image's alt text

- D) Nothing

4. Which rel value does Google prefer for paid links?

- A) dofollow
- B) noindex
- C) ugc
- D) sponsored

5. Is "rel=dofollow" a real HTML attribute?

- A) Yes, required for SEO
- B) Yes, but only on news sites
- C) Only in WordPress
- D) No, it's SEO slang for a link without nofollow

6. Which placement is usually most valuable?

- A) Inside the main article text
- B) Blog comment
- C) Footer
- D) Sidebar blogroll

7. Are nofollow links worthless?

- A) No; they can bring traffic, brand awareness and act as hints
- B) They hurt rankings
- C) Only on Mondays
- D) Yes, completely

8. An article about tirzepatide side effects should ideally link to…

- A) Ongo's tirzepatide content
- B) Ongo's homepage
- C) Ongo's careers page
- D) Ongo's privacy policy

9. How can you check a link's rel attribute without tools?

- A) Right-click → Inspect in Chrome
- B) Check the logo
- C) Call the site owner
- D) You can't

10. Which of these is NOT one of the seven parts of a backlink?

- A) The linking site's font colour
- B) Anchor text
- C) Context
- D) Placement

Sources

1. Google Search Central, Make your links crawlable (last updated December 10, 2025)
2. Google Search Central, Qualify your outbound links to Google (last updated December 10, 2025)
3. Google Search Central, Spam policies for Google web search (last updated August 28, 2026)
4. PPC Land, nofollow (history of the 2019 "hint" change)

Answer key, Chapter 7: 1-C · 2-A · 3-C · 4-D · 5-D · 6-A · 7-A · 8-A · 9-A · 10-A

LEVEL 1 · CHAPTER 8

Chapter 8: What a Backlink Gives You Beyond Rankings

You were told backlinks are for rankings. That's maybe half the story.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> Google says the **vast majority of new pages** it finds every day are discovered **through links**. [1] 🟢 Google official
>
> So before a link can help you rank, it has already done another job: it helped Google find you.

8.1 The seven gifts of a good backlink



Judge a link on all seven, not just follow vs nofollow.

#	Gift	What it means	Evidence
1	**Discovery**	Google finds our pages through links	🟢 Google official [1][2]
2	**Ranking signal**	Links feed Google's link analysis systems and PageRank	🟢 Google official [3]
3	**Referral traffic**	Real people click the link and visit	🔵 Basic web mechanics
4	**Brand trust**	Being mentioned by trusted sites builds reputation	🟢 Google's E-E-A-T guidance [4]
5	**Topic understanding**	Links and anchors help Google understand what our pages are about	🟢 Google official [3][5]

#	Gift	What it means	Evidence
6	**AI visibility**	AI features draw on what's said about brands across the web	🟢 Google official [6]
7	**Relationships**	Each earned link is a person who might help again	🔵 Expert judgment

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: shaadi mein ek acchi recommendation**
>
> Mausi ne kisi ko tumhare bete ke liye rishta suggest kiya. Ek recommendation se kya mila?
>
> 1. Ladki wale ko tumhare bare mein **pata chala** (discovery)
> 2. Family ki **izzat badhi** (ranking)
> 3. Log **ghar aaye** milne (traffic)
> 4. Mohalle mein **naam hua** (brand)
> 5. Sabko samajh aaya ladka **kya karta hai** (topic)
> 6. Agli baar koi poochhe toh **naam yaad aaya** (AI memory)
> 7. Mausi se **rishta mazboot hua** (relationship)

8.2 Gift 1: Discovery

Google primarily finds pages through links from pages it has already crawled, often on other websites. [2] 🟢 Google official

Why this matters for Ongo: When we publish a new guide, a link from a frequently crawled health site can help Google find it sooner than waiting for our own sitemap. 🔵 Expert judgment

8.3 Gift 2: Ranking signal

Google lists **link analysis systems and PageRank** among its ranking systems. These help Google understand **what pages are about** and **which might be most helpful**. [3] 🟢 Google official

But remember Chapter 4: links are **one of many** signals. [2] 🟢

8.4 Gift 3: Referral traffic

A backlink is also a door. Every click is a potential patient.

Why referral traffic is gold	Explanation
Pre-qualified visitors	They were already reading about weight loss or GLP-1s
Borrowed trust	They arrive after a trusted site sent them

Why referral traffic is gold	Explanation
Not dependent on rankings	Even if Google changes, the link keeps sending people
Measurable	GA4 shows referral sources (Chapter 39)

● *Expert judgment*

> 🟧 **Ongo example**
>
> A nofollow link from a popular health forum thread about GLP-1 costs sends 40 visitors a month, and 2 of them book appointments. That nofollow link may be worth more to Ongo than a followed link on a site nobody reads.
>
> 👍 **Thumb rule:** A link nobody clicks is a link nobody trusts. Ask "would anyone click this?"

8.5 Gift 4: Brand trust

Google's helpful content guidance asks whether someone researching a site would find it **well-trusted or widely recognized as an authority**. [4] ● Google official

Trusted mentions and links are how that reputation forms.

8.6 Gift 5: Topic understanding

Anchor text tells users and Google what a linked page is about. [5] ● Google official. Links from health and weight-loss content help place Ongo in the right topic neighbourhood. ●

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: mohalla ka pehchaan**
>
> Agar mohalle ke saare doctor tumhe "Sharma ji, woh dietician" bolte hain, toh naye log bhi tumhe dietician samajhte hain. **Log tumhe jis naam se bulate hain, wahi tumhari pehchaan banti hai.**

8.7 Gift 6: AI visibility

Google says its AI features can show **what's being said about products and services across the web**, including in blogs, videos and forum discussions. It also warns that **inauthentic** mentions aren't as helpful as they seem. [6] ● Google official

Google's AI features retrieve pages using its core ranking systems, and show links to those pages. [6] ●. A trusted, well-linked page has a better chance of being one of them. ●

Google also offers a **Generative AI performance report** in Search Console to see how content performs in AI features. [6] ● (Chapter 36.)

8.8 Gift 7: Relationships

The editor who linked to our guide might:

- Quote our doctor next month
- Invite us to a podcast
- Recommend us to another editor

🔵 *Expert judgment.* This is why outreach should be polite, honest and helpful (Chapter 30). One good relationship can produce many links over years.

8.9 Which gifts matter most for Ongo?

Gift	Priority for Ongo	Why
Brand trust	⭐⭐⭐⭐⭐	YMYL: trust is everything
Referral traffic	⭐⭐⭐⭐⭐	Direct patients
AI visibility	⭐⭐⭐⭐	Patients increasingly ask AI about GLP-1s
Ranking signal	⭐⭐⭐⭐	Competitive telehealth market
Relationships	⭐⭐⭐⭐	Compounds over time
Topic understanding	⭐⭐⭐	Supports relevance
Discovery	⭐⭐⭐	Helps new content get found

Priority ratings: 🔵 Expert judgment.

8.10 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Judge a link by all seven gifts	Judge a link only by follow/nofollow
Track referral traffic from each link	Ignore links that send visitors
Build relationships with editors	Treat editors as link vending machines
Value genuine mentions	Pay for fake mentions to look "visible in AI"

8.11 Pros and cons of thinking beyond rankings

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
You find value Google updates can't remove	Harder to report as one simple number
Better links (sites real people read)	Some high-traffic sites only give nofollow links
Better story for your manager (traffic + bookings)	Needs GA4 tracking set up properly

8.12 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 8 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Ignoring referral traffic	Only checking rankings	Adding a "referral visits" column in the sheet	Checking GA4 for past links
Rejecting a high-traffic nofollow link	"Only dofollow counts"	Scoring all seven gifts	Re-pursuing the opportunity
Burning bridges with editors	Pushy follow-ups	Being polite and helpful	Sending a genuine thank-you

8.13 Thumb rules

👍 A link is a door before it's a vote.

👍 If nobody clicks it, ask why it's there.

👍 Every editor is a relationship, not a transaction.

8.14 Notes to remember

📝 Seven gifts: discovery, ranking, traffic, trust, topic, AI visibility, relationships.

📝 Google's AI features reflect what's said about brands across the web, but not inauthentic mentions.

Chapter 8 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Discovery	Google finding a page for the first time

Term	Simple meaning
Referral traffic	Visitors arriving by clicking a link on another site
Brand mention	Our name appearing elsewhere online
Generative AI performance report	A Search Console report showing performance in Google's AI features
Pre-qualified visitor	Someone already interested in the topic before arriving

Chapter 8 Quiz

1. How does Google find most new pages?

- A) Through social media likes only
- B) Through phone calls
- C) Through links
- D) Through paid submissions

2. Which is NOT one of the seven gifts?

- A) Referral traffic
- B) Brand trust
- C) Guaranteed #1 ranking
- D) Discovery

3. Why can a nofollow link still be valuable?

- A) Google requires it
- B) It removes penalties
- C) It can send real visitors and build brand awareness
- D) It always passes full PageRank

4. What does Google say about inauthentic mentions in AI search?

- A) They aren't as helpful as they seem
- B) They're required
- C) They work only in Europe
- D) They're the best strategy

5. Which Search Console report shows performance in Google's AI features?

- A) Sitemaps
- B) Core Web Vitals
- C) Generative AI performance report
- D) Manual actions

6. Which gift has the highest priority for a YMYL brand like Ongo?

- A) Discovery only
- B) Brand trust
- C) Number of pages
- D) Font size

7. Why is referral traffic "pre-qualified"?

- A) They came from ads
- B) They are bots
- C) They paid to visit
- D) Visitors were already reading about the topic

8. How do links help topic understanding?

- A) They add keywords to our site
- B) They don't
- C) Anchor text tells users and Google what the linked page is about
- D) They change our page titles

9. What's a good habit after an editor links to us?

- A) Send a genuine thank-you and keep the relationship
- B) Ask for 10 more links immediately
- C) Ignore them
- D) Report them to Google

10. In the shaadi analogy, "agli baar koi poochhe toh naam yaad aaya" represents...

- A) Discovery
- B) Disavow
- C) AI memory / visibility
- D) Referral traffic

Sources

1. Google Search Central, SEO Starter Guide: Link to relevant resources (last updated December 10, 2025)
2. Google Search Central, SEO Starter Guide: Help Google find your content (last updated December 10, 2025)
3. Google Search Central, A guide to Google Search ranking systems (last updated December 10, 2025)
4. Google Search Central, Creating helpful, reliable, people-first content (last updated October 5, 2026)
5. Google Search Central, Make your links crawlable (last updated December 10, 2025)
6. Google Search Central, Optimizing your website for generative AI features on Google Search (last updated July 10, 2026)

Answer key, Chapter 8: 1-C · 2-C · 3-C · 4-A · 5-C · 6-B · 7-D · 8-C · 9-A · 10-C

LEVEL 1 · CHAPTER 9

Chapter 9: Metrics 101: DA, PA, DR, UR and Friends

Google doesn't use any of these numbers. You'll use all of them anyway. Here's how to use them without being fooled.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> Google's John Mueller has said many times that Google **doesn't use Domain Authority**, including in 2020: Google doesn't use it **at all** in its algorithms. [1] 🟡 Google spokesperson
>
> Moz, the company that invented DA, agrees: it says DA is **not a Google ranking factor**. [1] 🟠
>
> So why does every SEO team use it? Because you need **some** way to compare thousands of websites quickly. Just never forget what it is: a third-party estimate.

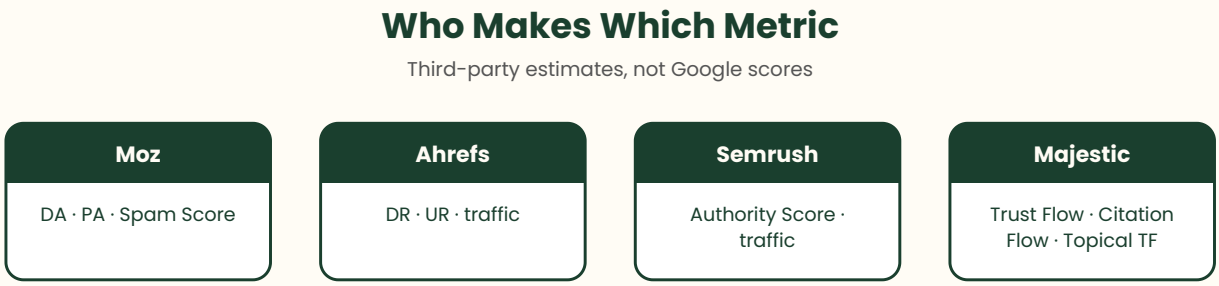
9.1 Why third-party metrics exist

Google's real scores are private (Chapter 4). SEO tool companies crawl the web themselves, build their own link databases, and calculate their own scores to **estimate** a site's strength.

> 🍛 **Desi analogy: weather apps**
>
> Phone mein teen weather apps hain. Ek bolta hai 32°C, doosra 34°C, teesra 31°C. Asli temperature sirf ek hai, lekin teeno **estimate** kar rahe hain, apne-apne sensors se.
>
> DA, DR, Authority Score bhi aise hi hain. **Teeno ek hi website ko alag number denge.** Isliye ek number pe andha bharosa mat karo.
>
> 📝 **Note to remember:** Google warns that **no third-party tool has access to its internal ranking or AI systems**, and to be wary of tools claiming "internal" Google metrics. [2] 🟢 Google official

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9.2 The main metrics at a glance



None of these are Google's. All are estimates from each tool's own crawl.

Metric	Tool	Measures	Scale	Free access
DA (Domain Authority)	Moz	Whole site's predicted ranking strength	1–100, logarithmic	Limited free queries
PA (Page Authority)	Moz	One page's predicted ranking strength	1–100	Limited free queries
Spam Score	Moz	Signals often seen on penalized sites	%	Limited free
DR (Domain Rating)	Ahrefs	Strength of a site's backlink profile	0–100	Own sites via Webmaster Tools; limited checker
UR (URL Rating)	Ahrefs	Strength of one page's backlinks	0–100	Limited
AS (Authority Score)	Semrush	Links + organic traffic + spam signals	1–100	~10 lookups/day
TF (Trust Flow)	Majestic	Link **quality**, based on closeness to trusted seed sites	0–100	Limited free
CF (Citation Flow)	Majestic	Link **quantity** / influence	0–100	Limited free
Topical TF	Majestic	Which **topics** a site's trust comes from	Categories	Limited free
Organic traffic	Ahrefs, Semrush	Estimated monthly Google visitors	Visits	Limited

Sources: [1][3][4][5][6][7]

9.3 Each metric, explained simply

Moz: DA, PA and Spam Score

- **DA** predicts how likely a **whole site** is to rank. Moz calculates it from link data using a machine-learning model, on a **100-point logarithmic scale**. [1][3]
- **Logarithmic** means going from 20 to 30 is much easier than going from 70 to 80. [3]
- **PA** is the same idea for a **single page**.
- Moz's 2019 "DA 2.0" update moved to a neural network and added spam and link-quality patterns. [3]
- **Spam Score** estimates the share of sites with similar features that Moz found penalized or banned.

Ahrefs: DR and UR

- **DR** measures the strength of a site's **backlink profile**. Each linking site passes value, stronger sites pass more, and a site's value is **split among all the sites it links to**. The result is scaled 0–100. [4]
- DR does **not** include traffic. [4]
- **UR** does the same for a single page, and Ahrefs says UR correlates better with Google rankings than DR. [4]

> 📝 **Note to remember:** DR's "split among outbound links" idea is the PageRank idea from Chapter 4.

Semrush: Authority Score (AS)

Semrush combines three things: [5]

Part	What it checks
Link power	Quantity and quality of backlinks
Organic traffic	Estimated monthly search traffic
Spam factors	Signs of manipulation, like no rankings despite many links, too many followed links, or many linking sites on the same network

Semrush says AS is best for **comparing** domains, not for judging a site good or bad by itself. [5]

Majestic: Trust Flow, Citation Flow, Topical Trust Flow

Metric	Simple meaning
Citation Flow (CF)	How **many** links point to a site, and how influential they are
Trust Flow (TF)	How **close** a site is to a hand-picked set of trusted seed sites
Topical Trust Flow	Which **topics** that trust comes from, across 800+ categories

A **high CF with low TF** suggests many low-quality links. When links come from quality sites, TF and CF tend to be close. [6]

🟧 **Ongo example**

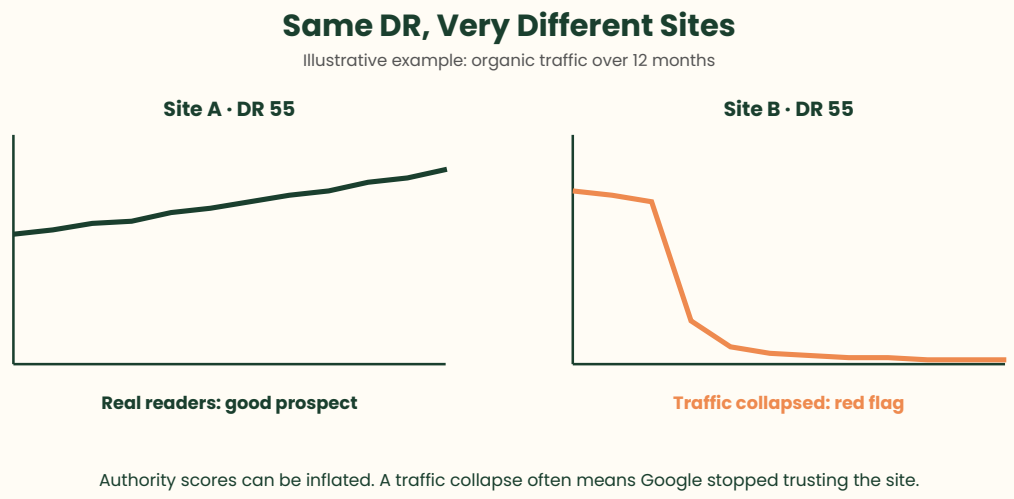
Majestic's **Topical Trust Flow** is the closest tool to your Tier 1–2–3 relevance idea. A site whose top topic is *Health/Medicine* or *Health/Nutrition* is likely Tier 1 or 2 for Ongo. A site whose top topic is *Games* is not, whatever its DA.

9.4 The most honest metric: organic traffic

Every authority score can be inflated with spammy links. **Organic traffic is much harder to fake**, because it means Google currently trusts the site enough to send it visitors. 🔵 Expert judgment

Semrush itself treats "no organic rankings despite many links" as a spam signal. [5] 🟠

👍 **Thumb rule: High DA + near-zero traffic = red flag.** A strong-looking site that Google sends nobody to is probably being ignored by Google.



9.5 How to read metrics together

Never judge a site on one number. Use this combination:

Check	Healthy sign	Warning sign
DA / DR / AS	Reasonable for its niche	Very high for an unknown site
Organic traffic	Steady or growing	Near zero, or a sudden crash
Traffic trend	Stable over 12 months	Sharp drop (possible penalty)
TF vs CF	Close to each other	CF much higher than TF

Check	Healthy sign	Warning sign
Topical TF	Health, medicine, nutrition, fitness	Unrelated topics
Spam Score	Low	High
Outbound links	Few, relevant	Hundreds of unrelated outbound links

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: rishta ka bio-data vs mohalla**
>
> Bio-data mein likha hai: "Salary 2 lakh, 6 foot, MBA." (DA/DR.) Lekin mohalle wale bolte hain: "Kabhi office jaate dekha nahi." (Traffic zero.)
>
> **Ek number pe nahi, poore picture pe rishta karo.**

9.6 Practical thresholds for Ongo

These are **starting guidelines**, not rules. 🔵 Expert judgment

Metric	Minimum to consider	Strong
DR / DA / AS	20+	50+
Organic traffic	500+ visits/month	10,000+ visits/month
Traffic trend	Not falling sharply in last 6 months	Stable or growing
Spam Score (Moz)	Under 30%	Under 10%
TF/CF ratio	TF at least ~half of CF	TF close to CF
Relevance	Health-adjacent (Tier 3+)	Health, medicine, weight loss (Tier 1)

> 📝 **Note to remember:** A **small, highly relevant** site (DR 25, real readers, all about GLP-1 patients) can beat a **big irrelevant** site (DR 70, gaming news). Relevance wins ties. Chapter 15 turns this into a score.

9.7 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Use at least 2 metrics plus traffic	Judge a site on DA alone
Check traffic trends over 12 months	Trust a single month's traffic
Use Topical TF for relevance	Assume high DA means relevant

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Write "Moz DA" or "Ahrefs DR" in reports	Call any of them "Google's score"
Compare sites in the same niche	Compare a news giant to a small blog

9.8 Pros and cons of third-party metrics

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
Quick way to compare thousands of sites	Not used by Google
Consistent within each tool	Different tools give different numbers
Help spot spam patterns	Can be manipulated with spammy links
Useful for reporting to managers	Encourage chasing numbers over relevance

9.9 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 9 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Choosing sites by DA only	Easy to filter	Checking traffic and relevance too	Re-grading past links honestly
Telling the manager "Google gave us DA 40"	Misunderstanding	Naming the tool every time	Correcting the report
Trusting DA 60 sites with no traffic	Number looks impressive	Running the traffic check	Marking them low quality
Buying links "to increase our DA"	Treating DA as the goal	Remembering DA isn't a Google factor	Focusing on real trust instead

9.10 Thumb rules

👍 One metric is a guess. Three metrics plus traffic is a judgment.

👍 Traffic is the hardest metric to fake.

👍 Relevance beats raw authority.

9.11 Notes to remember

> 📝 DA (Moz), DR (Ahrefs), AS (Semrush), TF/CF (Majestic) are all third-party.
>
> 📝 Google says no third-party tool has access to its internal systems.
>
> 📝 High CF + low TF = many low-quality links.

Chapter 9 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
DA	Moz's Domain Authority, a predicted ranking strength score
PA	Moz's Page Authority, the same for one page
DR	Ahrefs' Domain Rating, a backlink profile strength score
UR	Ahrefs' URL Rating, the same for one page
Authority Score	Semrush's score combining links, traffic and spam signals
Trust Flow	Majestic's link quality score based on trusted seed sites
Citation Flow	Majestic's link quantity/influence score
Topical Trust Flow	Majestic's topic categories for a site's trust
Spam Score	Moz's estimate of spam-like features
Logarithmic scale	Each step up is harder than the one before

Chapter 9 Quiz

1. Does Google use Moz's Domain Authority in its algorithm?

- A) Yes, it's a top factor
- B) Only in AI Overviews
- C) Only for health sites
- D) No; Google and Moz both say it isn't a Google ranking factor

2. Which tool makes Domain Rating (DR)?

- A) Ahrefs
- B) Google
- C) Semrush
- D) Moz

3. What does Semrush's Authority Score combine?

- A) Only page speed
- B) Font size and colours
- C) Link power, organic traffic and spam factors
- D) Only social media followers

4. A site has high Citation Flow but low Trust Flow. What does this suggest?

- A) A perfect site
- B) Nothing
- C) Many low-quality links
- D) A Google penalty for sure

5. Which Majestic metric is closest to judging topical relevance?

- A) URL Rating
- B) Citation Flow
- C) Spam Score
- D) Topical Trust Flow

6. A site has DR 65 but almost no organic traffic. What should you think?

- A) Red flag: Google may be ignoring it
- B) Excellent, get a link now
- C) It must be new
- D) Traffic doesn't matter

7. What does "logarithmic scale" mean for DA?

- A) Every point is equally easy
- B) It resets monthly
- C) It's only for pages
- D) Higher scores get harder to increase

8. What does Google say about third-party SEO tools?

- A) They have access to Google's internal systems
- B) Only Ahrefs is approved
- C) Google owns Moz
- D) No third-party tool has access to Google's internal ranking or AI systems

9. How should you write a metric in a report?

- A) "Ahrefs DR 40"
- B) "PageRank 40"
- C) "Official authority 40"
- D) "Google score: 40"

10. A DR 25 site entirely about GLP-1 patients vs a DR 70 gaming site. Which is usually better for Ongo?

- A) Neither
- B) Both are identical
- C) The gaming site, always
- D) The GLP-1 site, because relevance wins ties

Sources

1. Search Engine Journal, Domain authority: is it a Google ranking factor?
2. Google Search Central, Optimizing your website for generative AI features on Google Search (last updated July 10, 2026)
3. Altitude Marketing, What is Domain Authority 2.0?
4. Ahrefs Help, What is Ahrefs Domain Rating and how is it calculated
5. Semrush Knowledge Base, What is Authority Score?
6. Majestic, Flow Metric scores
7. Dupple, Best free SEO tools in 2026 (October 2026)

Answer key, Chapter 9: 1-D · 2-A · 3-C · 4-C · 5-D · 6-A · 7-D · 8-D · 9-A · 10-D

LEVEL 1 · CHAPTER 10

Chapter 10: Your Free Toolkit

You don't need a paid tool to start. You need to know exactly what each free tool can and can't do.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> **Bing Webmaster Tools** lets you compare your backlinks with a **competitor's** backlinks for free, without access to the competitor's site. [1]
>
> Most freshers never open it, because "nobody uses Bing." The tool is still free competitor link data.

10.1 The toolkit at a glance

Your Free Off-Page Toolkit



Limits as of October 2026; recheck before relying on them.

Tool	Best for	Free limit (as of October 2026)	Use for competitors?
Google Search Console	Ongo's own links, as Google sees them	Free; tables show up to 1,000 rows	No
Bing Webmaster Tools	Ongo's links + competitor comparison	Free; no usage limit listed	**Yes**
Ahrefs Webmaster Tools	Ongo's backlinks, DR, site audit	Up to 1,000 backlinks shown; 5,000 crawl credits/month per project	No (verified sites only)
Semrush Free	Quick checks of any domain	About 10 reports/queries a day	Yes, within limits
Moz Free	DA/PA/Spam Score checks	About 10 Link Explorer queries a month	Yes, within limits
Majestic (free)	TF, CF, Topical TF glimpses	Limited	Yes, limited

Tool	Best for	Free limit (as of October 2026)	Use for competitors?
Ubersuggest Free	Quick backlink snapshot	3 searches/day; 100 backlinks per site	Yes, limited
GA4	Referral traffic from each link	Free	No

Limits from [2][3]. 🟠 *Tool limits change often; recheck before relying on them.*

> 📝 **Note to remember:** You have **10 Moz queries a month**, not a day. Save them for final decisions, not exploring. 🟠 [2]

10.2 Google Search Console (GSC)

Search Console is the only tool that shows links as Google itself reports them.

The Links report

Section	What it shows
Top linked pages (external)	Ongo pages other sites link to most
Top linking sites	Sites linking to Ongo, with counts
Top linking text	Most common anchor text pointing to Ongo
Top linked pages (internal)	Ongo pages that get the most internal links

You can export external links. [4] 🟠

What GSC can't do

- It doesn't show competitors' links.
- It doesn't show a full link history with dates. 🔵
- It doesn't label links as nofollow or follow. 🔵

> 🟧 **Ongo example**
>
> Every month, export "Top linking sites" and compare it to your team sheet. Any site in GSC that isn't in the sheet is either a natural link (great, record it) or something suspicious (investigate).

Other GSC reports you'll use

Report	Use
Performance	Clicks, impressions, positions for Ongo's pages

Report	Use
Generative AI performance	How Ongo's content performs in Google's AI features [5] 🟢
Manual actions	Whether Google has penalised Ongo
URL Inspection	Whether a specific page is indexed

10.3 Bing Webmaster Tools

- Free backlink data for Ongo.
- A "similar sites" comparison to see a competitor's backlinks. [1] 🟠
- Data reflects Bing's crawl, not Google's. [2] 🟠

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: doosre mohalle ka khabri**
>
> Google ka khabri tumhe sirf tumhare ghar ki khabar deta hai. Bing ka khabri bolta hai: "Padosi ke ghar kaun aata-jaata hai, woh bhi bata deta hoon." Free mein. **Kyun mana karna?**

10.4 Ahrefs Webmaster Tools (AWT)

- Free for websites you **verify** you own. [3] 🟠
- Shows up to **1,000 backlinks** at a time, plus DR. [3] 🟠
- **Site Audit:** 5,000 crawl credits per month per project, checking 170+ issues. [3] 🟠
- **Cannot** show competitors' full backlinks on the free plan. [2] 🟠

10.5 Semrush Free

- About **10 reports a day** across tools. [2] 🟠
- Good for: checking a prospect site's **Authority Score** and **traffic trend**.
- Tip: plan your 10 checks before you log in.

10.6 Moz Free

- **Link Explorer: 10 queries a month.** [2] 🟠
- **MozBar** browser extension shows DA/PA while browsing. 🟠
- Use Moz mainly for **Spam Score** on shortlisted sites.

10.7 Majestic Free

Use it to glance at **Trust Flow, Citation Flow** and **Topical Trust Flow** for relevance checks (Chapter 9). [6] 🟠

10.8 GA4: proving a link worked

In GA4, referral traffic shows which external sites sent visitors, and what they did next. This is how you prove a link brought **patients**, not just a number. Chapter 39 covers the setup. 🔵

10.9 A daily free-tool routine (30 minutes)

Time	Task	Tool
5 min	Check new prospects' traffic trend (3–4 sites)	Semrush free
5 min	Check relevance via Topical TF	Majestic
5 min	Inspect links you created yesterday (live? rel?)	Chrome Inspect
5 min	Check target pages are indexed	GSC URL Inspection
5 min	Record everything in the sheet	Google Sheets
5 min (weekly)	Export GSC top linking sites; compare with sheet	GSC

🔵 *Expert judgment*

10.10 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Treat GSC as the most trusted source for Ongo's own links	Ignore GSC because other tools look nicer
Use Bing for free competitor link data	Skip Bing because of its market share
Plan your limited free queries	Waste Moz's 10 monthly queries on curiosity
Re-check tool limits regularly	Assume limits from an old blog post
Share one paid login only if the tool's terms allow it	Use "group buy" tool sellers (often against terms, and risky)

10.11 Pros and cons of free tools

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
Zero cost	Tight limits
GSC data comes straight from Google	Free plans mostly cover only your own site
Enough to vet sites and track links	Slower; more manual work

10.12 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 10 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Never opening Search Console	Thinking it's "technical"	Making the Links report a weekly habit	Exporting it today
Using up Moz queries on day 1	Exploring randomly	Saving Moz for shortlisted sites	Using Semrush/Majestic first
Trusting one tool's backlink count	Assuming tools see everything	Comparing GSC, Bing and Ahrefs	Using the union of all three
Buying "group buy" tool access	Cheap	Asking your team lead for proper access	Stopping use immediately

10.13 Thumb rules

👍 GSC first: it's Google's own view.

👍 Bing gives free competitor links; use them.

👍 Free queries are limited; spend them like money.

10.14 Notes to remember

📝 Moz free: ~10 Link Explorer queries per month. Semrush free: ~10 reports per day.

📝 Ahrefs Webmaster Tools works only for sites you verify.

📝 Tool limits change; recheck before relying on them.

Chapter 10 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Google Search Console (GSC)	Google's free tool showing how Google sees your site
Links report	GSC report of who links to your site
Bing Webmaster Tools	Bing's free version of Search Console
Ahrefs Webmaster Tools (AWT)	Ahrefs' free tool for sites you verify
Verified site	A site you've proven you own to a tool
MozBar	Moz's browser extension showing DA/PA
GA4	Google Analytics 4, used to measure visitors and actions
Group buy	Shared, resold access to paid tools, often against their terms

Chapter 10 Quiz

1. Which tool shows Ongo's links as Google itself reports them?

- A) Ubersuggest
- B) Majestic
- C) Moz
- D) Google Search Console

2. Which free tool lets you compare your backlinks with a competitor's?

- A) Google Search Console
- B) GA4
- C) Ahrefs Webmaster Tools free plan
- D) Bing Webmaster Tools

3. Roughly how many free Link Explorer queries does Moz give per month?

- A) Unlimited
- B) 100 per day
- C) 1,000
- D) About 10

4. Ahrefs Webmaster Tools is free for...

- A) Websites you verify you own
- B) Only news sites
- C) Only Google employees
- D) Any website, including competitors

5. Which GSC report shows how your content performs in Google's AI features?

- A) Removals
- B) Settings
- C) Sitemaps
- D) Generative AI performance report

6. What does the GSC "Top linking text" section show?

- A) Ad copy
- B) Your page titles
- C) The most common anchor text pointing to your site
- D) Competitor keywords

7. How should you treat "group buy" tool sellers?

- A) Avoid them; they often break tool terms and are risky
- B) Share them with the team
- C) Report them to Google
- D) Use them to save money

8. Which tool proves a link brought visitors who took action?

- A) Moz
- B) Majestic
- C) GA4
- D) Bing

9. Why should you recheck free tool limits regularly?

- A) They don't change
- B) Tools stop working at night
- C) Google requires it
- D) Limits change over time

10. What's a smart weekly GSC habit?

- A) Submitting the disavow file
- B) Deleting the property
- C) Changing the site name
- D) Exporting top linking sites and comparing with the team sheet

---

Sources

1. Search Engine Land, Bing Webmaster Tools now gives you competitive link data (June 2, 2020)
2. Dupple, Best free SEO tools in 2026 (October 21, 2026)
3. Ahrefs, Ahrefs Webmaster Tools

4. SEOTesting, How to use the Links report in Google Search Console
5. Google Search Central, Optimizing your website for generative AI features on Google Search (last updated July 10, 2026)
6. Majestic, Flow Metric scores

Answer key, Chapter 10: 1-D · 2-D · 3-D · 4-A · 5-D · 6-C · 7-A · 8-C · 9-D · 10-D

LEVEL 1 · CHAPTER 11

Chapter 11: Reading a Website Without Any Tool

Tools run out of free queries. Your eyes don't. Learn to judge a site in two minutes.

💡 **Trivia**

Google's own guidance asks whether content is clear about **who** created it, **how** it was created, and **why** it exists. [1] 🟢 Google official

You can check all three in under a minute, with no tool at all. Google's own quality questions double as your website-vetting checklist.

11.1 Why the eyeball test matters

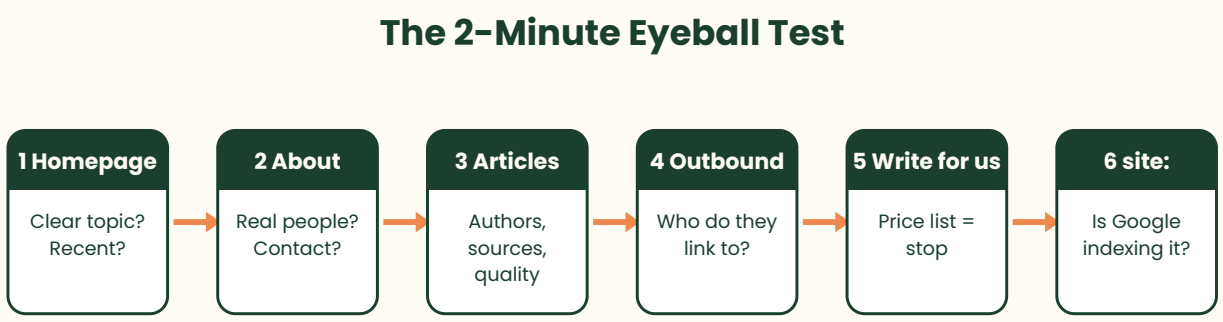
Every metric in Chapter 9 can be inflated. A site can show DR 60 and still be a link farm. Your eyes catch what numbers miss.

🪔 **Desi analogy: dukaan dekh ke samajh jaana**

Bazaar mein do medical stores hain. Ek pe board saaf, pharmacist ka naam likha, licence diwar pe. Doosre pe board toota, andar sabzi bhi bik rahi hai, aur dukaan wala bolta hai "sab milega bhai, prescription ki zaroorat nahi."

Kisi tool ki zaroorat nahi. Do second mein pata chal jaata hai kaunsa bharosemand hai.

11.2 The 2-minute eyeball test



Score each 0–2. Eyes first, tools second.

Step 1: Homepage (20 seconds)

Look for	Good sign	Red flag
Clear purpose	You can tell what the site is about	Random mix: crypto, casino, health, fashion
Design	Clean, maintained	Broken layout, ads everywhere
Recent content	Dates in the last few months	Nothing new in years
Ads	Some ads	Ads covering content, pop-ups everywhere

Step 2: About and contact (20 seconds)

Look for	Good sign	Red flag
About page	Real people, real story	Missing or generic
Contact	Real email, address or form	Only a "submit guest post" form
Ownership	Clear who runs it	Hidden owner

Google's guidance suggests linking to an author page or About page helps users trust content. [1]

Step 3: Article quality (40 seconds)

Open 2–3 recent articles.

Look for	Good sign	Red flag
Author	Real name with a bio	No author, or "Admin" everywhere
Writing	Clear, original, useful	Spun, repetitive, obviously mass AI text
Sources	Cites reliable sources	No sources on health claims

Look for	Good sign	Red flag
Topic fit	Matches the site's focus	"Best casino bonuses" on a parenting blog

Google warns that **fabricated creator profiles** (AI-generated headshots, made-up names, false credentials) are deception and a sign of a low-quality page. [1] 🟢 Google official

Step 4: The outbound link check (20 seconds)

Look for	Good sign	Red flag
Outbound links per article	A few, relevant, cited	Many commercial links with keyword anchors
Link destinations	Reputable sources	Casinos, loans, CBD, "cheap" anything
Labels	"Sponsored" posts clearly marked	Paid posts disguised as articles

> 📝 **Note to remember:** A site that links out to casinos, payday loans and pills in every post is almost certainly **selling links**. A link from it puts Ongo in that neighbourhood. 🔵

Step 5: The "write for us" check (10 seconds)

Search the site for "write for us," "guest post," "sponsored post." Then check:

Good sign	Red flag
Strict editorial guidelines, topic-focused	A price list for "dofollow links"
"We don't accept paid links"	"Guaranteed indexing, permanent link"

A price list for followed links = **link selling** = link spam. [2] 🟢 Google official

Step 6: The Google check (10 seconds)

Search Google for `site:theirdomain.com`. [3] 🟢

Result	Meaning
Many pages show	Google indexes the site
Very few or none	Google may be ignoring or penalizing it

11.3 The eyeball scorecard

Give each item 0, 1 or 2 points.

Check	0	1	2
Clear topic	Random	Mixed	Focused

Check	0	1	2
Real people	None	Partial	Clear authors + About
Content quality	Spammy	OK	Genuinely useful
Outbound links	Spammy	Mixed	Clean, relevant
Ads / pop-ups	Overwhelming	Noticeable	Minimal
Recent activity	Dead	Occasional	Regular
Link selling	Price list	Unclear	Clear editorial policy
Indexed in Google	No	Partial	Yes

Score out of 16: 13–16 = good · 9–12 = check with tools · 0–8 = skip. 🔵 Expert judgment

11.4 Ongo-specific eyeball checks

Because Ongo is a health brand, add these:

Check	Why
Does the site make wild health claims ("melt fat in 7 days")?	We don't want to sit next to misinformation
Does it sell unapproved or questionable weight-loss products?	Bad neighbourhood for a medical brand
Does it present compounded and brand-name drugs as the same thing?	Book One explained why this matters
Are health articles medically reviewed or sourced?	Signals a serious health publisher
Would an Ongo doctor be comfortable being linked from here?	The ultimate test

> 🟧 **Ongo example**
>
> Site A: a nutrition blog run by a registered dietitian, with author bios, sources, and posts about protein during GLP-1 treatment. No price list. **Eyeball score 15/16.** Strong prospect, even if its DR is only 28.
>
> Site B: "HealthTipsDaily," DR 58, posts about keto, crypto and casino bonuses, every post has 4 commercial links, "Admin" as author, and a "dofollow link $80" page. **Eyeball score 3/16.** Skip, whatever the DR says.

11.5 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Eyeball every site before using tools	Trust a DR without looking at the site

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Read 2–3 real articles	Judge from the homepage alone
Check outbound links	Ignore what neighbours we'd be sitting next to
Use the `site:` search	Assume every site is indexed
Ask "would our doctors be comfortable?"	Accept a link you'd hide from your manager

11.6 Pros and cons of the eyeball test

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
Free, fast, no limits	Subjective; two people may score differently
Catches spam that metrics miss	Can be fooled by a nice design
Teaches you real judgment	Doesn't show traffic or link data

Best practice: eyeball first, tools second. 🔵

11.7 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 11 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Skipping the eyeball test	Trusting tool numbers	Making it step 1	Re-checking recent links
Judging only the homepage	Rushing	Opening 2–3 articles	Re-scoring the site
Missing a link-selling page	Not searching for it	Searching "write for us" + "price"	Removing the site from prospects
Ignoring wild health claims	Not health-trained	Using the Ongo-specific checks	Flagging it to your team lead

11.8 Thumb rules

> 👍 Eyes first, tools second.
>
> 👍 A price list for dofollow links is a stop sign.
>
> 👍 If our doctor would be embarrassed, so are we.

11.9 Notes to remember

> 📝 Six steps: homepage, about/contact, articles, outbound links, "write for us," `site:` search.
>
> 📝 Fabricated author profiles are a low-quality signal, per Google.

Chapter 11 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Eyeball test	Judging a site by looking at it, without tools
Link farm	A site existing mainly to sell or exchange links
Outbound link	A link from a site to another site
"Write for us" page	A page inviting guest posts
Bad neighbourhood	A group of spammy sites linking to each other
site: search	A Google search showing a site's indexed pages

Chapter 11 Quiz

1. What three questions does Google suggest asking about content?

- A) What, where, when
- B) Cost, speed, size
- C) Who, how and why
- D) Font, colour, layout

2. A site has a "dofollow link: $80" price list. What does it mean?

- A) It sells links, which is link spam
- B) It's a news site
- C) Nothing
- D) A great opportunity

3. What does Google say about fabricated author profiles with AI headshots?

- A) Required for health sites
- B) They are fine
- C) They're a form of deception and a low-quality signal
- D) They boost E-E-A-T

4. What should you search to check whether Google indexes a site?

- A) `link:theirdomain.com`
- B) `cache:theirdomain.com`
- C) `site:theirdomain.com`
- D) `info:theirdomain.com`

5. A site posts about keto, crypto and casino bonuses. This is a sign of...

- A) A new site
- B) Medical authority
- C) A random mix, often a link-selling site
- D) Focus

6. In the eyeball scorecard, what score means "skip"?

- A) Any score
- B) 13–16
- C) 0–8
- D) 9–12

7. What's the ultimate Ongo-specific test?

- A) Would an Ongo doctor be comfortable being linked from here?
- B) Is it free?
- C) Is the site's DR above 50?
- D) Is the site blue?

8. Why check outbound links?

- A) To see who else the site links to and what neighbourhood we'd join
- B) To change their links
- C) To count words
- D) It doesn't matter

9. What's the right order of vetting?

- A) Only tools
- B) Eyes first, tools second
- C) Tools first, eyes never
- D) Only a phone call

10. A dietitian-run blog with DR 28 and real authors vs a DR 58 spammy site. Which is the better prospect for Ongo?

- A) Both equally
- B) The dietitian-run blog
- C) The DR 58 site
- D) Neither

Sources

1. Google Search Central, Creating helpful, reliable, people-first content (last updated October 5, 2026)
2. Google Search Central, Spam policies for Google web search (last updated August 28, 2026)
3. Google Search Central, SEO Starter Guide (last updated December 10, 2025)

Answer key, Chapter 11: 1-C · 2-A · 3-C · 4-C · 5-C · 6-C · 7-A · 8-A · 9-B · 10-B

02

LEVEL 2

Practitioner

Create links that actually deliver something, the right way, every time.

12 · Off-Page Rules for a Health Brand Like Ongo

13 · The Complete Catalog of Backlink Types

14 · Anchor Text Without Fear

15 · The Two-Axis Grading System

16 · Is This Website Good for a Backlink?

17 · Know Ongo's Market and Audience

18 · Competitor Backlink Analysis

19 · Linkable Assets: Content That Earns Links on Its Own

20 · Digital PR and Journalist Requests

21 · Guest Posting the Safe Way

22 · Broken Link Building and Resource Pages

23 · Unlinked Mentions and Link Reclamation

24 · Images and Visual Assets That Get Linked

25 · Communities: Reddit, Quora, Forums and Niche Groups

26 · Partnerships, Sponsorships, Testimonials and Associations

27 · Podcasts, Interviews, Webinars and Speaking

28 · Profiles Done Right

29 · Writing Bios, Descriptions and Submissions That Get Approved

30 · Cold Email Outreach That Gets Replies

31 · The Pre-Creation Checklist

32 · After Submission: Live, Under Review, Rejected, Removed

LEVEL 2 · CHAPTER 12

Chapter 12: Off-Page Rules for a Health Brand Like Ongo

Every other SEO book skips this chapter. For Ongo, it's the most important one.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> Between **September 2025 and June 2026**, the FDA sent **113 warning letters** to telehealth companies selling compounded semaglutide and tirzepatide. Every one cited **false or misleading claims**. The most common problem in the first wave was saying the compounded drug was the **same** as a brand-name product. [1] 🟠 Industry analysis of FDA letters
>
> None of these letters were about SEO. But every off-page article, guest post, bio or forum answer you place is **marketing in Ongo's name**. The same rules apply.

12.1 Why health off-page is different

In most niches, a bad guest post is just a bad guest post. For Ongo, a bad guest post can be:

Risk	Who cares
A misleading drug claim	FDA
An unsupported health benefit claim	FTC
A fake or undisclosed review	FTC
Low-trust content on a YMYL topic	Google
A patient misled about treatment	Patients, doctors, the business

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: dawai ki dukaan vs kapde ki dukaan**
>
> Kapde ki dukaan wala bole "yeh shirt sabse best hai," koi case nahi hota. Dawai ki dukaan wala bole "yeh goli se 7 din mein sugar khatam," toh drug inspector aa jaata hai.
>
> **Ongo dawai ki dukaan hai.** Humari har baat, chahe kisi aur ki website pe ho, drug inspector padh sakta hai.
>
> 📝 **Note to remember:** This chapter is not legal advice. When in doubt, ask Ongo's medical reviewer or legal contact before anything goes live. 🔵

12.2 Google's view: YMYL raises the bar

Google gives **even more weight** to trust signals for health topics, and says YMYL content must be **highly accurate** and consistent with **expert consensus**. [2] 🟢 Google official

Off-page impact: the sites mentioning Ongo, and what they say about us, are part of how our trust is judged (Chapter 1). Health misinformation next to our name hurts that trust. 🔵

12.3 The FDA lesson: words we never place anywhere

Ongo offers **compounded** semaglutide and tirzepatide (Book One). FDA warning letters to telehealth companies in 2025–2026 focused on misleading claims. The patterns flagged most often: [1] 🟠

Pattern FDA flagged	Example of what NOT to write
Sameness claims	"Same active ingredient as Wegovy/Ozempic," "same as Zepbound"
Implying FDA approval	"FDA-approved compounded semaglutide"
"Clinically proven" for compounded products	"Clinically proven compounded tirzepatide"
"FDA-licensed" pharmacy claims	"Made in an FDA-licensed pharmacy" (FDA doesn't license pharmacies)
Implying we manufacture the drug	Product photos of vials with our name

Ongo's red-word list for off-page content

❌ Never write	✅ Write instead (after medical review)
"Same as Ozempic / Wegovy / Mounjaro / Zepbound"	"Compounded semaglutide / tirzepatide, prescribed when appropriate by a licensed provider"
"FDA-approved" (for compounded medication)	"Compounded medications are not FDA-approved"
"Guaranteed weight loss," "lose X lbs in Y days"	"Results vary; your provider will discuss what to expect"
"Clinically proven" (about our compounded product)	Cite published research about the medication class, with medical review
"No side effects," "100% safe"	"Like any medication, it can have side effects"
"No doctor needed"	"A licensed provider evaluates every patient"
Brand names as if we sell them	Use brand names only to explain differences, with medical review
Naming the partner pharmacy	"A licensed U.S. partner pharmacy" (per Ongo's internal rule)

FDA patterns: 🟠 [1]. Replacement wording: 🔵 Expert judgment; must pass Ongo medical review.

🟧 **Ongo example**

A blogger writes about you: *"Ongo gives you the same semaglutide as Wegovy, cheaper!"* and links to Ongo.

That's a great-looking link with a dangerous sentence attached. **Action:** politely ask the blogger to update the wording (offer approved text), and record it in the sheet. If they won't, discuss with your team lead whether to request link removal. A link is never worth a misleading claim in our name.

12.4 The FTC lesson: claims, reviews and endorsements

Rule 1: Health claims need real evidence

The FTC's **Health Products Compliance Guidance** (December 2022) says health benefit claims must be backed by **competent and reliable scientific evidence**, generally meaning good-quality human clinical trials. Vague words like "may" or "helps" don't fix an unsupported claim. [3] 🟠 Legal summary of FTC guidance

Off-page impact: Don't place health benefit claims in guest posts, bios or answers unless Ongo's medical reviewer has approved them.

Rule 2: No fake, bought or undisclosed reviews

The FTC's **final rule on fake reviews and testimonials** (announced August 14, 2024) bans, among other things: [4] 🟢 US government source

- Fake reviews, including **AI-generated** ones or reviews from people with no real experience
- **Paying for reviews** that express a particular sentiment
- **Insider reviews** (from employees or their families) without clear disclosure
- Company-controlled "independent" review sites
- Buying or selling **fake followers or views**

The FTC can seek **civil penalties** for knowing violations. [4] 🟢

Rule 3: Disclose material connections

The FTC's updated **Endorsement Guides** (2023) say connections between an endorser and a brand (payment, free products, employment) must be **clearly and conspicuously disclosed** when the audience wouldn't expect them. [5] 🟠

🪔 **Desi analogy: shaadi mein "ladke ka dost" ki tareef**

Agar ladke ka sabse accha dost rishta wale ko bole "ladka hira hai," toh theek hai, **lekin batana padega ki woh dost hai.** Nahi batayega aur pakda gaya, toh dono ki izzat jaati hai.

Off-page impact:

Situation	Rule
A teammate answers a Reddit GLP-1 question and mentions Ongo	Must disclose: "I work with Ongo"

Situation	Rule
We sponsor a podcast and get a link	Link marked sponsored; sponsorship disclosed
We send a blogger something free	Disclosure required; link sponsored/nofollow (Chapter 6)
Someone offers "50 five-star reviews"	Refuse; it's banned

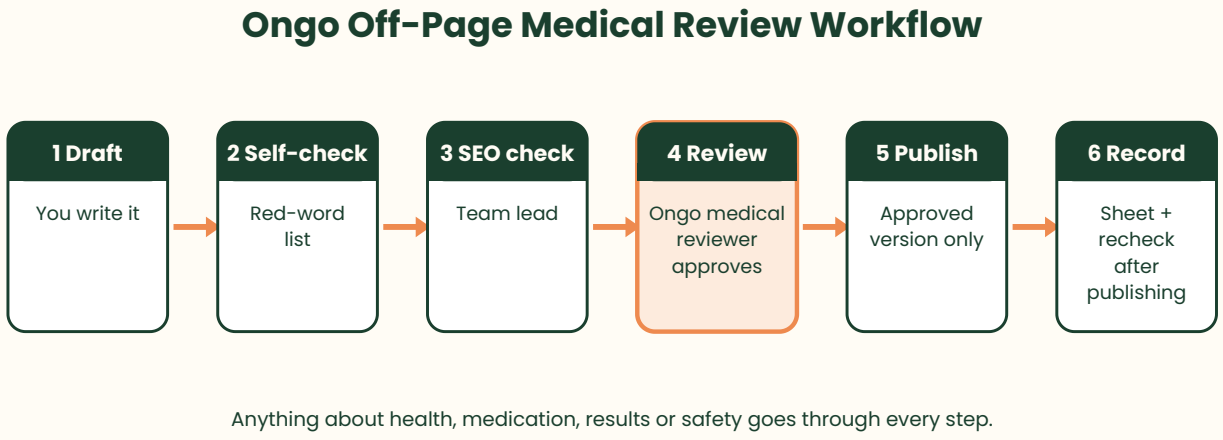
12.5 Safe neighbours and bad neighbourhoods

✅ Safe neighbours for Ongo	⚠️ Handle with care	❌ Bad neighbourhoods
Health publications with medical review	General lifestyle magazines	Sites selling unapproved weight-loss pills
Dietitian / nutritionist blogs	Fitness influencers' blogs	"Miracle fat-burner" content
Chronic disease patient communities	Personal finance (cost of GLP-1s)	Casino, adult, payday loan, CBD-heavy sites
Telehealth and digital health news	Local news	Link farms and PBNs (Chapter 43)
University or nonprofit health resources	Coupon/deal sites	Sites calling compounded drugs "generic Ozempic"

- *Expert judgment, based on YMYL guidance [2] and spam policies [6].*

12.6 The Ongo off-page medical review workflow

Anything that says something **about health, medication, results or safety**, on any external site, goes through this:



Anything about health, medication, results or safety goes through every step.

Step	Who	What
1. Draft	You	Write the guest post, answer, bio or pitch
2. Self-check	You	Run the red-word list (12.3)
3. SEO check	Team lead	Site quality, anchor, link attributes
4. Medical review	Ongo's medical reviewer	Accuracy, claims, risk language
5. Publish	You / the host site	Only the approved version
6. Record	You	Sheet: reviewer name, approval date
7. Re-check	You	After publishing, confirm the host didn't edit our approved text

⚠️ **Where freshers go wrong: "it's just a bio"**

- **The mistake:** Writing an author bio like "Ongo helps you lose weight fast with the same meds celebrities use" without review.
- **Why it happens:** Bios feel small and unimportant.
- **How to avoid it:** Use only pre-approved bios from Chapter 29.
- **How to fix it:** Update every bio you control; ask hosts to update theirs; log it.

What doesn't need medical review

No medical review needed	Why
Business listings with name, address, phone, website	No health claims
Brand-only mentions ("Ongo, a telehealth weight-loss clinic")	Factual, pre-approved description
Thank-you emails, outreach that makes no health claims	No claims

12.7 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Use the red-word list on every draft	Write sameness or FDA-approval claims
Get medical review for any health content off-site	Treat off-site content as "not our responsibility"
Disclose your Ongo connection in communities	Pose as a patient
Mark all paid or gifted placements	Hide sponsorships
Ask hosts to fix misleading claims about us	Celebrate a link with a misleading claim attached

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Keep approval records in the sheet	Rely on memory for approvals

12.8 Pros and cons of strict health rules

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
Protects patients and the business	Slower publishing
Builds the trust Google and AI answers reward	Some opportunities must be declined
Differentiates Ongo from careless competitors	Requires coordination with medical reviewers

12.9 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 12 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
"Same as Wegovy" in a guest post	Competitors' ads say it	Red-word list	Asking the host to edit; logging it
Answering on Reddit as "a happy patient"	Wants it to sound natural	Always disclosing	Editing the post to disclose, or deleting it
Buying reviews "just to start"	Pressure for social proof	Remembering the FTC rule	Reporting to team lead immediately
Skipping review on a "short" post	Feels minor	Workflow applies to all health claims	Pulling the post for review

12.10 Thumb rules

👍 If it mentions medicine, it goes to medical review.

👍 Never "same as," never "FDA-approved," never "guaranteed."

👍 Connected to Ongo? Say so.

12.11 Notes to remember

> 📝 FDA's 2025–2026 telehealth letters focused on misleading claims, especially sameness claims.
>
> 📝 FTC bans fake, bought and undisclosed insider reviews.
>
> 📝 Off-site content in our name is still our marketing.

Chapter 12 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Compounded medication	A medication prepared by a pharmacy for a patient; not FDA-approved
Sameness claim	Saying a compounded drug is the same as a brand-name drug
Misbranding	Marketing a drug with false or misleading claims
FTC	US Federal Trade Commission, which regulates advertising
Substantiation	Evidence that backs up a claim
Material connection	A relationship (payment, job, gift) that could affect an endorsement
Medical review	A qualified clinician checking content for accuracy and safety
Red-word list	Phrases Ongo never uses off-site

Chapter 12 Quiz

1. How many FDA warning letters went to telehealth companies selling compounded GLP-1s between Sept 2025 and June 2026?

- A) None
- B) 113
- C) 12
- D) 3

2. What was the most common problem flagged in the first wave of letters?

- A) Missing sitemaps
- B) Sameness claims, like "same active ingredient as Wegovy"
- C) Slow websites
- D) Too many backlinks

3. Which phrase is safe to use for compounded medications?

- A) "Same as Ozempic"
- B) "Guaranteed results"
- C) "Compounded medications are not FDA-approved"
- D) "FDA-approved compounded semaglutide"

4. What does the FTC require for health benefit claims?

- A) Nothing
- B) A celebrity endorsement
- C) A high DA website
- D) Competent and reliable scientific evidence

5. Which is banned by the FTC's 2024 fake reviews rule?

- A) Asking real patients for honest reviews
- B) Paying for reviews that express a particular sentiment
- C) Showing average ratings
- D) Replying to reviews

6. You work for Ongo and answer a GLP-1 question on Reddit, mentioning Ongo. What must you do?

- A) Use a fake account
- B) Pretend to be a patient
- C) Disclose that you work with Ongo
- D) Nothing

7. Which content does NOT need medical review?

- A) A podcast talking about results
- B) A forum answer about dosing
- C) A business listing with name, address, phone and website
- D) A guest post about GLP-1 side effects

8. A blogger links to Ongo but says "same semaglutide as Wegovy." What should you do?

- A) Celebrate the link
- B) Ask them to update the wording with approved text, and log it
- C) Buy more links from them
- D) Ignore it

9. Which site is a bad neighbourhood for Ongo?

- A) A dietitian's blog
- B) A medically reviewed health publication
- C) A site selling unapproved fat-burner pills
- D) A university health resource

10. Does the FDA license pharmacies?

- A) Only compounding pharmacies

- B) Yes, all of them
- C) Only in Texas
- D) No; calling a pharmacy "FDA-licensed" was flagged as false

---

Sources

1. Igility, What all 113 FDA telehealth warning letters actually say (analysis of FDA letters, 2025–2026); example letters: FDA warning letter, Remedy Meds (Sept 9, 2025), FDA warning letter, MEDVi (Feb 20, 2026)
2. Google Search Central, Creating helpful, reliable, people-first content (last updated October 5, 2026)
3. Covington, FTC issues new guidance on health-related claims (January 2023)
4. Federal Trade Commission, Final rule banning fake reviews and testimonials (August 14, 2024)
5. Venable, FTC finalizes updated Endorsement and Testimonial Guides (July 5, 2023)
6. Google Search Central, Spam policies for Google web search (last updated August 28, 2026)

Answer key, Chapter 12: 1-B · 2-B · 3-C · 4-D · 5-B · 6-C · 7-C · 8-B · 9-C · 10-D

LEVEL 2 · CHAPTER 13

Chapter 13: The Complete Catalog of Backlink Types

Every kind of link that exists, what it's worth in 2026, how often it works, and what can go wrong.

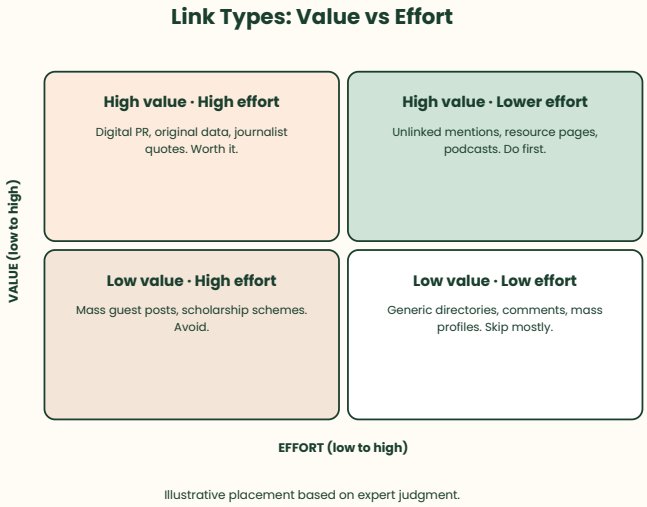
> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> Google's spam policies list **eleven specific examples** of link spam. [1] 🟢 Google official
>
> That means for any link type you're offered, you can check it against Google's own list in under a minute. This chapter does that for you.

13.1 How to read this catalog

Every link type gets four labels:

Label	Meaning
Value	How much it typically helps Ongo (⭐ to ⭐⭐⭐⭐⭐)
Success	Estimated chance of getting it when you try properly
Risk	Low / Medium / High (from the legend in the front matter)
Evidence	Where the judgment comes from

> 📝 **Note to remember:** Success percentages are **estimates** based on expert judgment 🔵 and industry reports 🟠 where available. Google publishes no success rates.



13.2 Earned editorial links (the gold standard)

Links someone gives because our content genuinely helps their readers.

Link type	What it is	Value	Success	Risk	Evidence
Editorial citation	A writer cites our guide or data in their article	⭐⭐⭐⭐⭐	5–15% per pitched asset	Low	●
Journalist quote link	A reporter quotes our doctor and links to us	⭐⭐⭐⭐⭐	5–20% per pitch on journalist platforms	Low	● [2]
Original data / study link	Others cite our survey or statistics	⭐⭐⭐⭐⭐	Varies with data quality	Low	●
Tool / calculator link	Others link to our free tool	⭐⭐⭐⭐	10–25% when pitched to resource pages	Low	●
Unsolicited natural link	Someone links without asking	⭐⭐⭐⭐⭐	Can't be controlled; grows with good content	Low	● [3]

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: bina bulaye tareef**
>
> Shaadi mein koi mehmaan khud aake bole, "Khana gazab tha, caterer ka number do," **yeh sabse keemti tareef hai.** Kisi ne kaha nahi, paise nahi diye, apne mann se boli.

13.3 Relationship and outreach links

Link type	What it is	Value	Success	Risk	Evidence
Guest article (quality)	We write a genuinely useful article for a relevant site	⭐⭐⭐	10–30% of good pitches	Medium (if anchors optimized)	🟢 [1][4]
Resource page inclusion	Our guide added to a curated list	⭐⭐⭐⭐	5–15%	Low	🔵
Broken link replacement	We offer our page to replace a dead link	⭐⭐⭐	5–10%	Low	🔵
Unlinked mention → link	A site mentions Ongo without a link; we ask them to add one	⭐⭐⭐⭐	20–40%	Low	🔵
Expert roundup	Our doctor contributes to a multi-expert article	⭐⭐⭐	20–40%	Low	🔵
Podcast / interview	Show notes link to us	⭐⭐⭐⭐	10–25%	Low	🔵

13.4 Business and community links

Link type	What it is	Value	Success	Risk	Evidence
Google Business Profile	Our official Google listing	⭐⭐⭐⭐	High if eligible	Low	🟢 [5]
Healthcare directories	Quality, curated medical/telehealth directories	⭐⭐⭐	50–80%	Low–Medium	🔵
Generic free directories	Mass "submit your site" directories	⭐	High	**Medium** (listed as link spam if low quality)	🟢 [1]
Association membership	Listing as a member of a real industry body	⭐⭐⭐	Depends on eligibility	Low	🔵
Partnership page	A real partner lists us	⭐⭐⭐	High with real partners	Medium if it becomes link exchange	🟢 [1]
Sponsorship	We sponsor an event or nonprofit	⭐⭐	High	Low **only if** link is sponsored/nofollow	🟢 [1][6]
Testimonial for a vendor	We review a tool we use; they link back	⭐⭐	30–60%	Low	🔵
Scholarship links	Offering a scholarship to get .edu links	⭐	Medium	**Medium–High** (widely abused pattern)	🔵

13.5 Social, community and user-generated links

Link type	What it is	Value	Success	Risk	Evidence
Reddit / Quora answers	Helpful answers with a relevant link	⭐⭐ (traffic, AI visibility)	Low if promotional	Medium (community bans)	[7]
Forum participation	Genuine discussions in health forums	⭐⭐	Medium	Medium if signature links are optimized	[1]
Social profiles	Ongo's official social accounts	⭐⭐ (entity, brand)	High	Low	
YouTube video descriptions	Links in our videos' descriptions	⭐⭐	High	Low	
Blog comments	Comments with links	⭐	High	Medium (optimized ones are link spam)	[1]

13.6 Profile links

Link type	What it is	Value	Success	Risk	Evidence
Professional profiles (doctors on medical directories, team on LinkedIn)	Real people's real profiles	⭐⭐⭐ (E-E-A-T, entity)	High	Low	
Mass profile creation	Hundreds of profiles on random sites for links	⭐	High	**Medium–High** (automated/low-value links)	[1]

13.7 Links to avoid completely

Link type	Why avoid	Evidence
Paid followed links	Link spam	[1]
Link exchanges at scale	Link spam	[1]
PBN links	Link schemes; high risk (Chapter 43)	[8]
Automated / software-built links	Link spam	[1]
Widget links with hidden keywords	Link spam	[1]
Sitewide footer links for SEO	Link spam when widely distributed	[1]

Link type	Why avoid	Evidence
Press release links with optimized anchors	Link spam	🟢 [1]
Article directory / web 2.0 / social bookmarking for links	Low-value; bookmark links listed	🟢 [1]
Parasite SEO placements	Site reputation abuse	🟢 [1]
Expired domain redirects for SEO	Expired domain abuse	🟢 [1]

13.8 The "link type pyramid" for Ongo



Level	Link types	Share of effort
Top	Journalist quotes, editorial citations, original data links	30%
Upper middle	Resource pages, unlinked mentions, podcasts, quality guest articles	35%
Lower middle	Healthcare directories, real partnerships, professional profiles	20%
Base	GBP, official socials, community participation	15%
Never	Everything in 13.7	0%

Effort split: 🔵 *Expert judgment.*

13.9 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Spend most effort at the top of the pyramid	Spend your week on directory submissions

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Use sponsored/nofollow for any paid relationship	Accept "dofollow guaranteed" offers
Track every link type separately in the sheet	Count all links as equal
Keep doctor and team profiles real	Create mass fake profiles

13.10 Pros and cons: easy links vs earned links

	Easy links (directories, profiles, comments)	Earned links (citations, PR, resource pages)
✅ Pros	Fast, high success rate	High value, durable, bring traffic
❌ Cons	Low value, can look like spam	Slow, lower success rate

13.11 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 13 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Spending 80% of time on base-level links	High success rate feels productive	Following the pyramid	Rebalancing next week's plan
Treating "scholarship links" as safe	Old tutorials recommend them	Checking the risk column	Dropping the tactic
Not marking sponsorship links	Not knowing the rule	Using sponsored/nofollow	Asking the host to update the link

13.12 Thumb rules

👍 The easier the link, the less it's worth.

👍 If you can buy it, Google counts it as spam unless it's labelled.

👍 Spend most of your time at the top of the pyramid.

13.13 Notes to remember

📝 Google lists 11 link spam examples; check every offer against them.

📝 Success rates in this book are estimates, clearly labelled.

Chapter 13 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Editorial link	A link a writer chooses to give because it helps readers
Resource page	A curated list of useful links on a topic
Broken link building	Offering your page to replace a dead link
Unlinked mention	Your brand named without a link
Expert roundup	An article collecting quotes from several experts
PBN	Private blog network built to manipulate rankings
Parasite SEO	Ranking content on someone else's strong site to borrow its authority
Sitewide link	A link appearing on every page of a site (footer, sidebar)

Chapter 13 Quiz

1. Which link type sits at the top of Ongo's pyramid?

- A) Blog comments
- B) Mass profiles
- C) Journalist quotes and editorial citations
- D) Generic directories

2. A sponsorship link is low risk only if...

- A) It's in the footer
- B) It's marked sponsored or nofollow
- C) It uses exact-match anchors
- D) It's from a big site

3. Which link type is listed by Google as link spam?

- A) A real partner listing
- B) A journalist quote
- C) A curated resource page
- D) Low-quality directory or bookmark links

4. What does "unlinked mention → link" mean?

- A) Building a PBN
- B) Asking a site that mentions Ongo without a link to add one
- C) Deleting old links
- D) Buying a link

5. Why avoid press release links with optimized anchors?

- A) They're too expensive
- B) They only work in Europe
- C) Google lists them as link spam
- D) They're too slow

6. Roughly how much of your effort should go to the "Never" level?

- A) 10%
- B) 50%
- C) 0%
- D) 30%

7. Which is the best description of mass profile creation?

- A) Gold-standard links
- B) Low value and risky
- C) Journalist links
- D) Required for E-E-A-T

8. Are success percentages in this book published by Google?

- A) Yes
- B) Only for health sites
- C) Only for directories
- D) No; they're labelled estimates

9. Which link brings the highest value?

- A) A free directory
- B) An unsolicited editorial link from a trusted health site
- C) A blog comment
- D) A web 2.0 blog

10. Scholarship link campaigns are…

- A) Required by Google
- B) A widely abused pattern; medium–high risk
- C) Always safe
- D) The top of the pyramid

Sources

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3. Google Search Central, SEO Starter Guide (last updated December 10, 2025)

4. Wordtracker, Google warns against misusing links in large-scale article campaigns (May 2017)
5. Google Search Central, Optimizing your website for generative AI features on Google Search (Business Profiles) (last updated July 10, 2026)
6. Google Search Central, Qualify your outbound links to Google (last updated December 10, 2025)
7. Redship, Reddit self-promotion rules in 2026
8. Wikipedia, Google Penguin

Answer key, Chapter 13: 1-C · 2-B · 3-D · 4-B · 5-C · 6-C · 7-B · 8-D · 9-B · 10-B

LEVEL 2 · CHAPTER 14

Chapter 14: Anchor Text Without Fear

The words inside a link can help you, or quietly tell Google you're manipulating it.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> Google's link spam list specifically mentions **"optimized anchor text"** in guest posts, press releases, advertorials and native ads. [1] ● Google official
>
> Same link, same site, same page: change only the clickable words from "Ongo" to "best compounded semaglutide online," and it can move from natural to suspicious.

14.1 What is anchor text?

Anchor text is the visible, clickable text of a link. Google uses it to understand what the linked page is about. [2] ● Google official

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: office mein naam ka tag**
>
> IT office mein naya banda aaya. Sab log usse alag naam se bulate hain: "Rohit," "Rohit bhai," "naya developer," "woh Java wala." **Natural hai.**
>
> Ab socho poora office use sirf "Best Senior Java Developer Delhi" bulaye. Har baar. Har insaan. **Ajeeb lagega na?** Sab samajh jayenge ki kisi ne sikhaya hai.
>
> Google bhi aisa hi sochta hai. Agar har link "best compounded semaglutide" bole, toh kisi ne "sikhaya" hai.

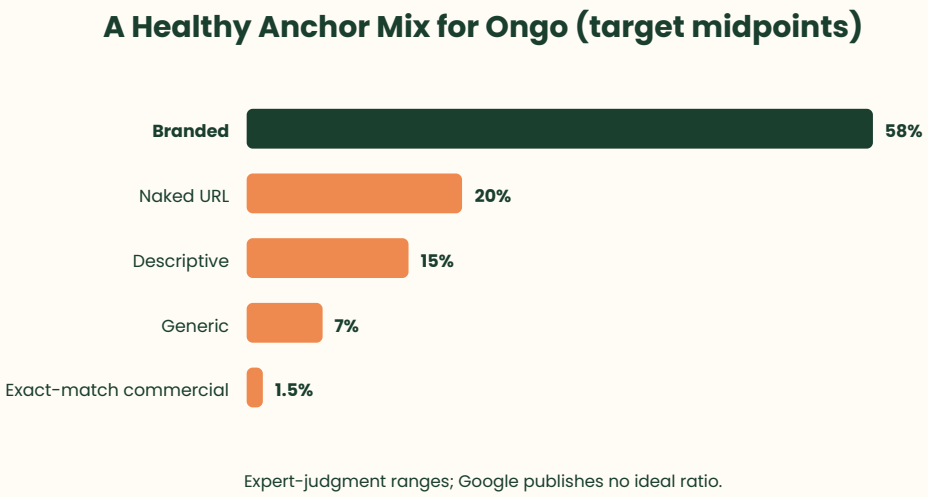
14.2 The types of anchor text

Type	Example (linking to Ongo)	Risk	Use for
Branded	"Ongo," "Ongo Weight Loss"	Low	Most links
Naked URL	"ongoweightloss.com"	Low	Directories, citations, profiles
Brand + topic	"Ongo's GLP-1 program"	Low	Editorial mentions
Generic	"this guide," "here"	Low (but less descriptive)	Occasional
Descriptive / partial match	"guide to tirzepatide side effects"	Low–Medium	Editorial links to specific guides

Type	Example (linking to Ongo)	Risk	Use for
Exact match (commercial)	"compounded semaglutide online"	**High** if repeated	Rarely, only when natural
Image anchor	Image with alt text	Depends on alt text	Infographics, logos

Google prefers anchors that are **descriptive**, **reasonably concise** and **relevant** to both pages, and dislikes "click here" style text. [2] ● Google official

14.3 A healthy anchor mix for Ongo



Anchor type	Target share of Ongo's backlinks
Branded (incl. brand + topic)	50–65%
Naked URL	15–25%
Descriptive / partial match	10–20%
Generic	5–10%
Exact-match commercial	0–3%

● *Expert judgment. Google publishes no "ideal ratio." These ranges reflect what natural link profiles of established brands tend to look like.*

> 📝 **Note to remember:** You don't control most anchors; editors choose them. That's fine and natural. The mix matters for links **you** influence: profiles, guest posts, bios, listings.

14.4 Rules for anchors you control

Situation	Best anchor
Directory / citation / profile	"Ongo" or "ongoweightloss.com"
Author bio	"Ongo Weight Loss"
Guest article body (if any link)	Descriptive, linking to a relevant guide, e.g. "our guide to GLP-1 side effects"
Podcast show notes	"Ongo" or the doctor's name
Press release	Brand name; ask for nofollow
Forum / Reddit	Usually no link; if needed, naked URL with disclosure

> 🟧 **Ongo example**
>
> **Bad:** In five guest posts, the author bio says *"Get the best compounded semaglutide online at Ongo."* with "best compounded semaglutide online" linked.
>
> **Good:** *"[Name] writes for Ongo Weight Loss, a US telehealth weight-loss clinic."* with "Ongo Weight Loss" linked to the homepage.

14.5 How to check Ongo's anchor profile

1. **Google Search Console → Links → Top linking text.** This shows the most common anchors pointing to Ongo. [3] 🟠
2. **Ahrefs Webmaster Tools → Anchors** for Ongo (verified site). 🟠
3. Put anchors into the sheet's anchor-type column (Chapter 40).
4. Monthly, count by type with `COUNTIF` and compare with the target mix.

Warning signs

Sign	What it may mean
Exact-match commercial anchors above ~10%	Looks manufactured
Many anchors in a language unrelated to our audience	Spam or negative SEO (Chapter 45)
Adult, casino or drug-spam anchors	Negative SEO or hacked sites linking
One anchor repeated across unrelated sites	A campaign footprint

🔵 *Expert judgment*

14.6 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Default to brand or URL anchors	Ask editors for exact-match anchors
Use descriptive anchors that match the target page	Repeat the same commercial anchor
Let editors choose natural anchors	Pressure hosts to change anchors to keywords
Monitor Top linking text monthly	Ignore spammy anchors appearing suddenly

14.7 Pros and cons of exact-match anchors

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
Strong relevance signal when natural	Listed as link spam when "optimized" in paid or guest content
	Easy footprint for spam systems
	Looks unnatural in bios and profiles

14.8 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 14 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Keyword anchors in every bio	Old SEO tutorials	Using approved brand bios	Updating bios you control
Asking an editor to "change anchor to our keyword"	Wants ranking boost	Accepting natural anchors	Apologizing; keeping the relationship
Never checking the anchor profile	Doesn't know where	GSC Top linking text	Running the monthly check today

14.9 Thumb rules

> 👍 When unsure, use the brand name.
>
> 👍 Natural anchors are messy. Perfect anchors are suspicious.
>
> 👍 Never ask for a keyword anchor.

14.10 Notes to remember

📝 Optimized anchors in guest posts and press releases are listed as link spam.

📝 GSC "Top linking text" shows Ongo's anchor profile.

Chapter 14 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Anchor text	The clickable words of a link
Branded anchor	The brand name as link text
Naked URL	The web address itself as link text
Exact-match anchor	Link text identical to a target keyword
Partial-match anchor	Link text containing part of a keyword naturally
Generic anchor	"Here," "this article," "click here"
Anchor profile	The mix of all anchors pointing to a site
Footprint	A repeated pattern that reveals manipulation

Chapter 14 Quiz

1. What does Google's spam policy say about "optimized anchor text" in guest posts?

- A) It's listed as link spam
- B) It's required
- C) It's ignored
- D) It's encouraged

2. Which anchor is safest for a directory listing?

- A) "Cheap weight loss pills"
- B) "ongoweightloss.com"
- C) "Click here"
- D) "Best compounded semaglutide online"

3. What share of Ongo's backlinks should ideally be exact-match commercial anchors?

- A) 0–3%
- B) 50–60%

- C) 30%
- D) 100%

4. Where can you see Ongo's most common anchors in Google's own data?

- A) GSC → Links → Top linking text
- B) Google Ads
- C) GA4 → Events
- D) Moz Spam Score

5. An editor chose "Ongo's guide" as the anchor. What should you do?

- A) Report it to Google
- B) Remove the link
- C) Ask them to change it to a keyword
- D) Accept it; it's natural

6. What does Google say good anchor text should be?

- A) Always "click here"
- B) As long as possible
- C) Descriptive, concise and relevant
- D) Empty

7. Sudden casino and adult anchors pointing to Ongo may indicate…

- A) Negative SEO or spam
- B) A Google update
- C) Great PR
- D) Better rankings

8. In the office analogy, why is everyone calling the new guy "Best Senior Java Developer Delhi" suspicious?

- A) It's unnatural, as if someone taught them to say it
- B) It's in Hindi
- C) It's rude
- D) It's too short

9. What's the best author bio anchor for Ongo?

- A) "Best semaglutide online"
- B) "Cheapest tirzepatide"
- C) "Click here"
- D) "Ongo Weight Loss"

10. Does Google publish an "ideal anchor ratio"?

- A) Yes, in Search Console
- B) Yes, 50/50
- C) No; the ranges in this book are expert judgment

- D) Only for health sites

Sources

1. Google Search Central, Spam policies for Google web search (last updated August 28, 2026)
2. Google Search Central, Make your links crawlable: anchor text (last updated December 10, 2025)
3. SEOTesting, How to use the Links report in Google Search Console

Answer key, Chapter 14: 1-A · 2-B · 3-A · 4-A · 5-D · 6-C · 7-A · 8-A · 9-D · 10-C

LEVEL 2 · CHAPTER 15

Chapter 15: The Two-Axis Grading System

Platinum, Gold, Silver, Bronze, Iron, and Tier 1, 2, 3. One system to grade every link the same way, every time.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> Majestic's **Topical Trust Flow** sorts websites into **800+ topic categories** based on where their trust comes from. [1]
>
> That's the closest thing in the tool world to a "relevance grade." Everything else (DA, DR, AS) only measures strength. Strength without relevance is like a strong recommendation from a stranger.

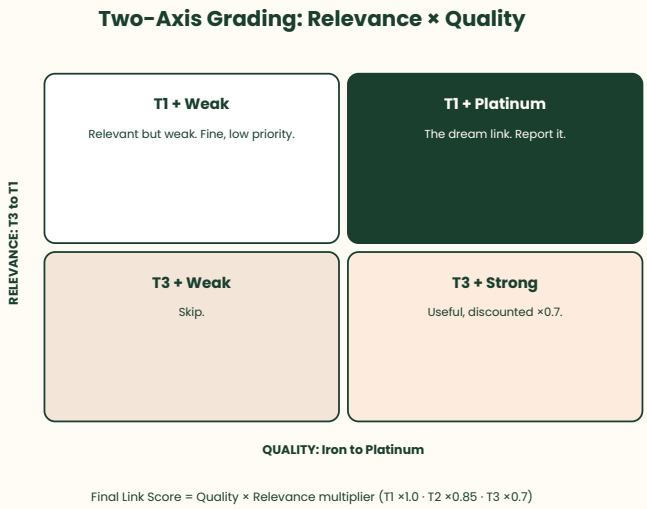
15.1 Why two axes?

Freshers usually grade a link with one number: "DA 45, good link." That mixes two separate questions:

Axis	Question	Example
Relevance (Tier 1–3)	How related is this site to Ongo?	A GLP-1 patient blog vs a gaming news site
Quality (Platinum → Iron)	How strong and trustworthy is this specific link?	Real traffic, clean editorial standards, in-content placement

A strong but irrelevant site and a relevant but weak site are **different problems**. One number hides that.

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: shaadi ki recommendation**
>
> Do log tumhare bete ki tareef karte hain:
>
> 1. **Shehar ke bade businessman**, jo tumhare bete ko kabhi mile nahi. (Strong, not relevant.)
> 2. **Bete ka college professor**, jo usse 4 saal se jaanta hai. (Relevant, maybe less famous.)
>
> Ladki wale kiski baat zyada maanenge? Professor ki. **Aur agar shehar ka sabse bada doctor, jo bete ka mentor bhi hai, tareef kare? Woh Platinum + Tier 1 hai.**



> 📝 **Note to remember:** This grading system is **Ongo's internal system** 🔵. Agencies use many versions of "Tier 1/2/3" and "Gold/Silver" labels. Google doesn't grade links this way publicly. We use it so every teammate scores links consistently.

15.2 Axis 1: Relevance tiers

Tier	Definition	Ongo examples
Tier 1: Exact niche	The site is mainly about weight loss, obesity medicine, GLP-1s, metabolic health or telehealth	A GLP-1 patient community blog, an obesity medicine society, a telehealth industry publication
Tier 2: Category	The site covers health, medicine, nutrition or fitness broadly, including our topic	A general health magazine, a dietitian's blog, a women's health site
Tier 3: Contextual	The site isn't about health, but the **specific page** is relevant	A personal finance site's article on "the real cost of GLP-1 drugs," a local news story on telehealth
Not relevant	Neither the site nor the page is related	A gaming site, a crypto blog, a random directory

Rule: "Not relevant" links are **not built**, whatever their strength. 🔵

How to decide the tier quickly

1. Read the site's homepage and About page. What's it **mainly** about? → Tier 1 or 2?
2. If not health, read the **specific page**. Is the page about our topic? → Tier 3?
3. Check Majestic's Topical Trust Flow: top categories like *Health/Medicine*, *Health/Nutrition*, *Health/Fitness* support Tier 1–2. [1] 🟠

15.3 Axis 2: Quality score (0–100)

Score every link on eight checks. This is Ongo's scoring checklist. 🔵

#	Check	Points	How to score
1	**Organic traffic**	0–20	0 = under 100/mo · 5 = 100–999 · 10 = 1k–9.9k · 15 = 10k–99k · 20 = 100k+
2	**Traffic trend (12 months)**	0–10	0 = crashed · 5 = flat/up-down · 10 = stable or growing
3	**Authority (DR or AS)**	0–15	0 = under 10 · 5 = 10–29 · 10 = 30–59 · 15 = 60+
4	**Editorial standards** (eyeball score, Chapter 11)	0–15	0 = eyeball 0–8 · 8 = 9–12 · 15 = 13–16
5	**Placement**	0–10	0 = footer/comment · 4 = sidebar/profile · 7 = bio/resource list · 10 = in main content
6	**Link attribute**	0–10	5 = nofollow/ugc/sponsored · 10 = followed editorial (never paid)
7	**Spam signals** (outbound links, spam score, link selling)	0–10	0 = clear spam signs · 5 = some concerns · 10 = clean
8	**Referral potential**	0–10	0 = nobody will click · 5 = some clicks likely · 10 = an audience of likely patients
	Total	**0–100**	

Quality tiers

Quality tier	Score	Meaning
🏆 **Platinum**	85–100	Rare, outstanding. Report to your manager.
🥇 **Gold**	70–84	Strong link. The core of a good month.
🥈 **Silver**	55–69	Solid. Worth doing.
🥉 **Bronze**	40–54	Small value. Do only if quick and safe.
⚙️ **Iron**	Below 40	Little or no value. Usually skip.

15.4 Putting both axes together: the Final Link Score

Relevance adjusts quality:

Relevance tier	Multiplier
Tier 1	× 1.00

Relevance tier	Multiplier
Tier 2	× 0.85
Tier 3	× 0.70
Not relevant	× 0 (don't build)

Final Link Score = Quality score × Relevance multiplier

Then apply the same Platinum → Iron bands to the **final** score.

🟧 **Ongo example**

Link	Quality	Tier	Final	Grade
Dietitian blog, in-content, followed, 12k visits, DR 35, clean	80	T2 (×0.85)	68	🥈 Silver
GLP-1 patient community guide, in-content, nofollow, 40k visits, DR 48	83	T1 (×1.0)	83	🥇 Gold
Health news site quoting our doctor, followed, 500k visits, DR 82	95	T1 (×1.0)	95	🏆 Platinum
Finance site "GLP-1 costs" article, followed, 60k visits, DR 70	88	T3 (×0.7)	62	🥈 Silver
Free directory, footer-style list, 50 visits, DR 25	22	T3 (×0.7)	15	⚙️ Iron

15.5 Google Sheets formulas

Assume these columns: **J** = Quality score (0–100), **K** = Relevance tier (T1/T2/T3/NR).

Final Link Score (column L):

```
=IF(K2="NR",0,ROUND(J2*IFS(K2="T1",1,K2="T2",0.85,K2="T3",0.7),0))
```

Grade (column M):

```
=IFS(L2>=85,"Platinum",L2>=70,"Gold",L2>=55,"Silver",L2>=40,"Bronze",TRUE,"Iron")
```

Quality score from the 8 checks (if checks are in columns B–I):

```
=SUM(B2:I2)
```

Chapter 40 builds the full sheet around these.

15.6 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Grade relevance and quality separately	Judge a link by DA alone
Score every link the same way	Score your own links generously
Reject "not relevant" links outright	Build a strong irrelevant link "because DR 70"
Re-score links every 6 months (traffic changes)	Assume a grade lasts forever

15.7 Pros and cons of a scoring system

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
Consistent across the team	Some checks are judgment calls
Easy to explain to your manager	Needs tool data for traffic and authority
Shows which tactics produce the best links	Can be gamed if people inflate scores

15.8 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 15 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Giving every link 10/10 placement	Optimism	Using the placement scale strictly	Peer review: a teammate re-scores 5 random links monthly
Calling a Tier 3 link "Tier 1"	Wants a better grade	Judging the site's main topic	Correcting the sheet
Building "NR" links because they're easy	Pressure for volume	The NR = 0 rule	Stopping and logging the lesson

15.9 Thumb rules

👍 Relevance decides **if**. Quality decides **how good**.

👍 Not relevant = not built.

👍 Score honestly. Your manager will check.

15.10 Notes to remember

📝 Platinum 85+ · Gold 70+ · Silver 55+ · Bronze 40+ · Iron below 40.

📝 T1 ×1.0 · T2 ×0.85 · T3 ×0.7 · NR ×0.

Chapter 15 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Relevance tier	How related a site or page is to Ongo (T1, T2, T3, NR)
Quality score	0–100 score from the eight checks
Final Link Score	Quality score × relevance multiplier
Platinum / Gold / Silver / Bronze / Iron	Ongo's link grades
Topical Trust Flow	Majestic's topic categories for a site's trust

Chapter 15 Quiz

1. What are the two axes of the grading system?

- A) Speed and price
- B) Font and colour
- C) DA and PA
- D) Relevance and quality

2. A finance site's article about GLP-1 costs is which tier?

- A) Not relevant
- B) Tier 2
- C) Tier 1
- D) Tier 3 (contextual)

3. What's the relevance multiplier for Tier 2?

- A) 0.85
- B) 0.7
- C) 0
- D) 1.0

4. A link scores 90 quality and is Tier 3. What's its final score and grade?

- A) 45, Bronze

- B) 90, Platinum
- C) 77, Gold
- D) 63, Silver

5. What happens to "not relevant" links?

- A) They're not built
- B) They're Tier 1
- C) They get a bonus
- D) They count as Gold

6. Which Sheets function assigns the grade in this book's formula?

- A) SUMIF
- B) CONCAT
- C) VLOOKUP
- D) IFS

7. A followed, never-paid editorial link gets how many points for "link attribute"?

- A) 10
- B) 5
- C) 20
- D) 0

8. Is this grading system an official Google system?

- A) No; it's Ongo's internal, expert-judgment system
- B) Only in Search Console
- C) Yes
- D) Only for Bing

9. What score range is Gold?

- A) 55–69
- B) 85–100
- C) 40–54
- D) 70–84

10. Which tool comes closest to grading relevance?

- A) Majestic Topical Trust Flow
- B) Moz DA
- C) GA4
- D) Google Ads

Sources

1. Majestic, Flow Metric scores (Topical Trust Flow)
2. Ahrefs Help, What is Ahrefs Domain Rating
3. Semrush Knowledge Base, What is Authority Score?

Answer key, Chapter 15: 1-D · 2-D · 3-A · 4-D · 5-A · 6-D · 7-A · 8-A · 9-D · 10-A

Chapter 16: Is This Website Good for a Backlink?

The full vetting process: no tools, free tools, premium tools. Plus every red flag of link farms, PBNs and link sellers.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> Semrush flags it as a **spam signal** when **another domain has a near-identical backlink profile**, or when **many linking domains share the same IP or network**. [1]
>
> That's exactly how private blog networks (PBNs) get caught: they're built by the same people, on the same servers, linking to the same customers.

16.1 The three-level vetting process



Any link-selling or PBN sign = reject, whatever the metrics.

Level	Time	When to use
1. No tools (eyeball test)	2 minutes	Every site, always
2. Free tools	5 minutes	Sites that pass Level 1
3. Premium tools	5–10 minutes	Shortlisted sites, or anything above Silver potential

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: kiraayedaar rakhna**
>
> Ghar kiraye pe dena hai. 1. **Dekh ke** samjho: kaisa insaan hai, kaisi baatein karta hai. (No tools.) 2. **Aadhaar aur pichle makaan-maalik se** poochho. (Free tools.) 3. **Police verification** karwao. (Premium tools.)
>
> Har kiraayedaar ke liye teeno step, chahe kitna bhi accha lage.

16.2 Level 1: No tools (2 minutes)

Run the eyeball test from Chapter 11. Skip the site if it scores 0–8 out of 16.

Add these quick checks:

Check	How	Red flag
Indexed?	`site:domain.com` in Google [2] 🟢	Few or no results
Brand search	Search the site's name	No independent mentions anywhere
Write-for-us page	Search site for "write for us," "sponsored"	Price list for dofollow links
Topic focus	Read 5 recent post titles	Health, casino, crypto, loans all mixed
Author reality	Click an author	"Admin," no bio, AI-looking headshot

16.3 Level 2: Free tools (5 minutes)

Check	Tool	Pass	Fail
Organic traffic estimate	Semrush free (or Ahrefs if available)	500+/month	Near zero
Traffic trend (12 months)	Semrush free	Stable or growing	Sudden crash
Authority Score	Semrush free	Reasonable for niche	Very high with no traffic
Trust Flow vs Citation Flow	Majestic	TF at least ~half of CF	CF far above TF
Topical Trust Flow	Majestic	Health-related top topics	Unrelated topics
Spam Score	Moz (save for shortlist)	Under 30%	High

Thresholds: 🔵 Expert judgment. Tool limits: Chapter 10.

16.4 Level 3: Premium tools (if you have access)

Check	Tool feature	What you're looking for
Referring domains growth	Ahrefs/Semrush backlink history	Natural growth, not sudden spikes
Outbound linking domains	Ahrefs "Linked domains"	Links to casinos, pills, loans = link seller
Organic keywords	Ahrefs/Semrush	Ranks for real topics, not just its own name
Top pages	Ahrefs/Semrush	Traffic spread across real articles
Anchor text of its backlinks	Ahrefs/Semrush	Natural brand anchors, not spammy keywords
Shared IPs / networks	Semrush spam factors [1] 🟠	Many linking sites on one network

> 📝 **Note to remember:** If your team doesn't have premium tools, Level 2 is enough for most decisions. Ask your team lead before using a prospect for a Platinum-level pitch. 🔵

16.5 Red flags: link farms

A **link farm** is a site (or group) that exists mainly to sell or exchange links.

Red flag	Why it matters
"Write for us" with a price list	Selling links = link spam [3] 🟢
Every post has 2–4 commercial outbound links	Built for selling
Topics all over the place	No real audience
Thin, generic, AI-sounding articles	Scaled content abuse [3] 🟢
"Admin" authors, no About page	No real publisher
Traffic doesn't match DR	Authority inflated

16.6 Red flags: PBNs (private blog networks)

A **PBN** is a group of websites, often built on expired domains, controlled by one person or company and used to link to their customers.

PBN footprint	How to spot it
Expired domain with a past life	The site's old content (check the Wayback Machine) was about something else entirely

PBN footprint	How to spot it
Generic theme, thin About page	Same template across many sites
Links to unrelated "client" sites	A plumbing post linking to a supplement shop
Shared hosting / IP with similar sites	Spam factor in some tools [1] 🟠
No social profiles, no real brand mentions	Nobody knows the site exists
Traffic near zero despite DR 30–60	Authority made from other PBN sites

🟧 **Ongo example**

A site called "WellnessDailyHub," DR 52, offers a "permanent dofollow link in a weight-loss article" for $120. The Wayback Machine shows it used to be a wedding photographer's site until 2023. Its last 10 posts cover keto, crypto, car insurance and CBD, each with commercial links. Traffic: ~40 visits/month.

Expired domain + topic mismatch + link selling + no traffic = **classic PBN/link farm. Reject and log.**

16.7 Red flags: link sellers in disguise

They say	What it means
"Guest post with permanent dofollow link"	Paid link
"Editorial fee" / "admin fee" for a link	Paid link
"We don't mark links sponsored"	They're selling ranking credit [3] 🟢
"Niche edit on an aged page"	Paying to insert links into old articles = paid link
"Guaranteed indexing within 48 hours"	Manufactured link

16.8 The vetting decision table

Result	Action
Fails eyeball test	**Reject**
Passes eyeball, fails 2+ free-tool checks	**Reject**
Passes eyeball, fails 1 free-tool check	**Hold**; ask your team lead
Passes all Level 1–2 checks	**Approve**; score it (Chapter 15)
Any link-selling or PBN red flag	**Reject**, regardless of metrics

16.9 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Vet every site at Level 1, no exceptions	Skip vetting for "big" sites
Use the Wayback Machine for suspicious domains	Trust a site's age without checking its history
Log rejected sites with a reason	Re-vet the same rejected site next month
Escalate unclear cases	Approve a site you have doubts about

16.10 Pros and cons of strict vetting

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
Keeps Ongo out of bad neighbourhoods	Fewer opportunities
Every approved link is defensible	Takes time per site
Builds a reusable approved/rejected list	Some tool data costs money

16.11 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 16 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Approving high-DR sites without looking	DR worship	Level 1 first	Re-vetting last month's approvals
Missing expired-domain PBNs	Not checking history	Wayback Machine	Adding them to the rejected list
Believing "editorial fee" isn't payment	Clever wording	Red-flag phrases table	Declining politely
Not logging rejections	Feels like wasted work	A "Rejected" tab in the sheet	Starting the tab today

16.12 Thumb rules

👍 Eyes, then free tools, then premium tools. Never skip step one.

👍 Any PBN or link-selling sign = reject, whatever the DR.

👍 Log every rejection with a reason.

16.13 Notes to remember

📝 Many linking sites on one network is a spam factor.

📝 "Editorial fee," "niche edit," "permanent dofollow" all mean paid links.

Chapter 16 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Vetting	Checking whether a site is safe and valuable for a link
Link farm	A site that exists mainly to sell or exchange links
PBN	Private blog network: sites controlled by one party to create links
Wayback Machine	An archive showing what a website looked like in the past
Niche edit	Inserting a link into an existing article, usually for payment
Footprint	A shared pattern that reveals sites are connected
Referring domains	Unique websites linking to a site

Chapter 16 Quiz

1. What's the first level of vetting?

- A) Calling the site owner
- B) Premium tools
- C) Buying a link
- D) No tools (eyeball test)

2. A site offers "permanent dofollow link, $120." What is it?

- A) A resource page
- B) A paid link: link spam
- C) An editorial opportunity
- D) A journalist request

3. What does a site's old life in the Wayback Machine help you spot?

- A) Its anchor text
- B) Its font
- C) Expired-domain PBNs
- D) Page speed

4. Which Semrush spam factor helps catch PBNs?

- A) Long articles
- B) A fast website
- C) A blue logo
- D) Many linking domains on the same IP or network

5. A site passes the eyeball test but fails two free-tool checks. Decision?

- A) Buy the link
- B) Reject
- C) Hold forever
- D) Approve

6. "Niche edit on an aged page" usually means...

- A) A free editorial link
- B) A podcast
- C) Paying to insert a link into an old article
- D) A press release

7. Should high-DR sites skip the eyeball test?

- A) Yes
- B) Only for Tier 1 sites
- C) Only if DR is above 80
- D) No; every site gets Level 1

8. A plumbing blog post linking to a supplement shop is a sign of...

- A) A news site
- B) Nothing
- C) Good relevance
- D) A PBN or link-selling pattern

9. Why log rejected sites?

- A) To avoid re-vetting them and to keep a record
- B) To buy links later
- C) To report them to Google
- D) No reason

10. What should you do with an unclear case?

- A) Ignore it
- B) Approve it
- C) Escalate to your team lead
- D) Delete the sheet

Sources

1. Semrush Knowledge Base, What is Authority Score?
2. Google Search Central, SEO Starter Guide (last updated December 10, 2025)
3. Google Search Central, Spam policies for Google web search (last updated August 28, 2026)

Answer key, Chapter 16: 1-D · 2-B · 3-C · 4-D · 5-B · 6-C · 7-D · 8-D · 9-A · 10-C

LEVEL 2 · CHAPTER 17

Chapter 17: Know Ongo's Market and Audience

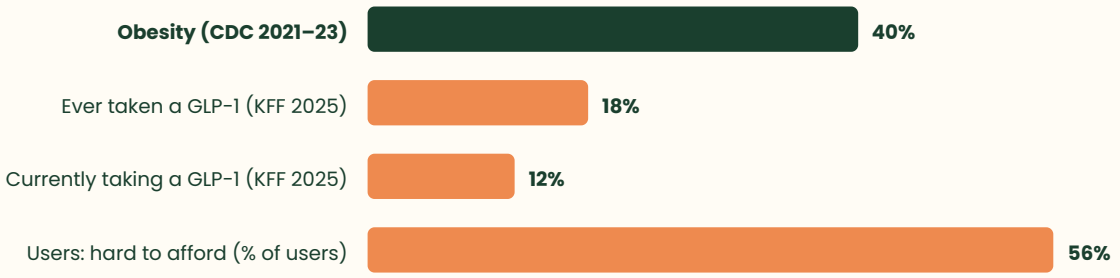
You can't earn mentions from places you don't know exist. First learn where Ongo's patients actually spend their time.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> In a KFF poll from late 2025, **12% of US adults** said they were **currently taking a GLP-1 drug**, and **18%** said they had **ever taken one**. More than half of current users (**56%**) said the drugs were **difficult to afford**. [1] 🟠
>
> That's tens of millions of Americans, with a strong worry about cost. Every place they ask questions about GLP-1s and cost is a place Ongo's reputation is being formed.

17.1 The market in numbers

Fact	Figure	Source
US adults (20+) with obesity, Aug 2021–Aug 2023	About **40%**	CDC/NCHS [2] 🟢 US government
US adults with severe obesity	Almost **1 in 10**	CDC/NCHS [2] 🟢
Adults currently taking a GLP-1 (Oct–Nov 2025)	**12%**	KFF poll [1] 🟠
Adults who have ever taken a GLP-1	**18%**	KFF poll [1] 🟠
GLP-1 users ages 50–64 currently taking	**22%** of that age group	KFF poll [1] 🟠
Users who say GLP-1s are hard to afford	**56%**	KFF poll [1] 🟠
Users who got their GLP-1 from an online provider or website	**17%**	KFF poll [1] 🟠

Ongo's Market in Numbers (US adults)



Sources: CDC/NCHS; KFF poll fielded Oct–Nov 2025.

🟧 **What this means for off-page work**

- **Cost** is a top worry → finance, budgeting and insurance sites are Tier 3 opportunities (Chapter 15).
- **Online access is already normal** for a share of users → telehealth and digital-health publications matter.
- **Ages 50–64** are heavy users → sites, forums and media for that age group are relevant.
- **Women** reported higher current use than men in the same poll (15% vs 9%) [1] 🟠 → women's health sites are relevant.

17.2 Who is Ongo's patient? (Persona sketches)

These personas are **illustrative**, built from the data above and Book One's audience profile. 🔵

Persona	Snapshot	Where they read and ask	What earns their trust
"Cost-conscious Carla," 52	Has tried diets for years; worried about price	Facebook groups, Reddit, personal finance sites, AARP-type media	Transparent pricing, real doctors, honest side-effect info
"Researcher Raj," 38	Reads everything before deciding	Reddit GLP-1 communities, health news, YouTube explainers	Data, citations, doctor explanations
"Busy Brenda," 45	Wants convenience, no clinic visits	Women's health sites, podcasts, Instagram	Clear process, reviews, telehealth convenience
"Skeptical Steve," 58	Unsure compounded drugs are safe	News sites, YouTube doctors, forums	Clear explanation of compounded vs brand, safety, licensed providers

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: shaadi ke mehmaan**
>
> Shaadi mein sab mehmaan ek jaise nahi hote. Dadi ko sabse pehle khana chahiye, cousins ko DJ, uncle log ko bar counter. **Har group ko alag jagah milta hai.**
>
> Patients bhi alag jagah milte hain. Carla Facebook pe, Raj Reddit pe, Brenda podcast pe. **Off-page ka kaam hai: har group ki jagah pe Ongo ka acchha naam ho.**

17.3 Where to find the audience: 7 research methods

#	Method	What you learn	Tool	Evidence
1	**Google autocomplete + "People also ask"**	Real questions people type	Google	🔵
2	**Google Trends**	Interest over time and by state	Google Trends [3] 🟢	🟢
3	**Search Console queries**	What people already search to find Ongo	GSC	🟢
4	**Reddit search**	Raw patient questions and worries	Reddit	🔵
5	**Quora / forums**	Repeated questions	Quora, health forums	🔵
6	**YouTube comments**	What confuses people	YouTube	🔵
7	**Competitor mentions**	Where competitors are discussed (Chapter 18)	Google, tools	🔵

Search operators to find audience spaces

Search	Finds
`semaglutide forum`	Forums discussing semaglutide
`tirzepatide site:reddit.com`	Reddit threads about tirzepatide
`"GLP-1" "cost" blog`	Blogs discussing GLP-1 costs
`"compounded semaglutide" "my experience"`	Personal experience posts
`weight loss podcast doctor guest`	Podcasts featuring doctors
`"GLP-1" intitle:resources`	Resource pages

17.4 Mapping audience questions to off-page opportunities

Patient question	Content Ongo can offer (with medical review)	Off-page opportunity
"How much does tirzepatide cost without insurance?"	A clear cost guide	Personal finance sites, budget blogs
"Is compounded semaglutide safe?"	Doctor-reviewed explainer	Health journalists, YMYL resource pages
"What should I eat on GLP-1s?"	Protein/nutrition guide with a dietitian	Nutrition blogs, recipe sites
"How do I inject semaglutide?"	Step-by-step video guide	YouTube, patient communities
"Side effects: nausea?"	Side-effect management guide	Forums, health Q&A sites

17.5 Understanding the market: who else is talking?

Group	Role in Ongo's off-page world
Health journalists	Quote doctors; link to useful data (Chapter 20)
Dietitians and nutritionists	Write about eating on GLP-1s; Tier 1–2 links
Patient bloggers and creators	Share experiences; need honesty and disclosure (Chapter 12)
Personal finance writers	Cover drug costs; Tier 3 links
Telehealth / digital health media	Industry coverage
Competitors	Already earned links we can study (Chapter 18)

17.6 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Build a list of real communities and publications	Assume patients only use Google
Use real questions to plan linkable content	Guess what patients want
Respect community rules (Chapter 25)	Drop links into every thread you find
Note audience data sources with dates	Quote old statistics without dates

17.7 Pros and cons of audience-first off-page

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
Links come from places patients actually read	Takes research time upfront
Better referral traffic and conversions	Some audience spaces don't give followed links
Content ideas come for free	Communities are sensitive to promotion

17.8 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 17 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Targeting only "SEO sites"	Thinking like a link builder	Starting with patient spaces	Building an audience map this week
Ignoring cost-focused sites	Not seeing them as "health"	Using Tier 3 thinking	Adding finance sites to prospects
Using stats without dates	Copy-paste habit	Always noting source + date	Fixing old outreach templates

17.9 Thumb rules

👍 Go where the patients are, not where the links are easy.

👍 Every patient question is a content idea and an outreach opportunity.

👍 Statistics need a source and a date, every time.

17.10 Notes to remember

📝 ~40% of US adults have obesity (CDC, 2021–2023).

📝 12% currently take a GLP-1; 56% of users find them hard to afford (KFF, late 2025).

Chapter 17 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Persona	A simple profile of a typical patient

Term	Simple meaning
Audience map	A list of places where Ongo's patients read and talk
Search operator	A special search command like `site:` or `intitle:`
People also ask	Google's box of related questions
Google Trends	Google's tool showing search interest over time

Chapter 17 Quiz

1. According to CDC data (2021–2023), about what share of US adults have obesity?

- A) 70%
- B) 40%
- C) 25%
- D) 10%

2. In the KFF late-2025 poll, what share of adults were currently taking a GLP-1?

- A) 12%
- B) 60%
- C) 40%
- D) 2%

3. What share of GLP-1 users said the drugs were difficult to afford?

- A) 90%
- B) 25%
- C) 10%
- D) 56%

4. Why are personal finance sites relevant to Ongo?

- A) They sell links
- B) Cost is a top patient worry, so they're Tier 3 opportunities
- C) They're Tier 1
- D) They aren't relevant

5. Which tool shows search interest over time and by state?

- A) Moz
- B) Bing Ads
- C) Majestic
- D) Google Trends

6. What does `tirzepatide site:reddit.com` find?

- A) Reddit threads about tirzepatide
- B) Ads about tirzepatide
- C) Ongo's pages
- D) FDA letters

7. Are the personas in this chapter real people?

- A) Only Raj
- B) Yes
- C) Only Carla
- D) No, they're illustrative

8. Which age group showed the highest current GLP-1 use in the poll?

- A) 50–64
- B) 18–29
- C) 30–49
- D) 65+

9. What's the best starting point for off-page planning?

- A) Where patients actually read and ask questions
- B) Random directories
- C) Sites that accept links easily
- D) The highest DA sites

10. What must every statistic in outreach include?

- A) A source and a date
- B) An emoji
- C) A discount code
- D) Nothing

Sources

1. KFF, Poll: 1 in 8 adults say they are currently taking a GLP-1 drug (published November 14, 2025; fielded Oct 27–Nov 2, 2025)
2. CDC National Center for Health Statistics, NHANES August 2021–August 2023 data released with obesity report (October 2024)
3. Google Search Central, Get started with Google Trends

Answer key, Chapter 17: 1-B · 2-A · 3-D · 4-B · 5-D · 6-A · 7-D · 8-A · 9-A · 10-A

LEVEL 2 · CHAPTER 18

Chapter 18: Competitor Backlink Analysis

Your competitors have already done years of off-page work. Learn from it, without copying their mistakes.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> You can see a large part of a competitor's backlinks **for free** using Bing Webmaster Tools' comparison feature, without any access to their website. [1] 🟠
>
> Most teams pay for tools before they've even tried the free one.

18.1 Why study competitors?

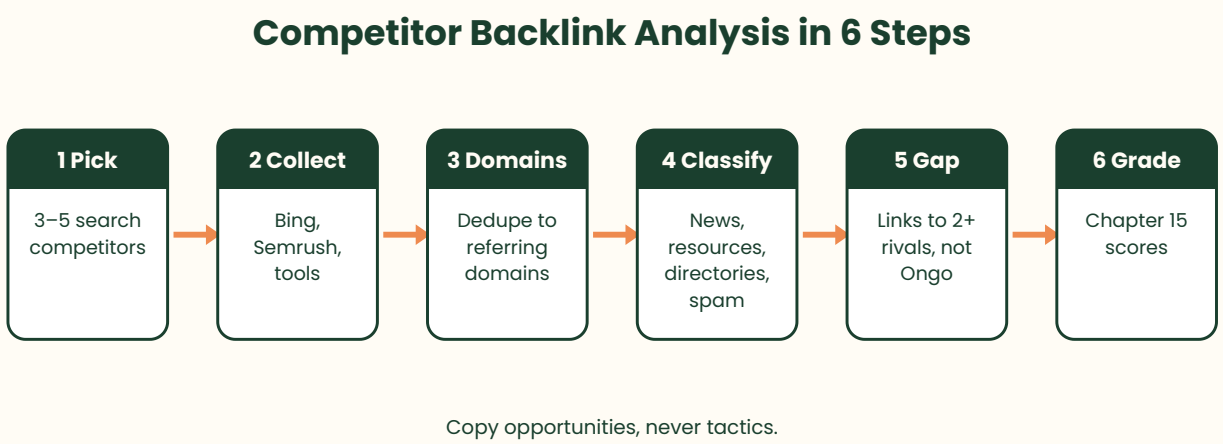
Ongo competes with telehealth brands such as Ro, Hims & Hers, Henry Meds, Mochi Health, Fridays, ShedRx, FuturHealth, LifeMD, WeightWatchers, Found, Calibrate, Form Health and IVIM Health (from the Ongo project's competitor list).

Studying their backlinks tells you:

Question	Why it helps
Which sites link to telehealth weight-loss brands?	A ready-made prospect list
Which content earns them links?	Ideas for linkable assets (Chapter 19)
Which journalists cover the space?	Digital PR targets (Chapter 20)
Which directories and associations list them?	Business link opportunities
Which of their links look spammy?	What **not** to copy

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: cricket team ka video analysis**
>
> Match se pehle team opponent ke purane match dekhti hai: kis bowler ne kahan wicket liya, kis batsman ki kamzori kya hai.
>
> Copy nahi karte. **Samajhte hain**, phir apni strategy banate hain. Competitor backlink analysis wahi video analysis hai.
>
> 📝 **Note to remember:** Don't assume a competitor's link profile is clean. Big brands sometimes have risky links too. Copy their **good** opportunities, never their tactics blindly. 🔵

18.2 The 6-step competitor analysis



Copy opportunities, never tactics.

Step 1: Pick 3–5 true search competitors

Your **search competitors** are the sites ranking for Ongo's important topics, not just business rivals.

1. Search Ongo's key topics (e.g. "compounded tirzepatide," "semaglutide cost").
2. Note the domains that appear repeatedly in the top results.
3. Mix: 2 big brands + 2 similar-size competitors + 1 content publisher.

Step 2: Collect their backlinks

Tool	How
Bing Webmaster Tools (free)	Backlinks → compare with a "similar site" [1]
Semrush free	Backlink overview for each competitor (limited reports/day) [2]
Ahrefs / Semrush paid (if available)	Referring domains export
Google search	`"competitor name" -site:competitor.com` to find mentions

Step 3: Filter to linking domains, not individual links

One site linking 500 times = **1 referring domain**. Work with domains.

Step 4: Classify each domain

Category	Example	Action
News / journalism	Health news site quoting a competitor's doctor	PR target (Chapter 20)
Resource page	"Best telehealth weight-loss resources"	Pitch our guide (Chapter 22)
Directory / listing	Healthcare directory	Get listed if quality (Chapter 33)
Review / comparison site	"Best GLP-1 telehealth companies"	Check for paid placements; approach carefully

Category	Example	Action
Partnership / sponsorship	Nonprofit sponsor page	Consider real partnerships (Chapter 26)
Spammy / irrelevant	Link farms, PBNs	**Ignore; don't copy**

Step 5: Link gap analysis

A **link gap** = sites linking to **two or more competitors** but **not to Ongo**.

> 📝 **Why "two or more"?** If a site links to several telehealth brands, it's open to the topic and likely to consider Ongo too. 🔵

In Google Sheets: put each competitor's referring domains in its own column, then count how many competitors each domain appears for:

```
=COUNTIF($B$2:$F$500, A2)
```

Then check Ongo's list:

```
=IF(COUNTIF(OngoDomains!A:A, A2)>0, "Already links", "Gap")
```

Step 6: Prioritize with the grading system

Score each gap domain with Chapter 15's system. Pursue Platinum/Gold first.

18.3 What content earns competitors links?

Use **"Top pages by links"** (Ahrefs/Semrush) or note which competitor pages get cited in articles. Look for patterns:

Pattern	What it tells you	Ongo idea (with medical review)
Cost calculators get many links	People link to useful tools	A GLP-1 cost comparison tool
Survey data gets cited by news	Journalists love numbers	An Ongo patient survey (anonymized, approved)
Doctor-reviewed guides get resource links	Trusted explainers spread	Side-effects guide reviewed by Ongo doctors
State-by-state pages	Local news links	A careful telehealth availability page

---

18.4 Competitor mentions without links

Search: `"competitor name" GLP-1 -site:competitor.com`

You'll find articles comparing telehealth brands. If Ongo isn't mentioned, it's a **pitch opportunity**: offer accurate, approved information so the writer can consider including Ongo in future updates. 🔵

🟧 **Ongo example**

You find "7 Telehealth Options for GLP-1 Treatment in 2026" on a health site, listing four competitors but not Ongo. The article was updated in August 2026.

Action: Polite email to the editor with a short, approved description of Ongo, our medical team, and transparent pricing, asking them to consider Ongo in the next update. No payment, no demands about anchors.

18.5 Warning: what not to copy

Competitor tactic you might see	Why not to copy
"Best GLP-1 clinic" lists that are clearly paid placements	Paid links without sponsored labels = link spam [3] 🟢
Coupon pages on big news sites	Site reputation abuse risk [3] 🟢
Hundreds of thin affiliate review sites	Scaled content / affiliate spam
Sameness claims in their PR	FDA risk (Chapter 12)

18.6 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Analyse 3–5 search competitors	Analyse 20 and finish none
Focus on domains linking to 2+ competitors	Pitch every site a competitor has
Grade gap domains before outreach	Assume competitor links are all good
Use Bing's free comparison	Wait for a paid tool before starting
Copy opportunities, not tactics	Buy the same paid placements competitors bought

18.7 Pros and cons of competitor analysis

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
Fast list of proven, relevant prospects	Competitors may have risky links
Shows what content earns links	Free tool data is limited
Reveals journalists covering the space	Some links came from relationships we don't have

18.8 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 18 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Copying every competitor link	Assuming big brand = clean	Grading every gap domain	Removing spammy domains from the list
Counting links, not domains	Confusing metrics	Using referring domains	Deduplicating the sheet
Pitching paid "best of" lists for free inclusion	Not noticing paid labels	Reading the page's disclosure	Skipping or treating as sponsored

18.9 Thumb rules

👍 Study the opponent; play your own game.

👍 Two or more competitors linked? Strong prospect.

👍 Copy opportunities, never tactics.

18.10 Notes to remember

📝 Link gap = links to 2+ competitors, not to Ongo.

📝 Bing Webmaster Tools offers free competitor backlink comparison.

Chapter 18 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Search competitor	A site ranking for the same topics as Ongo
Referring domain	A unique website linking to a site
Link gap	Sites linking to competitors but not to Ongo
Top pages by links	A competitor's pages that earned the most links
Paid placement	A position in a list that was bought

Chapter 18 Quiz

1. What is a "link gap"?

- A) Sites linking to 2+ competitors but not to Ongo
- B) Missing anchor text
- C) A gap in the website design
- D) A broken link

2. Which free tool lets you compare a competitor's backlinks?

- A) Google Trends
- B) Moz free
- C) Bing Webmaster Tools
- D) GA4

3. Why work with referring domains instead of individual links?

- A) Domains are cheaper
- B) Google requires it
- C) Links don't matter
- D) One site can link many times; domains show unique sources

4. A competitor appears in "best GLP-1 clinics" lists that are clearly paid. What should you do?

- A) Pay double
- B) Not copy; paid followed links are link spam
- C) Report Ongo
- D) Copy it exactly

5. Which Sheets function counts how many competitors a domain appears for?

- A) TODAY
- B) COUNTIF
- C) SUM
- D) VLOOKUP

6. How many competitors should you analyse?

- A) 1
- B) All of them
- C) 3–5
- D) 20+

7. An article lists four competitors but not Ongo. What's the best action?

- A) Leave an angry comment
- B) Ignore it
- C) Politely offer approved information for a future update
- D) Pay the editor

8. In the cricket analogy, competitor analysis is like…

- A) Skipping the match

- B) Changing teams
- C) Studying the opponent's past matches to plan your own strategy
- D) Copying the opponent's batting

9. Should you assume big competitors have clean link profiles?

- A) Only for nofollow links
- B) Yes
- C) Only Ro
- D) No

10. What do you do with gap domains before outreach?

- A) Disavow them
- B) Grade them with the Chapter 15 system
- C) Email all at once
- D) Buy links from them

Sources

1. Search Engine Land, Bing Webmaster Tools now gives you competitive link data (June 2, 2020)
2. Dupple, Best free SEO tools in 2026 (October 2026)
3. Google Search Central, Spam policies for Google web search (last updated August 28, 2026)

Answer key, Chapter 18: 1-A · 2-C · 3-D · 4-B · 5-B · 6-C · 7-C · 8-C · 9-D · 10-B

LEVEL 2 · CHAPTER 19

Chapter 19: Linkable Assets: Content That Earns Links on Its Own

The best link builders don't chase links. They build things people want to link to.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> Google's guide to AI search warns against **"commodity content"**: generic posts like "7 tips for first-time homebuyers" that anyone could write. It says **non-commodity content** with unique expert or experienced takes is what stands out. [1] ● Google official
>
> The same idea decides which pages earn links. Nobody links to the 500th copy of "What is semaglutide?"

19.1 What is a linkable asset?

A **linkable asset** is a page so useful, original or interesting that other sites link to it **without being paid or pressured**.

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: mohalle ki famous dukaan**
>
> Har mohalle mein ek dukaan hoti hai jiske baare mein sab bolte hain: "Samose chahiye? **Sharma ji ke yahan jao.**" Sharma ji ne kabhi kisi ko bolne ke paise nahi diye. Samosa itna accha hai ki log khud recommend karte hain.
>
> **Linkable asset = Sharma ji ka samosa.** Ek baar ban gaya, toh recommendations khud aati hain.

Google's own guidance supports this: content that is **original, insightful, beyond the obvious** and that people would **bookmark, share or recommend** is what its systems aim to reward. [2] ● Google official

19.2 The 8 types of linkable assets

Type	Example for Ongo (with medical review)	Who links	Link potential
Original data / survey	"What 1,000 US adults think GLP-1s cost" (properly run survey)	Journalists, bloggers	⭐⭐⭐⭐⭐
Free tool / calculator	BMI calculator, GLP-1 cost comparison tool	Resource pages, health blogs	⭐⭐⭐⭐⭐

Type	Example for Ongo (with medical review)	Who links	Link potential
Definitive guide	"Compounded vs FDA-approved GLP-1s: the complete patient guide"	Health sites, forums	⭐⭐⭐⭐
Visual asset	Infographic: "How GLP-1s work in the body"	Educators, bloggers	⭐⭐⭐⭐
Templates / checklists	"Questions to ask before starting GLP-1 treatment" printable	Patient communities, dietitians	⭐⭐⭐
Expert commentary	Doctor's take on new research	Journalists	⭐⭐⭐⭐
Glossary / reference	GLP-1 terms explained simply	Students, writers	⭐⭐⭐
State / local resources	Telehealth rules by state (carefully maintained)	Local news, state-focused blogs	⭐⭐⭐

Link potential: ● Expert judgment.

What Makes an Asset Linkable



Aim for at least two. For Ongo, 'trustworthy' is mandatory.

19.3 The linkable asset formula

A page earns links when it has at least **two** of these: ●

Ingredient	Question to ask
Original	Does it contain something nobody else has (data, experience, expert view)?
Useful	Does it solve a real problem better than what exists?
Trustworthy	Is it accurate, sourced, medically reviewed, with clear authors?
Easy to cite	Is there a clear stat, chart or quote someone can reference?
Up to date	Does it show a recent update date and current information?

📝 **Note to remember:** For YMYL topics, "trustworthy" isn't optional. Google says YMYL content must be highly accurate and match expert consensus. [2] ●

19.4 Step-by-step: building a linkable asset

1. **Find the gap.** Use Chapter 17 questions and Chapter 18 "top pages by links." What's missing or weak?
2. **Pick the format.** Data, tool, guide, visual or template.
3. **Plan the "citable bit."** One stat, one chart, one checklist people will quote.
4. **Build it with experts.** Ongo doctors or dietitians contribute; medical review approves.
5. **Make it easy to share.** Embed codes for charts, clear headings, a short summary at the top.
6. **Promote it.** Outreach (Chapter 30), PR (Chapter 20), communities (Chapter 25), resource pages (Chapter 22).
7. **Update it.** Set a review date (e.g. every 6 months) and show "Last reviewed" on the page.

🟧 **Ongo example: the cost tool**

Patients worry about cost (Chapter 17). Ongo builds a simple, honest **"GLP-1 monthly cost comparison"** page: typical price ranges for brand-name vs compounded options, insurance notes, sourced and dated, reviewed by the medical team, with no sameness claims.

Personal finance bloggers, health reporters and patient forums now have a reason to link to Ongo that has nothing to do with "please link to us."

19.5 Original data: doing it right

Original data is the strongest asset, and the easiest to get wrong.

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Use a reputable survey method; disclose sample size and dates	Survey 30 people and call it "Americans think..."
Anonymize patient data; get legal/privacy approval	Publish anything that could identify a patient
Present results honestly, including boring ones	Cherry-pick dramatic numbers
Let medical review approve health interpretations	Make medical claims from a survey

19.6 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Build assets around real patient questions	Write another generic "What is GLP-1?" post

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Include a clear, citable stat or chart	Bury the key finding at the bottom
Keep assets updated with review dates	Let a data page go stale
Promote every asset actively	Publish and wait for links to appear

19.7 Pros and cons of linkable assets

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
Earns links for years	Takes real time and expert input
Fully within Google's guidelines	Not every asset succeeds
Builds brand trust and AI visibility	Needs maintenance
Makes outreach easier ("here's something useful")	Data projects need privacy and legal care

19.8 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 19 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Calling a normal blog post a "linkable asset"	Wishful thinking	The two-ingredient test	Adding original data or a tool
Publishing without promotion	Expecting magic	Planning outreach before publishing	Running a 2-week promotion sprint
Unreviewed health claims in an asset	Rushing	Medical review step	Pulling and reviewing it

19.9 Thumb rules

> 👍 Build the samosa, and the recommendations come.
>
> 👍 One citable stat beats a thousand generic words.
>
> 👍 Publish, promote, update. All three.

19.10 Notes to remember

📝 Google contrasts commodity content with non-commodity content.

📝 Linkable = at least two of: original, useful, trustworthy, citable, current.

Chapter 19 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Linkable asset	A page so useful others link to it naturally
Commodity content	Generic content anyone could write
Non-commodity content	Content with unique expertise, data or experience
Citable stat	One clear number others can quote
Embed code	Code that lets others display our chart with credit

Chapter 19 Quiz

1. What does Google call generic content like "7 tips for first-time homebuyers"?

- A) Premium content
- B) Linkable content
- C) Viral content
- D) Commodity content

2. Which is usually the strongest linkable asset?

- A) Original data or a useful free tool
- B) A press release
- C) A directory listing
- D) A generic blog post

3. How many "formula ingredients" should an asset have at minimum?

- A) Two
- B) One
- C) Five
- D) None

4. What must happen before an Ongo asset with health information is published?

- A) A paid promotion

- B) Nothing
- C) A Google review
- D) Medical review

5. Why does a cost comparison tool fit Ongo's audience?

- A) Google requires it
- B) It replaces medical review
- C) Patients worry a lot about GLP-1 costs
- D) It's easy to rank

6. A survey of 30 people presented as "Americans think..." is...

- A) Great data
- B) Misleading
- C) A citation
- D) Required

7. What should you do after publishing an asset?

- A) Delete it
- B) Promote it actively
- C) Buy links to it
- D) Wait

8. Why add a "Last reviewed" date?

- A) It's decorative
- B) It increases word count
- C) Shows the asset is current and trustworthy
- D) Google bans pages without it

9. In the samosa analogy, what's the linkable asset?

- A) The samosa itself
- B) The shop owner
- C) The shop's sign
- D) The price

10. Which is a privacy mistake with original data?

- A) Getting legal approval
- B) Showing dates
- C) Disclosing sample size
- D) Publishing information that could identify a patient

Sources

1. Google Search Central, Optimizing your website for generative AI features on Google Search (last updated July 10, 2026)
2. Google Search Central, Creating helpful, reliable, people-first content (last updated October 5, 2026)

Answer key, Chapter 19: 1-D · 2-A · 3-A · 4-D · 5-C · 6-B · 7-B · 8-C · 9-A · 10-D

LEVEL 2 · CHAPTER 20

Chapter 20: Digital PR and Journalist Requests

The highest-value links Ongo can earn come from journalists who need an expert, fast.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> HARO, the famous "Help a Reporter Out" service, was **shut down by Cision in December 2024**, then **bought and relaunched by Featured.com in April 2025**. [1]
>
> Anyone still teaching "just sign up for HARO" from a 2019 blog post is teaching a service that died and came back in a different form.

20.1 What is digital PR?

Digital PR means getting Ongo, its doctors or its data **mentioned and linked in online news and publications**.

Traditional link building	Digital PR
"Please link to our page"	"Here's an expert answer / new data for your story"
Small blogs	News sites, health publications
One link at a time	One story can be picked up by many sites
SEO value	SEO + brand trust + AI visibility

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: akhbaar mein naam**
>
> Mohalle ke doctor sahab ka naam jab local akhbaar mein aata hai, "Dr. Sharma ne bataya ki dengue se kaise bachein," toh poora shehar unhe expert maanne lagta hai.
>
> **Digital PR = online akhbaar mein Ongo ke doctors ka naam.**

20.2 Journalist request platforms in 2026

Journalists post requests ("Looking for a doctor to comment on GLP-1 side effects") and experts respond.

Platform	How it works	Notes (as of 2026)
HARO (relaunched)	Free daily email digest	Relaunched by Featured.com in 2025; ad-funded [1]
Featured.com	Answer questions on a platform; subscription with limited free access	Approval rates around 18–20% reported in one 12-month test [1]
Qwoted	Verified journalists post requests	Many requests from high-DR publications; approval rate around 6% reported [1]
Source of Sources (SOS)	Free daily email from HARO's original founder	Highest follow-link rate (about 36%) in one study cited [1]

Platform details change often. Verify current terms before signing up.

20.3 The perfect pitch response

Journalists get hundreds of replies. Winners are **fast, short and useful**.



Part	What to write
Subject	Exactly what they asked for: "Doctor comment: GLP-1 nausea tips"
Line 1	Who: "Dr. [Name], [credential], medical team at Ongo Weight Loss"
Answer	2–4 short, quotable sentences that directly answer the question
Credibility	One line: experience, specialty
Offer	"Happy to provide more detail or a headshot"
Link	Author page on Ongo, not a sales page

🟧 **Ongo example**

Request: "Looking for doctors to share tips on managing nausea on GLP-1 medications. Deadline: tomorrow 5pm ET."

Response (after medical review):

Subject: Doctor comment: managing GLP-1 nausea

Hi [Journalist], I'm sharing a comment from Dr. [Name], [credentials], who treats patients on GLP-1 medications at Ongo Weight Loss:

"[2–3 sentences of practical, approved advice, e.g. about smaller meals and when to contact a provider.]"

Dr. [Name]'s profile: [ongoweightloss.com/medical-team/...]. Happy to provide more detail or a headshot.

20.4 Rules for Ongo PR

Rule	Why
Every quote goes through medical review	YMYL + FDA/FTC (Chapter 12)
Only real doctors, with their consent	Fabricated experts are deception [2] 🟢
Never use red-word phrases	"Same as Wegovy," "guaranteed," etc.
Never pay for editorial coverage	Paid links without labels = link spam [3] 🟢
Press releases: brand anchors, nofollow	Optimized anchors in press releases are link spam [3] 🟢
Respond only where we're genuinely expert	Quality over quantity

⚠️ **Where freshers go wrong: answering every request**

- **The mistake:** Replying to every request, even "best travel credit cards," just to get a link.
- **Why it happens:** Chasing volume.
- **How to avoid it:** Answer only health, weight-loss, telehealth and GLP-1 requests where Ongo's doctors are real experts.
- **How to fix it:** Unsubscribe from irrelevant categories; set up keyword filters.

20.5 Proactive digital PR

Waiting for requests is reactive. Proactive PR means **creating stories**:

Story type	Example
New data	Results from an Ongo survey on GLP-1 costs (Chapter 19)
Expert reaction	Doctor's comment on a new FDA announcement, within hours
Trend explainer	"Why more patients are asking about compounded GLP-1s"
Local angle	Telehealth access in a specific state

20.6 Measuring PR

Metric	Where
Coverage count (mentions)	Your sheet
Links (followed / nofollow)	Your sheet + GSC
Referral traffic from coverage	GA4
Brand searches after coverage	GSC Performance (queries with "Ongo")
Response → placement rate	Sheet formula: placements ÷ responses

20.7 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Respond within hours, not days	Reply after the deadline
Keep answers short and quotable	Send 800-word essays
Link to doctor profile pages	Push sales pages
Get medical review on every quote	Invent quotes for doctors
Thank journalists after publication	Ask them to change the anchor

20.8 Pros and cons of digital PR

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
Highest-authority links possible	Low acceptance rates
Builds expert reputation (E-E-A-T)	Needs fast medical review

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
Strong AI visibility signal	Many links are nofollow
Brings brand searches and trust	Unpredictable

20.9 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 20 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Using old HARO tutorials	Outdated content	Checking platform status	Updating your process
Writing quotes for doctors without consent	Speed pressure	A pre-approved quote bank (reviewed)	Withdrawing unapproved quotes
Pitching sales pages	Wants conversions	Linking to expert pages	Updating future responses

20.10 Thumb rules

👍 Fast, short, useful, approved.

👍 Only answer where Ongo is genuinely expert.

👍 Never pay for editorial coverage.

20.11 Notes to remember

📝 HARO closed in December 2024 and was relaunched by Featured.com in 2025.

📝 Press release links: brand anchors, nofollow.

Chapter 20 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Digital PR	Earning online media coverage and links
Journalist request	A reporter asking for expert input
Pitch	A short message offering a story or comment
Coverage	An article mentioning Ongo

Term	Simple meaning
Quote bank	Pre-approved expert statements ready for quick use
Reactive PR	Responding to journalists' requests
Proactive PR	Creating and pitching your own stories

Chapter 20 Quiz

1. What happened to HARO?

- A) It never existed
- B) Shut down in Dec 2024, relaunched by Featured.com in 2025
- C) Bought by Google
- D) It's unchanged since 2010

2. What makes a winning journalist response?

- A) Sent after the deadline
- B) Long and detailed
- C) Full of keywords
- D) Fast, short, useful and quotable

3. Where should the link in a PR response point?

- A) A competitor
- B) Nowhere
- C) The doctor's profile page on Ongo
- D) A sales page

4. What must happen to every doctor quote?

- A) A payment
- B) Medical review and the doctor's consent
- C) Nothing
- D) Keyword stuffing

5. Should you pay a journalist for coverage with a followed link?

- A) Only once
- B) No; paid unlabelled links are link spam
- C) Only for big sites
- D) Yes

6. What anchor style suits press releases?

- A) Brand name, ideally nofollow

- B) Exact-match keywords
- C) No text
- D) "Cheap tirzepatide"

7. Which is proactive PR?

- A) Buying ads
- B) Ignoring journalists
- C) Answering a request
- D) Creating and pitching an Ongo data story

8. Should you answer requests outside Ongo's expertise to get links?

- A) No; answer only where we're genuinely expert
- B) Only with fake experts
- C) Only on Fridays
- D) Yes, always

9. Which source reported the highest follow-link rate in one study?

- A) Featured
- B) Moz
- C) Qwoted
- D) Source of Sources

10. What should you do after coverage is published?

- A) Demand a followed link
- B) Ask to change the anchor to a keyword
- C) Thank the journalist
- D) Nothing ever

Sources

1. Blck Alpaca, HARO alternatives 2026: Featured, Qwoted and Source of Sources (citing BuzzStream research)
2. Google Search Central, Creating helpful, reliable, people-first content (last updated October 5, 2026)
3. Google Search Central, Spam policies for Google web search (last updated August 28, 2026)

Answer key, Chapter 20: 1-B · 2-D · 3-C · 4-B · 5-B · 6-A · 7-D · 8-A · 9-D · 10-C

Chapter 21: Guest Posting the Safe Way

Guest posting isn't dead. Guest posting for links is. Learn the difference.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> Back in **May 2017**, Google's webspam team warned about large-scale article campaigns. The warning signs: **keyword-rich links**, the **same or similar articles across many sites**, and authors **without real knowledge** of the topic. [1] ●
>
> Nearly a decade later, those three signs still describe almost every "guest post package" sold today.

21.1 Guest posting: the two versions

✅ Good guest posting	❌ Bad guest posting
Written for the host site's readers	Written to hold a link
By a real expert	By anonymous content writers
One thoughtful article for one relevant site	The same article spun across 50 sites
Brand-name author bio, natural links (or none)	Keyword-stuffed anchors
Host has editorial standards	Host sells "dofollow guest posts"
No payment for the link	"Editorial fee" for a followed link

Google lists **guest posts with ranking-passing links or optimized anchor text**, when part of paid or manipulative campaigns, among its link spam examples. [2] ● Google official

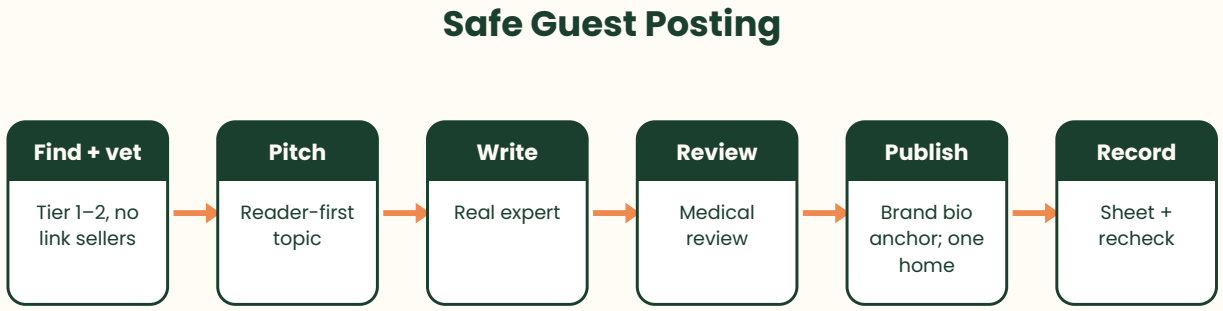
> 🪔 **Desi analogy: shaadi mein guest speech**
>
> Achha guest speech: dulhe ka purana dost, sachchi kahaniyan, sab muskuraate hain, log baad mein poochhte hain "yeh kaun tha?" **Naam apne aap failta hai.**
>
> Bura guest speech: koi anjaan aadmi stage pe aake apni company ka visiting card baantne lage. **Sab samajh jaate hain kyun aaya hai.**

21.2 When guest posting makes sense for Ongo

Good reason	Example
Reach a new audience	A dietitian's blog readers learning about protein on GLP-1s
Build doctor authority	Ongo's doctor writes for a respected health publication
Share expertise that's missing	A careful explainer on compounded vs brand-name medication

Bad reason: "We need 10 links this month."

21.3 The safe guest posting process



Guest post for readers, not for links.

1. **Find relevant sites** (Tier 1–2) with editorial standards. Run vetting (Chapter 16).
2. **Read their guidelines.** Reject any site with a link price list.
3. **Pitch a topic** their readers need, not one we want to rank for.
4. **Write with an expert** (Ongo doctor, dietitian, or a writer with medical review).
5. **Medical review** (Chapter 12).
6. **Links:** brand name in the bio; at most one natural, contextual link in the body if it genuinely helps readers. Accept nofollow happily.
7. **Never reuse the article** on another site. One article, one home.
8. **Record and re-check** after publication.

> 📝 **Note to remember:** If the host adds rel="nofollow" or "sponsored" to your links, **that's fine**. You're there for readers, brand and authority. 🔵

21.4 Guest post pitch template

> **Subject:** Article idea for [Site]: [Specific topic their readers need]
>
> Hi [Name],
>
> I enjoyed your recent piece on [specific article], especially [specific point].
>
> I'd like to offer an original article for your readers: **"[Title]."** It would cover: - [Point 1] - [Point 2] - [Point 3]
>
> It would be written by [Expert name, credential] at Ongo Weight Loss and medically reviewed. It won't appear anywhere else.
>
> Would this fit your editorial plans?
>
> [Your name]

No mention of links, anchors or SEO. 🔵

21.5 Guest post checklist

☐	Check
☐	Site is Tier 1–2 and passed vetting
☐	No price list for links; no "editorial fee"
☐	Topic serves their readers
☐	Written or reviewed by a real expert
☐	Medical review approved
☐	Bio uses brand anchor only
☐	No keyword-stuffed anchors anywhere
☐	Article is 100% original; never published elsewhere
☐	Recorded in the sheet with reviewer name

21.6 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Write for the host's readers	Write for our keywords
Use real experts	Use fake author personas

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Accept nofollow links gladly	Refuse because a link is nofollow
Publish one article in one place	Spin the same article across sites
Decline "pay for dofollow" offers	Pay "editorial fees" for followed links

21.7 Pros and cons of guest posting

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
Reaches new, relevant audiences	Time-consuming
Builds doctor authority	Many hosts are link sellers
Can earn editorial links	Risky when done at scale for links

21.8 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 21 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Buying "guest post packages"	Looks efficient	Reading Google's link spam examples	Cancelling; logging; informing team lead
Keyword anchors in the bio	Old habit	Brand-only bios	Asking the host to update
Reusing one article on many sites	Saves time	One article, one home	Asking hosts to remove duplicates

21.9 Thumb rules

> 👍 Guest post for readers, not for links.
>
> 👍 One article, one site, one real expert.
>
> 👍 A nofollow guest post on a great site beats a dofollow post on a link farm.

21.10 Notes to remember

📝 Google's 2017 warning signs: keyword-rich links, mass distribution, no real expertise.

📝 Paid guest posts with followed or optimized links are link spam.

Chapter 21 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Guest post	An article written for another site
Author bio	The short description of the writer at the end
Editorial guidelines	A site's rules for accepting articles
Article spinning	Rewriting one article into many versions
Guest post package	A paid bundle of guest posts with links, usually link spam

Chapter 21 Quiz

1. What did Google's 2017 warning flag about article campaigns?

- A) Long articles
- B) Keyword-rich links, mass distribution and authors without real knowledge
- C) Short titles
- D) Too many images

2. What's the main purpose of a good guest post?

- A) To help the host's readers
- B) To spin content
- C) To hold a link
- D) To stuff keywords

3. The host adds nofollow to your bio link. What should you do?

- A) Report the host
- B) Demand dofollow
- C) Remove the article
- D) Accept it; you're there for readers and brand

4. Which is safe for an author bio anchor?

- A) "Cheap tirzepatide online"

- B) "Ongo Weight Loss"
- C) "Click here for deals"
- D) "Best compounded semaglutide"

5. An "editorial fee for a permanent dofollow link" is...

- A) A paid link
- B) Normal
- C) A press release
- D) Required

6. How many sites should one guest article be published on?

- A) One
- B) 10
- C) As many as possible
- D) 50

7. Who should write Ongo guest posts on health topics?

- A) AI with no oversight
- B) Anonymous freelancers with no review
- C) Real experts, with medical review
- D) Fake personas

8. When should you mention links in a guest post pitch?

- A) In the subject line
- B) First sentence
- C) Repeatedly
- D) Not at all

9. In the wedding speech analogy, the bad speaker...

- A) Is the groom's friend
- B) Hands out business cards
- C) Makes people smile
- D) Tells real stories

10. Should Ongo buy guest post packages?

- A) Yes, they're efficient
- B) Only cheap ones
- C) Only from DR 50+ sites
- D) No; they're usually link spam

Sources

1. Wordtracker, Google warns against misusing links in large-scale article campaigns, summarizing Google's May 2017 post
2. Google Search Central, Spam policies for Google web search (last updated August 28, 2026)

Answer key, Chapter 21: 1-B · 2-A · 3-D · 4-B · 5-A · 6-A · 7-C · 8-D · 9-B · 10-D

Chapter 22: Broken Link Building and Resource Pages

Help a website fix its mistakes, and it may thank you with a link.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> Websites lose links constantly as pages move, close or break. Every dead link on a health resource page is a small problem for its owner and their readers.
>
> Broken link building turns someone else's problem into a polite, genuinely helpful email. It's one of the few outreach methods where you start by **giving**.

22.1 What is broken link building?

1. Find a page that links to a **dead page** (a 404 error).
2. Make sure Ongo has a **genuinely good replacement**.
3. Tell the site owner about the broken link and suggest our page as a replacement.

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: padosi ka band address**
>
> Mohalle ke notice board pe likha hai: "Achha dentist: Dr. Verma, Gali 4." Lekin Dr. Verma ka clinic band ho gaya. Log wahan jaate hain aur lautte hain.
>
> Tum notice board wale ko batate ho: "Uncle, Dr. Verma ka clinic band ho gaya. Gali 6 mein Dr. Kapoor bahut acche hain." **Uncle ka notice board sudhar gaya, aur Dr. Kapoor ka naam bhi aa gaya.**

22.2 What is a resource page?

A **resource page** is a curated list of useful links on a topic, like "Weight Loss Resources" or "Helpful Links for GLP-1 Patients." Health nonprofits, universities, clinics and bloggers often maintain them.

Good resource page	Bad "resource page"
Curated, relevant, updated	Hundreds of random links
Run by a real organization or expert	Exists to sell link spots
Links to genuinely useful pages	"Submit your link for $25"

22.3 Finding opportunities

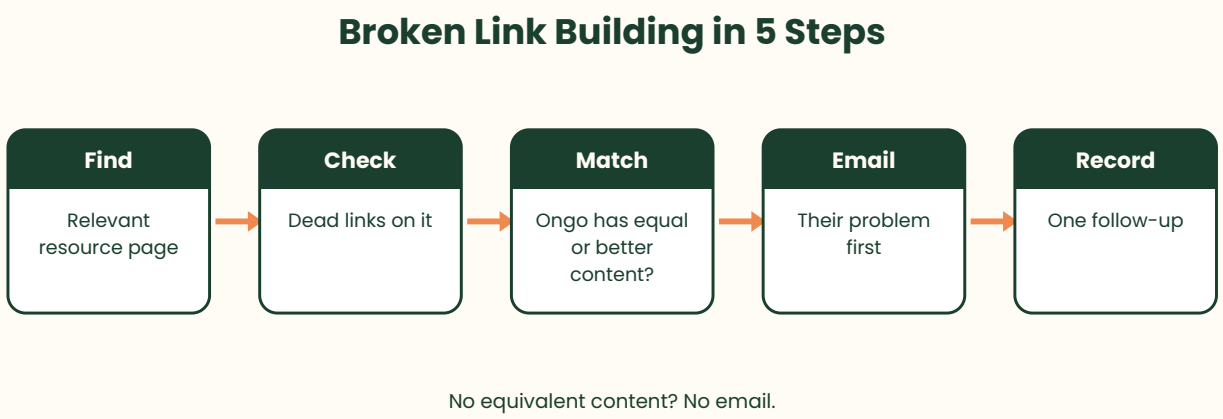
Search operators for resource pages

Search	Finds
`"weight loss" intitle:resources`	Weight-loss resource pages
`"GLP-1" inurl:resources`	Resource pages mentioning GLP-1
`"obesity" "helpful links"`	Lists of helpful links
`"diabetes" "useful websites"`	Related health resource lists
`"patient resources" weight management`	Patient resource pages

Finding broken links

Method	Tool
Check links on a resource page	Free browser extensions that check links, or manually click each
Find dead pages competitors had	Ahrefs/Semrush "broken pages" or "best by links" filtered to 404 (paid)
Use the Wayback Machine	See what the dead page used to contain

22.4 Step-by-step



1. **Find** a relevant resource page (Tier 1–2) and vet it (Chapter 16).
2. **Check** its links for dead ones.
3. **Match:** use the Wayback Machine to see what the dead page covered. Does Ongo have something **as good or better**? If not, stop (or plan a linkable asset, Chapter 19).
4. **Email** the owner: lead with the broken link, suggest Ongo second.
5. **Record and follow up** once after 7–10 days.

Email template

> **Subject:** Broken link on your [page name] page
>
> Hi [Name],
>
> I was reading your [page title] page and noticed the link to [dead resource name] now goes to an error page.
>
> In case it's useful, our medical team at Ongo Weight Loss published a reviewed guide on the same topic: [URL]. Happy to suggest other options too if you'd prefer.
>
> Thanks for maintaining such a helpful list.
>
> [Your name]

Lead with help; no pressure. 🔵

22.5 Ongo-specific cautions

Caution	Why
Only replace with **truly equivalent** content	Replacing a nonprofit's diabetes guide with our sales page is misleading
Point to **educational** pages, not sales pages	Resource pages exist for education
Respect "no commercial links" policies	Some nonprofits don't list businesses; accept it
Never pay for resource page placement	Paid links without labels = link spam [1] 🟢

22.6 Success rates and effort

Metric	Typical range
Reply rate	5–15%
Link rate per email	3–10%
Time per opportunity	15–30 minutes

🔵 *Expert judgment. Results depend on personalization and content quality.*

22.7 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Lead with the broken link (their problem)	Lead with "please link to us"

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Offer genuinely equivalent content	Offer a sales page
Follow up once	Send five follow-ups
Thank them even if they say no	Argue with a "no"

22.8 Pros and cons

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
Starts with genuine help	Low reply rates
Resource page links are relevant and curated	Many resource pages are abandoned
Builds relationships with health organizations	Needs a matching Ongo page

22.9 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 22 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Suggesting an unrelated Ongo page	Wanting any link	The "as good or better" rule	Not sending; noting the content gap
Template emails with no personalization	Speed	Mentioning the specific page	Rewriting the template
Pitching "resource pages" that sell spots	Not vetting	Chapter 16 vetting	Removing them from prospects

22.10 Thumb rules

> 👍 Lead with their problem, not our link.
>
> 👍 No equivalent content? No email.
>
> 👍 One follow-up, then let it go.

22.11 Notes to remember

> 📝 Use the Wayback Machine to see what a dead page contained.
>
> 📝 Resource pages want education, not sales pages.

Chapter 22 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Broken link	A link pointing to a page that no longer exists
404 error	The "page not found" response
Resource page	A curated list of helpful links
Wayback Machine	An archive of past versions of web pages
Search operator	A search command like `intitle:` or `inurl:`

Chapter 22 Quiz

1. What's the first step in broken link building?

- A) Buy a link
- B) Find a page linking to a dead page
- C) Build a PBN
- D) Write a press release

2. How should the outreach email start?

- A) With "please link to us"
- B) With our DA
- C) With a discount
- D) With the broken link (their problem)

3. What if Ongo has no equivalent content?

- A) Pay them
- B) Suggest the homepage
- C) Send the email anyway
- D) Don't send; note the content gap

4. Which tool shows what a dead page used to contain?

- A) Wayback Machine

- B) Moz
- C) Google Trends
- D) GA4

5. Which search finds weight-loss resource pages?

- A) `buy links weight loss`
- B) `"weight loss" intitle:resources`
- C) `cache:weight loss`
- D) `site:ongoweightloss.com`

6. How many follow-ups are reasonable?

- A) One
- B) Five
- C) None
- D) Daily until they reply

7. Which Ongo page suits a nonprofit's resource page?

- A) The careers page
- B) An educational, medically reviewed guide
- C) A sales checkout page
- D) A coupon page

8. A "resource page" offers "submit your link for $25." What is it?

- A) A journalist request
- B) Selling links
- C) A government site
- D) A great opportunity

9. In the analogy, who benefits when you report Dr. Verma's closed clinic?

- A) The notice board owner, readers and the new doctor
- B) Only Dr. Verma
- C) Nobody
- D) Only you

10. What's a typical link rate per broken-link email (expert estimate)?

- A) 50–70%
- B) 3–10%
- C) 100%
- D) 0%

Sources

1. Google Search Central, Spam policies for Google web search (last updated August 28, 2026)

Answer key, Chapter 22: 1-B · 2-D · 3-D · 4-A · 5-B · 6-A · 7-B · 8-B · 9-A · 10-B

Chapter 23: Unlinked Mentions and Link Reclamation

The easiest good links are the ones you've already half-earned.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> When Ongo moves or deletes a page that other sites link to, those links can end at an error page and help nobody. Google's own documentation explains how **redirects** tell Google where a page has moved. [1] 🟢 Google official
>
> A single forgotten redirect can quietly throw away links it took months to earn.

23.1 Two quick wins

Tactic	What it is	Typical success
Unlinked mentions	A site mentions "Ongo" but doesn't link	20–40% when asked politely
Link reclamation	Fixing links that broke, changed or disappeared	Often high, especially for our own broken URLs

Success: 🔵 Expert judgment.

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: naam liya, address nahi diya**
>
> Kisi ne apni Instagram story mein likha: "Ongo ke doctor bahut acche hain!" Lekin tag nahi kiya. Log poochh rahe hain "kaun Ongo? Kahan?"
>
> Tum politely bolte ho: "Thank you! Agar aap tag kar dein toh logon ko dhundhna aasaan hoga." **Zyaadatar log khushi se kar dete hain.** Unhone pehle hi tareef kar di thi.

23.2 Finding unlinked mentions

Method	How
Google search	`"Ongo Weight Loss" -site:ongoweightloss.com`
Doctor names	`"Dr. [Name]" "Ongo"`
Google Alerts	Set alerts for "Ongo Weight Loss" and doctor names (free) 🔵

Method	How
Paid tools	Brand monitoring in Ahrefs/Semrush (if available)
Then check	Open each result; is there a link? Use Inspect (Chapter 7)

Outreach template

> **Subject:** Thank you for mentioning Ongo
>
> Hi [Name],
>
> Thanks for mentioning Ongo Weight Loss in your article "[Title]." We really appreciate it.
>
> If it's helpful for your readers, you could link our name to [specific relevant page], so they can find [what they'd find].
>
> Either way, thank you again.
>
> [Your name]
>
> 📝 **Note to remember:** First check the mention is **accurate**. If the article contains a red-word claim (Chapter 12), ask for a correction first. Never ask for a link on top of misinformation. 🔵

23.3 Link reclamation: three kinds of lost links



Before any Ongo URL change: give developers a redirect list.

Kind	What happened	Fix
Our broken page	A site links to an Ongo URL that now shows a 404	Set up a **301 redirect** to the best matching page [1] 🟢
Changed link	The site changed our link (new URL, nofollow added, anchor changed, moved to footer)	Ask politely if there's an error; accept editorial choices
Removed link	The link or whole page disappeared	Ask if it was intentional; offer updated content

Finding our broken links

Source	How
Google Search Console	Links report → Top linked pages; check that each target still works
Ahrefs Webmaster Tools (free, verified)	Broken backlinks / 404 pages with backlinks
Your team sheet	Monthly re-check of every recorded link (Chapter 38)

> 🟧 **Ongo example**
>
> Ongo's site moves from `/glp-1/semaglutide` to `/services/weight-loss/glp-1-medications/semaglutide/` during the new site architecture. Twelve sites link to the old URL.
>
> **Fix:** Ask the developers to set a **301 redirect** from the old URL to the new one. Every one of those twelve links starts helping again. **Always give the dev team a redirect list before any URL change.**

23.4 Redirect basics for off-page SEOs

Redirect	Meaning	Use for links
301	Permanent move	✅ Best for moved pages
302	Temporary move	Only for truly temporary changes
No redirect (404)	Page gone	❌ Links wasted
Redirect everything to homepage	Lazy redirect	⚠️ Not ideal; Google may treat irrelevant redirects like a missing page 🔵

Google's documentation explains when to use permanent vs temporary redirects. [1] 🟢

23.5 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Search for brand and doctor mentions monthly	Assume every mention has a link
Thank first, ask second	Demand a link
Fix our own 404s with 301 redirects	Let linked pages die
Give developers a redirect list before URL changes	Change URLs without telling SEO
Accept an editor's decision	Argue about nofollow

23.6 Pros and cons

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
Highest success rates in off-page work	Limited by how often Ongo is mentioned
People already like us	Some mentions can't be linked (print, policies)
Reclaiming our own broken links is fully in our control	Needs developer help for redirects

23.7 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 23 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Asking for links on inaccurate mentions	Excitement	Accuracy check first	Requesting a correction
Ignoring 404 pages with backlinks	Not checking	Monthly GSC/AWT review	Sending a redirect list to dev
Pushy follow-ups	Impatience	One polite follow-up	Apologizing if needed

23.8 Thumb rules

> 👍 They already like us; just make it easy to link.
>
> 👍 No URL changes without a redirect plan.
>
> 👍 Accuracy first, link second.

23.9 Notes to remember

> 📝 Search `"Ongo Weight Loss" -site:ongoweightloss.com` monthly.
>
> 📝 301 = permanent move; use it for moved pages with backlinks.

Chapter 23 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Unlinked mention	Our brand named without a link
Link reclamation	Recovering lost or broken links

Term	Simple meaning
301 redirect	A permanent redirect from an old URL to a new one
302 redirect	A temporary redirect
404	Page not found
Google Alerts	Free email alerts when a phrase appears online

Chapter 23 Quiz

1. What is an unlinked mention?

- A) A broken page
- B) Ongo named without a link
- C) A redirect
- D) A paid link

2. What should you do first when you find an unlinked mention?

- A) Ignore it
- B) Report it to Google
- C) Demand a link
- D) Check the mention is accurate

3. Which redirect should you use for a permanently moved page?

- A) 302
- B) None
- C) 404
- D) 301

4. Before Ongo changes URLs, what should SEO give developers?

- A) A press release
- B) A redirect list
- C) A disavow file
- D) Nothing

5. Which search finds Ongo mentions on other sites?

- A) `cache:ongo`
- B) `link:ongo`
- C) `"Ongo Weight Loss" -site:ongoweightloss.com`
- D) `site:ongoweightloss.com`

6. An editor changes our link to nofollow. What do you do?

- A) Remove our content
- B) Disavow them
- C) Accept their editorial choice
- D) Threaten them

7. Why is "redirect everything to the homepage" not ideal?

- A) Google bans homepages
- B) It's illegal
- C) It's too fast
- D) Irrelevant redirects may be treated like a missing page

8. Which free tool can alert you to new brand mentions?

- A) GA4 funnels
- B) Moz DA
- C) Majestic CF
- D) Google Alerts

9. Typical success rate for polite unlinked-mention requests (expert estimate)?

- A) 0–1%
- B) 60–80%
- C) 20–40%
- D) 90–100%

10. In the Instagram analogy, what's the polite ask?

- A) "Please tag us so people can find us"
- B) "Pay us"
- C) "Delete your story"
- D) "Mention our competitor"

Sources

1. Google Search Central, Redirects and Google Search

Answer key, Chapter 23: 1-B · 2-D · 3-D · 4-B · 5-C · 6-C · 7-D · 8-D · 9-C · 10-A

LEVEL 2 · CHAPTER 24

Chapter 24: Images and Visual Assets That Get Linked

A good chart can travel further than a thousand-word article, if you make sure it carries your name.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> Google supports **image license metadata**: structured data and photo metadata that tell Google who created an image and how it can be licensed. It can show a "Licensable" badge in Google Images. [1] ● Google official
>
> Most sites never add it, then wonder why their charts get reused everywhere without credit.

24.1 Why images earn links

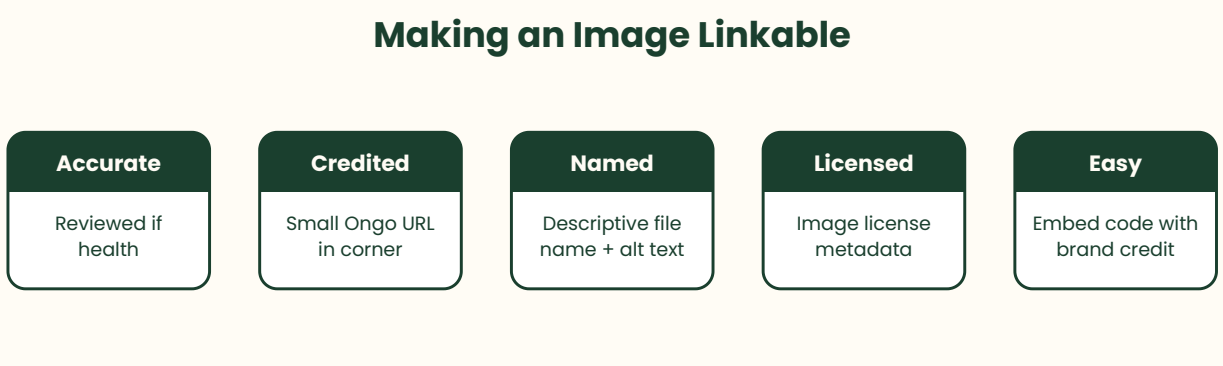
People and publishers reuse charts, infographics and diagrams. When they credit the source with a link, that's an image link. When they don't, it's an **unlinked use**, and you can ask for credit (Chapter 23).

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: shaadi ka photographer**
>
> Achha wedding photographer apni har photo pe chhota sa watermark aur Instagram handle lagata hai. Photo viral hui, toh har share ke saath naam bhi failta hai.
>
> **Ongo ke charts aur diagrams pe bhi chhoti si pehchaan honi chahiye**, aur ek aasaan tareeka ki log credit ke saath share karein.

24.2 Visual assets that work for Ongo

Visual	Example (with medical review)	Who reuses it
Data chart	GLP-1 cost ranges over time (sourced)	Journalists, finance bloggers
Process diagram	"How telehealth GLP-1 treatment works in 5 steps"	Health bloggers
Body diagram	"How GLP-1 medications act on appetite"	Educators, students
Comparison table image	"Compounded vs FDA-approved: what's different"	Patient communities
Checklist graphic	"Questions to ask your provider"	Dietitians, forums

24.3 Making images linkable: the checklist



☐	Step	Why
☐	Original and accurate; medically reviewed if health-related	YMYL trust
☐	Small "ongoweightloss.com" credit in the image corner	Credit travels with the image
☐	Descriptive file name (e.g. `glp-1-cost-comparison-2026.png`)	Helps Google understand the image [2] 🟢
☐	Descriptive **alt text**	Google uses alt text to understand images; it's the anchor for image links [2][3] 🟢
☐	Placed near relevant text on our page	Google uses surrounding text for context [2] 🟢
☐	**Image license metadata** (creator, credit, license page)	Can show licensing info in Google Images [1] 🟢
☐	"Use this image" box with an embed code including a credit link	Makes crediting easy

Simple embed code example

```
<a href="https://ongoweightloss.com/guides/glp-1-costs/">
  <img src="https://ongoweightloss.com/images/glp-1-cost-comparison-2026.png"
       alt="Chart comparing typical monthly GLP-1 medication costs, 2026">
</a>
<p>Source: <a href="https://ongoweightloss.com/guides/glp-1-costs/">Ongo Weight Loss</a></p>
```

📝 **Note to remember:** Never require a followed link as a condition of using an image in a way that turns into a widget-style link scheme. Google lists keyword-rich links in widely distributed widgets as link spam. [4] 🟢 A plain brand credit is fine. 🔵

24.4 Finding who uses our images (reverse image search)

Use **Google Lens**: [5] 🟠

On desktop (Chrome): 1. Right-click our image → **Search image with Google Lens**. 2. Scroll the Lens panel to see where the image appears. 3. Click **"Find image source"** for a list of sites using it.

On other browsers: go to images.google.com → Search by image → upload or paste the image URL.

Then for each site using our image:

Situation	Action
Credited with a link	Record it in the sheet
Credited without a link	Thank them; ask to link the credit (Chapter 23)
No credit at all	Politely ask for credit and a link
Edited with misleading claims added	Ask them to remove it; escalate if needed

24.5 Images we must NOT use

❌ Don't use	Why
Stock photos presented as "real patients"	Misleading in a YMYL context
Before/after photos without proper consent, context and disclaimers	Health claim risk (Chapter 12)
Vial photos with our name implying we make the drug	Flagged in FDA letters [6] 🟠
Images copied from other sites	Copyright risk; not original
AI images pretending to be real people or doctors	Fabricated profiles are deception [7] 🟢

24.6 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Add credit, alt text and license metadata	Publish charts with no attribution
Offer an easy embed code	Hide keyword links inside embed code
Reverse-search our images monthly	Ignore uncredited uses
Get medical review on health visuals	Publish unreviewed health claims in images

24.7 Pros and cons

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
Visuals spread widely	Many reuses won't credit
Great for PR and social	Design and review take time
Image links use alt text as anchor	Embed codes can be misused if keyword-stuffed

24.8 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 24 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Keyword-stuffed links in embed codes	Wants anchor value	Brand credit only	Updating the embed code
No alt text	Forgetting	The checklist	Adding alt text to existing images
Using stock "patients"	Looks nice	Real, consented images or illustrations	Replacing images

24.9 Thumb rules

👍 Every chart carries our name.

👍 Make crediting easier than not crediting.

👍 Real people, real consent, or illustrations.

24.10 Notes to remember

📝 Google uses alt text as anchor text for image links.

📝 Use Google Lens "Find image source" to find reuses.

Chapter 24 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Image link	A link where the clickable item is an image

Term	Simple meaning
Alt text	Text describing an image
Image license metadata	Data telling Google who made an image and how to license it
Embed code	Copy-paste code to show our image with credit
Reverse image search	Searching with an image to find where it appears
Google Lens	Google's visual search tool

Chapter 24 Quiz

1. What does Google use as anchor text for an image link?

- A) The colour
- B) Nothing
- C) The alt text
- D) The file size

2. Which Google tool finds where our image appears online?

- A) Google Trends
- B) GA4
- C) Google Ads
- D) Google Lens

3. What can image license metadata show in Google Images?

- A) A "Licensable" badge and licensing info
- B) A ranking boost guarantee
- C) A price tag
- D) Nothing

4. Which is risky in an embed code?

- A) Alt text
- B) A brand-name credit link
- C) A source line
- D) Keyword-rich hidden links

5. A blog uses our chart with no credit. What do you do?

- A) Ignore it
- B) Politely ask for credit and a link
- C) Sue immediately
- D) Copy their content

6. Why avoid stock photos presented as real patients?

- A) Google can't read them
- B) They're too expensive
- C) They're misleading in a YMYL context
- D) They load slowly

7. What's a good image file name?

- A) IMG_00234.png
- B) glp-1-cost-comparison-2026.png
- C) image.png
- D) final-final-v3.png

8. Which image type was flagged in FDA letters?

- A) Doctor headshots with consent
- B) Logos
- C) Charts
- D) Vial photos implying the seller manufactures the drug

9. How often should you reverse-search Ongo's key images?

- A) Only after a penalty
- B) Every 5 years
- C) Never
- D) Monthly

10. In the photographer analogy, what does the watermark represent?

- A) A penalty
- B) A credit that travels with the image
- C) Alt text
- D) A paid link

Sources

1. Google Search Central, Image metadata in Google Images
2. Google Search Central, SEO Starter Guide: images (last updated December 10, 2025)
3. Google Search Central, Make your links crawlable: image links (last updated December 10, 2025)
4. Google Search Central, Spam policies for Google web search (last updated August 28, 2026)
5. Tom's Guide, How to do a reverse image search using Google
6. Igility, What all 113 FDA telehealth warning letters actually say
7. Google Search Central, Creating helpful, reliable, people-first content (last updated October 5, 2026)

Answer key, Chapter 24: 1-C · 2-D · 3-A · 4-D · 5-B · 6-C · 7-B · 8-D · 9-D · 10-B

LEVEL 2 · CHAPTER 25

Chapter 25: Communities: Reddit, Quora, Forums and Niche Groups

Patients trust each other more than they trust brands. Earn your place in their conversations, or stay out.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> Reddit's Content Policy asks users to post **authentic content** in communities where they have a **personal interest**, and prohibits spamming, vote manipulation and ban evasion. [1] 🟠
>
> Reddit doesn't ban self-promotion outright. **Each community's moderators set their own rules**, and those rules decide whether you're welcome. [1] 🟠

25.1 Why communities matter for Ongo

Benefit	Why
Patients ask real questions here	Raw, honest patient voices (Chapter 17)
Referral traffic	Helpful answers get clicked for years
AI visibility	Google says its AI features can show what's said about products and services in blogs, videos and forum discussions [2] 🟢
Brand trust	Genuine help builds reputation

What communities are NOT	Why
A place to drop links	Most links are nofollow/ugc anyway [3] 🟢
A place for fake patient stories	FTC rules and platform rules (Chapter 12)
A shortcut to AI visibility	Google says inauthentic mentions aren't as helpful as they seem [2] 🟢

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: mohalla committee ki meeting**
>
> Mohalla committee ki meeting mein ek naya aadmi aata hai aur seedha apni dukaan ka pamphlet baantne lagta hai. **Sab naraz.** Agli meeting mein entry band.
>
> Doosra aadmi chaar meeting mein aata hai, logon ki problems sunta hai, kabhi kabhi madad karta hai. Paanchvi meeting mein koi poochhta hai "aapka kaam kya hai?" Tab woh batata hai. **Ab log khud uski dukaan jaate hain.**

25.2 The rules of community participation for Ongo

Rule	Why
1. Read and follow each community's rules	Moderators decide; rules vary widely [1] 🟠
2. Always disclose your Ongo connection	FTC material connection rules (Chapter 12) [4] 🟠
3. Never pose as a patient	Deception; FTC fake review rule [5] 🟢
4. Help first; link rarely	Most of your answers should have **no** link
5. No medical advice; general info + "talk to a provider"	YMYL; you're not a doctor
6. Use your real, personal account	Fake or bought accounts violate platform rules
7. No vote manipulation	Banned on Reddit [1] 🟠
8. Health claims follow the red-word list	Chapter 12

📝 **Note to remember:** You may hear about a "90/10 rule" for Reddit self-promotion. That's **folklore**, not an official Reddit rule. Each community's own rules are what count. [1] 🟠

25.3 Finding the right communities

Platform	How to find	Tip
Reddit	Search "semaglutide," "tirzepatide," "GLP-1," "weight loss"	Read the sidebar rules before posting
Quora	Search patient questions from Chapter 17	Answer with experience and clarity
Health forums	`GLP-1 forum`, `weight loss forum`	Check how old the latest posts are
Facebook groups	Search GLP-1 support groups	Many forbid any business presence
Patient communities	Diabetes and obesity patient networks	Highest sensitivity: listen first

25.4 Writing a helpful answer (template)

> **[Answer the question directly in 2–3 sentences.]**
>
> **[Add one practical detail from real experience or approved information.]**
>
> **[Safety line: "Your provider can tell you what's right for you."]**
>
> **[Disclosure, if Ongo is mentioned: "Disclosure: I work with Ongo Weight Loss."]**
>
> **[Link only if it directly answers the question better than text can.]**
>
> 🟧 **Ongo example**
>
> **Question on a forum:** "Is compounded tirzepatide the same as Zepbound?"
>
> ❌ **Bad:** "Yes, same thing, cheaper! Try Ongo: [link]"
>
> ✅ **Good (approved wording):** "They contain the same active ingredient name, but compounded medications are **not FDA-approved** and are prepared by licensed pharmacies for individual patients, while Zepbound is an FDA-approved brand product. That difference affects things like oversight and how they're made. A provider can explain which option fits your situation. *Disclosure: I work with Ongo Weight Loss, a telehealth clinic that offers compounded options.*"
>
> *Note: even the "good" version must use the medical team's approved wording.*

25.5 Measuring community work

Metric	Where
Answers posted (with disclosure)	Sheet
Upvotes / helpful votes	Platform
Referral visits	GA4 (source = reddit.com, quora.com, etc.)
Removed posts / warnings	Sheet (learn from them)
Brand mentions by others	Monthly mention search (Chapter 23)

25.6 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Disclose your connection every time	Pose as a patient
Read rules before posting	Post the same answer in 20 places
Help without linking most of the time	Drop links in every answer

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Use approved health wording	Give personal medical advice
Accept bans or removals gracefully	Evade bans with new accounts

25.7 Pros and cons

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
Direct contact with real patients	Slow; reputation takes months
Long-lasting referral traffic	Mostly nofollow/ugc links
Influences what's said about Ongo online	One bad post can damage the brand

25.8 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 25 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
"As a patient, I loved Ongo!" (not a patient)	Wants authenticity	Always disclosing	Deleting the post; telling team lead
Buying aged Reddit accounts	"Faster"	Using your real account	Stopping immediately
Linking in every answer	Treating it as link building	Help-first rule	Editing past answers

25.9 Thumb rules

👍 Help first. Link rarely. Disclose always.

👍 The community's rules beat our goals.

👍 Never pretend to be a patient.

25.10 Notes to remember

📝 Reddit's Content Policy prohibits spam, vote manipulation and ban evasion.

📝 The "90/10 rule" is folklore; subreddit rules decide.

Chapter 25 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Subreddit	A Reddit community on one topic
Moderator	A volunteer who enforces a community's rules
Sidebar rules	A community's posted rules
Disclosure	Telling people you're connected to Ongo
Vote manipulation	Artificially boosting posts; banned on Reddit
Ban evasion	Creating new accounts after a ban; banned

Chapter 25 Quiz

1. Who decides self-promotion rules in a subreddit?

- A) Google
- B) Nobody
- C) Ongo
- D) That community's moderators

2. Is the "90/10 rule" an official Reddit rule?

- A) Only for health
- B) Yes
- C) Only on weekends
- D) No, it's folklore

3. What must you do when mentioning Ongo in a community?

- A) Add an exact-match link
- B) Use a bought account
- C) Disclose your connection
- D) Pretend to be a patient

4. What does Google say about inauthentic mentions for AI search?

- A) They're required
- B) Google doesn't mention it
- C) They're very helpful
- D) They aren't as helpful as they seem

5. Which is banned by Reddit's Content Policy?

- A) Vote manipulation

- B) Disclosing your job
- C) Helpful answers
- D) Reading rules

6. Most of your community answers should contain...

- A) No link
- B) A link to Ongo
- C) Three links
- D) A coupon

7. What's the safest way to address medical questions?

- A) Give personal dosing advice
- B) Share general approved info and suggest talking to a provider
- C) Say "same as Zepbound"
- D) Ignore safety

8. You get banned from a subreddit. What should you do?

- A) Spam the subreddit
- B) Make a new account
- C) Buy upvotes
- D) Accept it gracefully and learn

9. Where do you measure referral visits from communities?

- A) Moz
- B) GA4
- C) Majestic
- D) Search Console Manual actions

10. In the mohalla analogy, why is the second man welcomed?

- A) He paid the committee
- B) He shouted loudest
- C) He handed out pamphlets first
- D) He listened and helped before promoting

Sources

1. Redship, The complete guide to Reddit self-promotion rules in 2026 (quoting Reddit's Content Policy and reddiquette)
2. Google Search Central, Optimizing your website for generative AI features on Google Search (last updated July 10, 2026)
3. Google Search Central, Qualify your outbound links to Google (last updated December 10, 2025)
4. Venable, FTC finalizes updated Endorsement and Testimonial Guides (July 5, 2023)

5. Federal Trade Commission, Final rule banning fake reviews and testimonials (August 14, 2024)

Answer key, Chapter 25: 1-D · 2-D · 3-C · 4-D · 5-A · 6-A · 7-B · 8-D · 9-B · 10-D

Chapter 26: Partnerships, Sponsorships, Testimonials and Associations

Real business relationships create real links. The rule is simple: if money or gifts are involved, label the link.

💡 **Trivia**

Google says `rel="sponsored"` is its preferred label for **advertisements or paid placements**, and that paid links with `sponsored` or `nofollow` **don't violate** its spam policies. [1][2] ● Google official

So sponsorships are perfectly allowed. The violation is only in hiding them.

26.1 Four kinds of relationship links

Type	Example for Ongo	Link label
Partnership	A dietitian practice that refers patients and is listed on each other's partner pages	Natural if the partnership is real; avoid mass cross-linking
Sponsorship	Ongo sponsors a community health walk; sponsor page links to us	**rel="sponsored"** (or nofollow)
Testimonial	Ongo writes a genuine review of software we use; vendor features it with a link	Natural, if we genuinely use it
Association	Ongo is a member of a real telehealth or healthcare industry body	Natural membership listing

🪔 **Desi analogy: shaadi ke banner**

Shaadi mein pandal pe banner laga hai: "Sponsored by Gupta Sweets." **Sabko pata hai Gupta ji ne paise diye.** Koi problem nahi.

Problem tab hai jab Gupta ji paise de ke bolein: "Banner pe 'sponsored' mat likhna, likho 'Shehar ki sabse acchi mithai, sab mehmaanon ki pasand.'" **Yeh dhokha hai.**

26.2 The labelling rules

Situation	Required
We pay money for a placement with a link	`rel="sponsored"` (or nofollow) [1] 🟢 + clear disclosure
We give a free product/service for a review with a link	Counts as payment; label it [2] 🟢 + FTC disclosure [3] 🟠
A real partner lists us (no payment for the link)	No label needed; keep it genuine
We require a link in a contract or terms of service	Allow the owner to label it; don't force followed links [2] 🟢
Excessive "you link me, I link you"	Link spam, even without money [2] 🟢

26.3 Partnerships that make sense for Ongo

Partner type	What both sides gain	Off-page value
Registered dietitians	Nutrition support for GLP-1 patients	Tier 1–2 editorial links, expert content
Fitness professionals (exercise during weight loss)	Complementary services	Tier 2 links, co-created content
Health content creators (with disclosure)	Accurate education	Brand reach, nofollow/sponsored links
Telehealth software vendors	Case studies, testimonials	Tier 3 links
Community health nonprofits	Sponsorship, education	Sponsored links + brand trust

🔵 *Expert judgment. All health content in partnerships goes through medical review (Chapter 12).*

26.4 Sponsorship checklist

☐	Check
☐	The sponsored organization is legitimate and relevant
☐	Link marked `rel="sponsored"` or `nofollow`
☐	Sponsorship clearly disclosed on their page
☐	No health claims about Ongo on their page without medical review
☐	Contract doesn't demand keyword anchors or followed links
☐	Recorded in the sheet as "Sponsored," with cost

> 🟧 **Ongo example**
>
> A local community 5K run offers Ongo a "Gold Sponsor" spot for $500, including a logo and link on their sponsors page.
>
> **Good deal if:** the link is `rel="sponsored"`, our listing says "Ongo Weight Loss" with the logo, and no claims are added. **Value:** brand trust, local visibility, a genuine community relationship. **Not** a ranking link, and that's fine.

26.5 Testimonials for vendors

If Ongo genuinely uses a tool (scheduling software, analytics, a design tool):

1. Write a short, honest testimonial (non-medical).
2. The vendor may publish it with "Ongo Weight Loss" and a link.
3. Record it as a "Testimonial" link.

Never give testimonials for products Ongo doesn't use. That's a fake review. [4] 🟢

26.6 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Label every paid or gifted link	Pay for followed links
Build partnerships that help patients	Join link exchange networks
Write honest testimonials for tools we use	Write testimonials for tools we don't use
Keep partner pages short and real	Create "partners" pages with 100 cross-links

---

26.7 Pros and cons

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
Real relationships and brand trust	Most sponsorship links don't pass ranking credit
Local and community visibility	Costs money
Partners create content and referrals	Needs careful contracts and review

---

26.8 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 26 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Not asking for `sponsored` on paid links	Doesn't know the rule	The labelling table	Asking the host to add it
Mass partner link swaps	"Partners help each other"	Remembering excessive exchanges are link spam	Removing excess swaps
Gifted products without disclosure	Feels like a favour	FTC disclosure rules	Asking the blogger to add disclosure

26.9 Thumb rules

> 👍 Paid or gifted? Label it.
>
> 👍 Real relationships, not link swaps.
>
> 👍 Sponsorships are for brand trust, not rankings.

26.10 Notes to remember

> 📝 Paid links with `sponsored` or `nofollow` don't violate Google's policies.
>
> 📝 Free products for a link count as payment.

Chapter 26 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Sponsorship	Paying to support an event or organization, usually for visibility
rel="sponsored"	Google's label for paid links
Partnership	A genuine business relationship
Testimonial	A statement praising a product or service
Link exchange	Swapping links, risky when excessive
Disclosure	Clearly stating a paid or material relationship

Chapter 26 Quiz

1. What is Google's preferred label for paid links?

- A) dofollow
- B) ugc
- C) canonical
- D) sponsored

2. Do paid links marked sponsored or nofollow violate Google's spam policies?

- A) Yes
- B) No
- C) Only in Europe
- D) Only for health sites

3. Sending free products to a blogger in exchange for a link counts as...

- A) A natural editorial link
- B) A gift with no rules
- C) Payment; the link should be labelled and disclosed
- D) A press release

4. Which is link spam even without money?

- A) A real partner listing
- B) A journalist quote
- C) Excessive "you link me, I link you" exchanges
- D) A sponsorship with sponsored label

5. What's the main value of a community event sponsorship?

- A) Big ranking boost
- B) Brand trust and local visibility
- C) PBN links
- D) Exact-match anchors

6. Should Ongo write testimonials for tools it doesn't use?

- A) No; that's a fake review
- B) Only for big vendors
- C) Yes, for links
- D) Only once

7. A contract requires a followed link with keyword anchors. What's wrong?

- A) It's too short
- B) Nothing
- C) Requiring links without letting owners qualify them is link spam

- D) It's in English

8. In the banner analogy, what's the "dhokha"?

- A) Paying for sweets
- B) Hiding the sponsorship and pretending it's an honest recommendation
- C) Having a banner
- D) Showing "Sponsored by Gupta Sweets"

9. How should you record a sponsorship link in the sheet?

- A) As "Editorial"
- B) As "PBN"
- C) As "Sponsored," with cost
- D) Not at all

10. Who must review health content created with partners?

- A) The partner's intern
- B) Ongo's medical reviewer
- C) Nobody
- D) Google

Sources

1. Google Search Central, Qualify your outbound links to Google (last updated December 10, 2025)
2. Google Search Central, Spam policies for Google web search (last updated August 28, 2026)
3. Venable, FTC finalizes updated Endorsement and Testimonial Guides (July 5, 2023)
4. Federal Trade Commission, Final rule banning fake reviews and testimonials (August 14, 2024)

Answer key, Chapter 26: 1-D · 2-B · 3-C · 4-C · 5-B · 6-A · 7-C · 8-B · 9-C · 10-B

Chapter 27: Podcasts, Interviews, Webinars and Speaking

When Ongo's doctors speak, people listen, and the show notes link back.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> Google's quality guidance asks whether content is **written or reviewed by an expert who demonstrably knows the topic well**, and whether a site is **widely recognized as an authority**. [1] ● Google official
>
> A doctor who appears on respected health podcasts, webinars and panels is building exactly that recognition, with a link in the show notes as a bonus.

27.1 Why spoken appearances work

Benefit	Explanation
Expert authority	Doctors become known names (E-E-A-T)
Show-notes links	Most podcasts link to guests' pages
Long life	Episodes get discovered for years
Multiple formats	Audio, video (YouTube), transcripts, social clips
Low competition	Fewer people pitch podcasts than blogs

● *Expert judgment*

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: radio pe doctor sahab**
>
> Purane zamaane mein Akashvani pe "Swasthya Charcha" mein ek doctor aate the. Saalon tak log unka naam yaad rakhte the, aur clinic mein bolte the "radio pe suna tha aapko."
>
> **Podcast aaj ka Akashvani hai.**

27.2 Finding the right shows

Search	Finds
`weight loss podcast "guest"`	Podcasts that host guests
`GLP-1 podcast episode doctor`	Shows already covering GLP-1s
`nutrition podcast "be a guest"`	Shows with guest application pages
`telehealth podcast interview`	Digital health shows
Apple Podcasts / Spotify search	Browse by topic; check recent episodes

Vetting a show

Check	Good sign
Recent episodes	Published in the last 1–2 months
Guests	Real experts, not just salespeople
Show notes	Include guest links
Topic fit	Health, weight loss, nutrition, women's/men's health
Tone	Responsible about health claims

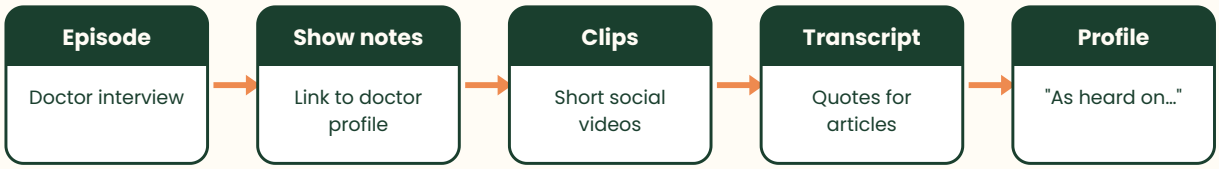
27.3 The podcast pitch

> **Subject:** Guest idea for [Show]: [specific episode topic]
>
> Hi [Host],
>
> I enjoyed your episode with [guest] on [topic], especially [specific moment].
>
> [Doctor name], [credentials], treats patients on GLP-1 medications at Ongo Weight Loss and could talk with your listeners about: - [Topic 1, e.g. common myths about GLP-1 medications] - [Topic 2, e.g. eating well while on treatment] - [Topic 3, e.g. what to ask before starting]
>
> [He/She] can keep it practical and non-promotional.
>
> Would this fit an upcoming episode?
>
> [Your name]

27.4 Ongo rules for appearances

Rule	Why
Doctor prepares talking points with medical review	YMYL + FDA/FTC (Chapter 12)
No sameness, FDA-approval or guarantee claims	Red-word list
Ask for the show-notes link to the **doctor's profile** or a relevant guide	Builds E-E-A-T
Paid appearances → disclosed; link sponsored	Google + FTC rules
Repurpose with permission	Clips, transcripts, social posts

One Appearance, Many Assets



Teach, don't sell. Then reuse everything (with permission).

27.5 After the episode

1. Check the show notes: link present? Correct URL? Record it.
2. Thank the host; share the episode on Ongo's channels.
3. Add the appearance to the doctor's profile page ("As heard on...").
4. Ask permission to embed or quote clips.
5. Measure referral traffic in GA4.

27.6 Webinars and speaking

Format	Off-page value
Co-hosted webinar with a dietitian or nonprofit	Partner page links, shared audience
Conference talk (telehealth, obesity medicine)	Speaker page links, authority
University guest lecture	Possible .edu mention, authority

27.7 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Pitch specific, useful topics	Pitch "Ongo is the best clinic"
Prepare reviewed talking points	Let doctors improvise risky claims
Link show notes to doctor profiles	Push sales pages
Thank hosts and share episodes	Disappear after the recording

27.8 Pros and cons

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
Strong authority building	Doctor time is limited
Easy, natural show-notes links	Smaller shows may have small audiences
Content you can reuse many ways	Live talk carries claim risks if unprepared

27.9 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 27 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Pitching inactive podcasts	Not checking dates	Vetting recent episodes	Removing from list
Promotional pitches	Thinking like ads	Listener-first topics	Rewriting the template
Not checking show notes	Assuming a link was added	Post-episode checklist	Polite request to add it

27.10 Thumb rules

> 👍 Teach, don't sell.
>
> 👍 One episode, five assets.
>
> 👍 Always check the show notes.

27.11 Notes to remember

> 📝 Podcast links usually point to the doctor's profile: perfect for E-E-A-T.
>
> 📝 Talking points go through medical review before recording.

Chapter 27 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Show notes	The episode description, often with guest links
Guest pitch	A request to appear on a show
Repurposing	Turning one piece of content into several formats
Talking points	Key messages prepared before an interview
Speaker page	An event page listing speakers

Chapter 27 Quiz

1. Where do podcasts usually place guest links?

- A) In the audio only
- B) In the show notes
- C) In ads
- D) Nowhere

2. Where should the show-notes link ideally point?

- A) A checkout page
- B) A competitor
- C) A coupon
- D) The doctor's profile page or a relevant guide

3. What must happen to a doctor's talking points?

- A) Nothing
- B) Shared with competitors first
- C) Medical review
- D) Keyword stuffing

4. Which is a good pitch topic?

- A) "Same as Wegovy"

- B) "Ongo is the best clinic"
- C) Buy now discounts
- D) Common myths about GLP-1 medications

5. Why vet a podcast's recent episodes?

- A) To check it's still active
- B) No reason
- C) To find their DA
- D) To count ads

6. What should you do after an episode publishes?

- A) Check show notes, record the link, thank the host
- B) Nothing
- C) Ask for exact-match anchors
- D) Delete the recording

7. A paid podcast appearance should be...

- A) Disclosed, with a sponsored link
- B) Free
- C) Hidden
- D) Avoided always

8. What does "one episode, five assets" mean?

- A) Five links per show
- B) Repurposing one appearance into clips, transcripts and posts
- C) Five podcasts
- D) Five doctors

9. In the analogy, what's today's "Akashvani"?

- A) Billboards
- B) Newspapers
- C) Directories
- D) Podcasts

10. Which Google quality question do podcast appearances support?

- A) Is the sitemap valid?
- B) Is the font readable?
- C) Is the page fast?
- D) Is the site widely recognized as an authority?

Sources

1. Google Search Central, Creating helpful, reliable, people-first content (last updated October 5, 2026)

Answer key, Chapter 27: 1-B · 2-D · 3-C · 4-D · 5-A · 6-A · 7-A · 8-B · 9-D · 10-D

Chapter 28: Profiles Done Right

Real people, real photos, real information. Plus the truth about using an AI portrait of yourself.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> Back in **October 2022**, LinkedIn announced a deep-learning model that **screens profile photo uploads to flag AI-generated images**, as part of catching fake accounts. [1] ●
>
> If a platform thinks your profile photo is AI-made, it may treat your whole account as fake, even if the person behind it is real.

28.1 Which profiles matter for Ongo?

Profile type	Example	Value
Doctor profiles on medical directories	Ongo's physicians on professional healthcare directories	High: E-E-A-T, entity
Team members' professional profiles	LinkedIn profiles listing Ongo as employer	Medium: brand, entity
Ongo's official brand profiles	Social accounts, Google Business Profile, Crunchbase-type listings	High: entity consistency (Chapter 34)
Contributor profiles on publications	Author pages where our doctors wrote guest articles	High
Mass "profile backlinks"	Hundreds of profiles on random forums for links	**Low value, risky** (Chapter 13)

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: visiting card**
>
> Achha visiting card: asli naam, asli photo, asli number, asli company. Log bharosa karte hain.
>
> Fake visiting card: kisi aur ki photo, banaya hua naam. **Pakde gaye toh izzat bhi gayi aur kaam bhi.**

28.2 Google's rule on fake creator profiles

Google says **fabricating creator profiles**, for example with **AI-generated headshots, made-up names or false credentials**, is a form of deception that makes a page untrustworthy and signals low quality. [2] ● Google official

✅ Allowed	❌ Not allowed
Real person, real name, real role	Invented "Dr. Sarah Miller" who doesn't exist
Real credentials, accurately stated	Claiming a credential someone doesn't have
A real photo of that person	An AI face of a person who doesn't exist

28.3 Your AI portrait of yourself: the honest guide

You told us you create profile images **of yourself** using AI. That's different from inventing a fake person, but it still carries risks.

Question	Honest answer
Is it a "fabricated profile"?	**No**, if it represents you, the real person, with your real name and role. 🔵
Can platforms flag it?	**Yes.** LinkedIn and others screen for AI-generated images. [1] 🟠
Can it confuse people?	Yes, if it looks very different from you.
Is it safe for doctors' profiles?	**No.** Medical professionals should always use real photos. 🔵

Safe-use checklist for an AI portrait of yourself

☐	Check
☐	It clearly looks like you (someone who met you would recognize you)
☐	It's used only on **your own** profile, never for anyone else
☐	The platform's rules don't ban AI-generated or edited photos (check each one)
☐	It's not "too perfect" (glamour filters, impossible lighting)
☐	You've run a **reverse image search** to make sure it isn't matching someone else's photo
☐	For high-trust platforms (LinkedIn, medical directories), you use a **real photo** instead

🔵 *Expert judgment, informed by [1][2]*

> 📝 **Note to remember:** When in doubt, **use a real photo**. A simple, well-lit phone photo is safer than any AI portrait on every platform.

28.4 Is this image already used elsewhere? (Reverse image search)

Before using **any** image on a profile, run a reverse image search with **Google Lens**: [3] 🟠

1. **Desktop Chrome:** right-click the image → **Search image with Google Lens** → scroll the panel → **Find image source**.
2. **Other browsers:** images.google.com → Search by image → upload the file.
3. **Phone:** Google app → Lens → choose the photo from your gallery.

Result	Action
No matches	✅ Safe to use
Matches only your own existing profiles	✅ Fine
Matches someone else's photo or a stock site	❌ Don't use
Matches look-alike AI faces	⚠️ Replace with a real photo

28.5 Building a profile: step by step

1. **Decide if the profile is worth it.** Does the platform matter to patients, doctors or our brand? If not, skip.
2. **Use the same core details everywhere** (Chapter 34): name "Ongo Weight Loss," website, description.
3. **Write an approved bio** (Chapter 29).
4. **Add a real photo or logo.**
5. **Website link:** homepage with brand anchor/URL.
6. **Record it** in the sheet: platform, URL, owner, login owner, date.
7. **Keep it alive:** check yearly that it's accurate.

28.6 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Use real people and real photos	Create fake doctors or employees
Run reverse image search on every image	Use stock photos as "team members"
Keep details consistent across profiles	Use different names and descriptions everywhere
Create profiles where patients or professionals actually are	Create 200 profiles on random forums
Store login owners safely (team password manager)	Lose access when a teammate leaves

28.7 Pros and cons of profile work

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
Builds entity and E-E-A-T signals	Mass profiles add little value
Quick to set up	Needs ongoing maintenance
Consistent profiles help Google understand Ongo	AI images may get flagged

28.8 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 28 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Creating fake staff profiles	"Looks more professional"	Google's fabricated profile rule	Deleting them; telling team lead
Using AI portraits on doctor profiles	Convenience	Real photos for clinicians	Replacing with real photos
Skipping reverse image search	Didn't know how	The 3-step Lens method	Checking all current profile images
Profiles on irrelevant sites	Link count pressure	"Is it worth it?" step	Leaving them; not creating more

28.9 Thumb rules

👍 Real person, real photo, real role.

👍 Reverse-search every image before use.

👍 Doctors always use real photos.

28.10 Notes to remember

📝 Google: AI headshots, made-up names and false credentials = deception.

📝 LinkedIn screens uploads for AI-generated photos.

Chapter 28 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Fabricated profile	A fake person or false credentials
AI portrait	An AI-generated image of a person
Reverse image search	Searching with an image to find matches
Google Lens	Google's visual search tool
Entity consistency	Using the same brand details everywhere

Chapter 28 Quiz

1. According to Google, which is deception?

- A) A real employee's LinkedIn
- B) AI-generated headshots, made-up names or false credentials for creators
- C) A company logo
- D) A real doctor's real photo

2. What did LinkedIn announce in 2022?

- A) Paid links
- B) Free ads
- C) A ban on all photos
- D) A model to flag AI-generated profile photos

3. Is an AI portrait of yourself the same as a fabricated profile?

- A) It's required
- B) Yes, always
- C) Only on Reddit
- D) Not if it represents you, but it can still be flagged by platforms

4. What photo should Ongo doctors use?

- A) Stock photos
- B) AI portraits
- C) No photo
- D) Real photos

5. How do you start a reverse image search in desktop Chrome?

- A) Right-click → Search image with Google Lens
- B) Use Moz

- C) Email Google
- D) Type the image name

6. A reverse search shows your chosen image on a stock site. What do you do?

- A) Use it anyway
- B) Crop it
- C) Don't use it
- D) Rename it

7. Mass profile creation on random forums is…

- A) Required by Google
- B) High value
- C) Low value and risky
- D) Tier 1

8. Why record login owners in a team password manager?

- A) To share passwords publicly
- B) Google requires it
- C) No reason
- D) So access isn't lost when someone leaves

9. What's the safe default if unsure about an AI image?

- A) Use a celebrity photo
- B) Use no profile
- C) Use a real photo
- D) Use it

10. In the visiting card analogy, what's the risk of a fake card?

- A) Too small
- B) Losing trust and the opportunity if caught
- C) Too expensive
- D) Too colourful

Sources

1. LinkedIn, New LinkedIn profile features help verify identity, detect and remove fake accounts (October 25, 2022)
2. Google Search Central, Creating helpful, reliable, people-first content (last updated October 5, 2026)
3. Tom's Guide, How to do a reverse image search using Google

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Answer key, Chapter 28: 1-B · 2-D · 3-D · 4-D · 5-A · 6-C · 7-C · 8-D · 9-C · 10-B

LEVEL 2 · CHAPTER 29

Chapter 29: Writing Bios, Descriptions and Submissions That Get Approved

Easy formulas for every field you'll ever fill, in Ongo-safe wording.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> Google uses the **words around a link** and the **anchor text** to understand what a linked page is about. [1] 🟢 Google official
>
> The 2–3 sentences you write in a bio or listing description aren't filler. They're context Google reads, and the first impression a patient gets.

29.1 Why descriptions matter

Reason	Explanation
Approval	Editors and directory moderators reject vague or salesy text
Trust	Patients see it before they see our site
Consistency	The same core description everywhere helps Google recognize Ongo (Chapter 34)
Compliance	Every word must pass the red-word list (Chapter 12)

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: rishta bio-data ka "About Me"**
>
> "Main bahut accha hoon, sabse best hoon, mujhse shaadi karo" — **reject.**
>
> "Software engineer, Pune mein kaam karta hoon, family ke saath rehta hoon, cricket aur cooking pasand hai" — **seedha, sachcha, bharosemand.**

29.2 The Ongo description formula

[Who we are] + [What we do] + [How it works] + [Who it's for] + [Trust detail]

Approved description bank (must be confirmed by Ongo's medical/legal reviewer before first use)

Length	Description
Short (1 line, ~100 characters)	Ongo Weight Loss is a US telehealth clinic offering doctor-led weight-loss care.
Medium (~250 characters)	Ongo Weight Loss is a US telehealth weight-loss clinic. Patients meet a licensed provider online, who evaluates whether medication such as compounded GLP-1 treatment is appropriate, with ongoing care-team support.
Long (~500 characters)	Ongo Weight Loss is a US-based telehealth clinic for medically supervised weight loss. Patients book an online appointment with a licensed provider, who reviews their health history and decides whether treatment, including compounded semaglutide or tirzepatide, is appropriate. Prescriptions are filled by a licensed US partner pharmacy, and patients receive ongoing support from Ongo's care team. Compounded medications are not FDA-approved.

● *Draft wording based on Ongo's process (Book One). Must be approved before use.*

> 📝 **Note to remember:** Notice what's **not** there: no "best," no "guaranteed," no "same as," no pharmacy name, no results promise.

29.3 Bios for people

Doctor bio formula

[Name, credentials] + [specialty/experience] + [role at Ongo] + [what they focus on]

> *Dr. [Name], [MD/DO], is a [board-certified specialty] physician with [X] years of experience. At Ongo Weight Loss, [he/she/they] [role], focusing on [area].*

Every credential must be accurate and verifiable. [2] ●

Writer / team member bio formula

> *[Name] writes about [topics] for Ongo Weight Loss, a US telehealth weight-loss clinic. Health content is reviewed by Ongo's medical team.*

Guest post author bio

> *[Name] is [role] at Ongo Weight Loss. [One relevant sentence of experience.]*

Anchor: brand name only (Chapter 14).

29.4 Field-by-field cheat sheet

Field	What to write	Avoid
Business name	Ongo Weight Loss (exactly the same everywhere)	"Ongo Weight Loss - Best GLP-1 Clinic"
Category	Telehealth / weight-loss clinic (closest available)	Unrelated categories for visibility
Website	https://ongoweightloss.com	Tracking codes, random subpages
Short description	Approved short line	Keywords stuffed in
Long description	Approved long version	Claims, prices that may change
Services	Factual list (telehealth consultations, weight-loss care)	"FDA-approved compounded..."
Hours / phone / address	Exactly as on the website	Inconsistent formats (Chapter 33)
Logo / images	Official logo; real photos	Stock "patients," vial photos
Tags / keywords	A few relevant terms	50 keywords

29.5 Brand name rule

The brand is written **"Ongo"**, not "ONGO," in all text. Keep it consistent everywhere, along with "Ongo Weight Loss" as the full name.

29.6 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Use the approved description bank	Write a new description each time
Keep name, URL and contact details identical	Vary the brand name
Write plainly and factually	Use "best," "#1," "guaranteed"
Get new wording approved	Invent health claims in bios

29.7 Pros and cons of standardized descriptions

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
Faster submissions	Can feel repetitive

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
Fewer compliance mistakes	Some platforms need custom lengths
Consistent entity signals	Must be updated everywhere if business details change

29.8 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 29 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
"Best GLP-1 clinic in USA" descriptions	Marketing habit	The description bank	Editing every listing you control
Different brand spellings	Typing from memory	Copy-paste from the bank	A consistency audit (Chapter 34)
Inflating credentials	Wanting authority	Only verifiable facts	Correcting immediately

29.9 Thumb rules

> 👍 Copy from the bank; don't freestyle.
>
> 👍 Facts, not hype.
>
> 👍 Same name, same URL, same description, everywhere.

29.10 Notes to remember

> 📝 Formula: who + what + how + who for + trust detail.
>
> 📝 Every credential must be accurate and verifiable.

Chapter 29 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Bio	A short description of a person
Description bank	A set of pre-approved descriptions
NAP	Name, address, phone (Chapter 33)
Entity consistency	Using identical details across the web

Term	Simple meaning
Credential	A qualification like MD, DO or RD

Chapter 29 Quiz

1. Which description is best for a directory?

- A) "Cheapest semaglutide online"
- B) "Same as Wegovy"
- C) "Best GLP-1 clinic, guaranteed results!"
- D) "Ongo Weight Loss is a US telehealth clinic offering doctor-led weight-loss care."

2. How should the brand be written in text?

- A) OnGo
- B) ongo
- C) Ongo
- D) ONGO

3. What must every doctor credential be?

- A) Impressive
- B) Long
- C) Accurate and verifiable
- D) Optional

4. What's the best anchor in a guest post author bio?

- A) The brand name
- B) A keyword
- C) A coupon code
- D) "Click here"

5. Why avoid prices in long descriptions?

- A) Google bans numbers
- B) Prices change and descriptions may go out of date
- C) Prices are illegal
- D) No reason

6. Which should never appear in Ongo descriptions?

- A) The partner pharmacy's name
- B) "Licensed provider"
- C) "Weight loss"
- D) "Telehealth"

7. What's the formula's first part?

- A) Discount
- B) Who we are
- C) Keywords
- D) Price

8. Where should the website field point?

- A) A URL with tracking codes
- B) A competitor
- C) https://ongoweightloss.com
- D) A random subpage

9. Why does Google care about the words around a link?

- A) They don't matter
- B) They help it understand what the linked page is about
- C) Only for images
- D) Only for ads

10. In the bio-data analogy, which "About Me" works?

- A) "Main sabse best hoon"
- B) A simple, honest, factual description
- C) An empty one
- D) "Mujhse shaadi karo"

Sources

1. Google Search Central, Make your links crawlable (last updated December 10, 2025)
2. Google Search Central, Creating helpful, reliable, people-first content (last updated October 5, 2026)

Answer key, Chapter 29: 1-D · 2-C · 3-C · 4-A · 5-B · 6-A · 7-B · 8-C · 9-B · 10-B

Chapter 30: Cold Email Outreach That Gets Replies

How to email strangers so they actually want to help, without breaking the law or Google's rules.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> Under the US **CAN-SPAM Act**, each separate commercial email that breaks the rules can cost **up to $53,088** in penalties, and the law makes **no exception for business-to-business email**. [1] 🟢 US government
>
> One careless outreach campaign of 100 emails is not "just marketing." Learn the rules once.

30.1 What cold outreach is (and isn't)

✅ Good outreach	❌ Bad outreach
A personal email offering something useful	Mass templates sent to 1,000 sites
Researched: you've read their work	"Dear Webmaster"
Honest about who you are	Pretending to be a fan or a patient
Easy to say no to	Repeated pushy follow-ups
Never offers money for followed links	"We'll pay $100 for a dofollow link"

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: rishta wali aunty**
>
> Ek aunty har ghar mein jaake same baat bolti hai: "Mere paas accha ladka hai." Log darwaza band kar dete hain.
>
> Doosri aunty pehle family ko samajhti hai, unki pasand jaanti hai, phir bolti hai: "Aapki beti ko classical music pasand hai na? Ek ladka hai jo tabla bajata hai, doctor hai, aapke shehar mein hai." **Darwaza khulta hai.**
>
> **Personalized outreach = doosri aunty.**

30.2 Where the line is

Allowed ✅	Not allowed ❌	Why
Suggesting our useful guide for their resource page	Offering money for a followed link	Link spam [2] 🟢
Offering a doctor quote for their article	Offering free products in exchange for a link	Link spam [2] 🟢
Asking to link an unlinked mention	Demanding a keyword anchor	Optimized anchors in paid/guest contexts [2] 🟢
Proposing a sponsorship with a sponsored link	Hiding a sponsorship	Google + FTC [2][3]
One polite follow-up	Five follow-ups	Spam complaints, deliverability

30.3 Legal and deliverability basics

CAN-SPAM essentials [1] 🟢

Requirement	What it means for outreach
Accurate "From" and header info	Use your real name and Ongo email
Honest subject line	Subject must match the email's content
Physical postal address	Include Ongo's business address in your signature
Clear way to opt out	"If you'd prefer I don't follow up, just let me know."
Honour opt-outs within 10 business days	Mark them in the sheet; never email again
You're responsible even if a vendor sends it	Outsourcing doesn't remove responsibility

CAN-SPAM's ad-disclosure rule applies to commercial messages; for one-to-one outreach, follow your team lead's or legal's guidance on exact wording. This book is not legal advice. 🔵

Gmail and Yahoo sender rules [4] 🟠

Rule	Detail
Authentication	Ongo's domain should have SPF, DKIM and DMARC set up (ask IT)
Spam complaints	Keep below **0.3%**, ideally under 0.1%
Bulk senders	Gmail treats about 5,000+ messages/day as bulk; one-click unsubscribe required for marketing mail

📝 **Note to remember:** Outreach emails go from **your real, warmed-up Ongo work inbox**, in small daily batches. Never blast hundreds of emails a day from a new address. 🔵

30.4 Finding the right person and email

Step	How
1. Find the right person	Article author, editor, or resource page owner (not "info@" if avoidable)
2. Check the site's contact or "write for us" page	Many list the right editor
3. Check the author's bio / social	Some list a contact email
4. Email-finder tools (free tiers exist)	Use within their terms; verify before sending
5. Record it	Sheet: name, role, email, source

30.5 The anatomy of a good outreach email



Part	Rule
Subject	Specific and honest (under ~8 words)
Opening	Proof you read their work (one specific detail)
Value	What's in it for **them / their readers**
Ask	One small, clear ask
Easy out	"No worries if it's not a fit"

Part	Rule
Signature	Real name, role, Ongo, address

Five templates (adapt, never copy-blast)

1. Resource page suggestion

> **Subject:** Resource for your GLP-1 patient guide page
>
> Hi [Name], your "[page]" list is one of the clearest I've seen, especially the section on [detail]. Our medical team at Ongo Weight Loss published a reviewed guide on [topic] that might be useful for your readers: [URL]. No worries if it's not a fit. Thanks for maintaining it.

2. Unlinked mention (see Chapter 23)

3. Broken link (see Chapter 22)

4. Expert offer to a journalist/editor

> **Subject:** Doctor available on GLP-1 [topic]
>
> Hi [Name], I read your piece on [topic]. If you cover [related topic] again, Dr. [Name], [credentials], at Ongo Weight Loss is available for comment. A short, reviewed perspective is below. [2–3 sentences.] Happy to help either way.

5. Content collaboration with a dietitian

> **Subject:** Collaboration idea: eating well on GLP-1s
>
> Hi [Name], your posts on protein intake are excellent. Many of our patients ask about eating well during treatment. Would you be interested in co-creating a practical guide for both our audiences? We'd credit you fully and share it with our patients.

Follow-up (one only, after 5–7 business days)

> Hi [Name], just bringing this to the top of your inbox in case it's useful. If not, no problem at all, and I won't follow up again.

30.6 Outreach metrics

Metric	Formula (Sheets)	Healthy range (🔵 estimate)
Reply rate	`=COUNTIF(Status,"Replied*")/COUNTA(Email)`	5–20%
Link rate	`=COUNTIF(Status,"Live*")/COUNTA(Email)`	2–10%

Metric	Formula (Sheets)	Healthy range (🔵 estimate)
Opt-out rate	`=COUNTIF(Status,"Opted out")/COUNTA(Email)`	Low; investigate spikes

30.7 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Personalize every email	Mail-merge "Dear Sir/Madam" to 500 sites
Send from your real Ongo inbox	Use fake names or personas
Include address and an easy opt-out	Ignore opt-outs
Offer value first	Offer money for followed links
Follow up once	Follow up five times

30.8 Pros and cons of cold outreach

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
Scalable relationship building	Low reply rates
Unlocks resource, PR and collaboration links	Legal and deliverability rules
Builds a contact network	Can damage reputation if spammy

30.9 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 30 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Copy-paste blasting	Speed pressure	One specific detail per email	Smaller, better batches
No address or opt-out	Didn't know CAN-SPAM	Signature template	Updating signature today
Offering payment for followed links	Pressure for results	The "line" table	Withdrawing the offer
New domain sending hundreds/day	Wants volume	Small daily batches from a warmed inbox	Pausing and asking IT about authentication

30.10 Thumb rules

👍 Read first, then write.

👍 Give value first; ask small.

👍 One follow-up. Then let it go.

30.11 Notes to remember

📝 CAN-SPAM: up to $53,088 per violating email; no B2B exception.

📝 Keep spam complaints under 0.3%.

Chapter 30 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Cold outreach	Emailing someone you haven't contacted before
CAN-SPAM	US law on commercial email
Opt-out	A way to stop receiving emails
SPF / DKIM / DMARC	Email authentication settings for a domain
Deliverability	Whether emails reach the inbox
Reply rate	Replies ÷ emails sent

Chapter 30 Quiz

1. What's the maximum CAN-SPAM penalty per violating email?

- A) $1 million
- B) $10
- C) None
- D) Up to $53,088

2. Does CAN-SPAM exempt business-to-business email?

- A) Only for health companies
- B) Only on Fridays
- C) No

- D) Yes

3. Which outreach is allowed?

- A) Demanding keyword anchors
- B) Suggesting a useful guide for a resource page
- C) Paying $100 for a dofollow link
- D) Sending free products for a link

4. What spam complaint rate should you stay under?

- A) 10%
- B) 30%
- C) 3%
- D) 0.3%

5. How many follow-ups are recommended?

- A) None
- B) Ten
- C) One
- D) Five

6. What should every outreach signature include?

- A) A fake name
- B) Real name, role, Ongo and a postal address
- C) A coupon
- D) Nothing

7. Someone replies "please don't email me again." What do you do?

- A) Use another address
- B) Call them
- C) Mark opted out; never email again
- D) Email again next week

8. What proves you read someone's work?

- A) One specific detail from their article
- B) "Dear Webmaster"
- C) Your DA
- D) A long introduction about Ongo

9. Which email settings help deliverability?

- A) Bold fonts
- B) SPF, DKIM and DMARC
- C) Many links
- D) Large images

10. In the rishta aunty analogy, why does the second aunty succeed?

- A) She's louder
- B) She visits more houses
- C) She brings sweets
- D) She understands the family first and makes a personal match

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Sources

1. Federal Trade Commission, CAN-SPAM Act: A Compliance Guide for Business
2. Google Search Central, Spam policies for Google web search (last updated August 28, 2026)
3. Venable, FTC finalizes updated Endorsement and Testimonial Guides (July 5, 2023)
4. Bird, Gmail and Yahoo sender requirements

Answer key, Chapter 30: 1-D · 2-C · 3-B · 4-D · 5-C · 6-B · 7-C · 8-A · 9-B · 10-D

Chapter 31: The Pre-Creation Checklist

Pilots run a checklist before every flight, no matter how experienced they are. You'll run this one before every link.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> Google says that once a link spam update removes the effect of spammy links, **the ranking benefit is lost and cannot be regained**. [1] ● Google official
>
> Some mistakes can be fixed later. Some can't. That's why the checking happens **before** you create anything.

31.1 Why a checklist?

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: ghar se nikalne se pehle**
>
> Ghar se nikalne se pehle: "Phone? Wallet? Chaabi? Gas band? Darwaza lock?" Roz karte ho, phir bhi kabhi kabhi kuch bhool jaate ho. **Checklist dimaag pe bharosa nahi karti, isliye kaam karti hai.**

31.2 The 25-point pre-creation checklist

A. The site (vetting)

#	Check	Pass?
1	Eyeball score 13+/16 (Chapter 11)	☐
2	`site:` search shows the site is indexed	☐
3	Organic traffic 500+/month and not crashing	☐
4	No link price list, "editorial fee," or "permanent dofollow" offer	☐
5	No PBN footprints (expired-domain mismatch, random topics, shared networks)	☐
6	Not a bad neighbourhood for a health brand (Chapter 12)	☐
7	Relevance tier decided: T1, T2 or T3 (not NR)	☐

B. The opportunity

#	Check	Pass?
8	A real patient might see this placement	☐
9	The site would plausibly mention Ongo even if SEO didn't exist	☐
10	No money, gift or product exchanged for a followed link	☐
11	If anything paid/gifted: link will be sponsored/nofollow and disclosed	☐
12	Not a duplicate: Ongo doesn't already have a link from this domain (check sheet)	☐
13	No teammate is already working on this site (check sheet "Owner" column)	☐

C. The content and link

#	Check	Pass?
14	Health content passed medical review (reviewer name recorded)	☐
15	Red-word list checked (no sameness, FDA-approval, guarantees)	☐
16	Anchor is brand, URL or natural descriptive text (no exact-match commercial)	☐
17	Target page is public, live, indexed and relevant	☐
18	Target URL is clean (no tracking codes unless planned)	☐
19	Content is original; not published anywhere else	☐
20	Any images are ours, credited, and reverse-searched	☐

D. People and accounts

#	Check	Pass?
21	Real names and real credentials only	☐
22	Disclosure included where required (communities, partnerships)	☐
23	Account login stored in the team password manager	☐

E. Recording

#	Check	Pass?
24	Row created in the team sheet **before** submitting (status "In progress")	☐
25	Your name in the "Owner" column	☐

The 25-Point Pre-Creation Checklist

A · Site	B · Opportunity	C · Content	D · People	E · Record
7 checks: vetting	6 checks: real, unpaid, not duplicate	7 checks: review, anchor, target	3 checks: real, disclosed	2 checks: logged, owner

Any stop rule fails › stop and ask your team lead.

31.3 Stop rules

If **any** of these is "No," **stop** and ask your team lead:

Stop rule	Checklist #
Link selling or PBN signs	4, 5
Bad neighbourhood	6
Not relevant (NR)	7
Payment for a followed link	10
Health content without medical review	14
Red-word claims present	15
Fake person or credential	21

● *Expert judgment, based on Chapters 6, 12 and 16.*

31.4 Fast mode: the 10-second version

For experienced teammates on low-risk tasks (e.g. a business listing):

1. Relevant? 2. Real site? 3. No payment for followed link? 4. No health claims (or reviewed)? 5. Brand anchor? 6. Logged with my name?

Six yeses or stop. ●

31.5 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Run the checklist every time	Skip it because "it's a small link"
Log the row before submitting	Log after (and forget)
Stop on any stop rule	Hope nobody notices
Keep a copy of the checklist open	Rely on memory

31.6 Pros and cons

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
Prevents irreversible mistakes	Takes a few extra minutes
Consistent quality across the team	Can feel repetitive
Makes audits easy later	Needs the sheet kept up to date

31.7 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 31 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Duplicate outreach to the same site as a teammate	Didn't check sheet	Checks 12–13	Apologizing to the site; coordinating
Logging links days later	Busy	Check 24	Logging before submission
Skipping medical review on "small" content	Feels minor	Check 14	Pulling content for review

31.8 Thumb rules

> 👍 Checklist first, always.
>
> 👍 One "no" on a stop rule = stop.
>
> 👍 Log before you submit.

31.9 Notes to remember

> 📝 25 checks in five groups: site, opportunity, content, people, recording.
>
> 📝 Link spam benefits Google removes can't be regained, so prevention matters most.

Chapter 31 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Pre-creation checklist	Checks done before creating or requesting a link
Stop rule	A check that, if failed, means stop and escalate
Owner column	The sheet column showing who handles a link
Duplicate outreach	Two teammates contacting the same site

Chapter 31 Quiz

1. When do you run the pre-creation checklist?

- A) Before every link
- B) Only for big sites
- C) After the link is live
- D) Once a month

2. Which is a stop rule?

- A) The editor replied quickly
- B) The article is long
- C) Payment offered for a followed link
- D) The site is blue

3. When should you create the sheet row?

- A) Only if the link goes live
- B) A week later
- C) Before submitting
- D) Never

4. Why check the "Owner" column first?

- A) No reason
- B) To avoid duplicate outreach with a teammate

- C) To change ownership
- D) To find passwords

5. Which anchor passes check 16?

- A) "Best compounded semaglutide online"
- B) "Cheap tirzepatide"
- C) "Ongo Weight Loss"
- D) "Buy now"

6. Health content without medical review means...

- A) Stop
- B) Publish anyway
- C) Publish on Fridays only
- D) Add a keyword

7. How many checks are in the fast mode?

- A) 6
- B) 2
- C) 50
- D) 25

8. Can lost link spam benefit be regained later?

- A) Only with disavow
- B) Only in Europe
- C) No, according to Google
- D) Yes, easily

9. Where are account logins stored?

- A) A public doc
- B) The team password manager
- C) A personal notebook
- D) Email drafts

10. In the analogy, why does the checklist work?

- A) It's in Hindi
- B) It doesn't rely on memory
- C) It's long
- D) It's optional

Sources

1. Google Search Central, Spam updates (last updated December 10, 2025)

2. Google Search Central, Spam policies for Google web search (last updated August 28, 2026)

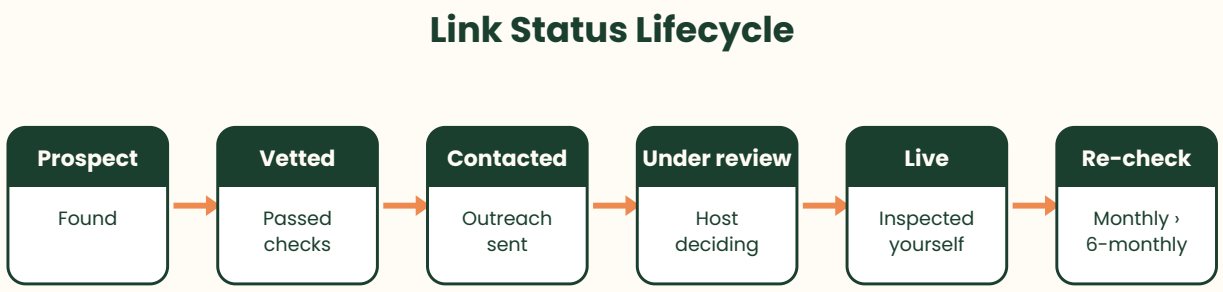
Answer key, Chapter 31: 1-A · 2-C · 3-C · 4-B · 5-C · 6-A · 7-A · 8-C · 9-B · 10-B

Chapter 32: After Submission: Live, Under Review, Rejected, Removed

Creating the link is half the job. What you do in the weeks after decides whether it lasts.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> Disavowed links still appear in Search Console's Links report, and changes from a disavow upload can take **a few weeks** to take effect. [1] ● Google official
>
> Off-page work runs on weeks, not minutes. A clear status system stops you from forgetting a link that's still "pending" three months later.

32.1 The status lifecycle



Status	Meaning
Prospect	Site found, not yet vetted
Vetted	Passed vetting, ready for outreach
Contacted	Outreach sent
In progress	Agreed; content being written/reviewed
Under review	Submitted; waiting for the host to approve/publish
Live	Published and verified
Live – changed	Published, but something changed (rel, anchor, URL, placement)

Status	Meaning
Rejected	Host declined
Removed	Was live, now gone
Opted out	Contact asked not to be emailed again
Do not use	Site failed vetting or a stop rule

32.2 When a link is LIVE: verify it

☐	Check	How
☐	Page loads and is public	Open in an incognito window
☐	Link exists and points to the right URL	Right-click → Inspect (Chapter 7)
☐	rel attribute recorded (follow / nofollow / sponsored / ugc)	Inspect
☐	Anchor text recorded	Inspect
☐	Placement recorded (body, bio, list...)	Visual check
☐	Our approved content wasn't edited into a risky claim	Read the article
☐	Source page indexed (or check again in 2–4 weeks)	`site:` search for the exact URL
☐	Grade it (Chapter 15)	Sheet
☐	Thank the host	Short email

> ⚠️ **Where freshers go wrong: "live" without checking**
>
> - **The mistake:** Marking "Live" because the editor said "done!"
> - **Why it happens:** Trusting the email.
> - **How to avoid it:** Never mark Live until you've inspected the link yourself.
> - **How to fix it:** Re-check all links marked Live in the last month.

32.3 When a link is UNDER REVIEW: wait smartly

Time since submission	Action
0–7 days	Wait
7–14 days	One polite follow-up

Time since submission	Action
14–30 days	Check if it's live without telling you (search the title)
30+ days, no reply	Mark "Stalled"; don't reuse the content elsewhere without asking

🔵 *Expert judgment; adjust to each site's stated timelines.*

> 📝 **Note to remember:** Never submit the same article to another site while one site is still reviewing it. If it goes live in both places, it's duplicate content and burns both relationships. 🔵

32.4 When a link is REJECTED: learn and move on

Step	Action
1	Thank them politely
2	Note the reason (if given) in the sheet
3	Ask once if a different topic would fit (only if the relationship is good)
4	If the content is still good, pitch it to a **different** relevant site
5	Review patterns monthly: are rejections about quality, relevance, or tone?

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: rishta mana ho gaya**
>
> Rishta mana ho gaya. Kya karte hain? Ladke wale ke ghar jaake jhagda? Nahi. "Koi baat nahi, aap ka bahut shukriya" bolte hain. Kabhi kabhi saal baad wahi log kisi aur rishte ke liye yaad karte hain. **Izzat se mana sunna bhi ek skill hai.**

32.5 When a link is REMOVED or CHANGED: diagnose first

What happened	Likely reason	Action
Whole page deleted	Site cleanup or redesign	Ask if it moved; offer updated content
Link removed, page still there	Editorial decision or policy change	Ask politely once; accept the answer
Link changed to nofollow/sponsored	Site policy change	Accept; update the sheet
Our target URL changed and now 404s	Ongo site change	Fix with a 301 redirect (Chapter 23)
Site disappeared entirely	Domain expired	Mark Removed; nothing to do

What happened	Likely reason	Action
Our approved text was edited into a risky claim	Editor edits	Ask for correction or removal (Chapter 12)

Decision flowchart

1. **Is the page still there?** No → was it moved? Yes → ask for the new URL. No → mark Removed.
2. **Is the link still there?** No → ask once politely. Yes → go to 3.
3. **Did the link change?** Yes → record the change; accept editorial decisions.
4. **Is the content still accurate?** No → request correction.

32.6 Re-check schedule

Link grade	Re-check
Platinum / Gold	Monthly
Silver	Every 3 months
Bronze / Iron	Every 6 months

● *Expert judgment. Chapter 38 explains the full audit.*

32.7 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Verify every live link yourself	Trust "done!" emails
Follow up once, politely	Chase editors weekly
Accept rejections and editorial changes gracefully	Argue or threaten
Update statuses the same day	Leave statuses stale for months

32.8 Pros and cons of a status system

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
Nothing gets forgotten	Requires discipline
Clear reporting for your manager	More columns to maintain
Patterns show what's working	

32.9 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 32 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Never re-checking live links	"It's done"	Re-check schedule	Monthly audit
Double-submitting content	Impatience	One site at a time	Asking one host to withdraw
Arguing with rejections	Frustration	Thank-you-and-move-on rule	Apologizing

32.10 Thumb rules

👍 Not inspected = not live.

👍 One follow-up, then patience.

👍 A graceful "no" keeps the door open.

32.11 Notes to remember

📝 Eleven statuses from Prospect to Do not use.

📝 Platinum/Gold links get re-checked monthly.

Chapter 32 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Status	Where a link is in its lifecycle
Under review	Submitted and waiting for the host
Removed	Was live, now gone
Live – changed	Still live, but something about it changed
Stalled	No reply after 30+ days

Chapter 32 Quiz

1. When should you mark a link "Live"?

- A) When the editor says "done"
- B) Never
- C) After you've inspected it yourself
- D) After submitting

2. How long might disavow changes take to apply, per Google?

- A) Seconds
- B) Five years
- C) A few weeks
- D) They never apply

3. What should you do 7–14 days after submission with no reply?

- A) Submit to five other sites
- B) Disavow the site
- C) Threaten the editor
- D) Send one polite follow-up

4. An editor changes our link to nofollow. Status?

- A) Prospect
- B) Removed
- C) Rejected
- D) Live – changed

5. Our target page now returns 404. Fix?

- A) Disavow
- B) Ask the host to delete the link
- C) 301 redirect to the right page
- D) Ignore it

6. Should you submit the same article to another site while one is reviewing it?

- A) Only if it's long
- B) No
- C) Yes, to save time
- D) Only to two sites

7. How often should Gold links be re-checked?

- A) Monthly
- B) Never
- C) Every 5 years
- D) Daily

8. What's the first question when a link disappears?

- A) Who's the CEO?

- B) What's their DA?
- C) What colour is the site?
- D) Is the page still there?

9. A host edited our approved text into "same as Wegovy." Action?

- A) Mark it Platinum
- B) Share it widely
- C) Leave it
- D) Request correction or removal

10. In the rishta analogy, how should you handle a rejection?

- A) Complain online
- B) Thank them politely and move on
- C) Never speak again
- D) Argue

Sources

1. Google Search Console Help, Disavow links to your site

Answer key, Chapter 32: 1-C · 2-C · 3-D · 4-D · 5-C · 6-B · 7-A · 8-D · 9-D · 10-B

03

LEVEL 3

Strategist

Plan, measure, report, and win in local search and AI search.

33 · Local SEO Off-Page (USA)

34 · Entity SEO: Making Google Recognize Ongo

35 · Off-Page for AI Search

36 · Tracking Ongo's AI Visibility

37 · Social Media and YouTube

38 · Auditing Your Backlinks

39 · Measuring Impact

40 · The Google Sheets System

41 · Your Best Link: Choosing It and Presenting It to Your Manager

42 · Off-Page Priorities: A 90-Day Plan

LEVEL 3 · CHAPTER 33

Chapter 33: Local SEO Off-Page (USA)

Business listings, citations, reviews and local links, and the hard truth about Google Business Profile for a telehealth brand.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> Google Business Profile's eligibility rules say a business must **make in-person contact with customers during its stated hours**, and list **"online-only businesses"** among those that are **not eligible**. [1] 🟢 Google official
>
> Many telehealth companies set up a Business Profile anyway, with a virtual office address. That's how listings get suspended.

33.1 Why local SEO is different for Ongo

Most local SEO advice assumes a shop, clinic or restaurant with a front door. Ongo is a **telehealth** clinic: patients meet providers online.

Typical local business	Ongo
Has a storefront customers visit	Patients meet providers online
Google Business Profile is the #1 local asset	GBP may not be available (see 33.2)
Competes in "near me" searches	Competes in state-level and national searches
Citations with one physical address	Must only list real, accurate addresses

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: online tiffin service**
>
> Ek aunty ka ghar se online tiffin service hai. Kya woh Google Maps pe "restaurant" bana sakti hai? **Nahi**, kyunki log wahan baith ke kha nahi sakte.
>
> Agar woh kisi khaali office ka address daal de taaki Maps pe dikhe, toh pakdi jayegi. **Sahi rasta:** apni website, reviews aur local logon mein naam banana.

33.2 Google Business Profile: the decision

Situation	GBP decision	Evidence
Ongo has **no** location where staff meet patients in person	**Not eligible.** Don't create one.	🟢 [1]

Situation	GBP decision	Evidence
Ongo has a real office that patients visit in person during set hours	Eligible for that location	🟢 [1]
An Ongo doctor runs their own in-person practice	That practice may have its own GBP (the doctor's, not Ongo's)	🔵
Someone suggests a virtual office or P.O. box	**Never.** Remote mailbox / P.O. box addresses are ineligible	🟢 [1]

> ⚠️ **Where freshers go wrong: the fake address**
>
> - **The mistake:** Creating a GBP for Ongo with a co-working or virtual office address.
> - **Why it happens:** "Every business needs a Google listing."
> - **How to avoid it:** Read GBP eligibility rules; escalate to your team lead.
> - **How to fix it:** Tell your team lead immediately. Don't try to "fix" it quietly; a suspended or misleading listing is a business decision.
>
> 📝 **Note to remember:** This book can't decide Ongo's GBP eligibility for you; that depends on Ongo's real operations. The rule for you: **never invent an address.** 🔵

33.3 NAP and citations

NAP = **Name, Address, Phone**. A **citation** is any listing of a business's NAP on another site.

Consistent business details across the web help people and systems trust that the information is correct. [2] 🟠

Ongo's NAP rules

Rule	Example
Same name everywhere	"Ongo Weight Loss"
Same phone format everywhere	Copy exactly from the website
Same URL everywhere	https://ongoweightloss.com
Address only if real and approved	Business mailing address only where the platform allows a non-storefront address, and never shown as a clinic patients can visit

Where citations make sense for a telehealth brand

Type	Examples	Note
Healthcare & telehealth directories	Curated telehealth provider directories, doctor directories for Ongo's physicians	Vet each one (Chapter 16)

Type	Examples	Note
Business directories	Major general business directories that allow online businesses	Check each directory's rules
Data aggregators	Data Axle, Foursquare and similar networks distribute business data to maps and apps [2] 🟠	Only if Ongo has an eligible, real business record
Professional bodies	Real memberships	Chapter 26

33.4 Reviews: the rules

Reviews build trust with patients and are part of what people (and AI answers) see about Ongo.

Google's review policies [3] 🟢

❌ Not allowed	✅ Allowed
Paying or giving discounts/freebies for reviews	Asking real patients for honest reviews
Reviews from employees, family, or contractors (conflict of interest)	Replying politely to all reviews
Selectively asking only happy patients ("review gating")	Asking every patient the same neutral way
Incentives to remove or change negative reviews	Fixing the problem, then letting the patient decide
Setting staff quotas for review requests	Simple follow-up email to all patients

FTC rules apply too

The FTC's fake reviews rule bans fake, bought, and undisclosed insider reviews (Chapter 12). [4] 🟢

Healthcare privacy caution

When replying to reviews, **never confirm someone is a patient or discuss their treatment**. Health privacy rules apply. Use general replies like "Thank you for your feedback; please contact our care team at..." Ask your compliance contact for approved reply templates. 🔵

33.5 Local links for a national telehealth brand

Opportunity	Example
State-level resources	A carefully maintained page on telehealth availability by state; pitched to state health resource lists
Local news	A doctor commenting on a local health story
Local sponsorships	Community health events (sponsored links, Chapter 26)

Opportunity	Example
Local partnerships	Dietitians or fitness professionals in a state Ongo serves
University / community health programs	Educational talks or resources

33.6 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Follow GBP eligibility rules	Create a GBP with a fake or virtual address
Keep NAP identical everywhere	Vary the brand name or phone
Ask every patient for honest reviews the same way	Buy, incentivize or gate reviews
Use privacy-safe review replies	Confirm a reviewer is a patient
Build state-level and local news links	Create fake "city pages" with no real value

33.7 Pros and cons of local off-page for Ongo

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
Builds patient trust through reviews	GBP may not be available
Consistent business data across the web	Fewer local "map" opportunities than storefronts
State-level links match Ongo's service areas	Review replies need privacy care

33.8 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 33 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Fake address GBP	Copying local SEO tutorials	Reading eligibility	Escalating immediately
"Leave us 5 stars and get $20 off"	Wants reviews fast	Google + FTC rules	Stopping the offer
Replying "Glad your semaglutide worked!"	Being friendly	Privacy-safe templates	Editing the reply
Different NAP formats	Typing from memory	Copy from the description bank	Running a citation audit

33.9 Thumb rules

👍 Never invent an address.

👍 Ask everyone, reward no one, gate nobody.

👍 Reply kindly, reveal nothing.

33.10 Notes to remember

📝 GBP: online-only businesses aren't eligible; in-person contact is required.

📝 Google bans incentivized, conflicted and gated reviews.

Chapter 33 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Google Business Profile (GBP)	A business's listing on Google Search and Maps
NAP	Name, address, phone
Citation	A listing of a business's details on another site
Data aggregator	A company that distributes business data to many apps and maps
Review gating	Asking only happy customers for reviews
Service-area business	A business that serves customers at their location

Chapter 33 Quiz

1. Who is eligible for a Google Business Profile?

- A) Only big brands
- B) Only telehealth companies
- C) Any website
- D) Businesses that make in-person contact with customers during stated hours

2. Are online-only businesses eligible for GBP?

- A) Yes
- B) Only with a virtual office
- C) No

- D) Only on weekends

3. What does NAP stand for?

- A) Network, Authority, Page
- B) Nofollow, Anchor, PageRank
- C) New Anchor Profile
- D) Name, Address, Phone

4. Which review practice is allowed?

- A) Employees reviewing the business
- B) Asking only happy patients
- C) Asking every patient for an honest review the same way
- D) Offering discounts for reviews

5. What is "review gating"?

- A) Deleting reviews
- B) Replying to reviews
- C) A type of directory
- D) Selectively asking only happy customers for reviews

6. A teammate suggests a virtual office address for Ongo's GBP. What do you do?

- A) Use a competitor's address
- B) Refuse and escalate; never invent an address
- C) Use a P.O. box instead
- D) Do it

7. Which reply to a review is privacy-safe?

- A) "You were our patient in May."
- B) "We checked your records..."
- C) "Glad your tirzepatide dose is working!"
- D) "Thank you for your feedback; please contact our care team."

8. Which local link fits a national telehealth brand?

- A) A virtual office listing
- B) Fake city pages
- C) A doctor commenting on a local health news story
- D) Buying local directory links

9. What do data aggregators do?

- A) Write reviews
- B) Distribute business data to many maps and apps
- C) Sell backlinks
- D) Run ads

10. In the tiffin analogy, what's the right path?

- A) Fake restaurant address
- B) Build reputation through the website, reviews and local word of mouth
- C) Hide the business
- D) Stop selling

Sources

1. Google Business Profile Help, Business eligibility and ownership guidelines
2. BrightLocal, Local data aggregators (updated July 2026)
3. Google Maps User Contributed Content Policy, Prohibited & restricted content
4. Federal Trade Commission, Final rule banning fake reviews and testimonials (August 14, 2024)

Answer key, Chapter 33: 1-D · 2-C · 3-D · 4-C · 5-D · 6-B · 7-D · 8-C · 9-B · 10-B

Chapter 34: Entity SEO: Making Google Recognize Ongo

Google doesn't just index pages. It tries to understand "things": brands, people, places. Help it understand Ongo.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> Google says **Organization structured data** helps it understand and tell your organization apart from others, and can influence **which logo appears in Search results and your knowledge panel**. Its `sameAs` property lists your other official profiles across the web. [1] 🟢 Google official
>
> A few lines of code on one page, plus consistent profiles everywhere, help Google connect every mention of "Ongo" to the right company.

34.1 What is an entity?

An **entity** is a distinct, identifiable "thing": a company (Ongo), a person (Dr. X), a place (Texas), a medication (semaglutide).

When Google sees "Ongo" on a news site, a directory, LinkedIn and YouTube, it tries to decide: **is this the same Ongo?**

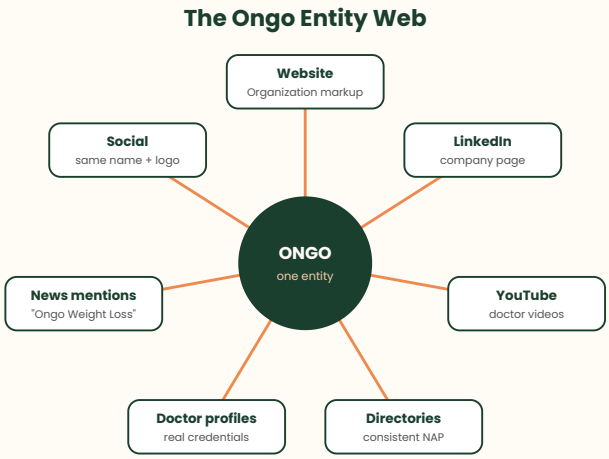
> 🪔 **Desi analogy: ek naam, kai log**
>
> Mohalle mein teen "Raju" hain. Raju doodhwala, Raju electrician, Raju ka beta Raju. Log pehchaante kaise hain? **Kaam, ghar ka address, papa ka naam.**
>
> Google ke liye bhi "Ongo" naam ke kai cheezein ho sakti hain. **Consistent details** se Google samajhta hai ki yeh wahi Ongo hai jo telehealth weight-loss clinic hai.

34.2 Why entities matter off-page

Benefit	How
Mentions connect to us	Unlinked mentions still count toward recognizing the brand 🔵
Knowledge panel eligibility	Google generates panels automatically for recognized entities [2] 🟠
Doctor E-E-A-T	Doctors recognized across the web strengthen trust

Benefit	How
AI answers	AI features summarize what's said about brands across the web [3] ●

34.3 The entity checklist for Ongo



Same name, same logo, same story everywhere, connected through sameAs.

☐	Task	Owner
☐	**Organization structured data** on the homepage or About page: name, url, logo, sameAs, contactPoint [1] ●	Dev + SEO
☐	**Same name, logo, description** on every official profile (Chapter 29)	SEO
☐	**sameAs list**: official social profiles, YouTube, LinkedIn company page, other official listings	SEO
☐	**Doctor profile pages** on Ongo with real credentials, linking to their professional profiles	SEO + medical team
☐	**Person structured data / ProfilePage** for doctor pages where appropriate	Dev
☐	**Consistent mentions**: ask publications to use "Ongo Weight Loss"	Off-page team
☐	**Monitor brand searches** in GSC (queries containing "ongo")	SEO

Example Organization markup

```
<script type="application/ld+json">
{
  "@context": "https://schema.org",
  "@type": "MedicalOrganization",
  "name": "Ongo Weight Loss",
  "url": "https://ongoweightloss.com",
  "logo": "https://ongoweightloss.com/logo.png",
  "sameAs": [
    "https://www.linkedin.com/company/…",
    "https://www.youtube.com/@…",
    "https://www.instagram.com/…"
  ]
}
</script>
```

Choose the most specific schema.org type that accurately fits; Google recommends using the most specific relevant subtype. [1] 🟢 *Final type choice should be confirmed with the dev team.*

34.4 Knowledge panels

Fact	Detail
Can you order one?	**No.** Google generates them automatically. [2] 🟠
Can you claim one?	If one exists, you can claim it through Google's verification process and suggest edits; not all panels can be claimed. [2] 🟠
What helps?	Being a well-documented, consistently described entity across trusted sources. 🔵

34.5 Wikipedia and Wikidata: proceed carefully

Platform	Reality for Ongo
Wikipedia	A company needs **in-depth coverage in independent, reliable sources** to be notable. Press releases and sponsored articles don't count. Employees and agencies have a conflict of interest and should not write about their own company; paid editing must be disclosed. [2] 🟠
Wikidata	Items need to describe an identifiable entity supported by serious, public references (or link to a Wikimedia project). The community decides. [2] 🟠

⚠️ **Where freshers go wrong: "let's make a Wikipedia page"**

- **The mistake:** Writing a Wikipedia article about Ongo.
- **Why it happens:** Old SEO advice about knowledge panels.
- **How to avoid it:** Earn independent press coverage first (Chapter 20). Never edit as an undisclosed employee.
- **How to fix it:** Stop; disclose any conflict of interest; let the community decide.

📝 **Note to remember:** No public Google statement says Wikipedia, Wikidata or sameAs guarantees a knowledge panel or AI citations. Treat entity work as **housekeeping that removes confusion**, not a ranking trick. [2]

34.6 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Add Organization structured data once, accurately	Mark up fake reviews or ratings
Keep every official profile consistent	Use different names and logos
Earn independent coverage	Write our own Wikipedia article
Link doctor pages to their real profiles	Invent credentials or affiliations

34.7 Pros and cons

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
Helps Google connect mentions to Ongo	No guaranteed knowledge panel
Supports doctor E-E-A-T	Needs dev help for structured data
Low risk, mostly one-time work	Wikipedia is out of our control

34.8 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 34 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
sameAs listing unofficial or old profiles	Copy-paste	Using only official, active profiles	Updating the markup
Inconsistent logos across platforms	Different teammates	One brand asset folder	Replacing old logos
Undisclosed Wikipedia editing	Not knowing the rules	COI disclosure	Stopping and disclosing

34.9 Thumb rules

👍 Same name, same logo, same story, everywhere.

👍 Entities are earned through independent coverage, not self-written pages.

👍 Structured data describes reality; it never invents it.

34.10 Notes to remember

📝 Organization markup: name, url, logo, sameAs, contactPoint.

📝 Knowledge panels can't be ordered, only claimed if they exist.

Chapter 34 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Entity	A distinct thing Google recognizes (brand, person, place)
Knowledge panel	Google's information box about an entity
Structured data	Code that describes page information for search engines
sameAs	A property listing other official profiles of the same entity
Wikidata	A free knowledge base used by many systems
Conflict of interest (COI)	Editing about something you're connected to

---

Chapter 34 Quiz

1. What can Organization structured data influence?

- A) Your DA
- B) Ad prices
- C) Which logo appears in Search and the knowledge panel
- D) Email deliverability

2. What does `sameAs` list?

- A) Other official profiles of the same organization
- B) Competitors
- C) Backlinks

- D) Keywords

3. Can you order a Google knowledge panel?

- A) Yes, for a fee
- B) No; Google generates them, but existing ones can sometimes be claimed
- C) Only for doctors
- D) Only through Wikipedia

4. Should an Ongo employee write Ongo's Wikipedia article?

- A) Only with keywords
- B) No; it's a conflict of interest and notability needs independent coverage
- C) Yes
- D) Only on weekends

5. What makes a company notable on Wikipedia?

- A) Press releases
- B) Sponsored articles
- C) In-depth coverage in independent, reliable sources
- D) Social media followers

6. What's an entity?

- A) A backlink
- B) A distinct, identifiable thing like a brand or person
- C) A keyword
- D) A directory

7. Where should Organization markup go?

- A) A competitor's site
- B) Nowhere
- C) The homepage or a single About page
- D) Every page

8. Does sameAs guarantee AI citations?

- A) Only on Bing
- B) Only with Wikidata
- C) Yes
- D) No public statement says so; treat it as housekeeping

9. In the "teen Raju" analogy, how do people tell them apart?

- A) By consistent details: work, address, father's name
- B) By their height
- C) By guessing
- D) They can't

10. What helps doctors' entity signals?

- A) Real profile pages linked to their real professional profiles
- B) AI headshots
- C) Invented credentials
- D) Anonymous bios

Sources

1. Google Search Central, Organization structured data (last updated September 8, 2026)
2. eSEOspace, Wikidata and Wikipedia for GEO: what businesses can and can't do
3. Google Search Central, Optimizing your website for generative AI features on Google Search (last updated July 10, 2026)

Answer key, Chapter 34: 1-C · 2-A · 3-B · 4-B · 5-C · 6-B · 7-C · 8-D · 9-A · 10-A

Chapter 35: Off-Page for AI Search

AI Overviews, AI Mode, ChatGPT, Perplexity, Gemini: how they pick sources, and what off-page work actually helps.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> Google says that from its point of view, "AEO" and "GEO" (answer/generative engine optimization) are **still SEO**, because its AI features are **rooted in its core Search ranking and quality systems**. [1] 🟢 Google official
>
> The new buzzwords haven't changed the old truth: be trustworthy, be useful, be talked about honestly.

35.1 How Google's AI features choose sources

Google describes two techniques: [1] 🟢 Google official

Technique	Simple meaning
Retrieval-augmented generation (RAG)	Google's ranking systems first **retrieve** relevant pages from the index; the AI then writes an answer from them, with links
Query fan-out	The AI runs **several related searches** to gather more information for one question

To appear, a page must be **indexed** and **eligible to show with a snippet**. [1] 🟢

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: shaadi ka "group discussion"**
>
> Family mein rishte pe discussion ho raha hai. Har koi apne bharose ke logon se poochh ke aata hai: mama kuch bolta hai, chachi kuch, padosi kuch. Phir sab milake ek summary banti hai.
>
> **AI answer = woh summary.** Usme wahi naam aate hain jinke baare mein bharose ke log acchi baat karte hain.

35.2 What off-page work helps AI visibility

Off-page activity	Why it helps	Evidence
Earning links and mentions on trusted sites	AI features retrieve from the same ranking systems that use link analysis	🟢 [1][2]
Being discussed genuinely in blogs, videos, forums	Google's AI features can show what's said about products and services across these	🟢 [1]
Doctor quotes in news (digital PR)	Builds recognized expertise	🔵

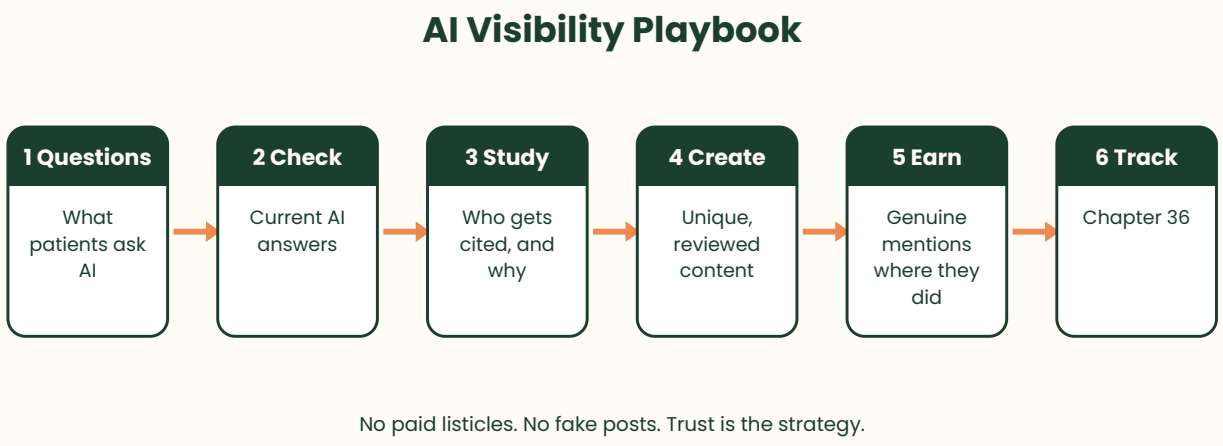
Off-page activity	Why it helps	Evidence
Consistent entity information	Reduces confusion about who Ongo is	🔵 (Chapter 34)
Linkable assets with clear facts	Citable, non-commodity content stands out	🟢 [1]

35.3 What doesn't help (or hurts)

Tactic	Google's position
Seeking inauthentic mentions (paid listicles, planted forum posts, fake reviews)	Not as helpful as it seems; AI features depend on spam-blocking systems too [1] 🟢
llms.txt files	Google Search doesn't use them [1] 🟢
Mass pages for every fan-out query	Can violate the scaled content abuse policy [1] 🟢
Manipulating AI responses	Now explicitly within Google's spam definition [3] 🟢

📝 **Note to remember:** Other AI assistants (ChatGPT, Perplexity, Gemini apps, Copilot) use their own systems and search partners. Google's guidance covers Google; for the others, the same principle is the safest bet: **be the most trustworthy, genuinely discussed source.** 🔵

35.4 The AI visibility playbook for Ongo



No paid listicles. No fake posts. Trust is the strategy.

Step	Action
1	**List the questions** patients ask AI about GLP-1s, costs, safety, telehealth (Chapter 17)
2	**Check current answers**: search them in Google (AI Overviews / AI Mode) and major assistants; note which sources are cited

Step	Action
3	**Study the cited sources**: what makes them trustworthy? Who links to them?
4	**Create non-commodity content** that answers better, with medical review
5	**Earn mentions** where cited sources earned theirs: PR, resource pages, communities
6	**Track** results (Chapter 36)

> 🟧 **Ongo example**
>
> Question: *"How much does compounded tirzepatide cost per month?"*
>
> You check AI answers and see they cite two personal finance sites and one telehealth comparison article. Ongo isn't mentioned.
>
> **Plan:** update Ongo's cost guide with clear, dated, approved price ranges (Chapter 19); pitch the finance sites with the updated data; offer the comparison article's editor accurate information for their next update (Chapter 18). **No** paid listicles, **no** fake Reddit posts.

35.5 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Treat AI visibility as part of SEO	Buy "AI visibility" packages
Earn genuine mentions in trusted places	Plant fake recommendations
Create clear, citable, reviewed content	Mass-produce pages for every query
Check AI answers regularly	Promise your manager "we'll be in ChatGPT next week"

35.6 Pros and cons of AI-era off-page

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
Same work helps classic search and AI	Hard to measure precisely
Trust compounds across platforms	AI answers change often
Mentions without links still matter	Many AI views produce no click

35.7 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 35 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Buying "ChatGPT ranking" services	Hype	Google's mythbusting list	Cancelling; reporting
Building llms.txt instead of earning mentions	Trend-following	Remembering Google ignores it	Refocusing effort
Checking one AI answer once	Impatience	Repeated, dated checks	A monthly prompt log (Chapter 36)

35.8 Thumb rules

👍 AI visibility = trust visibility.

👍 If you'd be embarrassed for a patient to find out how a mention happened, don't do it.

👍 Study who AI cites, then earn trust where they did.

35.9 Notes to remember

📝 Google's AI features use RAG and query fan-out on top of core ranking systems.

📝 Inauthentic mentions and llms.txt don't help in Google Search.

Chapter 35 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
AI Overview	AI-written summary at the top of some Google results
AI Mode	Google's conversational AI search
RAG	AI answers built from retrieved, ranked pages
Query fan-out	AI running several related searches for one question
AEO / GEO	Industry terms for AI-answer optimization
llms.txt	A proposed file for AI tools; Google Search doesn't use it

Chapter 35 Quiz

1. What does Google say AEO and GEO are, from its perspective?

- A) Completely new disciplines
- B) Banned
- C) Still SEO
- D) Paid ads

2. What is RAG?

- A) AI answers built from pages retrieved by ranking systems
- B) A spam policy
- C) A type of backlink
- D) A GA4 report

3. Does Google Search use llms.txt files?

- A) No
- B) Yes, heavily
- C) Only in AI Mode
- D) Only for health sites

4. What's Google's view on seeking inauthentic mentions?

- A) Required
- B) Very effective
- C) Not as helpful as it might seem
- D) Ignored

5. What must a page be to appear in Google's AI features?

- A) Indexed and eligible to show with a snippet
- B) Paid
- C) On Wikipedia
- D) Longer than 5,000 words

6. Which tactic risks scaled content abuse?

- A) One great guide
- B) A doctor quote
- C) Mass pages for every fan-out query
- D) A resource page link

7. First step in the AI visibility playbook?

- A) Delete old pages
- B) List the questions patients ask AI
- C) Buy listicles

- D) Create llms.txt

8. Do Google's guidelines cover ChatGPT and Perplexity?

- A) Only on Bing
- B) Only Perplexity
- C) No; they use their own systems, so the safest principle is genuine trust
- D) Yes, fully

9. What does "query fan-out" mean?

- A) The AI running several related searches
- B) Sharing queries on social media
- C) Deleting queries
- D) A paid ad format

10. In the family discussion analogy, which names appear in the summary?

- A) Whoever paid the most
- B) Those trusted people speak well of
- C) The loudest person's
- D) Random names

Sources

1. Google Search Central, Optimizing your website for generative AI features on Google Search (last updated July 10, 2026)
2. Google Search Central, A guide to Google Search ranking systems (last updated December 10, 2025)
3. Google Search Central, Spam policies for Google web search (last updated August 28, 2026)

Answer key, Chapter 35: 1-C · 2-A · 3-A · 4-C · 5-A · 6-C · 7-B · 8-C · 9-A · 10-B

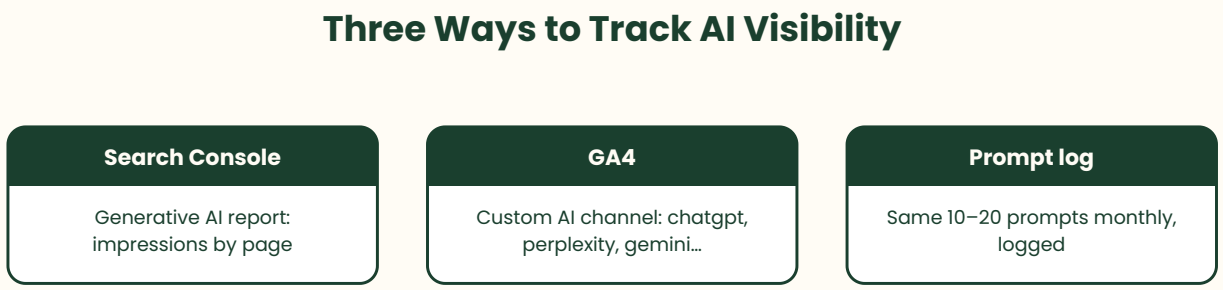
LEVEL 3 · CHAPTER 36

Chapter 36: Tracking Ongo's AI Visibility

If you can't measure it, you can't report it. Here's how to measure AI visibility honestly, including what can't be measured yet.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> In June 2026, Google began rolling out a **Search Generative AI performance report** in Search Console, starting with **a subset of UK users**. At launch it showed **impressions** but **no click data**. [1] 🟠
>
> Even Google's own AI reporting is still growing. Anyone promising "complete AI visibility tracking" is overselling.

36.1 Three ways to track AI visibility



Each method misses something; together they tell an honest story.

Method	What it shows	Limits
1. Search Console Generative AI report	Impressions of Ongo's pages in Google's AI features (AI Overviews, AI Mode, Discover), by page, country, device, date [1] 🟠	Rolling out gradually; no clicks at launch
2. GA4 AI referral channel	Visits from chatgpt.com, perplexity.ai, gemini.google.com, copilot and similar [2] 🟠	Many AI visits lose their referrer and show as Direct
3. Manual prompt log	Whether Ongo is mentioned/cited for key questions	Answers vary by user, time and wording

36.2 Method 1: Search Console

1. Open Search Console → look for the **Generative AI performance** report (if available for Ongo's property). [3] 🟢
2. Note impressions by **page**: which Ongo pages appear in AI features?
3. Compare monthly. Rising impressions on a page you promoted off-page = a useful signal.

> 📝 **Note to remember:** If the report isn't available in your account yet, note that in your monthly report rather than guessing numbers. 🔵

36.3 Method 2: GA4 AI channel

Setup (one-time, needs GA4 admin access) [2] 🟠

1. **Admin → Data display → Channel groups → Create new channel group.**
2. Add a channel named **"AI Assistants."**
3. Condition: **Session source → matches regex**:

```
chatgpt\.com|chat\.openai\.com|perplexity\.ai|claude\.ai|gemini\.google\.com|copilot\.microsoft\.com
```

4. Move the AI channel **above** Referral (GA4 uses the first matching rule).
5. Wait 24–48 hours; view under **Reports → Acquisition → Traffic acquisition**, switching to your new channel group.

Limitations [2] 🟠

Limitation	Effect
AI mobile apps often strip the referrer	Visits appear as Direct
People see Ongo in an AI answer, then Google "Ongo"	Appears as Organic Search
AI Overviews may cite without a click	No GA4 visit at all

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: shaadi ke mehmaan kahan se aaye**
>
> Shaadi mein mehmaan aate hain. Kuch card dikhate hain (referral), kuch seedha aa jaate hain (direct), kuch kehte hain "Sharma ji ne bataya tha" (AI mention, no card). **Har mehmaan ka record nahi hota**, lekin pattern samajh aata hai.

36.4 Method 3: The manual prompt log

Create a sheet tab: **"AI Prompt Log."**

Column	Example
Date checked	2026-10-27
Platform	Google AI Overview / AI Mode / ChatGPT / Perplexity / Gemini / Copilot
Prompt (exact)	"How much does compounded tirzepatide cost per month?"
Ongo mentioned?	Yes / No
Ongo linked/cited?	Yes / No
Sources cited	List domains
Accurate about Ongo?	Yes / No / N/A
Checked by	Your name

Rules for fair checks

Rule	Why
Use the **same prompts** every month	Comparable results
Use a **logged-out / clean** browser session where possible	Less personalization
Check from a **US** location setting if available	Ongo's market
Record **exact wording**	Small changes alter answers
10–20 core prompts	Enough to see trends, small enough to maintain

Useful Sheets formula: mention rate

```
=COUNTIFS(D:D,"Yes",B:B,"ChatGPT")/COUNTIF(B:B,"ChatGPT")
```

(Share of ChatGPT checks where Ongo was mentioned.)

36.5 What to do when AI says something wrong about Ongo

Situation	Action
Wrong price or service	Check our own pages are clear and current; update them
Confuses Ongo with another company	Strengthen entity consistency (Chapter 34)
Repeats a misleading claim from another site	Ask that site for a correction (Chapter 12)
Serious safety misinformation	Escalate to team lead and medical team

- *Expert judgment. AI systems don't offer guaranteed correction routes; fix the sources.*

36.6 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Use all three methods together	Rely on one screenshot
Report limitations honestly	Invent "AI traffic" numbers
Keep prompts identical month to month	Change prompts every time
Fix the sources AI reads	Try to "trick" AI answers

36.7 Pros and cons of AI tracking today

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
Shows trends over time	Incomplete data
GA4 channel is free	Referrers often missing
Prompt log is simple	Answers vary by user and time

36.8 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 36 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Reporting one lucky mention as success	Excitement	Monthly trends	Adding context to the report
AI channel below Referral in GA4	Not knowing order matters	Move it to the top	Reordering
Changing prompt wording	Trying to "help"	Fixed prompt list	Locking the list

36.9 Thumb rules

> 👍 Three methods, one honest story.
>
> 👍 Same prompts, every month.
>
> 👍 Fix the sources, not the AI.

36.10 Notes to remember

📝 GSC Generative AI report: impressions first; rolling out gradually.

📝 GA4 needs a custom AI channel group; order matters.

Chapter 36 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Channel group	GA4's grouping of traffic sources
Regex	A pattern for matching text
Referrer	Information about which site sent a visitor
Prompt log	A record of AI questions and answers checked over time
Mention rate	Share of checks where Ongo was mentioned

Chapter 36 Quiz

1. What did the GSC Generative AI report show at launch?

- A) Backlinks
- B) Impressions, without click data
- C) Clicks only
- D) Revenue

2. Why do some AI visits show as "Direct" in GA4?

- A) They're bots
- B) GA4 is broken
- C) AI apps often strip the referrer
- D) Google hides them deliberately

3. Where should the AI channel be placed in GA4's channel list?

- A) It can't be added
- B) Above Referral, near the top
- C) Anywhere
- D) At the bottom

4. What's the main rule for a prompt log?

- A) Use competitors' prompts

- B) Change prompts monthly
- C) Only check once
- D) Use the same prompts every month

5. AI says the wrong price for Ongo. First step?

- A) Buy ads
- B) Complain on social media
- C) Ignore it
- D) Make sure Ongo's own pages are clear and current

6. Which regex domain is for Perplexity?

- A) gemini.google.com
- B) copilot.microsoft.com
- C) chatgpt.com
- D) perplexity.ai

7. How many core prompts are recommended?

- A) 1
- B) 500
- C) 10–20
- D) 1,000

8. What should you report if the GSC AI report isn't available yet?

- A) Competitor data
- B) That it isn't available, honestly
- C) Made-up numbers
- D) Nothing ever

9. Serious safety misinformation about Ongo in AI answers should be...

- A) Fixed with fake posts
- B) Escalated to team lead and medical team
- C) Ignored
- D) Shared widely

10. In the wedding guest analogy, the guest who says "Sharma ji ne bataya" is like...

- A) A paid ad
- B) A referral visit
- C) A bot
- D) An AI mention that leaves no trackable card

Sources

1. SEO-Day, Google Search Console AI performance reports and controls (June 2026)
2. MO Agency, How to track AI traffic and referrals in Google Analytics 4
3. Google Search Central, Optimizing your website for generative AI features on Google Search (last updated July 10, 2026); Google Search Central Blog, Introducing Search Generative AI performance reports in Search Console (June 2026)

Answer key, Chapter 36: 1-B · 2-C · 3-B · 4-D · 5-D · 6-D · 7-C · 8-B · 9-B · 10-D

Chapter 37: Social Media and YouTube

Likes don't rank you. But social media still helps off-page SEO in ways freshers underestimate.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> In 2021, Google's John Mueller put it plainly: Google doesn't use **likes** as a ranking factor. [1] 🟡 Google spokesperson
>
> Yet Google's own starter guide lists **social media promotion** as a way to help new content get discovered faster. [2] 🟢 Both are true. This chapter explains how.

37.1 What social does and doesn't do

❌ Social media does NOT	✅ Social media DOES
Directly boost rankings through likes, followers or shares [1] 🟡	Help people discover content faster [2] 🟢
Pass much link value (most social links are nofollow) [1] 🟡	Put content in front of journalists and bloggers who might link to it 🔵
Replace backlinks	Strengthen entity consistency through official profiles (Chapter 34) 🔵
	Give AI features more genuine discussion to draw from [3] 🟢
	Send real referral traffic 🔵

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: shaadi ka WhatsApp group**
>
> Shaadi ka WhatsApp group mein "like" karne se rishta pakka nahi hota. Lekin group mein photo share hui, toh **door ke rishtedaar ne dekhi, unhone kisi ko bataya, woh shaadi mein aa gaya.**
>
> Social media seedha ranking nahi deta. **Logon tak pahunchata hai**, aur log links aur mentions dete hain.

37.2 The indirect path: social → links

How Social Helps Off-Page (Indirectly)



Likes don't rank. People who see the post might link.

1. Ongo publishes a linkable asset (Chapter 19).
2. It's shared on social channels.
3. A journalist, dietitian or blogger sees it.
4. They mention or link to it in their work.
5. That **editorial link** helps rankings and AI visibility.

37.3 YouTube: the special case

YouTube is owned by Google, and video results appear across Google Search.

Why YouTube matters for Ongo	Evidence
Google's AI features can include videos and draw on what's said in videos	🟢 [3]
Video is ideal for explaining processes (e.g. injection technique)	🔵
Video descriptions can link to Ongo's guides	🔵
Doctor videos build recognized expertise	🔵

YouTube checklist (with medical review)

☐	Task
☐	Official Ongo channel, same name/logo as everywhere else
☐	Doctor-led explainer videos with medical review
☐	Description links to the matching Ongo guide
☐	Clear disclaimers; no red-word claims
☐	Accurate captions/transcripts

☐	Task
☐	Channel listed in Organization `sameAs` (Chapter 34)

37.4 Social rules for a health brand

Rule	Why
Follow each platform's health and prescription-drug ad/content policies	Platforms restrict health promotion; Ongo's accounts must stay in good standing 🔵
No before/after claims without review and consent	FTC + platform rules (Chapter 12)
Disclose influencer partnerships	FTC endorsement rules [4] 🟠
No buying followers or views	Banned by the FTC rule on fake social indicators [5] 🟢
Reply without revealing patient information	Privacy

37.5 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Share every linkable asset on social	Expect likes to improve rankings
Build doctor-led YouTube content	Buy followers, likes or views
Keep profiles consistent	Use different brand names per platform
Disclose partnerships	Hide paid influencer posts

37.6 Pros and cons

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
Faster discovery of content	No direct ranking boost
Referral traffic	Health content faces platform restrictions
YouTube reaches searchers directly	Video production takes time

37.7 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 37 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
"Social signals" reports as ranking proof	Old myth	Google spokesperson statements	Reporting traffic and links instead
Buying followers	Wants to look big	FTC fake indicators rule	Stopping; cleaning up
Posting unreviewed health claims	Social feels casual	Same review workflow	Deleting and re-posting approved versions

37.8 Thumb rules

👍 Likes don't rank; people who see your post might link.

👍 YouTube is search too.

👍 Never buy followers.

37.9 Notes to remember

📝 Google has repeatedly said likes and social signals aren't direct ranking factors.

📝 Google lists social media promotion as a way to speed up discovery.

Chapter 37 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Social signals	Likes, shares, followers on social media
Discovery	People and search engines finding new content
Influencer	A social media creator with an audience
Fake indicators	Bought followers, likes or views
Transcript	Written text of a video's audio

Chapter 37 Quiz

1. Does Google use likes as a ranking factor?

- A) Only for health
- B) Yes
- C) Only on YouTube
- D) No, per Google's John Mueller

2. How does Google's starter guide describe social media?

- A) A ranking factor
- B) A spam signal
- C) Banned
- D) A way to promote content for faster discovery

3. What's the indirect path from social to rankings?

- A) Hashtags → PageRank
- B) Followers → DA
- C) Share → someone sees it → they link → link helps
- D) Likes → rankings

4. Why is YouTube special?

- A) It's owned by Google and videos appear in Search and AI features
- B) It sells links
- C) It's a directory
- D) It's banned

5. Buying followers is…

- A) Banned under the FTC's fake social indicators rule
- B) Required
- C) Smart marketing
- D) Free

6. Paid influencer posts must be…

- A) Hidden
- B) Anonymous
- C) Disclosed
- D) Deleted

7. Which belongs in a YouTube description?

- A) Competitor links
- B) Red-word claims
- C) Patient names

- D) A link to the matching Ongo guide

8. What should your report show instead of "social signals"?

- A) Nothing
- B) Traffic and links earned
- C) Likes as rankings
- D) Follower count only

9. Should Ongo's YouTube channel be in Organization sameAs?

- A) Only if it has 1M subscribers
- B) Yes
- C) No
- D) Only on Bing

10. In the WhatsApp group analogy, how does the distant relative end up at the wedding?

- A) By liking the photo
- B) By seeing the shared photo and telling someone
- C) By paying
- D) By accident

Sources

1. Search Engine Journal, Social signals and SEO (Google spokesperson statements, 2010–2021)
2. Google Search Central, SEO Starter Guide: promote your website (last updated December 10, 2025)
3. Google Search Central, Optimizing your website for generative AI features on Google Search (last updated July 10, 2026)
4. Venable, FTC finalizes updated Endorsement and Testimonial Guides (July 5, 2023)
5. Federal Trade Commission, Final rule banning fake reviews and testimonials (August 14, 2024)

Answer key, Chapter 37: 1-D · 2-D · 3-C · 4-A · 5-A · 6-C · 7-D · 8-B · 9-B · 10-B

LEVEL 3 · CHAPTER 38

Chapter 38: Auditing Your Backlinks

A monthly routine to catch lost links, changed links and risky links, and why you'll almost never need the disavow tool.

💡 **Trivia**

Google says that **in most cases it can assess which links to trust without additional guidance**, and calls the disavow tool an **advanced feature** that can **harm your site's performance** if used incorrectly. [1] 🟢 Google official

Freshers love the disavow tool because it feels like "doing something." Most of the time, the right action is to do nothing.

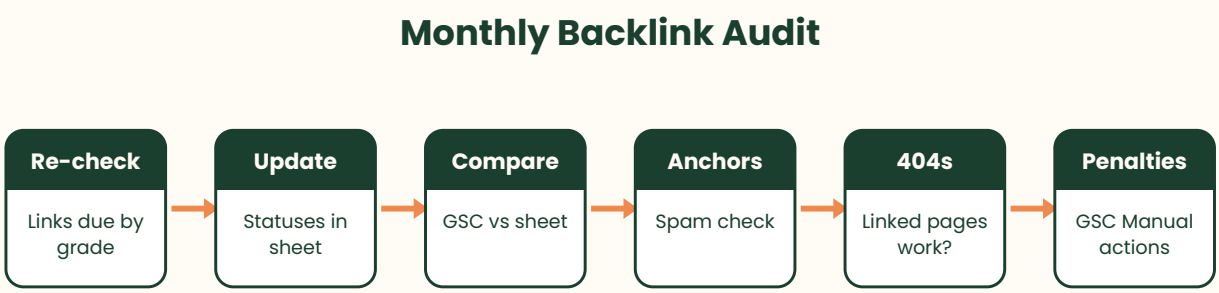
38.1 Two kinds of audit

Audit	Question	Frequency
Our-work audit	Are the links **we** built still live, correct and accurate?	Monthly (Platinum/Gold), quarterly (Silver), 6-monthly (Bronze/Iron)
Whole-profile audit	What does **everyone** linking to Ongo look like? Anything risky or unusual?	Monthly quick check; quarterly deep check

🪔 **Desi analogy: ghar ki safai**

Roz jhaadu (monthly quick check), hafte mein ek baar pocha (quarterly deep check), aur Diwali pe poori safai (yearly review). **Jo roz safai karta hai, use Diwali pe pareshani nahi hoti.**

38.2 The monthly audit routine (60–90 minutes)



Audit monthly. Disavow almost never.

Step	Task	Tool
1	Re-check links due this month (by grade)	Sheet + Chrome Inspect
2	Update statuses: Live / Live–changed / Removed	Sheet
3	Export GSC **Top linking sites**; compare with the sheet	GSC + Sheets
4	Investigate new, unknown linking domains	Eyeball test
5	Check GSC **Top linking text** for spammy anchors	GSC
6	Check Ongo pages with backlinks still work (no 404s)	GSC / AWT
7	Check **Manual actions** report	GSC
8	Summarize: gained, lost, changed, risks	Monthly report (Chapter 41)

Sheets: find domains in GSC but not in our sheet

```
=IF(COUNTIF(Sheet!$D:$D, A2)=0, "New / not ours", "Tracked")
```

(Column A = domains exported from GSC; Sheet column D = linking domains in our tracker.)

38.3 What makes a link "risky"?

Signal	Possible cause	Action
Spammy anchors (casino, pills, adult)	Spam or negative SEO	Note it; usually Google ignores it
Sudden spike of links from unrelated sites	Spam attack or scraper sites	Monitor; check Manual actions
Links from hacked pages	Compromised sites	Note it; usually ignore

Signal	Possible cause	Action
Links **we** built that look manipulative (paid, keyword anchors)	Past mistakes	Try to remove or get them labelled
A manual action for unnatural links	Google found a pattern	Clean up + disavow + reconsideration (Chapter 44)

38.4 Disavow: when (rarely) to use it

Google's guidance: use disavow only if you have **a lot of spammy, artificial or low-quality links** pointing to your site **and** they have caused, or are likely to cause, a **manual action**. [1] ●

Situation	Disavow?
Random spammy links you didn't build	**Usually no.** Google generally ignores them. [1] ●
A manual action for unnatural links	**Yes**, after trying to remove links [1] ●
Many paid/manipulative links **we** built in the past, with risk of a manual action	Consider, after removal attempts; team lead decides
"Toxic score" in a tool is high	Not by itself; tool scores aren't Google's view (Chapter 9)

If disavow is needed (team lead approves) [1] ●

1. **Try to remove** the links first (contact site owners).
2. Create a **.txt** file (UTF-8 or 7-bit ASCII), one URL or `domain:example.com` per line.
3. Lines starting with `#` are comments.
4. Upload in Search Console's disavow tool for the property. A new upload **replaces** the old list.
5. It can take **a few weeks** to take effect; disavowed links still appear in the Links report.

```
# Disavow file for ongoweightloss.com, updated 2026-10-27 by [name]
# Reason: paid links built in 2025; removal requests sent 2026-09, no response
domain:spammy-example-one.com
domain:spammy-example-two.net
https://some-site.example/specific-page.html
```

> ⚠️ **Where freshers go wrong: disavowing good links**
>
> - **The mistake:** Uploading a disavow file of every link with "low DA."
> - **Why it happens:** Tool "toxic" scores and fear.
> - **How to avoid it:** Never upload a disavow file without team lead approval.
> - **How to fix it:** Re-upload a corrected file (it replaces the old one) and tell your team lead.

38.5 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Re-check our links on schedule	Assume links stay live forever
Compare GSC with the sheet monthly	Ignore new unknown domains
Check the Manual actions report	Panic about random spam links
Treat disavow as a last resort	Disavow because a tool says "toxic"

38.6 Pros and cons of regular audits

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
Catch lost links early	Takes time monthly
Accurate reporting	Tools disagree on link counts
Spot problems before Google does	Can tempt over-reaction (disavow)

38.7 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 38 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Disavowing on tool scores	Fear	Google's guidance	Correcting the file
Never re-checking	"Done is done"	Grade-based schedule	Monthly audit
Not checking Manual actions	Forgetting	Audit step 7	Adding it to the routine

38.8 Thumb rules

👍 Audit monthly; disavow almost never.

👍 Random spam is noise; our own past mistakes are the real risk.

👍 No disavow upload without team lead approval.

38.9 Notes to remember

> 📝 Google: most sites don't need disavow; it can harm if misused.
>
> 📝 A new disavow upload replaces the old one.

Chapter 38 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Backlink audit	Reviewing links pointing to a site
Disavow	Asking Google to ignore specific links
Toxic score	A third-party tool's risk estimate (not Google's)
Manual action	A Google penalty after human review
Negative SEO	Someone building bad links to harm a site (Chapter 45)

Chapter 38 Quiz

1. What does Google say about disavow for most sites?

- A) Everyone must use it monthly
- B) In most cases Google can assess links without it
- C) It's required for health sites
- D) It boosts rankings

2. When is disavow appropriate?

- A) Never under any circumstances
- B) Whenever DA is low
- C) Many spammy links that caused or likely will cause a manual action, after removal attempts
- D) For every new link

3. What happens when you upload a new disavow file?

- A) Nothing
- B) It deletes the links from the web
- C) It replaces the old one
- D) It adds to the old one

4. How do you disavow a whole domain?

- A) `domain:example.com`

- B) `nofollow:example.com`
- C) `site:example.com`
- D) `block example.com`

5. A tool shows a high "toxic score." What do you do?

- A) Delete Ongo's site
- B) Buy more links
- C) Disavow immediately
- D) Investigate; tool scores aren't Google's view

6. Which GSC report should be checked monthly for penalties?

- A) Manual actions
- B) Sitemaps
- C) Removals
- D) Core Web Vitals

7. How often should Gold links be re-checked?

- A) Daily
- B) Never
- C) Yearly
- D) Monthly

8. Who approves a disavow upload?

- A) A competitor
- B) Any fresher
- C) The team lead
- D) The host site

9. Random spammy links you didn't build are usually...

- A) A guaranteed penalty
- B) Good for rankings
- C) Ignored by Google
- D) Required

10. In the cleaning analogy, what's the "roz jhaadu"?

- A) The monthly quick check
- B) A manual action
- C) Buying links
- D) The disavow file

Sources

1. Google Search Console Help, Disavow links to your site

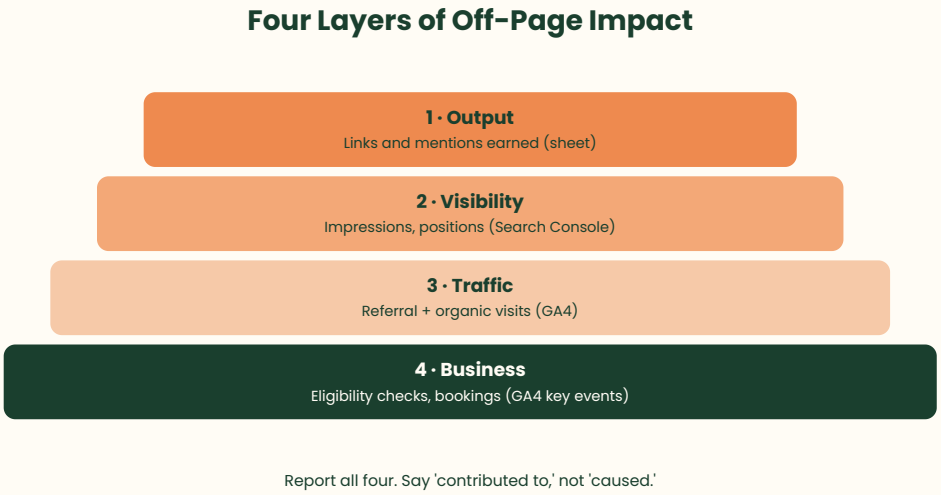
Answer key, Chapter 38: 1-B · 2-C · 3-C · 4-A · 5-D · 6-A · 7-D · 8-C · 9-C · 10-A

Chapter 39: Measuring Impact

Connecting off-page work to rankings, traffic and booked appointments, honestly.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> Google suggests waiting **a few weeks** to assess whether a change had beneficial effects in Search, and says not every change will produce noticeable impact. [1] ● Google official
>
> Off-page measurement is detective work: you rarely get a single smoking gun, but patterns tell the story.

39.1 The four layers of impact



Layer	Question	Tool
1. Output	Did we earn the links/mentions we planned?	Team sheet
2. Visibility	Did target pages gain impressions and better positions?	Search Console Performance
3. Traffic	Did referral and organic visits grow?	GA4 + GSC
4. Business	Did visits turn into eligibility checks and booked appointments?	GA4 conversions / key events

> 🍛 **Desi analogy: restaurant ka hisaab**
>
> 1. Kitne food bloggers ne review likha? (output)
> 2. Kitne logon ne naam suna? (visibility)
> 3. Kitne log aaye? (traffic)
> 4. Kitne logon ne khana order kiya? (business)
>
> **Sirf pehla number dikhaoge toh malik poochhega "toh paisa kitna aaya?"**

39.2 Layer 1: Output metrics

Metric	Sheets formula idea
Live links this month	`=COUNTIFS(Status,"Live",LiveDate,">="&EOMONTH(TODAY(),-1)+1)`
By grade	`=COUNTIFS(Grade,"Gold",Status,"Live")`
By owner	`=COUNTIFS(Owner,"Your Name",Status,"Live")`
Average final score	`=AVERAGEIFS(FinalScore,Status,"Live")`

39.3 Layer 2: Visibility (Search Console)

1. **Performance → Pages**: filter to the target page.
2. Compare **28 days before** vs **28 days after** a significant link went live (and again at 90 days).
3. Look at **impressions** and **average position** for relevant queries.
4. Note other changes in the same period (content updates, Google updates) before giving credit to links.

> 📝 **Note to remember:** One link rarely moves a page visibly by itself. Measure **clusters** of links to the same page or topic over months. 🔵

39.4 Layer 3: Traffic (GA4)

Report	What to look for
Traffic acquisition → Session source	Visits from each linking domain (referral)
Landing pages	Which Ongo pages referral visitors land on
AI channel (Chapter 36)	Visits from AI assistants
Organic Search for target pages	Growth after link clusters

39.5 Layer 4: Business outcomes

Ongo's GA4 should track key actions as events (e.g. **Get Started**, **Check Eligibility**, **Book Appointment**). Then:

- **Referral visits → key events:** which linking sites send visitors who take action?
- **Landing page → key events:** which pages that earned links also drive bookings?

🟧 **Ongo example**

Source	Referral visits (90 days)	Eligibility checks	Rate
Health publication (doctor quote)	420	21	5.0%
Dietitian blog (guide link)	180	11	6.1%
Generic directory	12	0	0%

Illustrative numbers. The dietitian blog has fewer visits but the best conversion rate. **That's a story your manager remembers.**

39.6 Honest attribution rules

Rule	Why
Never claim one link "caused" a ranking jump without evidence	Many factors change at once
Note Google updates in the same period	Check Google's Search Status Dashboard
Compare similar periods (e.g. month vs same month)	Seasonality
Report ranges and trends, not single days	Day-to-day noise
Say "contributed to" rather than "caused"	Honest and defensible

● *Expert judgment, consistent with Google's guidance on how long changes take. [1]*

39.7 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Report all four layers	Report only link counts
Wait weeks before judging	Judge after two days
Credit links cautiously	Claim certainty you don't have
Track key events from referral traffic	Ignore conversions

39.8 Pros and cons of four-layer measurement

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
Connects off-page to business value	Needs GA4 events set up correctly
Shows which tactics work best	Attribution is never perfect
Builds trust with managers	Takes time to analyse

39.9 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 39 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
"My link raised rankings 10 positions!"	Excitement	Checking other changes first	Rewording to "contributed to"
Only reporting link counts	Easiest number	Four-layer report	Adding GA4 data
Comparing different seasons	Not thinking	Like-for-like periods	Redoing the comparison

39.10 Thumb rules

👍 Output, visibility, traffic, business: report all four.

👍 Say "contributed to," not "caused."

👍 Measure clusters, not single links.

39.11 Notes to remember

📝 Google suggests waiting a few weeks before judging changes.

📝 Referral visits → key events show which links bring patients.

Chapter 39 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Attribution	Deciding what caused a result
Key event	An important action tracked in GA4 (e.g. booking)

Term	Simple meaning
Conversion rate	Actions ÷ visits
Seasonality	Regular ups and downs by time of year
Search Status Dashboard	Google's page listing ranking updates

Chapter 39 Quiz

1. What are the four layers of impact?

- A) DA, PA, DR, UR
- B) Output, visibility, traffic, business
- C) Links, likes, shares, follows
- D) Speed, size, colour, font

2. Which tool shows target page impressions and positions?

- A) Moz
- B) Search Console Performance
- C) Bing Ads
- D) Majestic

3. How long does Google suggest waiting to assess changes?

- A) A few weeks
- B) A few minutes
- C) Ten years
- D) Never

4. Which phrase is most honest in a report?

- A) "Google confirmed our link worked"
- B) "This link caused a 10-position jump"
- C) "This link contributed to"
- D) "Guaranteed results"

5. A source sends fewer visits but more eligibility checks. What does it show?

- A) Higher-quality traffic
- B) It's worse
- C) A penalty
- D) Nothing

6. What should you check before crediting links for a ranking change?

- A) Competitor logos

- B) Your horoscope
- C) Other changes in the same period, including Google updates
- D) Nothing

7. Which Sheets function counts live links by owner?

- A) TODAY
- B) COUNTIFS
- C) CONCAT
- D) LEN

8. Should you measure single links or clusters?

- A) Clusters of links over months
- B) Neither
- C) Only nofollow links
- D) Single links only

9. Where do you see visits from each linking domain?

- A) Moz Spam Score
- B) Robots.txt
- C) GA4 Traffic acquisition by session source
- D) Sitemaps

10. In the restaurant analogy, what does the owner care about most?

- A) The menu font
- B) The sign colour
- C) Number of reviews
- D) How much money came in

Sources

1. Google Search Central, SEO Starter Guide: how long until I see impact (last updated December 10, 2025)
2. Google Search Central, Using Search Console and Google Analytics data for SEO

Answer key, Chapter 39: 1-B · 2-B · 3-A · 4-C · 5-A · 6-C · 7-B · 8-A · 9-C · 10-D

LEVEL 3 · CHAPTER 40

Chapter 40: The Google Sheets System

One shared sheet, many teammates, zero confusion. Every column, every formula, every rule.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> Google Sheets' **Data validation** can turn any column into a dropdown, so nobody types "live," "Live," "LIVE" and "lve" for the same status. [1] ● Google official
>
> Most messy team sheets aren't messy because people are careless. They're messy because nobody set up dropdowns.

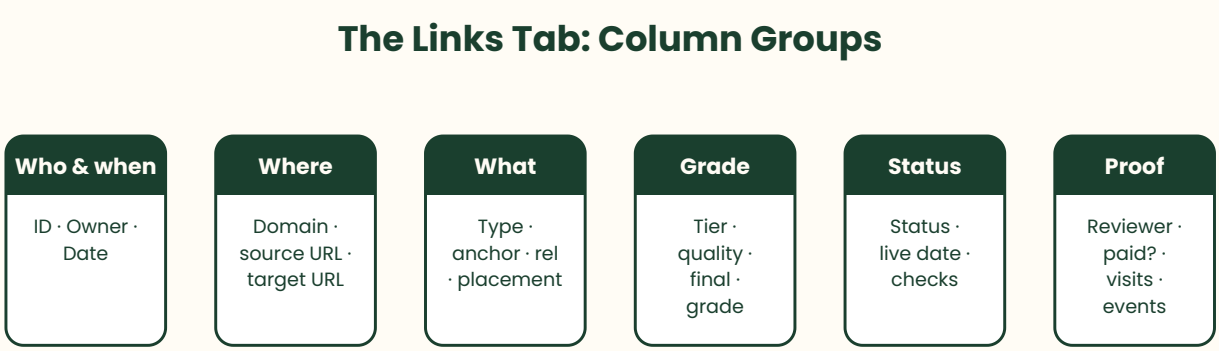
40.1 The sheet structure

Create one Google Sheet: **"Ongo Off-Page Tracker"** with these tabs:

Tab	Purpose
Links	Every link opportunity and link (main tab)
Prospects	Sites found but not yet vetted
Rejected	Sites that failed vetting, with reasons
Contacts	People, emails, opt-outs
AI Prompt Log	Monthly AI checks (Chapter 36)
Dashboard	Summary formulas and charts
Lists	Dropdown options (statuses, owners, tiers, types)

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: kirana dukaan ka register**
>
> Achhi kirana dukaan mein alag register hote hain: udhaar, stock, supplier. Sab ek hi register mein likho toh kuch nahi milta. **Alag tab, saaf hisaab.**

40.2 The "Links" tab: columns



Dropdowns for every category. Protected formula columns.

Col	Header	Type	Example
A	**ID**	Auto	L-0001
B	**Owner**	Dropdown (Lists!A:A)	Your name
C	**Date added**	Date	2026-10-27
D	**Linking domain**	Text	healthsite.com
E	**Source page URL**	URL	https://healthsite.com/glp-1-guide
F	**Target URL (Ongo)**	URL	https://ongoweightloss.com/...
G	**Link type**	Dropdown	Editorial / Guest / Resource / PR / Directory / Profile / Sponsored / Community / Podcast
H	**Anchor text**	Text	Ongo Weight Loss
I	**Anchor type**	Dropdown	Branded / URL / Descriptive / Generic / Exact
J	**rel**	Dropdown	Follow / Nofollow / Sponsored / UGC
K	**Placement**	Dropdown	Body / Bio / Resource list / Sidebar / Footer / Profile
L	**Relevance tier**	Dropdown	T1 / T2 / T3 / NR
M	**Quality score (0–100)**	Number	82
N	**Final score**	Formula	82
O	**Grade**	Formula	Gold
P	**Status**	Dropdown	Prospect ... Do not use (Chapter 32)

Col	Header	Type	Example
Q	**Live date**	Date	2026-11-03
R	**Last checked**	Date	2026-12-01
S	**Next check**	Formula	2027-01-01
T	**Medical reviewer**	Text	Dr. X
U	**Paid / gifted?**	Dropdown	No / Yes (sponsored)
V	**Referral visits (90d)**	Number	180
W	**Key events (90d)**	Number	11
X	**Notes**	Text	Editor: Priya; thanked 11/04
Y	**Duplicate check**	Formula	OK / DUPLICATE
Z	**Days since update**	Formula	12

40.3 The formulas

Final score (N2)

```
=IF(OR(M2="",L2=""),"",IF(L2="NR",0,ROUND(M2*IFS(L2="T1",1,L2="T2",0.85,L2="T3",0.7),0)))
```

Grade (O2)

```
=IF(N2="","",IFS(N2>=85,"Platinum",N2>=70,"Gold",N2>=55,"Silver",N2>=40,"Bronze",TRUE,"Iron"))
```

Next check date (S2), based on grade

```
=IF(OR(R2="",O2=""),"",R2+IFS(O2="Platinum",30,O2="Gold",30,O2="Silver",90,TRUE,180))
```

Duplicate domain check (Y2)

```
=IF(D2="","",IF(COUNTIF($D$2:$D,D2)>1,"DUPLICATE","OK"))
```

Days since last update (Z2)

```
=IF(R2="","",TODAY()-R2)
```

Overdue checks (Dashboard)

```
=COUNTIFS(Links!S:S,"<"&TODAY(),Links!P:P,"Live")
```

Extract the domain from a URL (helper, if needed)

```
=REGEXEXTRACT(E2,"^(?:https?://)?(?:www\.)?([^/]+)")
```

40.4 The Owner column: knowing who made which link

Rule	Why
Owner = dropdown of team names (from the Lists tab)	No spelling variations
Owner filled **before** outreach starts	Prevents two people pitching the same site
Never change another person's owner value	Use Notes to hand over
Optional: **protect** the Owner column so only editors can change it	Data → Protect sheets and ranges [2] 🟢

"My links only" view

Use **Data → Create a filter view**, filter Owner = your name, and save it. Each teammate gets their own view without changing what others see. [3] 🟢

Per-owner summary (Dashboard)

```
=QUERY(Links!A:Z,"select B, count(A), avg(N) where P = 'Live' group by B label count(A) 'Live links',
avg(N) 'Avg score'",1)
```

Per-owner grade counts

```
=COUNTIFS(Links!B:B,"Your Name",Links!O:O,"Platinum")
```

40.5 Making it foolproof

Feature	Where	Use
Dropdowns	Data → Data validation [1] 🟢	Status, Owner, Tier, rel, Type
Conditional formatting	Format → Conditional formatting [4] 🟢	Red if "DUPLICATE"; orange if overdue; green if Platinum
Protected ranges	Data → Protect sheets and ranges [2] 🟢	Formula columns (N, O, S, Y, Z)
Filter views	Data → Filter views [3] 🟢	Personal views without disturbing others

Feature	Where	Use
Freeze header row	View → Freeze → 1 row	Headers always visible

Conditional formatting rules (examples)

Range	Rule	Format
Y2:Y	Text is exactly "DUPLICATE"	Red fill
S2:S	Custom formula `=AND(S2<>"",S2<TODAY(),$P2="Live")`	Orange fill
O2:O	Text is exactly "Platinum"	Dark green fill, white text
U2:U	Text is exactly "Yes (sponsored)" AND J2 = "Follow" → custom `=AND($U2="Yes (sponsored)",$J2="Follow")`	Red fill (paid + followed = problem)

40.6 Team rules for the shared sheet

#	Rule
1	One row per link opportunity; never delete rows (use Status "Do not use")
2	Log the row **before** outreach
3	Only dropdown values; no free typing in dropdown columns
4	Update statuses the same day
5	Never edit formula columns
6	Medical reviewer name required for any health content
7	Any "Paid / gifted = Yes" must have rel = Sponsored or Nofollow
8	Weekly: check your rows for overdue checks

40.7 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Use dropdowns everywhere possible	Type statuses freely
Protect formula columns	Let anyone overwrite formulas
Use filter views for "my links"	Sort the shared sheet in ways that disturb others
Fill Owner before outreach	Leave Owner blank

40.8 Pros and cons of a shared Sheets system

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
Free, real-time, collaborative	Gets slow with very large data
Full transparency of who did what	Needs discipline to stay clean
Easy reporting with QUERY and COUNTIFS	Formulas can break if columns move

40.9 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 40 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Sorting the whole shared sheet	Wants own view	Filter views	Undo; use filter views
Typing over formulas	Doesn't notice	Protected ranges	Restoring from version history
Deleting rejected rows	Tidiness	"Do not use" status	Restoring from version history

40.10 Thumb rules

👍 Dropdowns stop arguments.

👍 Owner first, outreach second.

👍 Never delete; change the status.

40.11 Notes to remember

📝 Final score: `=ROUND(M2*IFS(L2="T1",1,L2="T2",0.85,L2="T3",0.7),0)`.

📝 Filter views let everyone see "my links" without disturbing the team.

Chapter 40 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Data validation	Rules that limit what can be typed in a cell (e.g. dropdowns)
Conditional formatting	Automatic colours based on cell values

Term	Simple meaning
Protected range	Cells only certain people can edit
Filter view	A personal filtered view of a shared sheet
QUERY	A Sheets function that summarizes data like a database
COUNTIFS	Counts rows matching several conditions

Chapter 40 Quiz

1. How do you stop teammates typing different versions of "Live"?

- A) Ask nicely
- B) Use bold text
- C) Data validation dropdowns
- D) Delete the column

2. When should the Owner column be filled?

- A) Never
- B) After the link is live
- C) At year-end
- D) Before outreach starts

3. Which feature gives each teammate their own filtered view without disturbing others?

- A) Hiding columns
- B) Filter views
- C) Deleting rows
- D) Sorting the sheet

4. What does the duplicate check formula look for?

- A) Spelling mistakes
- B) The same linking domain appearing more than once
- C) Broken links
- D) Anchors

5. What should you do with a rejected site's row?

- A) Move it to the bottom
- B) Delete it
- C) Hide it
- D) Set status to "Do not use"

6. Which function summarizes live links per owner?

- A) LEN
- B) TRIM
- C) QUERY
- D) NOW

7. How do you prevent formula columns from being overwritten?

- A) Comments
- B) Protected ranges
- C) Nothing works
- D) Bigger font

8. A row shows "Paid / gifted = Yes" and rel = Follow. What does it mean?

- A) A Platinum link
- B) Perfect link
- C) Nothing
- D) A problem: paid links must be sponsored or nofollow

9. Next check for a Silver link is how many days after the last check?

- A) 365
- B) 90
- C) 30
- D) 180

10. In the kirana analogy, why use separate registers?

- A) To confuse customers
- B) Tradition only
- C) To use more paper
- D) So everything stays organized and easy to find

Sources

1. Google Docs Editors Help, Create an in-cell dropdown list
2. Google Docs Editors Help, Protect, hide and edit sheets
3. Google Docs Editors Help, Sort & filter your data (filter views)
4. Google Docs Editors Help, Use conditional formatting rules in Google Sheets

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Answer key, Chapter 40: 1-C · 2-D · 3-B · 4-B · 5-D · 6-C · 7-B · 8-D · 9-B · 10-D

LEVEL 3 · CHAPTER 41

Chapter 41: Your Best Link: Choosing It and Presenting It to Your Manager

Your manager walks over and asks, "What's your best link this month?" You'll have the answer in 60 seconds.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> Google itself warns to be wary of third-party tools that claim to use **"internal" Google metrics**, because **no third-party tool has access to Google's internal ranking or AI systems**. [1] ● Google official
>
> So "it's DR 80" is never, by itself, a reason a link is your best. Your manager deserves a better answer, and the grading system gives you one.

41.1 How to choose your best link

Use the sheet. Your best link is usually the one with:

1. The **highest Final Link Score** (Chapter 15), and among ties,
2. The best **business evidence** (referral visits, key events), and
3. The cleanest **story** (earned, relevant, reviewed, safe).

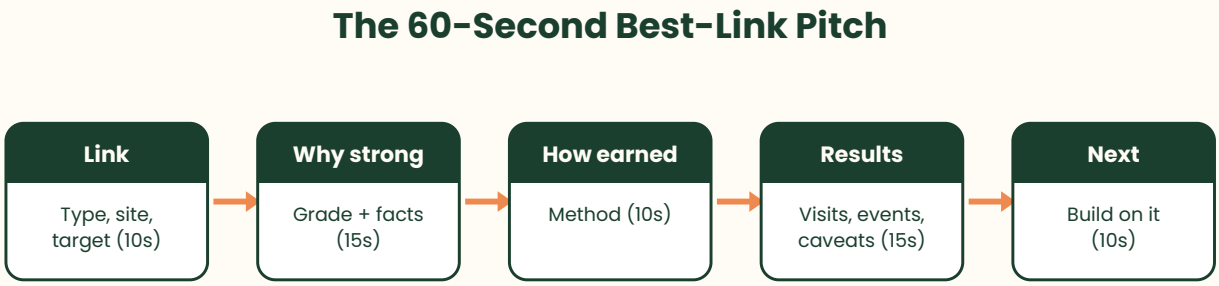
Sheets: find your top link this month

```
=SORTN(FILTER(Links!A2:Z, Links!B2:B="Your Name", Links!P2:P="Live", Links!Q2:Q>=EOMONTH(TODAY(),-1)+1),
1, 0, 14, FALSE)
```

(Filters your live links from this month and returns the one with the highest Final score, column N = 14th column.)

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: cricket ka "man of the match"**
>
> Man of the match sirf sabse zyada runs se nahi chuna jaata. **Kab bane, kiske khilaaf, team ko kitna fayda hua**, sab dekha jaata hai. 30 run pressure mein, final over mein, kabhi kabhi 80 run se zyada keemti hote hain.
>
> Best link bhi aise hi chuno: score + business impact + kahani.

41.2 The 60-second pitch format



Best score + best evidence + best story.

Part	Time	What to say
1. The link	10 sec	"My best link this month is a [type] from [site] to our [target page]."
2. Why it's strong	15 sec	Grade + relevance + one or two facts (traffic, editorial, placement)
3. How I earned it	10 sec	The method, in one sentence (PR response, resource pitch, etc.)
4. What it's done so far	15 sec	Referral visits, key events, or early visibility signals, with honest caveats
5. What's next	10 sec	How you'll build on it (relationship, similar sites, repeat tactic)

Example pitch

> "My best link this month is a **doctor quote in a health publication**, linking to Dr. [Name]'s profile on Ongo.
>
> It's **Platinum, Tier 1**: the site gets around [X] organic visits a month, the link is in the article body, followed, and our quote went through medical review.
>
> I earned it by responding to a **journalist request** within two hours.
>
> In three weeks it's sent **[N] referral visits** and **[n] eligibility checks**. It's too early to see ranking impact, and I'll report that at 90 days.
>
> Next, I'm pitching the same journalist our new cost guide, and responding to two similar requests this week."

41.3 The one-slide / one-row summary

When asked in writing, use this format:

Field	Example
Link	[Source page URL] → [Ongo target URL]

Field	Example
Grade	Platinum (Final score 92) · Tier 1
Type / placement / rel	Digital PR · body · follow
Why it matters	Real health audience; doctor expertise; editorial
Method	Journalist request response, medically reviewed
Results so far	3 weeks: [N] referral visits, [n] key events
Caveats	Ranking effect not yet measurable
Next step	Follow-up pitch to same editor
Owner	Your name

41.4 What NOT to say

❌ Avoid	✅ Say instead
"Google gave it DA 80"	"Ahrefs DR 80; more importantly, real health traffic"
"This will get us to #1"	"This strengthens [page]; we'll measure at 90 days"
"It's dofollow so it's the best"	"It's editorial, relevant and in-content"
"I got 50 links this month"	"I got 6 links; 2 Gold, 1 Platinum"
Hiding a paid element	"It's a sponsored link, labelled correctly; value is brand reach"

41.5 Monthly report template (one page)

Section	Contents
Headline	One sentence: the month's biggest win
Output	Live links by grade (Platinum/Gold/Silver/Bronze/Iron)
Best link	The 60-second pitch, written
Traffic	Referral visits and key events from new links
AI visibility	Prompt log mention rate; GSC AI impressions if available
Risks	Lost links, changed links, any red flags
Next month	Top 3 priorities

41.6 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Lead with grade and business evidence	Lead with DA alone
Be honest about what's not measurable yet	Overclaim ranking impact
Have the pitch ready before you're asked	Scroll through the sheet while your manager waits
Mention who helped (medical reviewer, teammate)	Take all the credit

41.7 Pros and cons of a pitch format

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
You look prepared and credible	Needs the sheet up to date
Managers remember stories with numbers	Early results are often small
Shows which tactics work	Requires honest caveats

41.8 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 41 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Choosing the highest-DR link as "best"	DR worship	Final Link Score + business evidence	Re-choosing with the formula
Overclaiming rankings	Wants credit	Honest caveats	Correcting in the next report
Not knowing their best link	Sheet not updated	Weekly updates	Updating today

41.9 Thumb rules

👍 Best link = best score + best evidence + best story.

👍 Sixty seconds, five parts.

👍 Honest caveats make you more credible, not less.

41.10 Notes to remember

> 📝 Pitch: link, why strong, how earned, results so far, what's next.
>
> 📝 Name the tool for every metric; never call it Google's.

Chapter 41 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Pitch	A short, structured explanation
Caveat	An honest limit on a claim
Key event	An important tracked action in GA4
SORTN / FILTER	Sheets functions to pick top rows by conditions

Chapter 41 Quiz

1. What usually makes a link your "best"?

- A) The newest link
- B) Highest DA only
- C) Highest Final Link Score, best business evidence and a clean story
- D) The longest anchor

2. How long should the best-link pitch take?

- A) 5 seconds
- B) 1 hour
- C) 10 minutes
- D) About 60 seconds

3. Which is the first part of the pitch?

- A) Competitor news
- B) The link: type, site and target
- C) What's next
- D) Your salary

4. What should you say instead of "Google gave it DA 80"?

- A) "Ahrefs DR 80; more importantly, real health traffic"
- B) Nothing

- C) "Google loves us"
- D) "PageRank 8"

5. Ranking impact isn't measurable yet. What do you say?

- A) Skip the meeting
- B) "It got us to #1"
- C) "Too early; I'll report at 90 days"
- D) Make up a number

6. Which Sheets functions find your top link this month?

- A) CONCAT
- B) SORTN and FILTER
- C) NOW and TODAY only
- D) LEN and TRIM

7. "I got 50 links this month" vs "6 links: 2 Gold, 1 Platinum." Which is better reporting?

- A) Both identical
- B) 50 links
- C) The graded version
- D) Neither

8. What does Google say about tools claiming internal Google metrics?

- A) Trust them fully
- B) Only Moz has access
- C) Be wary; no third-party tool has access to Google's internal systems
- D) Google sells metrics

9. In the cricket analogy, why can 30 runs beat 80?

- A) The umpire decides randomly
- B) 30 is bigger
- C) Context and impact matter, not just the number
- D) It can't

10. A sponsored link is your best link. How do you present it?

- A) Hide that it's sponsored
- B) State it's correctly labelled sponsored and explain its brand value
- C) Call it editorial
- D) Don't mention it

Sources

1. Google Search Central, Optimizing your website for generative AI features on Google Search (last updated July 10, 2026)

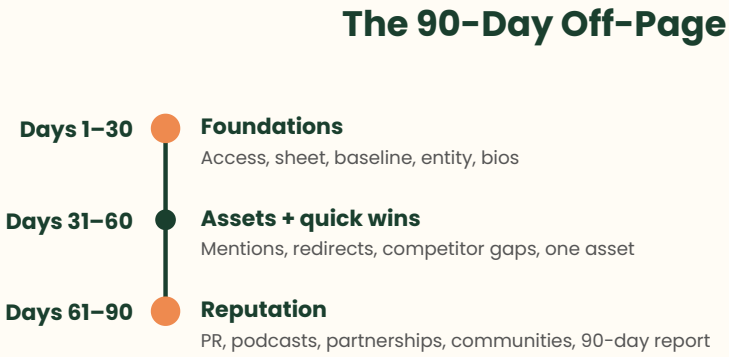
Answer key, Chapter 41: 1-C · 2-D · 3-B · 4-A · 5-C · 6-B · 7-C · 8-C · 9-C · 10-B

Chapter 42: Off-Page Priorities: A 90-Day Plan

What to do first, second and third, so a new teammate (or a new site) builds trust in the right order.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> Google's starter guide says word of mouth is effective and lasting, but also that it **takes time** and usually needs effort in other practices first, like **community engagement**. [1] ● Google official
>
> Order matters. Foundations first, reputation later.

42.1 The principle: foundations → assets → reputation



Target: 5–15 good links, zero risky links.

Phase	Days	Theme
Phase 1	1–30	**Foundations**: tracking, profiles, entity, audit, safety
Phase 2	31–60	**Assets and quick wins**: linkable assets, unlinked mentions, resource pages, competitor gaps
Phase 3	61–90	**Reputation**: digital PR, podcasts, partnerships, communities, measurement

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: ghar banana**
>
> Pehle neev (foundation), phir deewarein (assets), phir sajaavat aur mehmaan (reputation). **Neev ke bina sajaavat kis kaam ki?**

42.2 Phase 1: Days 1–30 (Foundations)

Week	Tasks	Chapter
Week 1	Read Book One + Level 1 of this book; pass MCQs (8/10+)	1–11
	Get access: GSC, Bing WMT, Ahrefs Webmaster Tools, GA4, the team sheet	10, 40
Week 2	Set up the sheet: dropdowns, formulas, owner column, filter view	40
	Export GSC top linking sites; record existing links	38
Week 3	Entity check: official profiles consistent; Organization markup request to dev	34
	Approved description and bio bank confirmed with medical/legal	29
Week 4	Baseline report: current links by grade, anchor mix, referral traffic, AI prompt log	14, 36, 39
	GA4 AI channel group set up	36

Phase 1 output: a clean sheet, a baseline report, consistent profiles. **Zero risky links.**

42.3 Phase 2: Days 31–60 (Assets and quick wins)

Week	Tasks	Chapter
Week 5	Unlinked mention search; outreach for accurate mentions	23
	Check Ongo pages with backlinks for 404s; send redirect list	23
Week 6	Competitor link gap analysis (3–5 competitors)	18
	Grade gap domains; shortlist Gold/Platinum potential	15
Week 7	Choose one linkable asset with the team (e.g. cost guide, checklist)	19
	Resource page + broken link prospecting for existing guides	22
Week 8	Outreach: 10–15 personalized emails/week	30
	Healthcare and telehealth directory listings (vetted, real details)	13, 33

Phase 2 output: first earned links, a prospect list, one asset in production.

42.4 Phase 3: Days 61–90 (Reputation)

Week	Tasks	Chapter
Week 9	Join journalist request platforms; set filters; build reviewed quote bank with doctors	20
Week 10	Podcast prospecting and pitches for doctors	27
	Promote the linkable asset (PR, communities, outreach)	19, 25
Week 11	Partnership conversations (dietitians, community health)	26
	Community participation with disclosure (2–3 helpful answers/week)	25
Week 12	90-day report: four layers of impact; best link pitch; next quarter plan	39, 41
	First full monthly audit	38

42.5 Weekly time budget (one full-time teammate)

Activity	Hours/week
Research and prospecting	8
Vetting and grading	6
Outreach and PR responses	10
Content coordination and review	6
Tracking, audits and reporting	5
Learning (this book, Google updates)	3
Buffer	2
Total	**40**

● *Expert judgment; adjust to team size.*

42.6 Realistic 90-day targets

Metric	Realistic range (● estimate)
Earned links (Silver or better)	5–15
Platinum links	0–2
Unlinked mentions converted	30–50% of those found

Metric	Realistic range (🔵 estimate)
Outreach reply rate	5–20%
Risky links built	**0**

> 📝 **Note to remember:** A 90-day plan that produces **10 good links and zero risks** beats one that produces 200 links and a manual action. 🔵

42.7 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Build foundations before outreach	Start blasting emails on day 1
Set realistic targets	Promise 100 links a month
Review progress every 30 days	Wait 90 days to look at data
Keep risky links at zero	Trade safety for volume

42.8 Pros and cons of a phased plan

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
Clear priorities	First month shows few links
Safe from day 1	Needs manager patience
Results compound	Requires discipline

42.9 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 42 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Skipping Phase 1	Wants to look productive	Showing the baseline report as output	Pausing outreach to set up tracking
Unrealistic targets	Pressure	Using the target table	Re-setting expectations with the manager
No 30-day reviews	Busy	Calendar reminders	Scheduling them now

42.10 Thumb rules

👍 Neev pehle, sajaavat baad mein.

👍 Ten safe, strong links beat two hundred weak ones.

👍 Review every 30 days.

42.11 Notes to remember

📝 Phase 1 foundations · Phase 2 assets and quick wins · Phase 3 reputation.

📝 Risky links target: zero.

Chapter 42 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Baseline	Your starting measurements, before new work
Quick win	A low-effort, high-success task
Quote bank	Pre-approved expert statements
Phase	A stage of the plan with a theme

Chapter 42 Quiz

1. What's the theme of Phase 1?

- A) Foundations
- B) Buying links
- C) Podcasts
- D) Digital PR

2. Which task belongs in Week 1?

- A) Upload a disavow file
- B) Read Book One + Level 1 and pass MCQs
- C) Pitch podcasts
- D) Build PBNs

3. When do unlinked mention outreach and redirect checks happen?

- A) Never

- B) Phase 2
- C) Phase 3
- D) Phase 1

4. What's the risky links target?

- A) 0
- B) 50
- C) Unlimited
- D) 10

5. Which is a realistic number of Platinum links in 90 days?

- A) 200
- B) 1,000
- C) 50
- D) 0–2

6. When should progress be reviewed?

- A) Only at 90 days
- B) Every 30 days
- C) Never
- D) Yearly

7. What does Google's starter guide say word of mouth needs?

- A) Paid links
- B) Money
- C) Time and effort in other practices first, like community engagement
- D) Nothing

8. Which is the main Phase 3 theme?

- A) Reputation
- B) Deleting links
- C) Account setup
- D) Spreadsheet design

9. How many outreach emails per week does the plan suggest in Week 8?

- A) 10–15 personalized emails
- B) 500
- C) 1,000 templates
- D) None

10. In the house analogy, what comes first?

- A) Guests
- B) Paint

- C) The foundation
- D) Decoration

Sources

1. Google Search Central, SEO Starter Guide: promote your website (last updated December 10, 2025)

Answer key, Chapter 42: 1-A · 2-B · 3-B · 4-A · 5-D · 6-B · 7-C · 8-A · 9-A · 10-C

04

LEVEL 4

Expert and Risk

Recognize danger before it costs you, and never make an irreversible mistake.

43 · White-Hat, Gray-Hat and Black-Hat

44 · Manual Actions and Recovery

45 · Negative SEO: Defending Ongo

46 · Reading Google Updates

47 · Myths That Waste Years

48 · The ZETA Model: Zero-Error Tolerance Approach

Chapter 43: White-Hat, Gray-Hat and Black-Hat

Know every trick in the book, so you can recognize it, refuse it, and explain why.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> Google's site reputation policy uses a **medical site hosting a low-quality casino page** as one of its own examples of abuse, and its expired domain abuse policy uses **commercial medical products on a former nonprofit medical charity's site**. [1] 🟢 Google official
>
> Health is already in Google's examples. A health brand has no room for "clever" tactics.

43.0 A note on this chapter

This chapter explains how manipulative tactics work **so you can recognize and refuse them**. It deliberately doesn't give step-by-step instructions for building them.

43.1 The three hats

Hat	Meaning	Ongo policy
⚪ **White-hat**	Within Google's guidelines: earn links with value, label paid links	✅ The only approach
🔘 **Gray-hat**	Technically disguised manipulation; often violates policies when you read them carefully	❌ Not used
⚫ **Black-hat**	Clear violations: link schemes, deception, automation	❌ Never

The Hat Spectrum

White hat	Gray hat	Black hat
Earned, disclosed, reviewed	Bends rules; risky over time	Breaks spam policies

Ongo stays white hat. Recognize gray and black; never build them.

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: exam ki taiyaari**
>
> - **White-hat:** padhai karo, notes banao, practice karo.
> - **Gray-hat:** "bhai, sirf important questions ratt lo, guess paper se." Kabhi chal jaata hai, kabhi poora paper alag aata hai.
> - **Black-hat:** cheating, chit, paper leak. Pakde gaye toh exam cancel, record kharab.
>
> **Ongo ka rule: sirf padhai.**

43.2 Black-hat tactics (recognize and refuse)

Tactic	What it is	Why it fails	Policy
PBN (private blog network)	A network of sites, often expired domains, controlled by one party to link to clients	Footprints get detected; links neutralized; manual actions possible	Link spam 🟢 [1]; expired domain abuse 🟢 [1]
Link farms	Sites existing to sell or swap links	No real audience; easy pattern	Link spam 🟢 [1]
Automated link building	Software creating links at scale (comments, profiles, forums)	Spam patterns	Link spam 🟢 [1]
Hacked links	Links inserted into compromised sites	Illegal and spam	Spam policies 🟢 [1]
Hidden links	Links hidden in text, widgets or code	Deception	Link spam / hidden links 🟢 [1]
Parasite SEO (site reputation abuse)	Renting a section of a strong site to rank low-value content	Manual actions on host; demotion	Site reputation policy 🟢 [1]
Expired domain abuse	Buying an old domain's reputation for unrelated content or redirects	Policy violation	🟢 [1]
Negative SEO	Building spam links to a competitor	Unethical; Google largely ignores random spam links [2] 🟡	—

Tactic	What it is	Why it fails	Policy
Fake reviews / fake mentions	Planted praise	FTC rule + Google policies	🟢 [3][4]

43.3 Gray-hat tactics (look innocent, aren't)

Tactic	Disguise	Reality
Paid guest posts with followed links	"Editorial fee"	Paid link = link spam unless labelled 🟢 [1]
Niche edits / link insertions	"Adding a relevant link to an aged article"	Usually paid link insertion
Link exchanges "between partners"	"We help each other"	Excessive exchanges are link spam 🟢 [1]
Three-way link swaps	"A links to C, B links to you"	Still a link scheme 🔵
Sponsored posts without labels	"It looks more natural"	Must be sponsored/nofollow 🟢 [1]
Scholarship link schemes	"Supporting students"	Widely abused pattern 🔵
Exact-match anchors in bios/press releases	"It's our bio"	Optimized anchors listed as link spam 🟢 [1]
"AI visibility" mention services	"Get recommended by ChatGPT"	Inauthentic mentions 🟢 [5]

> 📝 **Note to remember:** Gray-hat sellers often say "Google can't detect this." Google's link spam updates neutralize such links, and **the ranking benefit can't be regained**. [6] 🟢 Even "undetectable" isn't safe; it's just delayed.

43.4 Why they "work" (for a while)

Why it seems to work	The catch
Rankings jump quickly	Gains can disappear in one update
Competitors use it	You don't see their penalties or losses
Sellers show screenshots	Survivors show results; failures go silent
It's cheap	Recovery is expensive, sometimes impossible

🟧 **Ongo example**

A competitor jumps to page 1 using a coupon section on a big news site. Two months later, a site reputation manual action removes that section from results. The competitor loses the traffic and the money spent. Meanwhile, Ongo's earned links from health publications keep working.

43.5 What white-hat honestly can't do

Being honest about limits builds trust with your manager.

White-hat can't…	What to say instead
Guarantee rankings	"We'll improve trust signals and measure monthly."
Be fast	"Expect clear trends in 3–6 months."
Beat a much bigger brand's 10-year reputation in 90 days	"We'll win specific topics where we're genuinely better."
Control what editors do	"We'll earn opportunities; editors decide."
Promise AI citations	"We'll be a trusted source; AI decides what to cite."

43.6 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Learn to recognize every tactic	Try any gray or black tactic "just to test"
Report offers to your team lead	Accept "undetectable" promises
Explain white-hat limits honestly	Promise speed or guarantees
Document how every link was earned	Hide how a link happened

43.7 Pros and cons

	White-hat	Gray/Black-hat
✅ Pros	Durable, safe, builds brand	Fast (sometimes)
❌ Cons	Slower, needs creativity	Penalties, lost money, lost benefit that can't be regained, reputational damage

43.8 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 43 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
"Just one niche edit"	Pressure	Remembering it's a paid link	Telling team lead; logging it
Believing "Google can't detect it"	Seller pitch	The can't-be-regained rule	Declining
Copying a competitor's gray tactic	Envy	Chapter 18's "copy opportunities, not tactics"	Stopping

43.9 Thumb rules

👍 Learn black-hat to recognize it, never to use it.

👍 "Undetectable" means "not detected yet."

👍 Honest limits beat dishonest promises.

43.10 Notes to remember

📝 Google's own examples include health sites abusing reputation and expired medical charity domains.

📝 Gray-hat is usually black-hat with better marketing.

Chapter 43 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
White-hat	Within search engine guidelines
Gray-hat	Disguised manipulation
Black-hat	Clear guideline violations
PBN	Private blog network
Niche edit	Inserting a link into an existing article, usually paid
Parasite SEO	Ranking content on someone else's strong site
Footprint	A shared pattern revealing a scheme

Chapter 43 Quiz

1. Which hat does Ongo use?

- A) Whichever works
- B) Gray
- C) White only
- D) Black

2. A "niche edit on an aged article" is usually...

- A) A paid link insertion
- B) A podcast
- C) A free editorial link
- D) A press release

3. Parasite SEO falls under which Google policy?

- A) Site reputation policy
- B) Core Web Vitals
- C) Image policy
- D) Sitemaps

4. A seller says "Google can't detect this." What's true?

- A) It's safe forever
- B) Link spam benefits can be neutralized and can't be regained
- C) Google approves it
- D) Only Bing detects it

5. Which can white-hat NOT do?

- A) Earn editorial links
- B) Build trust
- C) Bring referral traffic
- D) Guarantee rankings

6. Excessive link exchanges "between partners" are...

- A) White-hat
- B) Digital PR
- C) Link spam
- D) Required

7. Why do black-hat tactics seem to work?

- A) They're slow
- B) Survivors show results; failures go silent

- C) They're legal
- D) Google rewards them

8. Which policy covers buying an old medical charity domain for commercial products?

- A) Image metadata
- B) Organization markup
- C) Page experience
- D) Expired domain abuse

9. What should you do if offered a gray-hat tactic?

- A) Test it once
- B) Use it on a competitor
- C) Report it to your team lead and decline
- D) Keep it secret

10. In the exam analogy, gray-hat is like...

- A) Cramming only "important questions" from a guess paper
- B) Paper leak
- C) Studying properly
- D) Skipping the exam

Sources

1. Google Search Central, Spam policies for Google web search (last updated August 28, 2026)
2. Search Engine Roundtable, Google: ignore link spam (April 2024)
3. Federal Trade Commission, Final rule banning fake reviews and testimonials (August 14, 2024)
4. Google Maps User Contributed Content Policy, Prohibited & restricted content
5. Google Search Central, Optimizing your website for generative AI features on Google Search (last updated July 10, 2026)
6. Google Search Central, Spam updates (last updated December 10, 2025)

Answer key, Chapter 43: 1-C · 2-A · 3-A · 4-B · 5-D · 6-C · 7-B · 8-D · 9-C · 10-A

LEVEL 4 · CHAPTER 44

Chapter 44: Manual Actions and Recovery

What a Google penalty looks like, and the exact steps Google says to take.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> When you request a review of a manual action, Google says most reviews take **several days or weeks**, and **link-related requests can take longer**. Google also says **don't resubmit** while a request is pending. [1] 🟢 Google official
>
> A manual action isn't fixed in an afternoon. Prevention (Chapter 31) is cheaper than cure.

44.1 What is a manual action?

A **manual action** is a penalty applied after a **human reviewer at Google** decides a site violates spam policies. It appears in Search Console's **Manual actions** report, and affected pages or the whole site can rank lower or disappear. [1][2] 🟢

Manual action (link-related)	Meaning [1] 🟢
Unnatural links to your site	A pattern of artificial or manipulative links **pointing to** your site
Unnatural links from your site	Your site has paid or manipulative **outbound** links

> 🍛 **Desi analogy: traffic challan**
>
> Camera ne automatically pakda (algorithm) ya traffic police ne roka (manual action), **challan dono mein lagta hai.** Manual action woh challan hai jo ek insaan ne dekh ke likha, aur notice seedha tumhare ghar aata hai (Search Console).

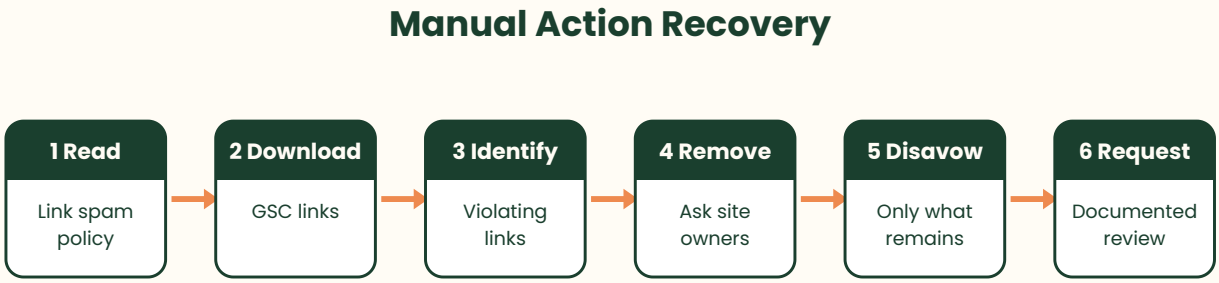
44.2 How to check

1. Open **Search Console → Security & Manual actions → Manual actions**.
2. "No issues detected" = no manual action.
3. If there's an action, it shows the type, affected pages (some or all) and examples.

Make this part of the monthly audit (Chapter 38).

44.3 Recovery steps for "unnatural links to your site"

Google's recommended steps: [1] ●



Remove first, disavow second, document everything.

Step	Action
1	**Read** Google's link spam policy
2	**Download** links from Search Console (top linking sites / latest links)
3	**Identify** violating links: start with the most prolific linking sites and recently created links
4	**Ask site owners** to remove the links or make them nofollow
5	**Disavow** only links you couldn't get removed; use `domain:` for whole domains; **don't disavow organic links**
6	**Request review**, with documentation of removed links and an explanation of those you couldn't remove

> 📝 **Note to remember:** Google says disavowing everything without trying to remove links may lead to rejection. A **good-faith removal effort** comes first. [1] ●

What a good reconsideration request includes [1] ●

Part	Example
The exact issue	"Between 2024 and 2025, a previous vendor bought followed links on 37 domains."
What you did	"We contacted all 37 site owners twice; 21 removed or nofollowed links; we disavowed the remaining 16 domains."
Documentation	A shared spreadsheet of each domain, dates contacted, outcome
Prevention	"We've adopted a written link policy and pre-creation checklist."

44.4 Recovery steps for "unnatural links from your site"

Step	Action [1] 🟢
1	Identify paid or violating outbound links on Ongo's site
2	Remove them, or add `nofollow` / `sponsored`
3	Request review with examples of what you removed

44.5 After a manual action is lifted

Expectation	Reality
"Rankings return to before"	Not necessarily. Links that were helping (even bad ones) no longer help; rankings reflect the remaining, legitimate signals. 🔵
"We're safe now"	Only if the practices that caused it have stopped
"We can start again quietly"	Repeat violations are treated seriously 🔵

44.6 Algorithmic drops vs manual actions

	Manual action	Algorithmic change (update)
Notice in Search Console	**Yes**	No
Caused by	Human review	Automated systems
Fix	Clean up + request review	Improve; wait for systems to re-assess
Link spam update losses	—	Benefit from neutralized links **can't be regained** [3] 🟢

44.7 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Check Manual actions monthly	Ignore Search Console notifications
Try to remove links before disavowing	Disavow everything at once
Document every step	Send vague requests
Fix all affected pages	Fix half and request review

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Wait for a response	Resubmit while pending

44.8 Pros and cons of the reconsideration process

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
A clear path back from manual actions	Slow (days to weeks or longer)
Google explains what's wrong	Lost link benefit doesn't return
Forces good documentation	Lots of manual work

44.9 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 44 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Panicking at any ranking drop	Assuming penalty	Checking the Manual actions report first	Diagnosing with Chapter 46
Disavowing organic links	Fear	Google's guidance	Re-uploading a corrected file
Thin reconsideration request	Rushing	The 4-part structure	Waiting for the result; preparing better documentation

44.10 Thumb rules

> 👍 No notice in Search Console = no manual action.
>
> 👍 Remove first, disavow second, document everything.
>
> 👍 Never resubmit while pending.

44.11 Notes to remember

> 📝 Two link-related manual actions: unnatural links to your site, and from your site.
>
> 📝 A good request: exact issue, steps taken, documented outcome.

Chapter 44 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Manual action	A penalty applied after human review at Google
Reconsideration request	Asking Google to review after fixing issues
Unnatural links	Artificial or manipulative links
Good-faith effort	A genuine attempt to fix a problem
Algorithmic change	A ranking change from automated systems

Chapter 44 Quiz

1. Where do you see manual actions?

- A) Search Console's Manual actions report
- B) GA4
- C) Moz
- D) Email spam folder

2. What should you do before disavowing for a manual action?

- A) Buy new links
- B) Make a good-faith effort to remove the links
- C) Delete the website
- D) Nothing

3. What does Google say about resubmitting while a request is pending?

- A) Resubmit weekly
- B) Don't resubmit while pending
- C) Resubmit daily
- D) It's required

4. A good reconsideration request includes...

- A) The exact issue, steps taken and documented outcome
- B) A list of competitors
- C) A payment
- D) Only an apology

5. "Unnatural links from your site" means...

- A) Your site is slow
- B) Your site has paid or manipulative outbound links

- C) Bad links pointing to you
- D) Missing alt text

6. After a manual action is lifted, do rankings always return to before?

- A) Not necessarily
- B) Yes, always
- C) Only for health sites
- D) They double

7. How long do link-related reviews take?

- A) Exactly one hour
- B) A year minimum
- C) Minutes
- D) Several days or weeks, sometimes longer

8. Algorithmic drops come with a Search Console notice?

- A) Only for links
- B) Only in Europe
- C) No
- D) Yes

9. Should you disavow organic links?

- A) Only nofollow ones
- B) No
- C) Only good ones
- D) Yes, all of them

10. In the traffic analogy, a manual action is…

- A) A camera challan
- B) A parking spot
- C) A challan written by a person after seeing the violation
- D) A free pass

Sources

1. Google Search Console Help, Manual Actions report
2. Google Search Central, Spam policies for Google web search (last updated August 28, 2026)
3. Google Search Central, Spam updates (last updated December 10, 2025)

Answer key, Chapter 44: 1-A · 2-B · 3-B · 4-A · 5-B · 6-A · 7-D · 8-C · 9-B · 10-C

Chapter 45: Negative SEO: Defending Ongo

What to do when strange spam links appear, and why panic is usually the wrong response.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> In 2024, Google's John Mueller said Google's systems are really good at dealing with **random spammy links**, and suggested site owners **ignore** link spam, adding that Google ignores it too. [1][2] 🟡 Google spokesperson
>
> The most common "negative SEO attack" is just the normal background noise of the internet.

45.1 What is negative SEO?

Negative SEO means someone deliberately tries to harm a site's rankings, for example by pointing thousands of spammy links at it, scraping its content, or filing fake complaints.

Type	Example
Spam link attack	Thousands of links from casino, adult or pill sites
Content scraping	Copying Ongo's pages onto other domains
Fake reviews	One-star reviews from fake accounts
Impersonation	Fake "Ongo" social profiles or sites
Hacking	Injecting spam into Ongo's own site

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: mohalle mein afwah**
>
> Kisi ne mohalle mein afwah faila di ki "Sharma ji ki dukaan ka samaan nakli hai." Jo log Sharma ji ko saalon se jaante hain, unhe fark nahi padta. **Mazboot reputation afwah se nahi tootti.** Lekin agar koi dukaan ke andar ghus ke kuch kharab kar de (hacking), toh turant action chahiye.

45.2 Spam link attacks: the calm response

Step	Action	Why
1	**Don't panic**	Google largely ignores random spam links [1][2] 🟡

Step	Action	Why
2	Check **Manual actions** in Search Console	A real problem shows there 🟢 [3]
3	Check rankings and traffic trends	Any real impact?
4	Log the pattern in the sheet (dates, domains, anchors)	Evidence if needed later
5	Only if a manual action appears: follow Chapter 44	Disavow becomes relevant then [4] 🟢

> 📝 **Note to remember:** Google says links to URLs that **404** on your site are already dropped, and to ignore link spam pointing to them. [2] 🟡

45.3 When to take action

Situation	Action
Random spam links, no manual action, no traffic drop	**Ignore**; log it
Manual action for unnatural links	Chapter 44 process
Ongo's site hacked (spam pages appearing on our domain)	**Urgent**: alert dev/IT immediately; Google's security guidance applies
Our content scraped and outranking us	Report copyright issues through proper channels; ask legal
Fake reviews	Report through the review platform's tools; reply calmly
Impersonating profiles or sites	Report to the platform; escalate to legal

🔵 *Expert judgment, consistent with [1][2][3].*

45.4 Prevention: the best defence

Defence	Why
A strong, clean link profile	Makes noise irrelevant
Monthly audits (Chapter 38)	Spot unusual patterns early
Site security (updates, strong passwords, 2FA)	Hacking is the real danger
Brand monitoring (Chapter 23)	Catch impersonation and scraping
Our own clean history	No old paid links that look like part of a pattern

45.5 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Check Manual actions before reacting	Disavow every spam link immediately
Log unusual patterns	Panic at tool "toxic" alerts
Treat hacking as urgent	Treat random spam as urgent
Report impersonation	Attack competitors back

45.6 Pros and cons of the "mostly ignore" approach

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
Saves time and avoids harmful over-reaction	Feels passive
Follows Google's public guidance	Rare real attacks still need attention

45.7 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 45 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Disavowing thousands of spam domains	Tool alerts	Checking Manual actions first	Correcting the file with team lead
Ignoring a hack	Thinking it's "just links"	Distinguishing links vs hacked pages	Escalating urgently
Blaming negative SEO for every drop	Easy excuse	Chapter 46 diagnosis	Re-diagnosing

45.8 Thumb rules

> 👍 Spam links pointing at us: usually ignore. Spam pages on our site: emergency.
>
> 👍 Manual actions report first, reaction second.
>
> 👍 Strong reputation is the best defence.

45.9 Notes to remember

> 📝 Google (2024): ignore link spam; Google ignores it too.
>
> 📝 Links to 404 pages are already dropped.

Chapter 45 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Negative SEO	Attempts to harm a site's rankings
Scraping	Copying content from another site
Impersonation	Pretending to be another brand
Hacking	Unauthorized access to a website
2FA	Two-factor authentication

Chapter 45 Quiz

1. What does Google say about random spammy links?

- A) Disavow all daily
- B) Its systems are good at dealing with them; generally ignore them
- C) They boost rankings
- D) They always cause penalties

2. What should you check first after noticing spam links?

- A) Domain age
- B) Social media
- C) The Manual actions report
- D) Competitor rankings

3. Spam pages appear on Ongo's own site. What is it?

- A) An urgent hacking issue
- B) Negative anchor text
- C) Normal noise
- D) Good for SEO

4. Links to URLs that 404 on your site are...

- A) Platinum links

- B) Very dangerous
- C) Required
- D) Already dropped, per Google

5. When does disavow become relevant in negative SEO?

- A) Always
- B) Never
- C) If a manual action for unnatural links appears
- D) When DA drops

6. What's the best long-term defence?

- A) Hiding the website
- B) A strong, clean link profile and regular audits
- C) Disavowing everything
- D) Attacking competitors

7. Fake one-star reviews appear. What do you do?

- A) Post fake five-star reviews
- B) Threaten reviewers
- C) Delete the business
- D) Report through the platform's tools and reply calmly

8. Should you blame negative SEO for every ranking drop?

- A) No; diagnose properly first
- B) Only on Mondays
- C) Only for health sites
- D) Yes

9. Someone creates a fake "Ongo" social profile. Action?

- A) Ignore
- B) Follow it
- C) Report to the platform and escalate to legal
- D) Copy it

10. In the rumour analogy, what protects Sharma ji?

- A) Shouting back
- B) Starting rumours about others
- C) Closing the shop
- D) A strong, long-standing reputation

Sources

1. Search Engine Journal, Google on spammy backlinks (March 2024)
2. Search Engine Roundtable, Google: ignore link spam, including to 404 pages (April 2024)
3. Google Search Console Help, Manual Actions report
4. Google Search Console Help, Disavow links to your site

Answer key, Chapter 45: 1-B · 2-C · 3-A · 4-D · 5-C · 6-B · 7-D · 8-A · 9-C · 10-D

Chapter 46: Reading Google Updates

Rankings dropped. Was it our links, our content, a Google update, or nothing at all? Here's how to tell.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> Google confirmed that its **June** and **August 2026** spam updates did **not** target link spam or site reputation abuse; those are handled by separate systems. [1][2] 🟠
>
> So if Ongo's rankings dropped in August 2026, "our backlinks" wasn't the first suspect. Reading the update correctly saves weeks of wrong work.

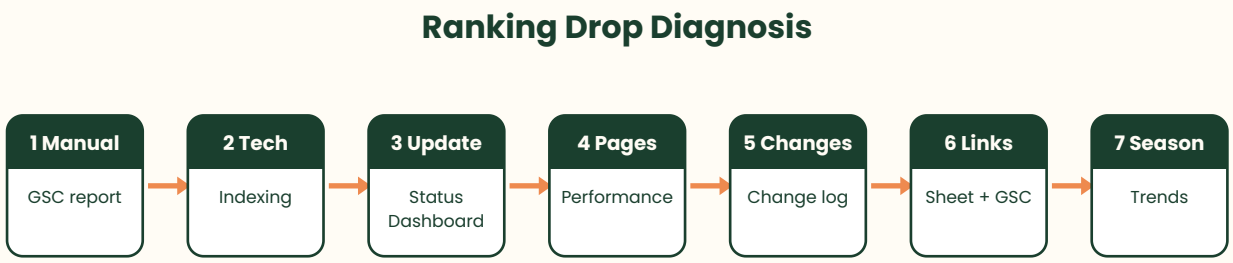
46.1 Types of Google updates

Update type	What it does	Link-related?
Core update	Broad changes to ranking systems, several times a year; not aimed at specific sites [3] 🟢	Indirectly (overall quality)
Spam update	Improves spam detection (SpamBrain) [4] 🟢	Sometimes; only if it targets link spam
Link spam update	Specifically targets link spam; neutralized benefit can't be regained [4] 🟢	**Yes**
Smaller unannounced updates	Google makes changes continuously [3] 🟢	Unknown

Google lists confirmed updates on its **Search Status Dashboard** (ranking updates history). [3] 🟢

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: monsoon vs pipe leak**
>
> Ghar mein paani aa gaya. Kya poore shehar mein baarish hui (Google update)? Ya sirf tumhari pipe leak hai (tumhari site ki problem)? **Pehle khidki se bahar dekho, phir plumber bulao.**

46.2 The diagnosis flowchart



Look out the window before calling the plumber.

Step	Question	How to check
1	Is there a **manual action**?	Search Console → Manual actions
2	Is there a **technical problem** (pages not indexed, site down, robots.txt, redirects)?	Search Console Pages/indexing reports, URL Inspection
3	Did a **Google update** run at the same time? What did it target?	Search Status Dashboard + reputable reporting
4	Which **pages and queries** dropped?	Search Console Performance, compare periods
5	Did **we** change something (content, URLs, internal links)?	Team change log
6	Did we **lose important links**?	Sheet + GSC Links report
7	Is it **seasonal** or a demand change?	Same period last year; Google Trends

Order based on Google's guidance for assessing core update impact [3] 🟢 and expert judgment 🔵.

46.3 Assessing a core update properly

Google's advice: [3] 🟢

1. Wait until the update has **finished rolling out** (check the dashboard).
2. Wait **at least a week** after it ends.
3. Compare that week to the **week before the rollout began**.
4. A **small** position drop usually needs no drastic action; a **large, sustained** drop warrants deeper review.
5. Improvements can take **days to months** to show; Google doesn't guarantee results.

46.4 When is it about links?

Sign	Likely link-related?
The update is announced as a **link spam update**	**Yes, possibly**
A **manual action** for unnatural links	**Yes**
Pages that relied on **paid or manipulative links** dropped	Likely
The update explicitly **excluded** link spam (e.g. June/Aug 2026 spam updates)	**No**; look elsewhere [1][2] 🟠
A core update hit pages with thin or unhelpful content	Probably content quality, not links 🔵

> 📝 **Note to remember:** Clean, earned links don't usually "cause" drops. If Ongo has only earned links, a ranking drop is almost always about something else: content, technical issues, competition, or demand. 🔵

46.5 The 2026 update calendar (so far)

Update	Dates (approx.)	Targeted links?
March 2026 spam update	Started March 24, 2026 [5] 🟠	Not specified by Google
March 2026 core update	March 27 – April 8, 2026 [5] 🟠	Broad
May 2026 core update	Started May 21, 2026 [5] 🟠	Broad
June 2026 spam update	Late June 2026 [1] 🟠	**No** (confirmed)
August 2026 spam update	Started August 18, 2026 [2] 🟠	**No** (confirmed)
September 2026 spam update	Started September 24, 2026 [5] 🟠	Not specified

Always verify on Google's Search Status Dashboard; reporting summaries may differ slightly.

46.6 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Check Manual actions and technical issues first	Blame backlinks first
Wait for rollouts to finish	Make big changes mid-update
Read what an update targeted	Assume every update is about links
Compare week-before vs week-after	Compare random days

46.7 Pros and cons of a structured diagnosis

✅ Pros	❌ Cons
Prevents wrong fixes (like disavowing good links)	Takes patience
Faster recovery when the real cause is found	Some drops have no clear cause

46.8 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 46 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Disavowing after every drop	Fear	Flowchart step 1	Correcting the disavow file
Reacting on day 2 of a rollout	Panic	Waiting for rollout end + 1 week	Rolling back hasty changes
Ignoring technical issues	"I'm off-page"	Checking indexing reports	Escalating to dev

46.9 Thumb rules

👍 Look out the window before calling the plumber.

👍 Read what an update targeted before blaming links.

👍 Rollout finished + one week, then compare.

46.10 Notes to remember

📝 Core updates: broad; spam updates: SpamBrain; link spam updates: lost benefit can't be regained.

📝 June and August 2026 spam updates did not target link spam.

Chapter 46 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Core update	A broad change to Google's ranking systems
Spam update	An improvement to spam detection
Rollout	The period an update takes to apply fully
Search Status Dashboard	Google's list of confirmed ranking updates

Term	Simple meaning
Seasonality	Predictable demand changes by time of year

Chapter 46 Quiz

1. What's the first check after a ranking drop?

- A) Buy new links
- B) Disavow links
- C) Change the logo
- D) The Manual actions report

2. Did Google say the August 2026 spam update targeted link spam?

- A) Google never comments
- B) No
- C) Yes
- D) Only in the US

3. How long should you wait after a core update finishes before comparing?

- A) Five years
- B) One hour
- C) No need to wait
- D) At least a week

4. Which update type means lost link benefit can't be regained?

- A) Image update
- B) Core update
- C) Page experience update
- D) Link spam update

5. Where does Google list confirmed ranking updates?

- A) Moz blog
- B) GA4
- C) Bing
- D) Search Status Dashboard

6. If Ongo has only clean, earned links and rankings drop, the cause is likely...

- A) Those links
- B) Google hating health sites
- C) PageRank removal
- D) Something else: content, technical, competition or demand

7. Small position drops after a core update usually need…

- A) Disavowing everything
- B) No drastic action
- C) Drastic action
- D) Deleting the site

8. Which step checks seasonality?

- A) Checking logos
- B) Checking DA
- C) Comparing with the same period last year and Google Trends
- D) Counting anchors

9. Should you make big changes in the middle of a rollout?

- A) No; wait for it to finish
- B) Yes
- C) Only for links
- D) Only on Fridays

10. In the monsoon analogy, "looking out the window" means…

- A) Ignoring the problem
- B) Calling the plumber immediately
- C) Checking whether a Google-wide update happened
- D) Buying a new house

Sources

1. TechWyse, Google June 2026 spam update
2. Relevant Audience, Google rolls out the August 2026 spam update: not links, not site reputation abuse
3. Google Search Central, Google Search's core updates
4. Google Search Central, Spam updates (last updated December 10, 2025)
5. Coalition Technologies, Will another Google core update come after the September 2026 spam update? (October 2026); Search Engine Roundtable, March 2026 core update

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Answer key, Chapter 46: 1-D · 2-B · 3-D · 4-D · 5-D · 6-D · 7-B · 8-C · 9-A · 10-C

LEVEL 4 · CHAPTER 47

Chapter 47: Myths That Waste Years

Twenty beliefs that sound true, spread fast, and quietly waste careers, each checked against evidence.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> Google added a whole section to its SEO Starter Guide in 2024 about ideas people **shouldn't focus on**, because the same myths kept circulating for years. [1][2] ● Google official
>
> If Google felt it needed to write myth-busting into its beginner guide, imagine how many freshers are still following them.

47.1 The myth table

#	Myth	Reality	Evidence
1	"DA is Google's score"	DA is Moz's metric; Google doesn't use it	● [3]
2	"More links = higher rankings"	Links are one signal among many; Google says it needs very few links to rank pages	● [1] ● [4]
3	"Nofollow links are useless"	They're hints, and bring traffic and brand	● [5] ●
4	"Disavow regularly to stay safe"	Most sites don't need it; misuse can harm	● [6]
5	"Social likes boost rankings"	Google says likes aren't a ranking factor	● [7]
6	"E-E-A-T is a ranking factor"	Google says it isn't, itself	● [1]
7	"Exact-match anchors are best"	Optimized anchors in guest posts/press releases are link spam	● [8]
8	"Guest posting is dead"	Guest posting **for links** is risky; for readers, it's fine	● [8] ●
9	"Directories are always spam"	Low-quality ones are; curated, relevant ones can be fine	● [8] ●
10	"PageRank no longer exists"	It's evolved and still part of core ranking	● [9]
11	"You need an llms.txt for AI search"	Google Search doesn't use it	● [10]
12	"AEO/GEO replaced SEO"	Google says it's still SEO	● [10]
13	"Fake mentions get you into AI answers"	Inauthentic mentions aren't as helpful as they seem	● [10]
14	"Spammy links from others will penalize you"	Google says it ignores random link spam	● [11]

#	Myth	Reality	Evidence
15	"You can buy links if they look natural"	Paid followed links are link spam	[8]
16	"A link spam penalty can be undone fully"	Neutralized link benefit can't be regained	[12]
17	"Google gives health sites special treatment"	YMYL gets **stricter** trust standards, not a shortcut	[13]
18	"Keywords in the domain help a lot"	Hardly any effect	[1]
19	"There's a perfect word count"	Length alone doesn't matter	[1]
20	"Somebody at Google can boost us"	Google doesn't accept payment to rank	[14]

> 🍛 **Desi analogy: dadi maa ke nuskhe**
>
> Kuch dadi maa ke nuskhe kaam karte hain (haldi doodh). Kuch nahi (bukhar mein nazar utaarna). **Problem tab hai jab dono ko ek jaisa bharosa milta hai.**
>
> SEO myths bhi aise hi hain. Har "tip" ko evidence se check karo.

47.2 How to check any new "tip"

Step	Question
1	**Who said it?** Google docs, a Google employee, a study, or a random post?
2	**When?** Before or after the latest relevant updates? (Chapter 5)
3	**Does it match Google's spam policies?**
4	**Is someone selling something?**
5	**Would it work for a YMYL health brand, specifically?**

> 👍 **Thumb rule:** No source, no date, no trust.

47.3 Ongo-specific myths

Myth	Reality
"Competitors say 'same as Wegovy,' so we can too"	FDA letters targeted exactly that (Chapter 12)

Myth	Reality
"Reviews are just marketing"	FTC and Google have strict review rules (Chapters 12, 33)
"Telehealth must have a Google Business Profile"	Online-only businesses aren't eligible (Chapter 33)
"AI headshots for authors are fine"	Fabricated creator profiles are deception (Chapter 28)

47.4 Do's and Don'ts

✅ Do	❌ Don't
Check every tip's source and date	Trust viral threads
Prefer Google's docs for Google claims	Trust sellers' screenshots
Update your beliefs when evidence changes	Defend old habits

47.5 Where freshers go wrong in Chapter 47 topics

Mistake	Why it happens	Avoid it by	Fix it by
Repeating myths in reports	Copying seniors	Citing sources	Correcting reports
Believing sales pitches	Confident language	Step 4 of the tip check	Asking team lead

47.6 Thumb rules

> 👍 No source, no date, no trust.
>
> 👍 Google's own docs beat anyone's opinion about Google.

47.7 Notes to remember

> 📝 Twenty myths, each with a source. Re-read this chapter every six months.

Chapter 47 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
Myth	A popular belief not supported by evidence
Source	Where a claim comes from
Evidence label	This book's 🟢 🟡 🟠 🔵 system

Chapter 47 Quiz

1. Is DA Google's score?

- A) No; it's Moz's
- B) Only for health
- C) Only in AI Mode
- D) Yes

2. Are nofollow links useless?

- A) They're illegal
- B) Yes
- C) No; they're hints and bring traffic and brand
- D) They hurt rankings

3. Does Google Search use llms.txt?

- A) Only in Europe
- B) Only for news
- C) Yes
- D) No

4. Is E-E-A-T itself a ranking factor?

- A) Yes
- B) No, per Google
- C) Only on Bing
- D) Only for YMYL

5. Should you disavow regularly to stay safe?

- A) No; most sites don't need it
- B) Daily
- C) Weekly
- D) Yes

6. Can someone at Google boost Ongo for payment?

- A) Yes
- B) Only via ads
- C) Only big brands
- D) No; Google doesn't accept payment to rank

7. Is guest posting completely dead?

- A) Only on weekends
- B) No; guest posting for links is risky, for readers it's fine
- C) Yes
- D) Only for health

8. Do keywords in the domain help a lot?

- A) Only .com
- B) Required
- C) Hardly any effect, per Google
- D) Yes, hugely

9. First question when checking any SEO tip?

- A) Is it free?
- B) Is it popular?
- C) Is it short?
- D) Who said it?

10. In the dadi maa analogy, what's the problem?

- A) Nothing
- B) Haldi doodh
- C) All remedies are wrong
- D) Useful and useless advice get equal trust

Sources

1. Google Search Central, SEO Starter Guide: things we believe you shouldn't focus on (last updated December 10, 2025)
2. Google Search Central Blog, The SEO Starter Guide got a makeover (February 2, 2024)
3. Search Engine Journal, Domain authority: is it a Google ranking factor?
4. Search Engine Journal, Google needs very few links to rank pages (April 2024)
5. PPC Land, nofollow
6. Google Search Console Help, Disavow links to your site
7. Search Engine Journal, Social signals and SEO
8. Google Search Central, Spam policies for Google web search (last updated August 28, 2026)
9. Google Search Central, A guide to Google Search ranking systems (last updated December 10, 2025)

10. Google Search Central, Optimizing your website for generative AI features on Google Search (last updated July 10, 2026)
11. Search Engine Roundtable, Google: ignore link spam (April 2024)
12. Google Search Central, Spam updates (last updated December 10, 2025)
13. Google Search Central, Creating helpful, reliable, people-first content (last updated October 5, 2026)
14. Google Search Central, In-depth guide to how Google Search works (last updated December 18, 2025)

Answer key, Chapter 47: 1-A · 2-C · 3-D · 4-B · 5-A · 6-D · 7-B · 8-C · 9-D · 10-D

Chapter 48: The ZETA Model: Zero-Error Tolerance Approach

Some mistakes cost a day. Some cost the business. ZETA is how a fresher avoids the second kind, every single time.

> 💡 **Trivia**
>
> Google says that when a link spam update removes the effect of spammy links, **any ranking benefit those links generated is lost and cannot be regained**. [1] 🟢 Google official
>
> Most SEO mistakes are fixable. A few are not. ZETA exists for those few.

48.1 What is ZETA?

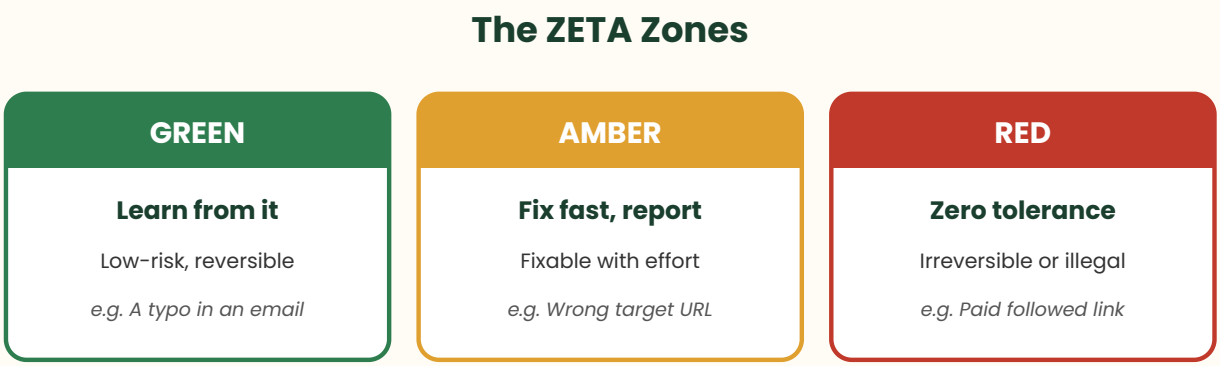
ZETA = Zero-Error Tolerance Approach. It's Ongo's rulebook for the mistakes that must **never** happen, because they're irreversible, dangerous for patients, or legally risky.

> 📝 **Note to remember:** ZETA is Ongo's internal training model, built from the rules in this book. It's not a Google term. 🔵

ZETA doesn't mean "never make mistakes." Typos, a slow outreach week, a rejected pitch: those are normal. ZETA means: **for a short list of critical mistakes, the tolerance is zero.**

> 🪔 **Desi analogy: operation theatre**
>
> Hospital mein receptionist se naam ki spelling galat ho jaaye, chalega, theek kar lenge. **Operation theatre mein galat side ka operation? Zero tolerance.** Isliye wahan checklist, double-check aur "time-out" hota hai.
>
> Off-page SEO mein bhi kuch kaam receptionist wale hain, kuch operation theatre wale. **ZETA batata hai kaunse kaun se hain.**

48.2 The ZETA zones



When in doubt: stop, check, confirm, record, then proceed.

Zone	Meaning	Tolerance	Example
🟢 **Green**	Low-risk, reversible	Learn from mistakes	A typo in an outreach email
🟠 **Amber**	Medium risk; fixable with effort	Fix fast, report it	Wrong target URL on a live link
🔴 **Red (ZETA zone)**	Irreversible, dangerous or illegal	**Zero tolerance**	Buying a followed link; a "same as Wegovy" claim

48.3 The ZETA Red List: never, ever

#	Never do this	Why it's zero-tolerance	Chapter
1	Pay, gift or trade for a **followed** link	Link spam; benefit can't be regained [1][2]	6
2	Place **sameness, FDA-approval or guarantee** claims about our medications anywhere	FDA misleading-claims risk; patient safety	12
3	Publish health content **without medical review**	YMYL accuracy; patient safety	12
4	Create **fake people**, fake credentials or fake patient stories	Deception per Google; FTC rules [3][4]	12, 28
5	Write, buy, incentivize or **gate reviews**	FTC rule; Google review policy [4][5]	33
6	Use **PBNs, link farms, parasite SEO** or expired-domain tricks	Spam policies; manual actions [2]	43
7	Create a Google Business Profile with a **fake or virtual address**	GBP eligibility rules [6]	33
8	Upload a **disavow file** without team lead approval	Can harm the site if misused [7]	38

#	Never do this	Why it's zero-tolerance	Chapter
9	Reveal **patient information** (even "confirming" someone is a patient)	Health privacy	33
10	Send commercial email **ignoring opt-outs** or without a real identity/address	CAN-SPAM penalties [8]	30
11	Pose as a patient or hide your Ongo connection in communities	FTC disclosure; platform rules [9]	25
12	Change or delete Ongo **URLs with backlinks** without redirects	Lost links; broken patient journeys	23

48.4 Dangerous situations: the warning signs

These are the moments freshers most often slip into the red zone. When you see one, **slow down**.

Warning sign	What it usually means
Someone says **"Google can't detect this"**	A link scheme is being sold
A price list for **"dofollow"** or **"permanent"** links	Link selling
"Editorial fee," "admin fee," "niche edit"	Paid link in disguise
"Everyone in our industry does it"	Copying a competitor's risk
"It's just a small bio / short post"	Skipping medical review
"We need it live today"	Pressure skipping checks
"Just say you're a patient, it's more natural"	Deception
"Give them a discount for a review"	Incentivized review
"Use a co-working address for the listing"	Fake GBP address
A sudden ranking drop and someone says "disavow everything"	Panic reaction
A message from a "Google partner" promising rankings	Scam

48.5 The "stop and ask your team lead" rules

Stop and ask before you act in any of these situations:

#	Situation
1	Any money, gift, product or service is involved in getting a link
2	Any health claim, treatment description or result is involved
3	Any medication brand name (Wegovy, Ozempic, Zepbound, Mounjaro...) appears in content we place

#	Situation
4	You're unsure whether a site is a PBN, link farm or link seller
5	Any request involves a doctor's name, quote or credentials
6	Any review-related activity beyond a neutral request to all patients
7	Any disavow, redirect or URL change
8	Any Google Business Profile or address decision
9	Any manual action, security warning or hacking sign
10	Anything that would embarrass Ongo if a patient, journalist or regulator saw it

> 👍 **Thumb rule:** If you have to ask yourself "Is this okay?", the answer is "Ask your team lead."

48.6 The ZETA time-out (30 seconds before any red-zone-adjacent action)

Borrowed from operating theatres: a short pause before acting.

Step	Ask yourself
1. Stop	Am I about to do something on the Red List?
2. Check	Has it passed the pre-creation checklist (Chapter 31)?
3. Confirm	Do I have medical review / team lead approval where required?
4. Record	Is it logged in the sheet with my name?
5. Proceed	Only if all four are yes

48.7 Where freshers make ZETA mistakes, and how to fix them

ZETA mistake	Why freshers make it	How to avoid it	If it already happened
Paid followed link	Vendor pressure, cheap offers	Red List #1; check 10 of the checklist	Tell team lead today; ask host to remove or label; log it
Sameness claim published	Copying competitors' wording	Red-word list	Ask for edit/removal; tell team lead and medical team
Unreviewed health content	Speed	Workflow (Chapter 12)	Pull it for review; replace with approved text

ZETA mistake	Why freshers make it	How to avoid it	If it already happened
Fake patient post	"Sounds natural"	Disclosure rule	Delete; tell team lead
Incentivized review	Wanting reviews fast	Review rules	Stop the offer; tell team lead and compliance
Fake address listing	Copying tutorials	GBP eligibility	Tell team lead immediately
Disavow without approval	Panic	Red List #8	Tell team lead; correct the file
URL changed without redirect	Not knowing	Redirect list rule	Send redirect list to dev today

📝 **Note to remember:** The worst ZETA mistake is **hiding** a ZETA mistake. Reporting early almost always makes it smaller. 🔵

48.8 ZETA in one page (pin this to your desk)

ZETA	
Never	Pay for followed links · make drug claims · skip medical review · fake people or reviews · use PBNs/parasite SEO · fake addresses · disavow alone · reveal patient info · ignore opt-outs · hide your Ongo connection · break URLs
Always	Run the checklist · log before you act · disclose connections · label paid links · get medical review · ask when unsure · report mistakes immediately
Ask your team lead when	Money, health claims, brand-name drugs, doctors, reviews, disavow, URLs, GBP, penalties, or anything embarrassing

48.9 Thumb rules

👍 Receptionist mistakes are fine. Operation theatre mistakes are not.

👍 When in doubt, stop and ask.

👍 Report mistakes early; never hide them.

48.10 Notes to remember

> 📝 ZETA = Zero-Error Tolerance Approach: twelve Red List items, eleven warning signs, ten stop-and-ask rules.
>
> 📝 Some damage can't be undone, so prevention is the whole game.

Chapter 48 Glossary

Term	Simple meaning
ZETA	Zero-Error Tolerance Approach: Ongo's rules for zero-tolerance mistakes
Red List	Actions that are never allowed
Warning sign	A phrase or situation that signals danger
Stop-and-ask rule	A situation requiring team lead approval first
Time-out	A 30-second pause before risky actions

Chapter 48 Quiz

1. What does ZETA stand for?

- A) Zone of Extra Traffic Authority
- B) Zonal Entity Trust Algorithm
- C) Zero-Error Tolerance Approach
- D) Zero Effort Traffic Acquisition

2. Which is on the ZETA Red List?

- A) A typo in an email
- B) A rejected pitch
- C) Paying for a followed link
- D) A slow week

3. Someone says "Google can't detect this." What does it usually mean?

- A) A new algorithm
- B) Google approval
- C) A safe tactic
- D) A link scheme being sold

4. What should you do if you've made a ZETA mistake?

- A) Delete the sheet
- B) Report it to your team lead immediately
- C) Hide it
- D) Wait for someone to notice

5. Which situation requires stopping to ask your team lead?

- A) Any medication brand name appearing in content we place
- B) Reading an article
- C) Updating your own notes
- D) Sending a thank-you email

6. What's the first step of the ZETA time-out?

- A) Celebrate
- B) Proceed
- C) Stop: am I about to do something on the Red List?
- D) Record

7. "Just say you're a patient, it's more natural." This is...

- A) Digital PR
- B) Required
- C) Good community practice
- D) A warning sign of deception

8. Which zone is "wrong target URL on a live link"?

- A) None
- B) Amber
- C) Red
- D) Green

9. Is ZETA a Google term?

- A) It's an FDA rule
- B) It's an FTC rule
- C) No; it's Ongo's internal training model
- D) Yes

10. In the operation theatre analogy, what's zero-tolerance?

- A) A late lunch
- B) A spelling mistake at reception
- C) A misplaced pen
- D) Operating on the wrong side

Sources

1. Google Search Central, Spam updates (last updated December 10, 2025)
2. Google Search Central, Spam policies for Google web search (last updated August 28, 2026)
3. Google Search Central, Creating helpful, reliable, people-first content (last updated October 5, 2026)
4. Federal Trade Commission, Final rule banning fake reviews and testimonials (August 14, 2024)
5. Google Maps User Contributed Content Policy, Prohibited & restricted content
6. Google Business Profile Help, Business eligibility and ownership guidelines
7. Google Search Console Help, Disavow links to your site
8. Federal Trade Commission, CAN-SPAM Act: A Compliance Guide for Business
9. Venable, FTC finalizes updated Endorsement and Testimonial Guides (July 5, 2023)

Answer key, Chapter 48: 1-C · 2-C · 3-D · 4-B · 5-A · 6-C · 7-D · 8-B · 9-C · 10-D

Back Matter

Master Checklists

Checklist 1: Website vetting (Chapters 11, 16)

☐	Check
☐	Eyeball score 13+/16
☐	`site:domain.com` shows indexed pages
☐	Organic traffic 500+/month and not crashing
☐	No link price list, "editorial fee," "permanent dofollow" or "niche edit" offers
☐	No PBN footprints (Wayback mismatch, random topics, client-style outbound links)
☐	Trust Flow at least ~half of Citation Flow
☐	Topical Trust Flow in health-related categories (for T1/T2)
☐	Not a bad neighbourhood for a health brand
☐	Relevance tier decided: T1 / T2 / T3 (NR = stop)

Checklist 2: Pre-creation (Chapter 31, short version)

☐	Check
☐	Site passed vetting
☐	A real patient might see this
☐	No payment/gift for a followed link (paid = sponsored/nofollow + disclosed)
☐	No teammate already working this site (Owner column)
☐	Medical review done for any health content (reviewer recorded)
☐	Red-word list checked
☐	Brand / URL / natural anchor
☐	Target page live, indexed, relevant
☐	Real people, real credentials, disclosure where needed
☐	Row logged with your name before submitting

Checklist 3: Post-creation / link went live (Chapter 32)

☐	Check
☐	Page loads publicly (incognito)
☐	Link present, correct URL (Inspect)
☐	rel recorded
☐	Anchor and placement recorded
☐	Our approved text unchanged
☐	Graded (Final score + grade)
☐	Host thanked
☐	Next check date set

Checklist 4: Monthly audit (Chapter 38)

☐	Check
☐	Re-check links due (by grade)
☐	Statuses updated
☐	GSC Top linking sites exported and compared with sheet
☐	New unknown domains eyeballed
☐	GSC Top linking text checked for spam anchors
☐	Ongo pages with backlinks return 200 (no 404s)
☐	Manual actions report checked
☐	AI prompt log updated
☐	Monthly report written (Chapter 41)

Templates

Template 1: Resource page suggestion

> **Subject:** Resource for your [topic] page
>
> Hi [Name], your "[page]" list is genuinely useful, especially [specific detail]. Our medical team at Ongo Weight Loss published a reviewed guide on [topic] that may help your readers: [URL]. No worries if it isn't a fit. Thanks for maintaining it.
>
> [Your name] · [Role], Ongo Weight Loss · [Business address] · If you'd prefer I don't follow up, just let me know.

Template 2: Broken link

> **Subject:** Broken link on your [page name] page
>
> Hi [Name], the link to [dead resource] on your [page] now shows an error. In case it helps, our medical team published a reviewed guide on the same topic: [URL]. Happy to suggest other options too. Thanks for keeping the list up to date.

Template 3: Unlinked mention

> **Subject:** Thank you for mentioning Ongo
>
> Hi [Name], thanks for mentioning Ongo Weight Loss in "[Title]." If useful for your readers, you could link our name to [relevant page]. Either way, thank you.

Template 4: Journalist response

> **Subject:** [Exactly what they asked for]
>
> Hi [Journalist], a comment from Dr. [Name], [credentials], at Ongo Weight Loss:
>
> "[2–4 approved, quotable sentences.]"
>
> Profile: [doctor page URL]. Happy to provide more detail or a headshot.

Template 5: Guest article pitch

> **Subject:** Article idea for [Site]: [topic]
>
> Hi [Name], I enjoyed [specific article]. I'd like to offer an original article for your readers: "[Title]," covering [3 points]. It would be written by [expert] at Ongo Weight Loss and medically reviewed, and published only on your site. Would this fit your plans?

Template 6: Podcast pitch

> **Subject:** Guest idea for [Show]: [topic]
>
> Hi [Host], I enjoyed your episode with [guest] on [topic]. Dr. [Name], [credentials], at Ongo Weight Loss could talk with your listeners about [topic 1], [topic 2] and [topic 3], keeping it practical and non-promotional. Would this fit an upcoming episode?

Template 7: Follow-up (one only)

> Hi [Name], just bringing this to the top of your inbox in case it's useful. If not, no problem at all, and I won't follow up again.

Template 8: Monthly manager report

Section	Content
Headline	[One sentence]
Output	Platinum __ · Gold __ · Silver __ · Bronze __ · Iron __
Best link	[60-second pitch, written]
Traffic	Referral visits __ · Key events __
AI visibility	Mention rate __% · GSC AI impressions __ (if available)
Risks	Lost __ · Changed __ · Red flags: [list]
Next month	1. __ 2. __ 3. __

Google Sheets Formula Cheat Sheet

Purpose	Formula
Final Link Score	`=IF(OR(M2="",L2=""),"",IF(L2="NR",0,ROUND(M2*IFS(L2="T1",1,L2="T2",0.85,L2="T3",0.7),0)))`
Grade	`=IF(N2="","",IFS(N2>=85,"Platinum",N2>=70,"Gold",N2>=55,"Silver",N2>=40,"Bronze",TRUE,"Iron"))`
Quality score from 8 checks	`=SUM(B2:I2)`
Next check date	`=IF(OR(R2="",O2=""),"",R2+IFS(O2="Platinum",30,O2="Gold",30,O2="Silver",90,TRUE,180))`

Purpose	Formula
Duplicate domain	`=IF(D2="","",IF(COUNTIF($D$2:$D,D2)>1,"DUPLICATE","OK"))`
Days since update	`=IF(R2="","",TODAY()-R2)`
Extract domain	`=REGEXEXTRACT(E2,"^(?:https?://)?(?:www\.)?([^/]+)")`
Overdue live checks	`=COUNTIFS(Links!S:S,"<"&TODAY(),Links!P:P,"Live")`
Live links this month	`=COUNTIFS(P:P,"Live",Q:Q,">="&EOMONTH(TODAY(),-1)+1)`
Live links by owner	`=COUNTIFS(B:B,"Your Name",P:P,"Live")`
Grade count by owner	`=COUNTIFS(B:B,"Your Name",O:O,"Gold")`
Average final score (live)	`=AVERAGEIFS(N:N,P:P,"Live")`
Per-owner summary	`=QUERY(Links!A:Z,"select B, count(A), avg(N) where P = 'Live' group by B",1)`
Your top link this month	`=SORTN(FILTER(Links!A2:Z,Links!B2:B="Your Name",Links!P2:P="Live",Links!Q2:Q>=EOMONTH(TODAY(),-1)+1),1,0,14,FALSE)`
Competitor overlap count	`=COUNTIF($B$2:$F$500,A2)`
Link gap flag	`=IF(COUNTIF(OngoDomains!A:A,A2)>0,"Already links","Gap")`
GSC domain not in sheet	`=IF(COUNTIF(Sheet!$D:$D,A2)=0,"New / not ours","Tracked")`
Outreach reply rate	`=COUNTIF(StatusRange,"Replied*")/COUNTA(EmailRange)`
AI mention rate (ChatGPT)	`=COUNTIFS(D:D,"Yes",B:B,"ChatGPT")/COUNTIF(B:B,"ChatGPT")`

Purpose	Formula
Paid + followed alert (conditional format)	`=AND($U2="Yes (sponsored)",$J2="Follow")`

Glossary (A to Z)

Term	Simple meaning	Ch.
2FA	Two-factor authentication	45
301 redirect	A permanent redirect from an old URL to a new one	23
302 redirect	A temporary redirect	23
404	Page not found	23
404 error	The "page not found" response	22
Advertorial	Paid content made to look like an article	6
AEO / GEO	Industry terms for AI-answer optimization	35
Ahrefs Webmaster Tools (AWT)	Ahrefs' free tool for sites you verify	10
AI Mode	Google's conversational AI search	35
AI Overview	AI-written summary at the top of some Google results	35
AI Overviews / AI Mode	Google's AI-generated answers in Search	1
AI portrait	An AI-generated image of a person	28
Algorithmic change	A ranking change from automated systems	44
Alt text	Text describing an image; used as anchor text for image links	7
Anchor profile	The mix of all anchors pointing to a site	14
Anchor text	The visible, clickable words of a link	7
Article spinning	Rewriting one article into many versions	21
Attribution	Deciding what caused a result	39
Audience map	A list of places where Ongo's patients read and talk	17
Author bio	The short description of the writer at the end	21

Term	Simple meaning	Ch.
Authority Score	Semrush's score combining links, traffic and spam signals	9
Backlink	A link from another website to yours	1
Backlink audit	Reviewing links pointing to a site	38
BackRub	The original name of Page and Brin's search project	4
Bad neighbourhood	A group of spammy sites linking to each other	11
Ban evasion	Creating new accounts after a ban; banned	25
Baseline	Your starting measurements, before new work	42
Bing Webmaster Tools	Bing's free version of Search Console	10
Bio	A short description of a person	29
Black-hat	Clear guideline violations	43
Branded anchor	The brand name as link text	14
Brand mention	Your brand name appearing on another site, with or without a link	3
Broken link	A link pointing to a page that no longer exists	22
Broken link building	Offering your page to replace a dead link	13
Canonical	The main version Google picks among duplicate pages	2
CAN-SPAM	US law on commercial email	30
Caveat	An honest limit on a claim	41
Channel group	GA4's grouping of traffic sources	36
Citable stat	One clear number others can quote	19
Citation	Your business name, address and phone listed on another site	3
Citation Flow	Majestic's link quantity/influence score	9
Cold outreach	Emailing someone you haven't contacted before	30
Commodity content	Generic content anyone could write	19
Compounded medication	A medication prepared by a pharmacy for a patient; not FDA-approved	12
Conditional formatting	Automatic colours based on cell values	40
Conflict of interest (COI)	Editing about something you're connected to	34
Contextual link	A link inside the main text, surrounded by relevant words	7

Term	Simple meaning	Ch.
Conversion rate	Actions ÷ visits	39
Core update	A broad change to Google's ranking systems	46
COUNTIFS	Counts rows matching several conditions	40
Coverage	An article mentioning Ongo	20
Crawling	Google's robot visiting and downloading pages	2
Credential	A qualification like MD, DO or RD	29
DA	Moz's Domain Authority, a predicted ranking strength score	9
Damping factor	The chance the random surfer stops following links and jumps elsewhere	4
Data aggregator	A company that distributes business data to many apps and maps	33
Data validation	Rules that limit what can be typed in a cell (e.g. dropdowns)	40
Deliverability	Whether emails reach the inbox	30
Description bank	A set of pre-approved descriptions	29
Devalue	Ignore a link's value without penalizing the whole site	5
Digital PR	Getting covered and quoted by journalists and publications	3
Disavow	Asking Google to ignore certain links pointing to your site	5
Disclosure	Telling people you're connected to Ongo	25
Discovery	Google finding a page for the first time	8
DR	Ahrefs' Domain Rating, a backlink profile strength score	9
Duplicate outreach	Two teammates contacting the same site	31
Earned link	A link someone gives because your content genuinely helps their readers	3
Editorial guidelines	A site's rules for accepting articles	21
Editorial link	A link a writer chooses to give because it helps readers	13
EEA	European Economic Area	5
E-E-A-T	Experience, Expertise, Authoritativeness, Trustworthiness	1
Embed code	Code that lets others display our chart with credit	19
Entity	A "thing" Google recognizes, like a brand, person or place	3
Entity consistency	Using the same brand details everywhere	28

Term	Simple meaning	Ch.
Evidence label	This book's 🟢🟡🟠🔵 system	47
Exact-match anchor	Link text identical to a target keyword	14
Expert roundup	An article collecting quotes from several experts	13
Expired domain abuse	Buying an old domain to repurpose it mainly for ranking manipulation	5
Eyeball test	Judging a site by looking at it, without tools	11
Fabricated profile	A fake person or false credentials	28
Fake indicators	Bought followers, likes or views	37
Filter view	A personal filtered view of a shared sheet	40
Final Link Score	Quality score × relevance multiplier	15
Follow / dofollow	Slang for a normal link without nofollow/sponsored/ugc	7
Footprint	A repeated pattern that reveals manipulation	14
FTC	US Federal Trade Commission, which regulates advertising	12
GA4	Google Analytics 4, used to measure visitors and actions	10
Generative AI performance report	A Search Console report showing performance in Google's AI features	8
Generic anchor	"Here," "this article," "click here"	14
GEO / AEO	Industry terms for optimizing for AI answers; Google says this is still SEO	1
Good-faith effort	A genuine attempt to fix a problem	44
Google Alerts	Free email alerts when a phrase appears online	23
Googlebot	Google's crawler program	2
Google Business Profile (GBP)	A business's listing on Google Search and Maps	33
Google index	Google's giant database of known pages	2
Google Lens	Google's visual search tool	24
Google Search Console (GSC)	Google's free tool showing how Google sees your site	10
Google Trends	Google's tool showing search interest over time	17
Gray-hat	Disguised manipulation	43
Group buy	Shared, resold access to paid tools, often against their terms	10
Guest pitch	A request to appear on a show	27

Term	Simple meaning	Ch.
Guest post	An article written for another site	21
Guest post package	A paid bundle of guest posts with links, usually link spam	21
Hacking	Unauthorized access to a website	45
href	The web address inside a link	7
Image license metadata	Data telling Google who made an image and how to license it	24
Image link	A link where the clickable item is an image	24
Impersonation	Pretending to be another brand	45
Inauthentic mention	A fake or paid mention made to look natural	6
Indexing	Google understanding and storing a page	2
Influencer	A social media creator with an audience	37
Journalist request	A reporter asking for expert input	20
Key event	An important action tracked in GA4 (e.g. booking)	39
Knowledge panel	Google's information box about an entity	34
Linkable asset	A page so useful others link to it naturally	19
Link equity / "link juice"	Industry slang for the value a link passes	4
Link exchange	Swapping links, risky when excessive	26
Link farm	A site existing mainly to sell or exchange links	11
Link gap	Sites linking to competitors but not to Ongo	18
Link reclamation	Recovering lost or broken links	23
Link spam	Links created mainly to manipulate rankings	3
Link spam update	A Google update specifically targeting manipulative links	5
Links report	GSC report of who links to your site	10
Live – changed	Still live, but something about it changed	32
llms.txt	A proposed file for AI tools; Google Search doesn't use it	35
Logarithmic scale	Each step up is harder than the one before	9
Manual action	A penalty applied after human review, shown in Search Console	6
Material connection	A relationship (payment, job, gift) that could affect an endorsement	12

Term	Simple meaning	Ch.
Medical review	A qualified clinician checking content for accuracy and safety	12
Mention rate	Share of checks where Ongo was mentioned	36
Misbranding	Marketing a drug with false or misleading claims	12
Moderator	A volunteer who enforces a community's rules	25
MozBar	Moz's browser extension showing DA/PA	10
Myth	A popular belief not supported by evidence	47
Naked URL	The web address itself as link text	14
NAP	Name, address, phone (Chapter 33)	29
Native ad	An ad designed to blend in with normal content	6
Negative SEO	Someone building bad links to harm a site (Chapter 45)	38
Niche edit	Inserting a link into an existing article, usually for payment	16
Nofollow	A label meaning "don't associate us with this link"	7
Non-commodity content	Content with unique expertise, data or experience	19
Off-page SEO	Building trust and visibility outside your website	1
On-page SEO	Improving what's on your own pages	1
Optimized anchor text	Link text stuffed with target keywords	6
Opt-out	A way to stop receiving emails	30
Organic results	Unpaid search results, earned through SEO	1
Outbound link	A link from a page to another page	4
Owner column	The sheet column showing who handles a link	31
PA	Moz's Page Authority, the same for one page	9
PageRank	Google's original link-based ranking system, still part of its core systems	1
Paid placement	A position in a list that was bought	18
Paid results / ads	Results a business pays for, marked "Sponsored"	1
Parasite SEO	Ranking content on someone else's strong site to borrow its authority	13
Partial-match anchor	Link text containing part of a keyword naturally	14
Partnership	A genuine business relationship	26

Term	Simple meaning	Ch.
PBN	Private blog network built to manipulate rankings	13
Penguin	Google's 2012 system against link spam, part of core since 2016	5
People also ask	Google's box of related questions	17
Persona	A simple profile of a typical patient	17
Phase	A stage of the plan with a theme	42
Pitch	A short message offering a story or comment	20
Platinum / Gold / Silver / Bronze / Iron	Ongo's link grades	15
Pre-creation checklist	Checks done before creating or requesting a link	31
Pre-qualified visitor	Someone already interested in the topic before arriving	8
Proactive PR	Creating and pitching your own stories	20
Prompt log	A record of AI questions and answers checked over time	36
Protected range	Cells only certain people can edit	40
Quality raters	People who give Google feedback on search quality; they don't change rankings	1
Quality score	0–100 score from the eight checks	15
QUERY	A Sheets function that summarizes data like a database	40
Query fan-out	The AI running several related searches to build one answer	2
Quick win	A low-effort, high-success task	42
Quote bank	Pre-approved expert statements ready for quick use	20
RAG	Retrieval-augmented generation: AI answers built from pages Google retrieves	2
Random surfer	An imaginary person clicking links at random, used to explain PageRank	4
Reactive PR	Responding to journalists' requests	20
Real-time	Evaluated continuously instead of in occasional refreshes	5
Reconsideration request	Asking Google to review a site after fixing a manual action	6
Red List	Actions that are never allowed	48
Red-word list	Phrases Ongo never uses off-site	12
Referral traffic	Visitors who arrive by clicking a link on another site	3

Term	Simple meaning	Ch.
Referrer	Information about which site sent a visitor	36
Referring domain	A unique website linking to a site	18
Referring domains	Unique websites linking to a site	16
Regex	A pattern for matching text	36
rel attribute	A label telling Google about the link relationship	7
Relevance tier	How related a site or page is to Ongo (T1, T2, T3, NR)	15
rel="sponsored"	Google's label for paid links	26
Removed	Was live, now gone	32
Rendering	Running a page's code (like JavaScript) to see it as a user would	2
Reply rate	Replies ÷ emails sent	30
Repurposing	Turning one piece of content into several formats	27
Resource page	A curated list of useful links on a topic	13
Reverse image search	Searching with an image to find where it appears	24
Review gating	Asking only happy customers for reviews	33
robots.txt	A file that tells crawlers which parts of a site not to visit	2
Rollout	The period an update takes to apply fully	46
sameAs	A property listing other official profiles of the same entity	34
Sameness claim	Saying a compounded drug is the same as a brand-name drug	12
Scaled content abuse	Mass-producing low-value pages to manipulate rankings	5
Scraping	Copying content from another site	45
Search competitor	A site ranking for the same topics as Ongo	18
Search engine	A website that finds pages answering your question	1
Search operator	A special search command like `site:` or `intitle:`	17
Search Status Dashboard	Google's page listing ranking updates	39
Seasonality	Regular ups and downs by time of year	39
SEO	Search Engine Optimization: helping search engines understand you and people find you	1

Term	Simple meaning	Ch.
Service-area business	A business that serves customers at their location	33
Serving	Choosing which pages to show for a search	2
Show notes	The episode description, often with guest links	27
Sidebar rules	A community's posted rules	25
Sitemap	A file listing a site's important URLs	2
Site reputation abuse	Using a trusted site's reputation to rank low-value third-party content	5
site: search	Typing `site:example.com` in Google to see pages it has indexed	2
Sitewide link	A link appearing on every page of a site (footer, sidebar)	13
Social signals	Likes, shares, followers on social media	37
SORTN / FILTER	Sheets functions to pick top rows by conditions	41
Source	Where a claim comes from	47
Source page	The page containing the link	7
SpamBrain	Google's AI-based spam-prevention system	5
Spam policies	Google's rules about manipulative tactics	6
Spam Score	Moz's estimate of spam-like features	9
Spam update	An improvement to spam detection	46
Speaker page	An event page listing speakers	27
SPF / DKIM / DMARC	Email authentication settings for a domain	30
Sponsored	A label for paid or advertising links	7
Sponsorship	Paying to support an event or organization, usually for visibility	26
Stalled	No reply after 30+ days	32
Status	Where a link is in its lifecycle	32
Stop-and-ask rule	A situation requiring team lead approval first	48
Stop rule	A check that, if failed, means stop and escalate	31
Structured data	Code that describes page information for search engines	34
Subreddit	A Reddit community on one topic	25
Substantiation	Evidence that backs up a claim	12

Term	Simple meaning	Ch.
Talking points	Key messages prepared before an interview	27
Target page	The page the link points to	7
Technical SEO	Making sure search engines can reach and read your site	1
Testimonial	A statement praising a product or service	26
Third-party content	Content on a site written or provided by someone else	6
Time-out	A 30-second pause before risky actions	48
Toolbar PageRank	The old public 0–10 score, removed in 2016	4
Topical Trust Flow	Majestic's topic categories for a site's trust	9
Top pages by links	A competitor's pages that earned the most links	18
Toxic score	A third-party tool's risk estimate (not Google's)	38
Transcript	Written text of a video's audio	37
Trust Flow	Majestic's link quality score based on trusted seed sites	9
UGC	User-generated content label	7
Under review	Submitted and waiting for the host	32
Unlinked mention	Your brand named without a link	13
Unnatural links	Artificial or manipulative links	44
UR	Ahrefs' URL Rating, the same for one page	9
Verified site	A site you've proven you own to a tool	10
Vetting	Checking whether a site is safe and valuable for a link	16
Vote manipulation	Artificially boosting posts; banned on Reddit	25
Warning sign	A phrase or situation that signals danger	48
Wayback Machine	An archive showing what a website looked like in the past	16
White-hat	Within search engine guidelines	43
Wikidata	A free knowledge base used by many systems	34
"Write for us" page	A page inviting guest posts	11
YMYL	"Your Money or Your Life": topics that can affect health, money or safety	1
ZETA	Zero-Error Tolerance Approach: Ongo's rules for zero-tolerance mistakes	48

MCQ Answer Keys (all chapters)

Try every quiz first, then turn the page upside down to check.

Chapter	Answers
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Earned, not built.

Links that last are the ones people choose to give. Every chapter in this book points back to one question: would a real, trusted source mention Ongo because it genuinely helps their readers?

Edition: October 2026. Policies, tools and limits change; every source is dated so you can recheck it.

Prepared by **Ashish Osten**, Team Lead, Ongo Weight Loss.

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